

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY

TEACHING MANUAL

Business Freelancing

Session Roadmap · Lesson Notes · Concept Diagrams · Answer Keys

READY TO TEACH

© 2026 Cyber Elias Academy · cea.ng

Table of Contents

Course Roadmap

Session 01 — Business Freelancing Foundations

Session 02 — Finding Your Market and Validating an Idea

Session 03 — Registration Legal and Money Basics

Session 04 — Pricing Your Work and Costing

Session 05 — Finding Your First Customers and Selling

Session 06 — Customer Service and Managing Clients

Session 07 — Invoicing Getting Paid and Basic Accounting

Session 08 — Digital Presence and Marketing for Small Business

Session 09 — Capstone Your Business and Freelance Plan

OVERVIEW

Course Roadmap

What we cover in every session

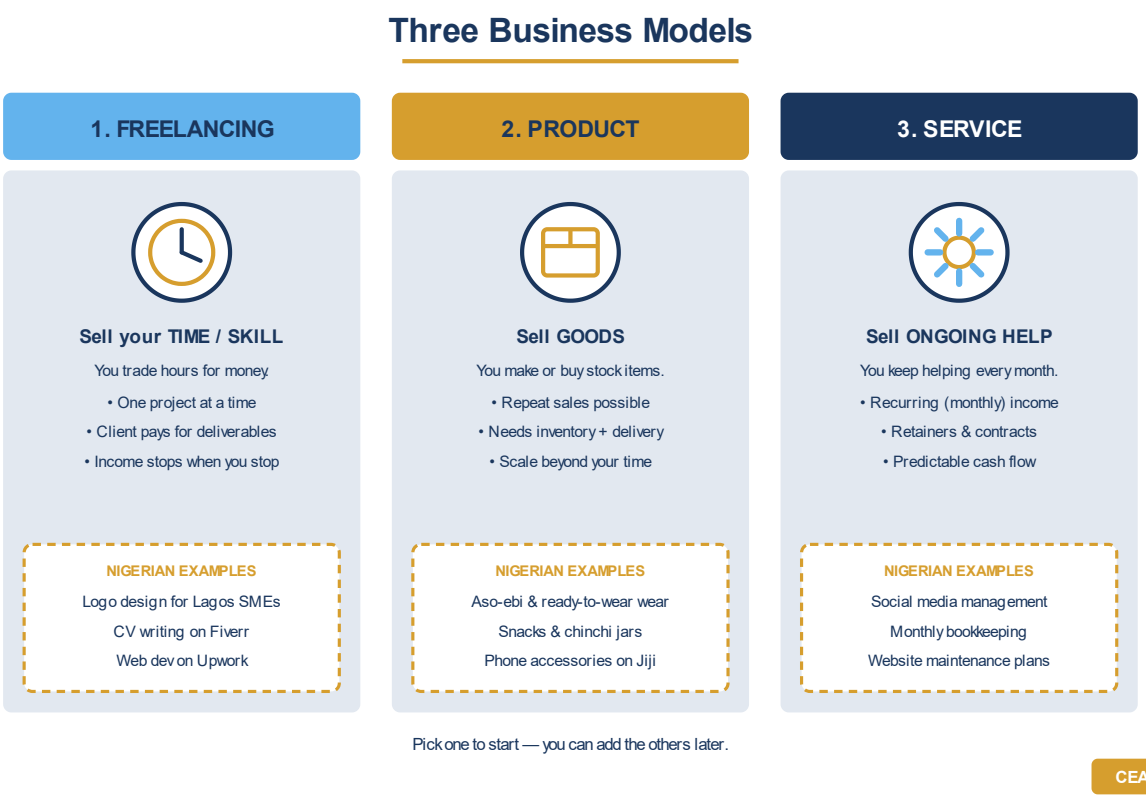
#	SESSION TOPIC	WEEK / MODULE	DURATION
01	Business Freelancing Foundations	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Start Right (Foundations)	105 minutes
02	Finding Your Market and Validating an Idea	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Start Right (Foundations)	105 minutes
03	Registration Legal and Money Basics	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Start Right (Foundations)	105 minutes
04	Pricing Your Work and Costing	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Win and Price Clients	105 minutes
05	Finding Your First Customers and Selling	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Win and Price Clients	105 minutes
06	Customer Service and Managing Clients	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Win and Price Clients	105 minutes
07	Invoicing Getting Paid and Basic Accounting	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Run and Grow	105 minutes
08	Digital Presence and Marketing for Small Business	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Run and Grow	105 minutes
09	Capstone Your Business and Freelance Plan	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Run and Grow	105 minutes

How to use this book: Each session below is a complete, ready-to-teach lesson note. Section A tells you what to prepare, B lists the outcomes, D–F are the teaching content, G–H are your demos and practicals, and the knowledge check with answer key is at the end. The concept diagram for each session is embedded as a visual aid.

SESSION 01 OF 9

Business Freelancing Foundations

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 01



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" BUSINESS & FREELANCING

SESSION 1 â€" BUSINESS & FREELANCING FOUNDATIONS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	1 of 9
Session title	Business & Freelancing Foundations
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Start Right (Foundations)
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with business thinking)
Prerequisite knowledge	None. Learners need a smartphone and the willingness to speak and write in class. No business, accounting or English proficiency beyond everyday conversation is assumed.

Item	Detail
Connection to previous work	This is the first session of the course. It connects directly to everyday Nigerian life: nearly everyone in the room knows a trader, a tailor, a phone repairer, a hairdresser or a POS operator who is busy but never seems to get ahead. Today we find out why â€" and what to do about it.
Preparation before class	Print the three weak/strong "my business" statements for the opening activity; prepare the projector with the FastFix Phone Repair case pack (Section G); print one Offer Sheet template per learner (Section H); open a sample Google Doc Offer Sheet on the projector; have the skill inventory worksheet printed; confirm the class has a pen and notebook or phone notes app.

Instructor note on tone: Many learners arrive believing "business" means big shops and big money. Today we bring it down to earth: business is any consistent exchange of value for money. Every learner is already closer to business than they think. Keep the mood warm, practical and confident.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Define** what a business is in their own words and explain why the definition includes a pure oga who sells recharge card and a freelance writer equally.
2. **Distinguish** between the three routes to income â€" **freelancing**, **service business** and **product business** â€" and give a Nigerian example of each, including a hybrid.
3. **Describe** the trade-offs of each route in terms of capital needed, speed to first naira, risk and control, and say which route fits their own situation.
4. **Explain** the entrepreneur mindset: responsibility, action before perfect conditions, handling "no", following up and patience â€" with a real-life story for each.
5. **Name** at least three opportunities and three constraints in the Nigerian environment that affect a small business.
6. **Complete** a personal skill inventory of at least five marketable skills and draft a first **Offer Sheet**: who the customer is, the problem, the deliverable and a realistic starting price range in naira.
7. **Score at least 70%** on the Session 1 knowledge check (LO1).

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with a notes app) or an academy computer with Google Docs.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.
- Notebook and pen (optional â€" some learners prefer paper for drafts).

Software

- A simple text app: phone Notes, Google Docs or Microsoft Word. No special software is required â€" this session is thinking and writing.
- The **Offer Sheet template** (Section H of this session) projected and printed.

Sample files

- Printed opening activity: **three "my business" statements** â€" two weak, one strong (Section D).
- **FastFix Phone Repair case pack** (Section G): a one-page story of Chidi Okonkwo's phone repair shop at Mile 3 Market, Diobu, Port Harcourt, including his current problems (no registration, no separate account, guessed pricing, no records, no invoices).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 1.1 â€" "My Skill Inventory" (a table for listing skills, evidence and who needs them).
- Worksheet 1.2 â€" "First Offer Sheet" (who / problem / deliverable / starting price range boxes).

Accounts

- None required this session. Gmail accounts are needed from Session 3 â€" remind learners now and help anyone who needs one at the break.

Internet

- Not required. The session works fully offline with printed examples.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a notes app works. A learner who cannot type quickly may write by hand or dictate to a classmate; the skill is the **business thinking**, not the typing.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show three short "business statements" without labelling them as good or bad. Read each aloud.

- **Statement A (weak):** "I sell phones and accessories and repair. Everybody in Port Harcourt needs me. I will charge what the next shop charges."
- **Statement B (weak):** "My business is the best phone repair in Nigeria. I have no competitors. I will become a millionaire in one month."
- **Statement C (strong):** "I repair phone screens and batteries for busy workers around Mile 3 and Trans-Amadi who need their phone fixed the same day. I charge â‚¦4,000 for a screen repair and â‚¦2,500 for a battery, and I give a 30-day warranty."

What the instructor says:

> *"Good morning. These are three ways a phone repairer could describe their business. Hands up â€" which one would you trust with your own phone? â€¦ Almost everybody chose C. Why? Because C tells us **who** the customer is, **what** the problem is, **what** the repair costs, and **what** the customer gets back â€" a warranty. A and B are just noise. Today, we turn noise like A and B into clear offers like C. That is what business is."*

Expected learner response: Learners will say "C tells me the price", "C sounds serious", "A is everywhere", "B is lying". Accept all answers and draw out the four parts: **who, problem, deliverable, price**.

Then reveal the hook: Ask, "How many of you already know someone who runs a business like Statement A â€" busy but not getting ahead?" Almost every hand goes up. Say:

> *"That is not a failure of hard work. That is a failure of **structure** â€" and structure is learnable. By the end of these nine sessions, you will be the person with a Statement C for your own skill."*

Why this opener works: It uses a business shape everyone in the room recognises, it isolates clarity as the variable (three statements, one obviously better), and it sets the course promise: structure is learnable, and you can learn it in three weeks with a phone and free tools.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector. There is no previous session, so the "prerequisite" is everyday life â€" use it to surface prior experience and build confidence.

Question 1: "Who in your family or street sells something or does paid work â€" even small? What do they sell?"

- Expected answer: anything from recharge card, to tailoring, to a provision shop, to hairdressing, to a POS business, to a uncle who fixes generators.
- Common gap: some learners say "nobody" because they do not count small trading as business. Clarify: "Mama who sells pure water by the road is a business. The oga who does barbing on weekends is a business. Business starts small."

Question 2: "In one sentence, what do you think makes the difference between a business that is busy and a business that makes money?"

- Expected answer: prices, costs, customers, records, time, attitude â€" accept all.
- Common gap: learners often say "capital" as the only answer. Clarify: "Capital helps, but it is not the whole story. A trader with â‚¦100,000 and no records can go broke faster than a pure-water seller with â‚¦5,000 and good habits."

Question 3: "Have you ever done any work and not been paid properly, or been paid less than agreed? What happened?"

- Expected answer: stories of clients who disappeared, "I will pay you tomorrow", jobs done for "exposure".
- Common gap: learners stay quiet because they feel shame. Say: "That is not your shame â€" that is the most common business experience in Nigeria. The question is what you do next time, and we will teach you exactly that."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You already know what business looks like from the outside. Today we look from the inside. We start with the most important question in business: what exactly are you selling, and to whom? Get that right, and everything else â€" price, customers, records â€" gets easier. Get it wrong, and no amount of hard work will save you."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1, spend 5 extra minutes brainstorming examples from the room before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What a business is

The idea. A business is any **consistent exchange of value for money**. That is it. If someone gives you money â€" or a promise of money â€" for something you provide, and you do it with some consistency, you are in business.

Plain-English definition. A business is a person or group that solves a problem for a customer and charges for the solution. The customer pays because the problem bothers them more than the money does.

Why this definition matters. Many Nigerians believe business means a shop, a signboard, a big shopfront with AC and a logo. That belief stops people who "only" sell food from home, repair phones on the street, or type documents for others. But the definition is wider than a shop: a business is a **value exchange**, and value can be a repaired screen, a plate of jollof, a delivered document, or a bus ride. Once you see it this way, millions of Nigerians are already business owners â€" they just do not manage themselves like one.

The four parts of every business â€" say them slowly and write them on the board:

1. **Customer** â€" a specific person or group with a problem.
2. **Problem** â€" something that bothers them enough to pay.
3. **Solution** â€" what you do or provide (the deliverable).
4. **Price** â€" what they pay, and what you keep after costs.

Real-life comparison. Think of a pure-water seller at the junction. Customer: thirsty commuters. Problem: no clean water nearby. Solution: sachets of water. Price: â‚¦20 a sachet. She is a business. If she keeps no record of how many sachets she bought and sold, she will not know if she is making profit â€" but the business exists. Our course adds the structure.

Important limitation / misconception. A business is not the same as a job, and it is not the same as a hobby. A job sells your time to an employer; a business solves a problem for a customer. A hobby is done for fun; a business is done for a customer's benefit â€" and must eventually pay for itself. Some of the best businesses start as hobbies; the switch is made when you begin asking "who needs this, and what will they pay?"

How a learner recognises whether they have a business: Ask yourself four questions: Do I solve a problem? Is there a specific person who has that problem? Would they pay for the solution? Do I do it consistently? If three of four are yes, you are closer than you think.

F.2 The three routes to income: freelancing, service and product

The idea. There are three main ways to turn a skill or effort into money. They are not rigid boxes â€" most real businesses mix them â€" but learning the difference helps you choose where to start.

Route 1 â€" Freelancing: selling time and skill directly.

- **What it is:** You sell your own time and skill to complete specific jobs for clients. One job, one client, one price. When you stop working, the money stops.
- **Nigerian examples:** a graphic designer making flyers for businesses; a writer drafting CVs; a photographer shooting events; a barber cutting hair; a phone repairer fixing one phone at a time; a tailor sewing one dress.
- **What you need:** a skill, a phone, and a way to find clients. Little or no capital.
- **Speed to first naira:** fast â€" often within the first week if you already have the skill.
- **Trade-off:** your income is capped by the hours in your day. You cannot fix ten phones at once. But your risk is low and your start is cheap.

Route 2 â€" Service business: running a repeatable service.

- **What it is:** You build a service that customers use regularly, and you systemise it so it does not depend only on your personal hours â€" though at the start, it usually does.
- **Nigerian examples:** a salon with staff; a cleaning company; a laundry service; a POS business that keeps running while the owner is away; a phone repair shop (FastFix) that serves many customers a week; a catering service that takes event bookings.
- **What you need:** the skill, plus some structure â€" a place (even a corner), maybe one helper, simple records, and a way to get repeat customers.
- **Speed to first naira:** medium â€" you need a little setup, but once running, it produces repeat income.
- **Trade-off:** more control and more growth potential than freelancing, but more responsibility â€" you manage money, people, time and customer expectations at once.

Route 3 â€" Product business: making or buying and reselling goods.

- **What it is:** You make a product, or you buy it and sell it at a higher price. You can sell many units without being present at each sale.
- **Nigerian examples:** a bakery selling bread; a fashion designer selling ready-made dresses; a phone accessories seller; a food seller packaging rice and stew; a soap maker; a yam farmer selling to retailers.
- **What you need:** the product itself, money for stock (capital), storage, and buyers.
- **Speed to first naira:** can be fast if demand exists, but you must spend money before you earn.
- **Trade-off:** the most scalable â€" a product can sell while you sleep â€" but the most capital-hungry and the riskiest for a beginner, because unsold stock is money lost.

How to choose your route (a practical decision rule):

- If you have **no capital** and a **skill** â†' start with **freelancing**.
- If you have a skill, a **small space**, and want **repeat customers** â†' build a **service business**.
- If you have **some capital**, a product people want, and a way to sell â†' consider a **product business**.
- Most honest advice for a beginner: **start where you are, with what you have.** A phone repairer starts as a freelancer on the street, then opens a stand, then sells accessories as products. All three routes lived in one journey.

The hybrid truth (say this): FastFix is a service business (repair) and a product business (accessories) in one. Most successful small businesses mix routes. The goal is not to pick one forever â€" it is to start with one, learn, and add the others.

Real-life comparison. Think of three friends: Emeka the freelance writer charges per article. Ada the salon owner runs a service with one assistant. Kelechi the baker sells bread. Emeka earns per job and can start today. Ada earns more, but must pay rent and manage staff. Kelechi earns the most per day if the bread sells, but loses money daily if it does not. Same city, three different businesses.

F.3 The entrepreneur mindset â€" the habits that separate busy from successful

The idea. A business does not fail because the market is bad. It usually fails because the owner stopped doing the small, boring, unglamorous things. The entrepreneur mindset is a set of habits you can learn.

The six habits â€" teach each with a story and a "do this" action:

1. **Responsibility.** When something goes wrong, the owner looks in the mirror first. Not the economy, not the customer â€" "What did I miss?" Do this: after any failed job, write one thing you would change.
2. **Action before perfect conditions.** Perfect conditions never come. You do not need a shop, a loan, a logo and a business plan before your first customer. Do this: make your first offer this week, with what you have.
3. **Handling "no".** Customers will say no â€" often many times before one yes. A "no" is information, not a verdict. Do this: after a no, ask one question: "Is it the price, the timing, or something else?"
4. **Following up.** Most sales are lost because the seller did not follow up. The customer who said "maybe" on Monday might buy on Friday. Do this: keep a list of everyone who showed interest, and contact them weekly.
5. **Patience.** A business is a seed, not a microwave. Some months are hungry; some are fat. Do this: give every business decision at least three months before judging it, and keep records so you can actually see progress.
6. **Learning from every job.** Every paid job is feedback. What did the customer love? What did they complain about? Do this: after each job, write one sentence: "Next time I will _____."

Real-life comparison. Think of two plantain sellers at the same market. Seller A sells, goes home, complains about the market, and waits for the next day. Seller B sells, notes which plantain sold first, asks one customer why, adjusts her display, and texts her regular customers when fresh stock arrives. In six months, B is not luckier â€" she is better. The market did not change; her habits did.

Misconception to correct. "I need money to think like an owner." No â€" the mindset comes first, the money follows. A person who keeps records of â,¦500 sales is more of an owner than a person with â,¦500,000 and no record.

F.4 Nigerian realities: constraints and opportunities

The idea. Business in Nigeria is not business in London or Lagos-island. The environment is hard in specific ways â€" and full of specific opportunities. A smart owner works with reality, not against it.

The constraints â€" name them honestly:

1. **Power and fuel.** No light, no charging, no cold room, no welding. Generator and fuel costs eat profit. Businesses plan around the national grid's absence.
2. **Transport and logistics.** Traffic in Port Harcourt, bad roads, delivery costs. A product that looks cheap becomes expensive once transport is added.
3. **Cash flow.** Customers pay late, or in pieces. Many businesses die not from no profit but from no cash on hand this week.
4. **Trust deficit.** Customers have been burned by fake products and ghost services. They are suspicious â€" and that suspicion is earned. Every honest business must work harder to prove itself.
5. **Competition and copying.** If your idea works, someone will copy it within weeks. Your defence is not the idea â€" it is your reputation, your service and your customer relationship.
6. **Seasonality.** School terms, festive seasons, rainy months, salary periods â€" demand rises and falls in predictable waves. A business that does not plan for the lean months will panic when they come.
7. **Policy and regulation.** Multiple taxes, permits and levies â€" some official, some not â€" can surprise a new business owner. (We learn the legal basics in Session 3.)

The opportunities â€" name them with equal honesty:

1. **Huge population with everyday problems.** 200 million people need food, phones fixed, clothes, hair, transport, repairs, services. Small problems are big markets.
2. **Phone and internet penetration.** Nearly everyone has a phone; many have data. A business can find and serve customers without a shopfront â€" WhatsApp, Facebook, Instagram, Google.
3. **The informal economy is the economy.** The woman selling at the junction, the man fixing generators, the student selling phone credit â€" this is where most Nigerians actually earn. Structure turns this into a real business.
4. **Demand for quality and trust.** Customers are tired of fake and disappointing. A business that delivers honestly, on time, with a clear price and a follow-up â€" wins repeat customers for life.
5. **Digital services for local businesses.** Every salon, church, school and shop needs someone to design flyers, manage WhatsApp, take photos, keep records. A beginner with a phone can sell these services locally.
6. **Government and NGO focus on MSMEs.** Grants, training and support schemes exist â€" and a registered business with records can access them. (Session 3 covers registration.)

Real-life comparison. Two phone repairers in Diobu face the same power cuts and the same traffic. Repairer One complains and waits. Repairer Two buys a small power bank, repairs phones by daylight, tells customers the pick-up time honestly, and texts when the phone is ready. Same environment â€" different business. The environment is the same for everyone; the response is what differs.

Say this to the class:

> *"The Nigerian environment is not your enemy â€" it is your reality. You do not wait for perfect conditions; you build a business that works in the conditions you have. That is what every successful business in this country has done."*

F.5 The skill inventory â€" you have more than you think

The idea. Most beginners say "I have no skill." This is almost always false. You have skills from school, church, home, street, work and hobbies. The skill inventory is a structured way to find them.

How to build a skill inventory â€" three columns:

1. **Skill** â€" something you can do that someone might pay for.
2. **Evidence** â€" a time you actually did it (for family, church, a friend, a previous job).
3. **Who needs it** â€" the person or business that has this problem.

Common beginner skills â€" a starter list to jog memory:

- **Phone and computer:** typing, formatting documents, fixing phone issues, installing apps, transferring data, editing photos, designing simple graphics with Canva, managing WhatsApp groups.
- **Creative:** writing (messages, letters, church announcements, social media posts), drawing, photography with a phone, making hair, barbing, sewing, baking, cooking a specific dish well.
- **Practical/technical:** repairing (phone, fan, generator, bicycle), painting, plastering, cleaning, arranging events, organising files, driving, wiring, filling forms.
- **People and organisation:** talking to people, explaining things, planning events, keeping time, remembering details, negotiating prices, teaching/tutoring, selling.
- **Business-ish:** buying and selling, keeping simple records, using POS, managing a market stall, knowing a market's prices.

Worked example â€" a skill inventory for a fictional learner, Boma:

Skill	Evidence	Who needs it
Typing and formatting documents	Typed my brother's CV; formatted church bulletins	Students, job seekers, small offices
Editing phone photos	Take product photos for my aunt's food business	Food sellers, small shops
Managing WhatsApp groups	Admin of my church youth group (300 members)	Churches, associations, businesses
Explaining things clearly	Tutored my cousin in maths for one term	Students, parents
Keeping records	Kept the money for my family's party	Events, small businesses

The evidence rule: "I think I can do it" is not a skill. "I did it, and someone can confirm" is a skill. Every skill in your inventory needs at least one real example.

Misconception to correct. "My skill is too common â€" everybody can do it." Common skills are the best skills, because the demand is common. The question is not "is this skill rare" â€" it is "can I do it better, faster or more reliably than the next person?" You do not need to be the best in Nigeria; you need to be dependable in your street.

F.6 The Offer Sheet â€" from skill to something you can sell

The idea. The Offer Sheet is one page that says: who the customer is, what problem you solve, what you deliver, and what you charge. It is the foundation of everything else in this course â€" pricing, selling, invoicing, marketing all grow from this one page.

The four parts â€" with a worked example for FastFix:

1. **Who we serve (the customer).** A specific person or group â€" never "everybody". Example: "Busy workers and students around Mile 3 and Trans-Amadi who rely on their phone for work."
2. **The problem.** What bothers them. Example: "A cracked phone screen or a dead battery stops their calls, messages and mobile money â€" and they need it fixed fast."
3. **What we sell (the deliverable).** What they get from you. Example: "Same-day screen and battery replacement using quality parts, with a 30-day warranty."
4. **Starting price range.** A realistic range in naira, based on what customers actually pay in that area. Example: "Screen repair â‚¦4,000â€"â‚¦7,000 depending on the phone model; battery replacement â‚¦2,500â€"â‚¦4,000."

Why a price range and not one number? Because the exact price depends on the phone model, the part quality and the job difficulty. A range is honest and gives you room. You will learn exact costing in Session 4 â€" for now, a range from observing what shops charge is the right start.

The test of a good Offer Sheet: Read it to a friend and ask: "Would you know what this business does, who it serves, and roughly what it charges?" If yes â€" the sheet works.

Real-life comparison. Think of two ways to describe the same business: "I repair phones" (weak â€" no customer, no price, no outcome) versus the FastFix Offer Sheet (strong). The first gets forgotten; the second gets a customer. Same business â€" different description â€" different result.

Important limitation / misconception. The Offer Sheet is a draft, not a contract. You will test it against real customers in Session 2 and adjust the price range and the customer description based on what you learn. Do not marry the first version.

F.7 The running example: FastFix Phone Repair

The idea. For the rest of this course, we follow one fictional business so you always see concepts on a real-shaped case. FastFix is not perfect â€" it is typical. Its problems are the problems you are learning to solve.

The FastFix case â€" read this aloud to the class:

> ***FastFix Phone Repair*** *is a small phone repair and accessories shop at Mile 3 Market, Diobu, Port Harcourt, owned by* ***Chidi Okonkwo****. Chidi repairs 5â€"10 phones a week â€" screens, batteries, charging ports and software problems â€" and also sells cases, chargers and data bundles. He learned the phone repair trade from an older technician who has since retired. He has no registered business name, no separate bank account and no invoices â€" customers pay cash or transfer into his personal account. He keeps jobs in an exercise book and prices by "what the next shop charges." He has a personal Facebook page he rarely updates and no WhatsApp Business profile. He has lost count of what a repair truly costs once transport, data and his own time are added.*

What is wrong with FastFix â€" list the problems on the board:

- No registered business name (no legal identity).
- No separate bank account (business money and personal money are mixed).
- No invoices (no proof of what was agreed or paid).
- Pricing by copying the neighbour (no costing â€" he may be losing money on every repair).
- Records in an exercise book (no way to see profit, trends or problems).
- No digital presence (customers cannot find him when they search).
- No agreements (customers and jobs are verbal â€" disputes are likely).

Say this: "By Session 9, you will fix every one of these problems on paper. FastFix will have a one-page business plan, a costed price list, quotes, an invoice, records, a WhatsApp Business profile and a pitch. You will do it step by step â€" and if the plan works for Chidi, it will work for you."

F.8 Summary of the session

- A **business** is any consistent exchange of value for money: customer, problem, solution, price.
- Three routes to income: **freelancing** (time and skill), **service** (repeatable service), **product** (goods). Most businesses mix them; start where you are.

- The **entrepreneur mindset** is six learnable habits: responsibility, action before perfect conditions, handling "no", following up, patience, learning from every job.
- **Nigerian constraints** are real (power, transport, cash flow, trust, competition, seasonality, regulation) â€" and so are the **opportunities** (population, phones, informal economy, demand for trust, digital services).
- A **skill inventory** with evidence turns "I have no skill" into a list of sellable abilities.
- The **Offer Sheet** â€" who, problem, deliverable, starting price range â€" is the first document of the business.
- The running example **FastFix Phone Repair** shows a typical small Nigerian business â€" and shows us exactly what we are going to fix.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Have a Skill] --> B{Which type?}
    B --> C[Freelancing<br/>Sell your time]
    B --> D[Product<br/>Sell goods]
    B --> E[Service<br/>Sell ongoing help]
    C --> F[Get paid per job]
    D --> G[Get paid per item]
    E --> H[Get paid monthly]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Show the class how to think from a skill to a clear Offer Sheet â€" live â€" so they can do it themselves in the practical.

Setup: Open a blank Google Doc titled "Offer Sheet â€" [Instructor's example]". Have the FastFix case page open for reference. Project both.

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A blank Offer Sheet template on the projector.
- The FastFix case pack.
- A second example ready (e.g., the instructor's own made-up skill â€" "phone photography for food sellers").

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" dissect a weak business statement (3 minutes)

Say: "Before we build, let us see why the weak one fails."

Show Statement A from the opening activity:

> *"I sell phones and accessories and repair. Everybody in Port Harcourt needs me. I will charge what the next shop charges."*

Label it on the board out loud:

- **Who?** "Everybody" â€" too wide. A specific customer is missing.
- **Problem?** None stated. What bothers the customer?
- **Deliverable?** "Phones and accessories and repair" â€" three things, no clarity.
- **Price?** "What the next shop charges" â€" copied, not costed.

Say: "This statement does not know what it is selling or to whom. Now watch me rebuild it."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" build an Offer Sheet live for FastFix (8 minutes)

Fill the template on the projector, narrating each choice:

Offer Sheet â€" FastFix Phone Repair (draft)

Part	Entry	Why
Who we serve	Busy workers and students around Mile 3 and Trans-Amadi who depend on their phone for work, school and mobile	Specific people in a specific area â€" not "everybody".

Part	Entry	Why
	money.	
The problem	A cracked screen, dead battery or faulty charging port stops their calls, messages and payments â€” and they need it fixed the same day, not next week.	Names the actual pain, in the customer's language.
What we sell	Same-day phone repair (screen, battery, charging port, software) using quality parts, plus cases, chargers and data bundles.	Clear deliverables with a same-day promise.
Starting price range	Screen repair â‚¦4,000â€“â‚¦7,000; battery replacement â‚¦2,500â€“â‚¦4,000; charging port â‚¦3,000â€“â‚¦5,000.	A realistic range for the area â€” to be tested in Session 2 and costed exactly in Session 4.

Point out each part and ask questions:

- "Why is 'busy workers around Mile 3' better than 'everybody'?" (It tells you where to find customers and what they can afford.)
- "Why a price range and not one number?" (Phone models differ; a range is honest.)
- "What is missing that we will add later?" (Costing, exact price, payment terms, scope â€” Sessions 4â€“7.)

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€” second example: from a different skill (3 minutes)

Run the same process quickly for a made-up learner skill â€” e.g., "phone photography for food sellers":

Part	Entry
Who we serve	Small food businesses in Port Harcourt (jollof, meat pie, small chops) that post on WhatsApp and Instagram.
The problem	Their food photos look dark and unappetising, so people scroll past instead of ordering.
What we sell	10 bright, appetising food photos shot with a phone, edited, ready to post the same day.
Starting price range	â‚¦3,000â€“â‚¦5,000 per photo session.

Say: "Same four parts, different business. The Offer Sheet is a structure â€” it works for a phone repairer, a food photographer, a tailor, a writer. If you can fill these four boxes, you are in business."

G.5 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Why is 'everybody' a bad customer?" (You cannot find everybody; you cannot price for everybody; you cannot serve everybody.)
- "Why a price range?" (The exact price depends on the job; a range is honest and testable.)
- "What do we do with this sheet next?" (Test it with real customers in Session 2.)
- "Can this sheet change?" (Yes â€” it is a draft; every version gets better.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner completes a **Skill Inventory** (at least five skills with evidence) and a **first Offer Sheet** for one chosen skill.

Starting materials: A pen and notebook or phone notes app; the Offer Sheet template (projected and printed).

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name and today's date at the top of your workbook or notes app.
2. **Skill Inventory:** Draw a table with three columns â€” Skill / Evidence / Who needs it. List **at least five skills** you have. (Worksheet 1.1.)
3. Choose **one** skill to build your first Offer Sheet around. Circle it.

4. **Pause and predict:** Ask yourself: "Who around me actually has this problem â€" can I name three real people?" If not, pick a different skill.
5. Fill the **Offer Sheet** (Worksheet 1.2): Who / Problem / What we sell / Starting price range.
6. For the price range, write what you think is realistic â€" and next to it, write "test in S2".
7. Read your Offer Sheet aloud to yourself. Ask: "If a stranger read this, would they know what I do and roughly what it costs?"
8. **Pair share:** Swap with the person next to you. Read each other's Offer Sheet and say one thing that is clear and one question you have.
9. Revise your Offer Sheet based on your partner's question.
10. Save your final version in your notes or on paper â€" you will add to it in Session 2.

Expected result: A Skill Inventory with at least five evidenced skills, and a first Offer Sheet for one skill with all four parts filled.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 4: "Can you name three real people who need this?" If not, what does that tell you about the customer?
- After step 8: "Did your partner understand your offer without you explaining?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner writes "everybody" â†' Ask: "Where do those people live? What do they do? How old are them?" Push for specifics.
- Learner has no price â†' Ask: "What do you think a similar service costs around here? What would you pay?" Any realistic range is fine; it will be tested.
- Learner says "I have no skills" â†' Ask: "What do people come to you for help with? What do you do in church or at home that others cannot?" Draw out one skill at a time.
- Learner's evidence is weak ("I think I can") â†' Ask: "Have you done anything like this before? Even once?" If yes, that is evidence; if no, pair them with a classmate who has.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Skill Inventory has at least five skills with evidence
- ☐ One skill chosen for the Offer Sheet
- ☐ Offer Sheet has a specific customer (not "everybody")
- ☐ Offer Sheet has a clear problem in the customer's language
- ☐ Offer Sheet has a clear deliverable
- ☐ Offer Sheet has a realistic price range in naira
- ☐ Offer Sheet shared with a partner and revised

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Write a **second Offer Sheet** â€" this time for a skill you did NOT choose in the practical â€" and a short paragraph answering the question: "Which of the three routes (freelance / service / product) fits my chosen skill best, and why?"

Scenario. Your friend Tobi is good at three things: (1) making small chops for parties, (2) designing event flyers on his phone with Canva, and (3) fixing laptop charging ports. He wants to start earning this month but has no money for stock and no shop.

Requirements:

1. Choose **one** of Tobi's skills and write a full Offer Sheet for it (Who / Problem / What we sell / Starting price range).
2. State which route â€" **freelance, service or product** â€" fits this skill best, and give at least two reasons.
3. Write one sentence: "In the first month, Tobi should focus on _____, because _____."
4. Write one risk: "One thing that could go wrong is _____, and Tobi can prepare by _____."

Constraints:

- The customer must be specific â€" not "everybody".
- The price range must be in naira and realistic for Port Harcourt.
- Do not copy the FastFix or the Boma example.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Offer Sheet has all four parts complete.
- The route choice is justified with at least two reasons.
- The first-month focus and the risk are realistic and specific.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For "who", think of the person who would pay â€" a party planner? a church? a business?
- Hint 2: For the route, ask: does Tobi sell time (freelance), run a repeatable service, or make a product?
- Hint 3: For the price, think: what would someone pay around here for this?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Option 1 â€" Small chops (product route):

Part	Entry
Who we serve	Event planners, churches and families in Port Harcourt hosting small gatherings of 30â€"80 people.
The problem	Hosts need reliable finger food for parties but do not have time to cook and fear a caterer who will disappoint them on the day.
What we sell	Party small chops packages (spring rolls, samosa, grilled chicken, meat pies) â€" ordered 3 days ahead, delivered on the day.
Starting price range	â‚¦15,000â€"â‚¦35,000 per party package (depending on menu and guest count).

- **Route:** Product â€" because the food is made in advance and delivered; it can be priced per package and sold repeatedly. Some service elements exist (customisation, delivery) but the core is a product.
- **First-month focus:** "Tobi should focus on 2â€"3 small orders from people he knows (family events, church gatherings), because those first orders become photos and testimonials he can show to strangers."
- **Risk:** "One thing that could go wrong is underpricing â€" Tobi charges too little and loses money after ingredients and transport. He can prepare by listing every ingredient cost per package before quoting."

Option 2 â€" Flyer design (freelance route):

Part	Entry
Who we serve	Small businesses and churches in Port Harcourt that need flyers, posters and social media graphics but cannot afford an agency.
The problem	Their events and products look unprofessional in print and online, so people ignore them.
What we sell	Same-day event flyers and social media graphics designed on a phone with Canva, delivered by WhatsApp.
Starting price range	â‚¦2,000â€"â‚¦5,000 per design, depending on complexity.

- **Route:** Freelance â€" because Tobi sells his time per job; one design, one client, one price. As demand grows, he can turn it into a service business (a small design studio).
- **First-month focus:** "Tobi should focus on 5 paying customers from his contacts, because 5 jobs build a portfolio and 5 testimonials."
- **Risk:** "One thing that could go wrong is free-work requests â€" 'design this one for free for exposure.' Tobi can prepare by deciding in advance what he will say to a free-work request (we practise this in Session 6)."

Option 3 â€" Laptop charging port repair (service route):

Part	Entry
Who we serve	Students, office workers and small business owners in Port Harcourt whose laptop charging port has failed.
The problem	A broken charging port means a dead laptop â€" no work, no study, no business.
What we sell	Same-week laptop charging port diagnosis and repair, with a 14-day warranty.

Part	Entry
Starting price range	â‚¦8,000â€“â‚¦20,000 depending on laptop model and damage.

- **Route:** Service â€” because it is a repeatable technical service that customers need regularly and can be built into a small workshop.
- **First-month focus:** "Tobi should focus on building trust through 3â€“5 repairs at fair prices, because repairs live on word of mouth."
- **Risk:** "One thing that could go wrong is damaging a customer's laptop and facing a big complaint. He can prepare by testing the laptop with the customer present and writing down the agreed condition before starting."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Offer Sheet has all four parts, customer specific (2)
- Problem and deliverable are clear (2)
- Price range is realistic and in naira (2)
- Route choice is justified with reasons (2)
- First-month focus and risk are realistic (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Ngozi* is a final-year student in Port Harcourt. She sews well â€” she has made clothes for herself and her roommates since 100 level. Her roommates tell her she should sell. She has no money for a shop, no sewing machine of her own (she uses her landlady's), and no idea what to charge. She prices by guessing: "I think a skirt should be â‚¦5,000." She has made two dresses for friends and been paid â‚¦5,000 and â‚¦7,000, with no discussion of fabric cost or time. She is now considering giving up sewing because "it is not paying."

Relevant facts.

- Ngozi's time: about 4 hours per dress.
- Fabric and materials for a simple dress: about â‚¦3,500.
- She can make 2â€“3 dresses per week alongside studies.
- Her landlady's machine is available only in the evenings.
- She has no records of the two dresses she made â€” she does not know if she made profit.

Decision point. Ngozi thinks her problem is "no money and no shop." Is that really her problem?

Possible approaches.

1. Give up sewing â€” it is not paying.
2. Borrow money, rent a shop and start "properly".
3. Treat sewing as a small business from where she is: define her customer, price from cost, keep records, find customers among students and staff.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Ngozi's problem is not money or a shop â€” it is that she is running a business without the structure. She does not know her cost, so her prices are guesses. She has no records, so she cannot see if she is making profit. She has no defined customer, so she makes only when a friend asks.

Reasoning / example first steps for Ngozi:

- **Offer Sheet:** "I sew simple dresses and skirts for female students and young workers in Port Harcourt who want something that fits well without a boutique price."
- **Cost one dress:** fabric â‚¦3,500 + thread/accessories â‚¦500 + transport â‚¦500 + time (4 hours Ã— â‚¦500/hour) = â‚¦7,000 total.
- **Price:** â‚¦9,000â€“â‚¦11,000 per dress (cost â‚¦7,000 + profit â‚¦2,000â€“â‚¦4,000).
- **Records:** a simple note of each dress â€” materials, time, price, customer.
- **Customers:** her hostel, her department, the church WhatsApp group â€” with her roommate's testimonials.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (give up) loses a skill and a possible income forever.

- Approach 2 (borrow, rent) risks debt for a business that has not yet proven demand â€" the most common way beginners fail.
- Approach 3 (structure from where she is) starts free, tests demand, and builds the habits that make a future shop succeed when she can afford one.

Professional connection. The difference between a hobbyist and a business owner is not capital â€" it is a **defined offer, a costed price, and records**. Ngozi already has the hardest part: the skill. The rest is paperwork â€" and paperwork is what this course teaches.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 "Everybody" is my customer

Symptoms: The Offer Sheet says "everybody" or "all Nigerians"; marketing is scattered; nothing sells. **Likely cause:** The learner has not narrowed to a specific person with a specific problem. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Where do these people live? What do they do? How much can they pay?" **Corrective steps:** Rewrite the customer as one specific group in one specific place (e.g., "female students in my department" not "everybody"). **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can name at least three real people who fit the customer description. **Prevention:** Every Offer Sheet starts with a named group â€" a face, not a crowd.

K.2 Pricing by copying the neighbour

Symptoms: Prices are "what the next shop charges"; the learner does not know if they make profit. **Likely cause:** Fear of charging too high â€" so copy a number that feels safe. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What does your job actually cost â€" materials, transport, your time?" If they cannot answer, costing is missing. **Corrective steps:** Build a full cost first (Session 4), then price from cost plus profit â€" not from fear. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can explain their price from its cost. **Prevention:** Never price before costing; never copy a price without knowing the other person's cost.

K.3 "I have no skill"

Symptoms: The skill inventory is empty or vague ("I am just a student"). **Likely cause:** The learner does not count everyday abilities as skills. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What do people come to you for? What do you do in church, at home, in your area?" **Corrective steps:** Build the inventory from life, not from job titles â€" use the starter list in Section F.5. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner lists five skills with evidence. **Prevention:** Skills are things you have done, not things you have certificates for.

K.4 Confusing the three routes

Symptoms: The learner says "I want a business" but cannot say which route they are on. **Likely cause:** The routes were presented as choices to memorise, not as a decision to make. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Do you sell your time (freelance), run a repeatable service, or sell goods (product)?" **Corrective steps:** Re-explain with the learner's own skill; label it and justify the choice. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner names their route and gives one reason. **Prevention:** Every Offer Sheet carries a route label: freelance / service / product.

K.5 Waiting for perfect conditions

Symptoms: "I will start when I have money / a shop / a machine / a logo." **Likely cause:** Fear disguised as planning. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What can you do this week with what you already have?" If the answer is nothing, the conditions are real; if the answer is something, the conditions were an excuse. **Corrective steps:** Define the smallest first step that costs nothing: define the customer, price from cost, tell five people. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner takes one action this week. **Prevention:** Repeat the mindset lesson: action before perfect conditions.

K.6 A weak Offer Sheet (no problem, no price, no deliverable)

Symptoms: The sheet says "I repair phones" and stops. **Likely cause:** The learner wrote a description of what they do, not an offer to a customer. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What problem does this solve for the customer? What exactly do they get? What do they pay?" **Corrective steps:** Return to the four parts and fill each one with a customer's perspective. **How to confirm resolved:** A stranger reading the sheet knows what is sold, to whom, and roughly what it costs. **Prevention:** Every Offer Sheet is tested on a pair partner before it is finished.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it with the learner â€” ask them the investigation question and listen to the answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Skill-to-Income Map and First Offer Sheet"

Purpose: To practise turning a personal skill into a defined, priced offer â€” the foundation of everything that follows â€” and to build the first two documents of the capstone pack.

Realistic scenario. You have just learned that you already have sellable skills. This week, you will prove it on paper: list your skills with evidence, choose the strongest one, and write a clear Offer Sheet that a stranger could understand.

Detailed instructions:

1. Open your notebook or a Google Doc titled "Skill-to-Income Map â€” [Your Name]".
2. **Skill Inventory:** List at least **five skills**. For each, write: (a) the skill, (b) one piece of evidence that you can do it (a real example), (c) who needs it.
3. **Choose one skill** â€” the one you would most enjoy selling and that people around you actually need. Circle it.
4. **Offer Sheet:** For your chosen skill, complete the four parts:
    - Who we serve (a specific group â€” not "everybody")
    - The problem (in the customer's language)
    - What we sell (the deliverable)
    - Starting price range (realistic, in naira)
5. Write one paragraph (5â€“8 sentences): **Which route** â€” freelance, service or product â€” fits your skill best, and **why**? Give at least two reasons.
6. Write one paragraph: **What is your first step this week** â€” one action you will take before Session 2 to test this offer? (For example: ask three people if they have the problem; check what similar services charge.)
7. If you do not yet have a Gmail account, create one this week (we need it from Session 3). Ask the instructor for help if needed.

Required deliverables:

- A Skill Inventory with at least five skills and evidence.
- A first Offer Sheet with all four parts complete.
- Two short paragraphs (route choice + first step).

Submission format: Save as a Google Doc (or a clear photo of handwritten work) and upload to your Drive folder `CEA-Biz-YourName`, or show it to the instructor at the start of Session 2. You may also copy the text into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 2.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Skill inventory complete	5	At least five skills, each with evidence and a "who needs it"
Offer Sheet â€” customer specific	3	A named group in a named place, not "everybody"
Offer Sheet â€” problem & deliverable	4	Clear problem in the customer's language; clear deliverable
Offer Sheet â€” price range	3	Realistic, in naira, honest range
Route choice justified	3	Route named with at least two reasons
First step & clarity	2	One realistic first step; writing clear

Common mistakes to avoid: listing skills with no evidence; "everybody" as customer; copied prices without costing; no first step; messy or missing submission.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Skill Inventory (model â€" a fictional learner, "Adaeze"):

Skill	Evidence	Who needs it
Baking small chops	Made spring rolls for my sister's birthday (20 people)	Event planners, churches, families
Writing messages and announcements	Wrote my church's youth week announcement	Churches, associations, small businesses
Designing flyers (Canva)	Made a flyer for my cousin's food business	Food sellers, small shops, churches
Organising events	Helped plan my department's farewell party	Schools, churches, associations
Keeping records	Tracked the money for my sister's wedding contributions	Events, families, small businesses

Offer Sheet (for "Baking small chops"):

Part	Entry
Who we serve	Event planners, churches and families in Port Harcourt hosting small gatherings of 30â€"80 people.
The problem	Hosts need reliable finger food for parties but do not have time to cook and fear a caterer who will disappoint them on the day.
What we sell	Party small chops packages (spring rolls, samosa, grilled chicken, meat pies) â€" ordered 3 days ahead, delivered on the day.
Starting price range	â‚¦15,000â€"â‚¦35,000 per party package (depending on menu and guest count).

Route paragraph (model): "The product route fits best because small chops are made in advance and delivered per package â€" I can sell the same package many times without being present at each sale. Second, the demand is predictable: parties happen every weekend, so I can plan production. Third, I have no capital for a shop, so a product made to order from home is the right start."

First step (model): "This week I will ask three people â€" my church's youth leader, my sister's friend who plans events, and a caterer I know â€" whether they ever need reliable small chops, and what they currently pay. I will also check what a similar party package costs in my area."

A strong learner solution differs in content but ticks every rubric row.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. In your own words, what is a business? Name the four parts of every business.

Q2. Multiple choice. Which of these is the best example of a freelancer? a) A baker who sells bread every morning from her shop b) A graphic designer who charges per flyer for different clients c) A shop that sells phone accessories d) A POS agent who runs a stand at the market

Q3. Matching. Match each route to its example: (1) freelancing, (2) service business, (3) product business. a) A tailor who sews one dress for one customer at a time b) A salon with an assistant that serves many customers a week c) A shop that buys and resells phone cases

Q4. True or false. "I need a shop, a loan and a logo before I can call myself a business."

Q5. Explain. What is the difference between a hobby and a business? Give one example.

Q6. Practical. Write one sentence describing a specific customer for a phone repair business â€" not "everybody".

Q7. Scenario. Your friend makes good cakes and has sold three to friends, but prices by guessing and keeps no records. Name two things she should do before her next cake order.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q7)

A1. A business is any consistent exchange of value for money. The four parts: customer, problem, solution (deliverable), price. (Accept any answer covering value-for-money and the four parts.)

A2. (b) A graphic designer who charges per flyer for different clients. (Selling time and skill per job = freelancing.)

A3. (1) = a, (2) = b, (3) = c.

A4. False. A business is a value exchange â€” it can start from a phone and a skill with no shop, loan or logo.

A5. A hobby is done for fun; a business solves a problem for a customer and charges for it. Example: making hair for yourself (hobby) versus making hair for clients who pay (business). (Accept any correct contrast with example.)

A6. Any specific group, e.g., "Students and office workers around Mile 3 and Trans-Amadi whose phone screen or battery has failed and who need it fixed the same day." (Must be specific, not "everybody".)

A7. Two of: (1) list the full cost of the cake (ingredients, transport, her time) before pricing; (2) choose a price based on cost plus profit, not a guess; (3) keep a record of the order â€” materials, time, price, customer; (4) define who her customer is and what she delivers. (Accept any two sensible actions from the session content.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that a business is any consistent exchange of value for money â€” and that the four parts of every business are customer, problem, solution and price. You learned the three routes to income â€” freelancing, service and products â€— and how to choose the one that fits where you are now. You learned the six habits of an entrepreneur: responsibility, action before perfect conditions, handling "no", following up, patience and learning from every job. You looked honestly at the Nigerian environment â€— the constraints (power, transport, cash flow, trust, competition, seasonality, regulation) and the opportunities (population, phones, informal economy, demand for trust, digital services). You built a skill inventory, proved you have skills with evidence, and wrote your first Offer Sheet: who, problem, deliverable, starting price range. And you met FastFix Phone Repair â€— our running example â€— and saw exactly what we are going to fix together.

Five important takeaways:

1. A **business** is a value exchange: customer, problem, solution, price â€— not a shopfront.
2. Three routes: **freelancing** (time and skill), **service** (repeatable), **product** (goods) â€— start where you are.
3. The **entrepreneur mindset** is six learnable habits â€— you do not need money to start thinking like an owner.
4. The **Nigerian environment** is the same for everyone; your response is what differs.
5. The **Offer Sheet** â€— who, problem, deliverable, price range â€— is the first document of your business, and it is a draft that gets better.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I define a business in my own words and name its four parts?
- Can I tell the difference between freelancing, a service business and a product business?
- Can I name at least three habits of an entrepreneur?
- Can I list at least five of my skills with evidence?
- Can I write a first Offer Sheet with a specific customer, a clear problem, a deliverable and a price range?

Connection to the next session. You have an Offer Sheet â€— but is it true? Does the customer really have that problem, and will they really pay that price? Next session we go outside: we learn how to find your market, talk to real customers, check what competitors charge, and decide whether to sell, adjust or park the idea. Validation is what separates a business from a guess.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner defines a business correctly in their own words and names the four parts without prompting.
- Learner distinguishes freelancing / service / product with correct examples and labels their own route.
- Learner's skill inventory has five or more skills, each with a real piece of evidence.

- Learner's Offer Sheet has a specific customer (not "everybody"), a clear problem, a clear deliverable and a realistic price range.
- Learner can name at least three of the six entrepreneur habits.
- Learner speaks concretely about Nigerian constraints and opportunities â€" not vague complaints or vague optimism.
- Learner identifies FastFix's problems correctly (no registration, no account, guessed pricing, no records, no invoices, no presence).

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Business means a shop and big money." â†' A business is a value exchange; it can start with a phone.
- "I have no skill." â†' Skills come from life, not certificates; use the starter list and evidence questions.
- "Everybody is my customer." â†' Push for a named group in a named place.
- "Price what the neighbour charges." â†' Price from cost plus profit (Session 4); guessing loses money.
- "I need money to start." â†' Action before perfect conditions; the smallest first step costs nothing.
- "Freelancing is not real business." â†' It is one of the three legitimate routes; many earn well from it.
- "The Offer Sheet is final." â†' It is a draft; Session 2 tests it and it gets revised.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Customer narrowing drill:** give three weak customer descriptions ("everybody", "all students", "people who like phones") and ask the learner to rewrite each as a specific group in a specific place with a specific problem.
2. **Route sorting drill:** give six mixed examples (a baker, a barber, a freelance writer, a POS agent, a phone repair shop, a soap maker) and ask the learner to label each freelance / service / product and explain one reason.
3. **Skill evidence drill:** ask the learner to list everything they did this week that someone might pay for; turn each into a skill with evidence.
4. **Offer Sheet pair test:** learners swap Offer Sheets and write down what they think the business does, who it serves, and what it costs; the author revises until the stranger's reading matches their intent.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed Offer Sheet (customer and problem already filled for a chosen skill); learner writes only the deliverable and price range. Provide a skill starter list and help with evidence.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" full skill inventory and Offer Sheet.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to write Offer Sheets for **two different skills** and a short paragraph comparing which is more likely to earn first and why. Also ask them to identify one way their chosen skill could be turned from freelance into a service or product business over time.

Capstone links. This session's deliverables â€" the skill inventory and the first Offer Sheet â€" become the "who we serve / what we sell" lines of the capstone one-page plan. The route choice shapes the business model; the price range is tested in Session 2 and replaced with a costed price in Session 4. Collect and keep the Offer Sheets: in Session 9 the learner will be able to show how the offer evolved from draft to validated, costed, priced and marketed â€" that visible evolution is excellent evidence of learning.

Timing guidance. The priority is learners producing a real Skill Inventory and a first Offer Sheet (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten Section F.4 (Nigerian realities) to the top three constraints and top three opportunities, and limit the independent exercise to the Offer Sheet only (the route paragraph becomes optional). Protect the practical time â€" a learner who leaves without a written Offer Sheet has no foundation for Session 2.

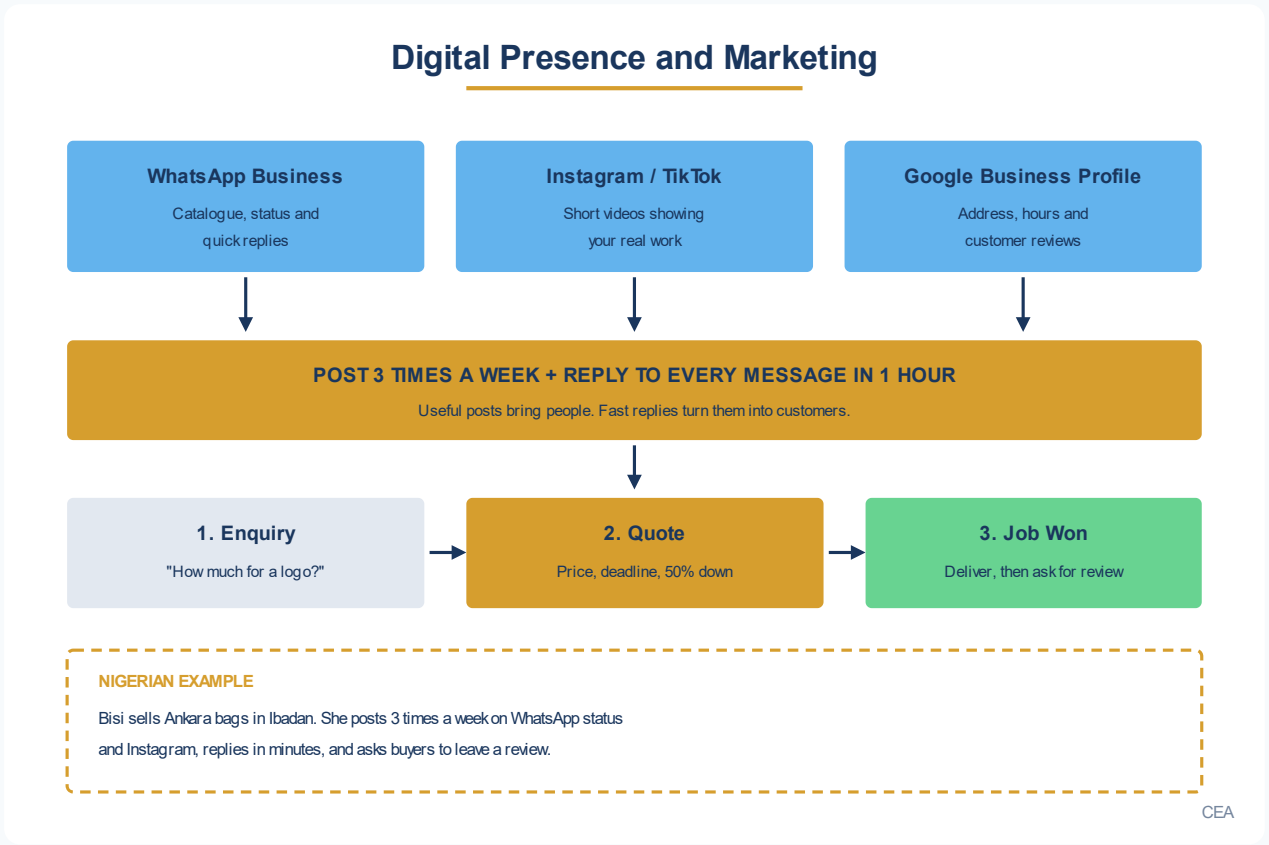
END OF SESSION 1

Next: Session 2 â€" Finding Your Market and Validating an Idea.

SESSION 02 OF 9

Finding Your Market and Validating an Idea

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 02



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" BUSINESS & FREELANCING

SESSION 2 â€" FINDING YOUR MARKET AND VALIDATING AN IDEA

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	2 of 9
Session title	Finding Your Market and Validating an Idea
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Start Right (Foundations)
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with market research)
Prerequisite knowledge	The Session 1 Offer Sheet (who / problem / deliverable / starting price range). Learners must be able to type or write a few sentences. No prior research knowledge required.

Item	Detail
Connection to previous work	In Session 1 you wrote a first Offer Sheet â€" a draft of who you serve, the problem, the deliverable and a price range. Today we test that draft against the real world: does the customer actually have that problem, and will they actually pay that price?
Preparation before class	Print the five open questions (Section F.3) on a handout; prepare the "Validation Notes" template (Section H) printed per learner; prepare the competitor price scan sheet; have the FastFix case pack ready; bring a sample completed Validation Notes sheet (the instructor's own example) for the demonstration; confirm learners brought their Session 1 Offer Sheet.

Instructor note on tone: Many learners are afraid that validation will "kill their idea". Reframe it: validation saves you from building something nobody wants. A "no" today is cheaper than a "no" after you have spent your savings. Keep the mood curious, not fearful.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Write** a clear customer-problem statement in one sentence and describe a specific target customer.
2. **Narrow** "everybody" into a niche and explain why a niche is easier to serve and to find.
3. **Describe** at least four free market research methods: market walks, competitor price checks, online search (Google, Jiji, Facebook, WhatsApp status) and respectful listening in WhatsApp groups.
4. **Ask** five open questions in a customer conversation, listen more than they talk, and record answers honestly â€" not as they hoped.
5. **Complete** a competitor price scan with at least five real observed prices and their sources.
6. **Apply** a simple decision rule â€" problem real? skill adequate? willingness to pay? competition survivable? â€" to make a reasoned **go / adjust / stop** decision.
7. **Produce** a Validation Notes sheet with three recorded customer conversations and a competitor scan (LO3, LO4).

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with a notes app) or an academy computer with Google Docs/Sheets.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.
- Notebook and pen (optional).

Software

- A simple text app: phone Notes, Google Docs or Microsoft Word.
- The **Validation Notes template** (Section H) projected and printed.
- The **Competitor Price Scan** sheet (Section H) printed.

Sample files

- Printed **five open questions** handout (Section F.3).
- A **sample completed Validation Notes sheet** (instructor's own example â€" e.g., for a fictional "Mama Chika's Kitchen" or for FastFix) for the demonstration.
- The **FastFix case pack** (from Session 1).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 2.1 â€" "Customer-Problem Statement" (one sentence, one specific customer).
- Worksheet 2.2 â€" "Five Open Questions" (printed handout).
- Worksheet 2.3 â€" "Validation Notes" (three conversations + decision).
- Worksheet 2.4 â€" "Competitor Price Scan" (five prices with sources).

Accounts

- None required this session. (Gmail needed from Session 3.)

Internet

- Useful but not required. If available, the instructor may show a live Google search or a Jiji listing to demonstrate a competitor check. The session works fully offline with printed examples and role-play.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a notes app works. A learner who cannot type quickly may write by hand or dictate to a classmate; the skill is the **thinking and the questions**, not the typing.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two short "idea statements" without labelling them.

- **Idea A:** "I want to start a food business. I will sell rice, beans, jollof and small chops. I will sell to everybody in Port Harcourt. I think it will make a lot of money."
- **Idea B:** "I want to sell fresh jollof rice to office workers around Trans-Amadi and GRA who have no time to cook lunch and are tired of the same old buka food. I will deliver a hot plate for â‚¦1,500, ordered by 10 a.m., delivered by 1 p.m."

What the instructor says:

> *"Two food businesses. Hands up â€" which one would you bet â‚¦10,000 on? â€¦ Idea B, almost always. Why? Because B knows exactly who the customer is, what bothers them, what they get, what it costs and when it arrives. A is a wish; B is a plan. Today we learn how to turn an Idea A into an Idea B â€" and then how to check whether Idea B is actually true before you spend your money."*

Expected learner response: Learners will say "B tells me who", "B has a price", "B solves a real problem", "A is too wide". Accept all answers and draw out the difference: **specific vs vague**.

Then reveal the hook: Ask, "How many of you have an idea that is still an Idea A â€" a wish?" Most hands go up. Say:

> *"Good. That is normal. Every good business starts as a wish. The difference between a wish and a business is **evidence** â€" and evidence is free to collect. Today you learn how to collect it."*

Why this opener works: It uses a business shape everyone understands (food), it isolates specificity as the variable, and it frames validation as a money-saving activity rather than a creativity-killing one.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the four parts of an Offer Sheet from Session 1?"

- Expected answer: **Who we serve / The problem / What we sell / Starting price range.**
- Common gap: learners remember the parts but not the order or the purpose. Clarify: "The Offer Sheet is a draft â€" today we test it."

Question 2: "Why is 'everybody' a bad customer?"

- Expected answer: You cannot find everybody, price for everybody or serve everybody; a specific customer is findable and describable.
- Common gap: some learners still write "everybody" because it feels safe. Clarify: "A niche is not a limitation â€" it is a focus. You can widen later."

Question 3: "What are the three routes to income?"

- Expected answer: **Freelancing** (time and skill), **service** (repeatable service), **product** (goods).
- Common gap: learners confuse the routes with the Offer Sheet. Clarify: "The route is the shape of the business; the Offer Sheet is the description of the offer."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have a draft Offer Sheet. Today we do not change it â€" we **test** it. We go to the market, we ask real people, we check what competitors charge, and then we decide: sell, adjust or park. That decision â€" made with evidence, not hope â€" is what turns a wish into a business."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the four parts of the Offer Sheet, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing them on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What validation is and why it saves you money

The idea. Validation is the process of checking whether your business idea is true before you spend serious money on it. You test the problem, the customer and the price with free research and real conversations.

Plain-English definition. Validation is asking the world â€" politely and cheaply â€" "Is this real? Will people pay?" before you bet your savings on the answer.

Why it exists. Most small businesses fail not because the owner is lazy, but because they build something nobody asked for. They spend money on stock, a shop, a logo â€" and then discover the customer does not exist, or will not pay. Validation moves that discovery to the beginning, when it is still free.

What it does:

- Confirms the **problem** is real and painful enough to pay for.
- Confirms the **customer** exists and is findable.
- Confirms the **price** is acceptable â€" or reveals it is not.
- Reveals the **competition** and whether you can survive it.
- Gives you **evidence** you can use in your plan, your pitch and your marketing.

Real-life comparison. Think of a market trader who wants to sell a new product. The lazy way: buy â‚¦50,000 of stock, put it on the table, and hope. The smart way: ask five regular customers, "Would you buy this? How much would you pay?" If three say yes at a good price, buy a small quantity first. If they say no, you have saved â‚¦50,000. Validation is the second way.

Important limitation / misconception. Validation does not guarantee success. It reduces risk. A "go" decision means "worth trying with a small first step" â€" not "guaranteed to make millions". A "stop" decision means "this idea, as described, is not worth your money" â€" not "you are a failure".

How a learner recognises a validated idea: They can point to at least three real people who confirmed the problem, at least five real competitor prices, and a decision made with reasons â€" not a feeling.

F.2 The customer-problem statement and the niche

The idea. Before you research, you must be able to say exactly who has the problem and what the problem is. A **customer-problem statement** is one sentence that names a specific customer and their specific pain.

Plain-English definition. A customer-problem statement is a single sentence: "[Specific customer] struggles with [specific problem] and needs [specific outcome]."

The anatomy â€" with a worked example for FastFix:

- **Customer:** "Office workers and students around Mile 3 and Trans-Amadi"
- **Problem:** "whose phone screen or battery fails during the workday"
- **Outcome:** "and who need it fixed the same day without losing their data."

- **Full statement:** "Office workers and students around Mile 3 and Trans-Amadi struggle with phone screens and batteries that fail during the workday, and they need same-day repair without losing their data."

Why a niche matters â€” the "everybody" trap:

- "Everybody" is not a customer; it is a crowd. You cannot find everybody, you cannot speak to everybody's problem, and you cannot price for everybody.
- A **niche** is a specific group with a specific problem in a specific place. It is easier to find, easier to serve, and easier to charge.
- You can always widen later â€” but you must start narrow enough to learn.

Worked example â€” narrowing "everybody" to a niche:

- Weak: "I sell food to everybody."
- Better: "I sell food to students."
- Niche: "I sell affordable lunch to students around the University of Port Harcourt who have no time to cook and are tired of the same buka food."
- The niche tells you: where to find them (campus), what they want (affordable, fast, different), and what to charge (student budget).

Real-life comparison. Think of two churches. Church A says "everybody is welcome" â€” and has no idea who is in the building. Church B says "we serve young families in this estate" â€” and knows exactly what to preach, what time to start, and what to put on the flyer. Both are churches; one is focused. Focus is not exclusion â€” it is clarity.

Misconception to correct. "A niche limits my market." No â€” a niche makes your first market findable. Once you serve the niche well, you can widen to the next group. Every big business started as a niche.

F.3 Free market research â€” four methods that cost nothing

The idea. You do not need a paid survey or a consultant. You need four free methods, used together, to see your market clearly.

Method 1 â€” The market walk.

- **What it is:** Physically walk where your customer is and observe.
- **What to look for:** Who is there? What are they buying? What are the prices? What is the competition doing? What is missing?
- **FastFix example:** Chidi walks around Mile 3 and Trans-Amadi at lunchtime. He counts phone repair stands, notes their prices on a piece of paper, watches how customers behave, and asks one or two people what they wish existed.
- **Why it works:** You see reality, not what people tell you. A customer may say "I would pay â‚¦5,000" â€” but the market walk shows what they actually pay.

Method 2 â€” The competitor price check.

- **What it is:** Find out exactly what your competitors charge, where they are, and what they offer.
- **How to do it:** Visit their shop, check their WhatsApp status, look at their Facebook page, search Jiji or Google. Write down: business name, location, price, what is included, what is missing.
- **FastFix example:** Chidi finds three other repair shops near Mile 3. He notes: Shop A charges â‚¦4,500 for a screen repair but has no warranty; Shop B charges â‚¦6,000 with a 30-day warranty; Shop C charges â‚¦3,500 but uses cheap parts. Now he knows the market â€” and where he can be different.
- **Why it works:** You cannot price in a vacuum. The market walk and the price check together show you the real range and the real gaps.

Method 3 â€” Online search and social listening.

- **What it is:** Use Google, Jiji, Facebook, Instagram and WhatsApp to see what customers are saying and what competitors are doing.
- **How to do it:** Search "phone repair Port Harcourt" on Google. Look at the results â€” who appears, what do they charge, what do customers say in the comments? Check Jiji for phone repair listings. Look at WhatsApp status of repair shops near you. Read the comments â€” customers complain and praise publicly.
- **Why it works:** Customers tell you the truth in comments and messages. A competitor's Facebook page with 500 comments is a free research report.

Method 4 â€” Respectful listening in WhatsApp groups.

- **What it is:** Join groups where your customer already is â€” and listen before you sell.

- **How to do it:** Join a church group, a student group, a market association group, a business group. Do not post your offer. Instead, listen: what problems do people mention? What do they ask for? What do they complain about? When a relevant problem appears, you can answer helpfully â€" and learn.
- **Why it works:** People say things in groups they would never say in a formal interview. You hear the real language of the problem.
- **Important rule:** Never spam a group with your offer. Listen first, help second, sell third â€" and only when it is genuinely relevant.

Real-life comparison. Think of a detective. A detective does not guess â€" they gather clues from the scene (market walk), the other suspects (competitors), the public records (online search) and the witnesses (WhatsApp groups). Validation is detective work â€" and it costs nothing but time.

Misconception to correct. "Market research is for big companies." No â€" it is for anyone who does not want to lose money. The cheapest research is the one that saves you from a bad decision.

F.4 The five open questions â€" how to talk to customers

The idea. The heart of validation is a conversation with a real potential customer. But most people do it wrong: they pitch instead of ask. The fix is five **open questions** â€" questions that cannot be answered with yes or no.

The five open questions â€" teach them one by one:

1. **"Tell me about the last time you had this problem."**
   - Why it works: It gets a real story, not an opinion. You learn how often the problem happens and how it feels.
   - Example: "Tell me about the last time your phone screen broke."
2. **"What did you do about it, and how much did it cost you?"**
   - Why it works: It reveals the current solution and the real price â€" the two most important facts in validation.
   - Example: "What did you do when your screen broke, and how much did you pay?"
3. **"What was the most frustrating part of that experience?"**
   - Why it works: It finds the pain you can remove. The pain is your selling point.
   - Example: "What was the most frustrating part â€" the cost, the time, the quality, or something else?"
4. **"If you could wave a magic wand and fix this perfectly, what would the solution look like?"**
   - Why it works: It lets the customer design your offer for you. You learn what "good" means to them.
   - Example: "If you could wave a magic wand, what would the perfect phone repair look like â€" price, time, quality, warranty?"
5. **"How much would you expect to pay for that?"**
   - Why it works: It tests the price without you guessing. You learn the customer's real budget.
   - Example: "How much would you expect to pay for a same-day screen repair with a warranty?"

The golden rules of the customer conversation:

- **Listen more than talk.** Aim for 70% listening, 30% asking. The customer is the teacher.
- **Do not pitch while listening.** This is not a sales call. You are gathering information, not closing a deal.
- **Record answers honestly.** Write what they said â€" not what you hoped they would say. If they say "I would never pay more than â‚¦3,000", write that, even if it hurts.
- **Thank them and ask for one referral.** "Do you know one other person who has this problem? Could I talk to them too?" This is how you get three conversations from one.
- **Do not argue.** If they say your idea is bad, say "Thank you â€" that is exactly what I needed to hear." Then ask why.

Real-life comparison. Think of a doctor. A doctor does not walk in and say "take this medicine". They ask: "Where does it hurt? When did it start? What have you tried?" Then they diagnose. The customer conversation is a diagnosis â€" and the diagnosis comes before the prescription.

Misconception to correct. "I should convince them my idea is good." No â€" you should discover whether it is good. Convincing is selling (Session 5). Today is learning.

F.5 The decision rule: go, adjust or stop

The idea. After your research, you make a decision. Not a feeling â€" a decision based on four questions.

The four questions â€" ask them in order:

1. **Is the problem real?** Did at least three people confirm they have this problem, and did they describe it in their own words?
2. **Is my skill adequate?** Can I actually deliver the solution well enough to make the customer happy?
3. **Is there willingness to pay?** Did the customer confirm they would pay a price that covers my cost plus profit?
4. **Is the competition survivable?** Can I differentiate enough â€" on price, quality, speed, warranty, service â€" to win customers?

The three decisions:

- **GO** â€" all four answers are yes. Start with a small first step.
- **ADJUST** â€" some answers are no, but the idea can be fixed. Change the customer, the problem, the price or the offer â€" then test again.
- **STOP** â€" the answers are mostly no, and the idea cannot be fixed without a different skill or more capital than you have. Park it. It is not a failure â€" it is a lesson.

Worked example â€" FastFix's validation decision:

- Problem real? Yes â€" Chidi talks to five office workers; four say their phone has failed in the last six months and they paid â‚¦3,000â€"â‚¦7,000 to fix it.
- Skill adequate? Yes â€" Chidi has repaired 50+ phones and learned from an experienced technician.
- Willingness to pay? Yes â€" three of the five say they would pay â‚¦4,000â€"â‚¦6,000 for a same-day repair with a warranty.
- Competition survivable? Yes â€" the three nearby shops either have no warranty or use cheap parts; Chidi can differentiate on quality and warranty.
- **Decision: GO** â€" with a small first step: offer same-day repair with a 30-day warranty at â‚¦4,500â€"â‚¦6,500, and test with 10 customers.

Real-life comparison. Think of a farmer. A farmer does not plant in a storm. They check the soil (problem), the seed (skill), the market price (willingness to pay) and the other farmers (competition) â€" then they plant. Validation is the farmer's check.

Misconception to correct. "A 'stop' decision means I failed." No â€" a stop decision means you saved your money and learned something. Many successful entrepreneurs have a list of stopped ideas behind them. The failure is spending money on an idea you never tested.

F.6 The Validation Notes sheet â€" your evidence document

The idea. Validation is only real if you write it down. The **Validation Notes** sheet is one page that records: the customer-problem statement, three customer conversations, the competitor scan, and the decision.

The structure â€" teach it part by part:

1. **Customer-problem statement** (one sentence).
2. **Three customer conversations** â€" for each: who they are, what they said (in their words), what they currently pay, what they would pay.
3. **Competitor price scan** â€" at least five competitors: name, location, price, what is included, what is missing.
4. **Decision** â€" go / adjust / stop, with reasons.

Worked example â€" a completed Validation Notes sheet for a fictional "Mama Chika's Kitchen":

Customer-problem statement: "Office workers around Trans-Amadi and GRA struggle with finding fresh, hot, affordable lunch near their workplace, and they need a reliable option that does not taste like the same old buka food."

Conversation 1: "I am a bank worker in GRA. I buy lunch every day. The buka near my office is always the same â€" rice and stew, rice and stew. I would love something different, maybe jollof with grilled chicken. I pay â‚¦1,000â€"â‚¦1,500 now. I would pay â‚¦1,500â€"â‚¦2,000 if it is fresh and hot."

Conversation 2: "I am a student near Trans-Amadi. I have no time to cook. I buy from the woman at the junction, but sometimes the food is cold. I pay â‚¦800â€"â‚¦1,200. I would pay â‚¦1,500 if it is delivered hot to my hostel."

Conversation 3: "I am a market woman in Mile 3. I need lunch I can eat quickly. I pay â‚¦1,000. I would pay â‚¦1,500 if it is packaged well and I can eat it fast."

Competitor scan:

Competitor	Location	Price	What is included	What is missing
Buka A	GRA	â‚¦1,000	Rice, beans, stew	No variety, no delivery
Buka B	Trans-Amadi	â‚¦1,200	Rice, jollof, small chops	No delivery, slow service
Mama Chika (current)	Home	â‚¦1,500	Jollof, grilled chicken	No consistent marketing
Restaurant C	GRA	â‚¦2,500	Full meal	Too expensive for daily lunch
Food seller D	Mile 3	â‚¦800	Rice, stew	No variety, no packaging

Decision: GO â€" the problem is real (three people confirmed), the skill is adequate (Mama Chika has cooked for events), willingness to pay is confirmed (â‚¦1,500â€"â‚¦2,000), and the competition has gaps (no delivery, no variety, no packaging). First step: sell 20 plates in week one to office workers and students, collect feedback, adjust.

Why this sheet matters: It is the evidence behind your business plan. In Session 9, you will show this sheet to prove your idea is not a guess. It is also the document you will update as you learn more.

Misconception to correct. "I will remember what people said." No â€" you will forget. Write it down. The sheet is your memory and your evidence.

F.7 Summary of the session

- **Validation** is checking whether your idea is true before you spend serious money.
- A **customer-problem statement** names a specific customer and their specific pain in one sentence.
- A **niche** is a specific group with a specific problem in a specific place â€" it makes your first market findable.
- Four free research methods: **market walk**, **competitor price check**, **online search and social listening**, **respectful listening in WhatsApp groups**.
- The **five open questions** â€" ask, listen, record honestly, do not pitch.
- The **decision rule**: problem real? skill adequate? willingness to pay? competition survivable? â†' **go / adjust / stop**.
- The **Validation Notes sheet** is your evidence document â€" three conversations, a competitor scan, and a decision.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Idea] --> B[Talk to 10 people]
    B --> C{Do they have the problem?}
    C -->|Yes| D{Will they pay?}
    C -->|No| A
    D -->|Yes| E[Validate & build]
    D -->|No| A
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Show the class how to run a customer conversation and record it on the Validation Notes sheet â€" live â€" so they can do it themselves.

Setup: Open a blank Google Doc titled "Validation Notes â€" [Instructor's example]". Have the five open questions on the projector. Invite a volunteer (or use a planted learner) to play a customer â€" e.g., an office worker looking for lunch.

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A blank Validation Notes template on the projector.
- The five open questions printed or projected.
- A volunteer briefed to play a realistic customer (or the instructor plays both roles, switching chairs).

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" the customer-problem statement (2 minutes)

Say: "Before we talk to anyone, we write the statement we are testing."

Write on the projector:

> *"Office workers around Trans-Amadi and GRA struggle with finding fresh, hot, affordable lunch near their workplace, and they need a reliable option that does not taste like the same old buka food."*

Say: "This is what we are testing. If the customer says 'no, that is not my problem', we adjust the statement. The statement is a hypothesis, not a fact."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" the customer conversation (8 minutes)

Say: "Now I ask the five open questions. Watch how I listen more than I talk."

Instructor (as researcher): "Thank you for talking to me. Tell me about the last time you had this problem â€" finding fresh, hot lunch near your office."

Volunteer (as customer): "Last week. I was so hungry, and the buka near my office had only rice and beans. I ate it, but I was not happy. I wanted something different."

Instructor: "What did you do about it, and how much did it cost you?"

Volunteer: "I ate the rice and beans. It was â‚¦1,000. I also bought a bottle of water for â‚¦200."

Instructor: "What was the most frustrating part of that experience?"

Volunteer: "The same food every day. And sometimes the food is cold by the time I get it."

Instructor: "If you could wave a magic wand and fix this perfectly, what would the solution look like?"

Volunteer: "Hot jollof with grilled chicken, delivered to my office, not too expensive."

Instructor: "How much would you expect to pay for that?"

Volunteer: "Maybe â‚¦1,500 to â‚¦2,000. Not more than that."

Instructor: "Thank you â€" that is exactly what I needed. Do you know one other person who has this problem?"

Volunteer: "Yes, my colleague. I can give you her number."

Say to the class: "Notice what I did not do. I did not say 'I sell jollof for â‚¦1,500, would you buy it?' I asked, I listened, I recorded. And I got a referral â€" that is how you get three conversations from one."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" record the conversation on the sheet (3 minutes)

Fill in the Validation Notes sheet on the projector as you narrate:

Field	Entry
Customer	Office worker, GRA
What they said (in their words)	"The buka near my office has only rice and beans. I want something different â€" hot jollof with grilled chicken, delivered to my office."
What they currently pay	â‚¦1,000â€"â‚¦1,200 (food + water)
What they would pay	â‚¦1,500â€"â‚¦2,000
Referral	Colleague at the same office

Say: "This is one conversation. We need three. And we need the competitor scan. Then we decide."

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€" the decision (2 minutes)

Say: "Let us say we did three conversations and a competitor scan. The problem is real â€" three people confirmed. The skill is adequate â€" we have cooked for events. Willingness to pay is confirmed â€" â‚¦1,500â€"â‚¦2,000. Competition has gaps â€" no delivery, no variety. What is the decision?"

Class: "GO!"

Say: "Yes â€" GO, with a small first step: 20 plates in week one. Not 200. Twenty. Test, learn, adjust."

G.6 Questions to ask during the demo

- "What did I ask first?" (The last time they had the problem â€" a story, not an opinion.)
- "What did I not do?" (I did not pitch. I did not convince.)
- "How did I get a referral?" (I asked for one at the end.)
- "What if the customer says 'I would never pay that'?" (We record it honestly and adjust â€" that is the point of validation.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner writes a customer-problem statement, practises the five open questions with a partner, and starts a Validation Notes sheet.

Starting materials: A pen and notebook or phone notes app; the five open questions handout; the Validation Notes template (projected and printed).

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name and today's date at the top of your workbook or notes app.
2. **Customer-problem statement:** Using your Session 1 Offer Sheet, write one sentence: "[Specific customer] struggles with [specific problem] and needs [specific outcome]." (Worksheet 2.1.)
3. **Pause and predict:** Ask yourself: "Is this customer specific enough that I could find three of them this week?" If not, narrow it.
4. **Pair up:** Find a partner. You will play the researcher; they will play a customer with the problem in your statement.
5. **Practise the five open questions:** Ask your partner the five questions, one at a time. Listen. Record their answers in your notes. (Worksheet 2.2.)
6. **Swap roles:** Your partner now plays the researcher; you play a customer for their idea.
7. **Record the conversation:** On your Validation Notes sheet (Worksheet 2.3), write down what your partner said â€" in their words, not your hopes.
8. **Competitor scan:** On the Competitor Price Scan sheet (Worksheet 2.4), write down at least three competitors you already know (from your area, your church, your market) â€" their name, location, price, what is included, what is missing. (You will add two more for the assignment.)
9. **First decision:** Based on your one practice conversation and your existing knowledge, write a preliminary decision: go / adjust / stop â€" with one reason.
10. **Share:** Tell your partner your decision and one thing you learned.

Expected result: A customer-problem statement, one recorded practice conversation, a partial competitor scan, and a preliminary decision.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 3: "Is your customer specific enough to find three of them this week?"
- After step 5: "Did you listen more than you talk? What did you learn that surprised you?"
- After step 9: "What would change your decision from adjust to go?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner's statement is still vague â†' Ask: "Where do these people live? What do they do? What exactly bothers them?"
- Learner pitches instead of asks â†' Stop them. "You are selling. Go back to asking. What did they say about the last time they had the problem?"
- Learner records what they hoped â†' Ask: "What did they actually say? Read me the exact words."
- Learner has no competitors â†' Ask: "Where do people currently go to solve this problem? Even one place is a competitor."
- Learner's decision is "go" with no evidence â†' Ask: "What evidence do you have? What would make you say adjust or stop?"

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Customer-problem statement is one sentence with a specific customer
- ☐ Five open questions practised with a partner
- ☐ One conversation recorded in the customer's words

- [ ] At least three competitors recorded with prices
- [ ] Preliminary decision written with one reason
- [ ] Decision shared with a partner

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Write a **full Validation Notes sheet** for a business idea that is NOT your own â€" a fictional "Port Harcourt Phone Accessories Shop" â€" using the supplied information, and make a go / adjust / stop decision.

Scenario. *Blessing* wants to open a small phone accessories shop (cases, chargers, earpieces, screen protectors) near the University of Port Harcourt. She has â‚¦30,000 for stock. She has sold accessories informally to friends before. She has not done any research yet.

Supplied information (use this to complete the sheet):

Customer-problem statement (draft): "Students around the University of Port Harcourt struggle with finding good-quality phone accessories at student-friendly prices near campus, and they need a shop they can trust not to sell fake products."

Conversation 1 (with a student): "I buy accessories from the market, but I never know if they are real. Last month I bought a charger that stopped working after two weeks. I paid â‚¦2,500. I would pay â‚¦3,000â€"â‚¦4,000 if I knew it would last."

Conversation 2 (with a student): "I mostly buy from Jiji because it is cheaper, but the quality is hit or miss. I would buy from a shop near campus if the prices were not too high â€" maybe 10% more than Jiji."

Conversation 3 (with a student): "I need a case and a screen protector. I want to see them before I buy. I would pay â‚¦5,000â€"â‚¦7,000 for both if they are good quality."

Competitor scan (partial â€" add two more from your own knowledge):

Competitor	Location	Price	What is included	What is missing
Jiji sellers	Online	â‚¦2,000â€"â‚¦3,000	Wide variety	No quality guarantee, no physical shop
Market stall A	Campus gate	â‚¦3,000â€"â‚¦5,000	Physical products	No warranty, limited stock
Shop B	Near campus	â‚¦4,000â€"â‚¦6,000	Quality products	Higher prices, no student discount

Requirements:

1. Complete the customer-problem statement (adjust it if the conversations suggest a better one).
2. Record the three conversations on the Validation Notes sheet â€" what they said, what they currently pay, what they would pay.
3. Add **two more competitors** to the scan (from your own knowledge of Port Harcourt).
4. Make a **go / adjust / stop** decision with at least two reasons.
5. Write one sentence: "Blessing's first step should be _____, because _____."

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Customer-problem statement is specific and reflects the conversations.
- Three conversations recorded with prices.
- Competitor scan has at least five entries.
- Decision is justified with reasons.
- First step is realistic and small.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: Look at what the students said â€" what problem comes up most often?
- Hint 2: For the decision, ask: is the problem real? Is the skill adequate? Will they pay? Can she compete?
- Hint 3: For the first step, think small â€" what is the smallest thing Blessing can do to test this?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Customer-problem statement (adjusted): "Students around the University of Port Harcourt struggle with finding good-quality phone accessories at student-friendly prices near campus, and they need a trustworthy shop that sells real products with a warranty."

Conversations recorded:

#	What they said	Currently pay	Would pay
1	"I never know if they are real. Last charger stopped after two weeks."	â‚¦2,500	â‚¦3,000â€"â‚¦4,000
2	"Jiji is cheaper but hit or miss. I would buy near campus if not too high."	â‚¦2,000â€"â‚¦3,000 (Jiji)	10% more than Jiji
3	"I want to see before I buy. Case + screen protector."	â€"	â‚¦5,000â€"â‚¦7,000

Competitor scan (with two added):

Competitor	Location	Price	What is included	What is missing
Jiji sellers	Online	â‚¦2,000â€"â‚¦3,000	Wide variety	No quality guarantee
Market stall A	Campus gate	â‚¦3,000â€"â‚¦5,000	Physical products	No warranty
Shop B	Near campus	â‚¦4,000â€"â‚¦6,000	Quality products	Higher prices
Roadside vendor C	Campus road	â‚¦1,500â€"â‚¦2,500	Cheap prices	No quality, no warranty
Online store D	Instagram	â‚¦3,500â€"â‚¦5,500	Quality + delivery	Delivery delay, no physical shop

Decision: ADJUST â€" the problem is real (three students confirmed quality concerns), the skill is adequate (Blessing has sold before), and willingness to pay is confirmed (â‚¦3,000â€"â‚¦7,000). But the competition is strong â€" Jiji is cheap, Shop B has quality. Blessing should adjust: differentiate on **warranty and student service** (e.g., "30-day warranty, student discount, see-before-you-buy") rather than competing on price alone. First step: buy a small stock of the most requested items (cases, screen protectors, chargers) and sell to 10 students with a warranty card, collect feedback.

First step: "Blessing's first step should be to buy a small stock of cases, screen protectors and chargers (â‚¦15,000) and sell to 10 students with a 30-day warranty, because this tests demand and quality without risking all â‚¦30,000."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Customer-problem statement specific and adjusted (2)
- Three conversations recorded with prices (2)
- Competitor scan has at least five entries (2)
- Decision justified with reasons (2)
- First step realistic and small (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Emeka* is a young man in Port Harcourt who noticed that many small businesses around him â€" salons, food sellers, phone repair shops â€" have terrible photos of their work. He thinks he can make money taking professional photos of their products and services with his phone. He has a good smartphone and has taken nice photos before. He has not done any research. He is thinking of buying a ring light and a small backdrop (â‚¦15,000) and printing flyers.

Relevant facts.

- Emeka has taken photos for his sister's food business â€" the photos helped her get more orders.
- He has not talked to any business owner about whether they would pay for photos.
- He does not know what photographers in Port Harcourt charge.
- He has â‚¦20,000 saved.

Decision point. Should Emeka buy the ring light and print flyers now?

Possible approaches.

1. Buy the equipment and print flyers â€" invest before testing.

2. Do nothing â€” the idea is too risky.
3. Validate first: talk to 10 business owners, check what photographers charge, test with 3 free or cheap jobs.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Emeka's idea may be good â€” but he does not know if business owners will pay, or how much. Buying equipment and printing flyers before validating is the most common way beginners lose money.

Reasoning / example validation plan for Emeka:

- **Customer-problem statement:** "Small business owners in Port Harcourt struggle with getting good photos of their products and services, and they need affordable photos that make their business look professional online."
- **Five open questions:** Ask 10 business owners: "Tell me about the last time you needed photos of your business. What did you do? How much did it cost? What was frustrating? What would perfect look like? How much would you pay?"
- **Competitor scan:** Check 5 photographers on Instagram and Jiji. Note their prices (â‚¦5,000â€“â‚¦30,000 per session), what is included, and what is missing.
- **Test:** Offer 3 free or cheap jobs to build a portfolio and testimonials.
- **Decision:** If at least 5 of 10 say yes and would pay â‚¦5,000+, GO â€” with a small first step. If most say no or "I use my phone", ADJUST â€” maybe the customer is different, or the price is wrong, or the service is different (e.g., "photos + social media posts").

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (buy first) risks â‚¦15,000 on an untested idea â€” and the equipment may sit unused.
- Approach 2 (do nothing) loses a possible income â€” but costs nothing.
- Approach 3 (validate first) costs only time and conversation â€” and either confirms the idea or saves the money.

Professional connection. Every successful business â€” from a one-person photography service to a big company â€” starts with understanding the customer. The ones that skip this step are the ones that fail quietly. Validation is not a delay â€” it is the fastest path to a real business.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Pitching instead of asking

Symptoms: The learner's "conversation" is a sales pitch; the customer says yes to everything. **Likely cause:** The learner is nervous and wants to sell, not learn. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What questions did you ask? What did the customer say â€” in their words?" **Corrective steps:** Return to the five open questions. Remind them: "You are a detective, not a salesman. Today you gather evidence." **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can repeat the customer's actual words, not a sales pitch. **Prevention:** Practise the five open questions in pairs before any real conversation.

K.2 Recording what you hoped, not what they said

Symptoms: The Validation Notes say "the customer loved it and would pay anything" â€” but the conversation was vague. **Likely cause:** The learner heard what they wanted to hear. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What exactly did they say? Read me the sentence." **Corrective steps:** Re-record with exact words. If the customer was vague, mark it as "unclear" â€” do not invent enthusiasm. **How to confirm resolved:** The notes contain direct quotes, not interpretations. **Prevention:** Write the customer's words in quotation marks. If you cannot quote it, you did not record it.

K.3 Talking to the wrong people

Symptoms: The learner asks their friends and family, who say "great idea!" â€” but strangers are not interested. **Likely cause:** Friends and family are kind, not honest. They are not the customer. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Who did you talk to? Are they the customer you described?" **Corrective steps:** Talk to real potential customers â€” people in the niche, not people who love you. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner has talked to at least three people who fit the customer description. **Prevention:** The customer-problem statement defines who to talk to â€” stick to it.

K.4 No competitor scan

Symptoms: The learner has conversations but no idea what competitors charge. **Likely cause:** They think competitors are not relevant â€” "I am different." **How to investigate:** Ask: "Where do people currently go to solve this problem? What do they

pay?" **Corrective steps:** Do the market walk and the price check. Find at least five competitors. **How to confirm resolved:** The scan has five entries with prices and sources. **Prevention:** You cannot price or position without knowing the competition.

K.5 A "go" decision with no evidence

Symptoms: The learner decides "go" but cannot point to three conversations or five prices. **Likely cause:** Excitement, not evidence. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What evidence do you have? What would make you say adjust or stop?" **Corrective steps:** Return to the four questions. If the evidence is missing, the decision is "adjust" (do more research) â€" not "go". **How to confirm resolved:** The decision is backed by specific evidence. **Prevention:** The decision rule requires evidence for all four questions â€" no evidence, no "go".

K.6 A "stop" decision that is really fear

Symptoms: The learner says "stop" after one vague conversation. **Likely cause:** Fear of rejection, not evidence. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How many people did you talk to? What did they actually say?" **Corrective steps:** If the evidence is thin, the decision is "adjust" (talk to more people) â€" not "stop". **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can explain what evidence would change their mind. **Prevention:** A stop decision requires multiple conversations that confirm the problem is not real â€" not one awkward chat.

K.7 Asking leading questions

Symptoms: "Wouldn't you love a service that…?" "Don't you think this is a good idea?" **Likely cause:** The learner wants confirmation, not truth. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What did you ask? Was it a yes/no question?" **Corrective steps:** Replace leading questions with open questions. "Tell me about…" not "Wouldn't you…" **How to confirm resolved:** The learner's questions cannot be answered with yes or no. **Prevention:** The five open questions are the script â€" use them.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it with the learner â€" ask them the investigation question and listen to the answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Validation Notes â€" Three Real Conversations and a Competitor Scan"

Purpose: To practise real market research â€" talking to actual potential customers and checking real competitors â€" and to produce the evidence document that will support your business plan.

Realistic scenario. You have a draft Offer Sheet from Session 1. This week, you will test it in the real world. You will talk to at least three real people who fit your customer description, record what they actually say, check at least five competitors, and make a go / adjust / stop decision.

Detailed instructions:

1. **Customer-problem statement:** Write one sentence based on your Session 1 Offer Sheet. Make it specific.
2. **Three real conversations:** Talk to at least three real people who fit your customer description. Use the five open questions. Record their answers in their words â€" not your hopes. For each, note: who they are, what they said, what they currently pay, what they would pay.
3. **Competitor scan:** Find at least five competitors (real businesses, online sellers, or people who currently solve the problem). For each, record: name, location, price, what is included, what is missing.
4. **Decision:** Make a go / adjust / stop decision with at least two reasons, based on the four questions (problem real? skill adequate? willingness to pay? competition survivable?).
5. **First step:** Write one sentence: "My first step is _____, because _____."
6. **Reflection:** Write 3â€"5 sentences: "What surprised me most in my conversations was _____. What I will change in my Offer Sheet is _____."

Required deliverables:

- A complete Validation Notes sheet (customer-problem statement, three conversations, competitor scan, decision, first step).
- A short reflection paragraph.

Submission format: Save as a Google Doc (or a clear photo of handwritten work) and upload to your Drive folder `CEA-Biz-YourName`, or show it to the instructor at the start of Session 3. You may also copy the text into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 3.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Customer-problem statement	2	One sentence, specific customer, specific problem
Three real conversations	6	Three people, answers in their words, prices recorded
Competitor scan	5	At least five competitors with prices and sources
Decision with reasons	4	Go/adjust/stop with at least two evidence-based reasons
First step & reflection	3	Realistic first step; honest reflection

Common mistakes to avoid: talking to friends instead of customers; recording hopes instead of words; no competitor scan; a decision with no evidence; no first step.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Model â€" for a fictional "Tobi's Phone Photography for Food Sellers":

Customer-problem statement: "Small food businesses in Port Harcourt struggle with getting appetising photos of their food, and they need affordable photos that make people want to order."

Conversations:

#	Who	What they said	Currently pay	Would pay
1	Food seller, Mile 3	"I take photos with my phone but they look dark. I want people to see how good my food looks."	â‚¦0 (own phone)	â‚¦3,000â€"â‚¦5,000
2	Food seller, Trans-Amadi	"I paid a photographer â‚¦10,000 once but the photos were not what I wanted. I want someone who understands food."	â‚¦10,000	â‚¦5,000â€"â‚¦8,000
3	Caterer, GRA	"I need photos for my WhatsApp status and Instagram. I want 10 photos I can post over two weeks."	â‚¦0 (own phone)	â‚¦5,000â€"â‚¦7,000

Competitor scan:

Competitor	Location	Price	What is included	What is missing
Photographer A	Instagram	â‚¦15,000â€"â‚¦30,000	Professional shoot	Too expensive for small sellers
Photographer B	Jiji	â‚¦5,000â€"â‚¦10,000	Basic shoot	No food specialisation
Friend with phone	â€"	â‚¦0	Free	Poor quality
Online stock photos	â€"	â‚¦0	Free	Not their food
Photographer C	Facebook	â‚¦8,000â€"â‚¦12,000	Event + food	No WhatsApp delivery

Decision: GO â€" the problem is real (three sellers confirmed), the skill is adequate (Tobi has taken good food photos), willingness to pay is confirmed (â‚¦3,000â€"â‚¦8,000), and the competition has gaps (too expensive, no food specialisation, no WhatsApp delivery). First step: offer 3 food sellers a photo session at â‚¦3,000 each, deliver 10 photos by WhatsApp in 2 days, collect testimonials.

First step: "My first step is to photograph three food sellers' meals for â‚¦3,000 each and deliver 10 photos by WhatsApp within 2 days, because this tests demand, builds a portfolio, and creates testimonials."

Reflection (model): "What surprised me most was that one seller paid â‚¦10,000 before and was disappointed â€" so price is not the only problem, quality and understanding are. I will change my Offer Sheet to emphasise 'photos that make your food look as good as it tastes' and to include WhatsApp delivery."

A strong learner solution differs in content but ticks every rubric row.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is validation, and why is it cheaper to do it before you spend money?

Q2. Multiple choice. Which of these is the best customer-problem statement? a) "I sell food to everybody." b) "Students around the University of Port Harcourt struggle with finding fresh, affordable lunch near campus, and they need a reliable option that does not taste like the same old buka food." c) "Food is important to everyone." d) "I want to start a food business."

Q3. Matching. Match each research method to what it is: (1) market walk, (2) competitor price check, (3) online search, (4) WhatsApp group listening. a) Searching Google and Jiji for what competitors charge b) Walking where your customer is and observing c) Joining groups where your customer is and listening before selling d) Checking competitors' prices, offers and gaps

Q4. True or false. "During a customer conversation, you should pitch your idea and convince them it is good."

Q5. Explain. What are the five open questions, and why are they better than "Would you buy my product?"

Q6. Practical. A learner has done three conversations and a competitor scan. The problem is real, the skill is adequate, but customers say they would only pay half of what the learner needs to charge. What is the decision â€" go, adjust or stop â€" and why?

Q7. Scenario. Your friend wants to start a business but has only talked to his mother, who says "it is a wonderful idea." What is wrong with his validation, and what should he do?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q7)

A1. Validation is checking whether your business idea is true before you spend serious money. It is cheaper to do it before because discovering that nobody wants your idea after you have spent money on stock, equipment or a shop is expensive; discovering it before costs only time and conversation.

A2. (b) â€" it names a specific customer, a specific problem, and a specific outcome.

A3. (1) = b, (2) = d, (3) = a, (4) = c.

A4. False. During a customer conversation you should ask and listen, not pitch. Pitching is for selling (Session 5); validation is for learning.

A5. The five open questions: (1) Tell me about the last time you had this problem. (2) What did you do about it, and how much did it cost you? (3) What was the most frustrating part? (4) If you could wave a magic wand, what would the solution look like? (5) How much would you expect to pay for that? They are better than "Would you buy my product?" because they cannot be answered with yes or no â€" they get real stories, real prices and real pain, not polite agreement.

A6. ADJUST. The problem is real and the skill is adequate, but willingness to pay is not confirmed at the needed price. The learner should adjust: lower the cost, change the offer, find a different customer, or add value â€" then test again. A "go" at a price that does not cover cost is a loss.

A7. His validation is weak because his mother is not his customer â€" she is kind, not honest, and she does not represent the market. He should talk to at least three real potential customers who fit his customer description, using the five open questions, and record what they actually say.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that validation is checking whether your idea is true before you spend serious money. You learned to write a customer-problem statement â€" one sentence naming a specific customer and their specific pain. You learned that a niche is not a limitation but a focus â€" it makes your first market findable. You learned four free research methods: the market walk, the competitor price check, online search and social listening, and respectful listening in WhatsApp groups. You practised the five open questions â€" ask, listen, record honestly, do not pitch. You learned the decision rule: problem real? skill adequate? willingness to pay? competition survivable? â€" leading to go, adjust or stop. And you started your Validation Notes sheet â€" the evidence document that will support your business plan.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Validation saves money** â€” it moves discovery to the beginning, when it is still free.
2. A **customer-problem statement** names a specific customer and their specific pain â€” not "everybody".
3. **Four free research methods** â€” market walk, competitor check, online search, WhatsApp listening â€” used together.
4. The **five open questions** â€” ask, listen, record honestly, do not pitch.
5. The **decision rule** â€” go / adjust / stop â€” based on evidence, not hope.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I write a customer-problem statement in one sentence?
- Can I name four free research methods?
- Can I ask the five open questions without pitching?
- Can I make a go / adjust / stop decision with reasons?
- Can I record a customer's words honestly, even when they are not what I hoped?

Connection to the next session. You now have evidence that your idea is real â€” or you have adjusted it until it is. But a business also needs a legal identity and clean money habits. Next session we cover registration, legal basics and money: what CAC registration does, what a TIN is, why a separate business account matters, how to separate personal and business money, and how to keep simple records. By the end of Session 3, you will have the foundation of a proper business â€” not just a good idea.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner writes a customer-problem statement with a specific customer and a specific problem â€” not "everybody".
- Learner asks open questions and listens more than they talk.
- Learner records the customer's actual words, including prices and frustrations â€” not their hopes.
- Learner completes a competitor scan with at least five real entries and sources.
- Learner makes a go / adjust / stop decision with evidence-based reasons.
- Learner identifies gaps in the competition â€” what is missing that they can provide.
- Learner can explain why validation is cheaper than guessing.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Validation kills ideas." â†’ It saves you from building something nobody wants; a "no" today is cheaper than a "no" after you spend money.
- "I should pitch during the conversation." â†’ No â€” ask and listen. Pitching is for Session 5.
- "My friends and family are my customers." â†’ They are kind, not honest. Talk to real potential customers.
- "I will remember what they said." â†’ Write it down. The sheet is your memory and your evidence.
- "A niche limits my market." â†’ A niche makes your first market findable; you can widen later.
- "A 'stop' decision means I failed." â†’ It means you saved your money and learned something.
- "I do not need to check competitors." â†’ You cannot price or position without knowing the competition.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Statement narrowing drill:** give three weak statements ("I sell to everybody", "Students need food", "I want a business") and ask the learner to rewrite each as a specific customer-problem statement.
2. **Question practice drill:** give a scenario and ask the learner to write five open questions â€” then check that none can be answered with yes or no.
3. **Recording honesty drill:** play a short customer statement (or read one) and ask the learner to write down exactly what was said â€ then compare with the original.
4. **Decision practice drill:** give a scenario with evidence (e.g., "3 of 5 people said yes, but they would only pay half your price") and ask the learner to make a go / adjust / stop decision with reasons.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed Validation Notes sheet (customer-problem statement and one conversation already filled); learner adds two more conversations and the decision. Provide a competitor list to choose

from.

- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€” full Validation Notes with three conversations and a competitor scan.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to validate **two different ideas** and write a short comparison: which is more promising and why. Also ask them to identify one way to differentiate from the strongest competitor.

Capstone links. This session's Validation Notes sheet becomes the market evidence in the capstone pack. The customer-problem statement becomes the "who we serve / the problem" lines of the one-page plan. The competitor scan informs the pricing and positioning in Sessions 4 and 5. The go / adjust / stop decision is the first real business decision the learner makes with evidence â€” and it is the kind of decision they will defend in the Session 9 viva.

Timing guidance. The priority is learners practising the five open questions and starting the Validation Notes sheet (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten Section F.3 (research methods) to the market walk and competitor check only, and limit the independent exercise to the decision and first step. Protect the conversation practice â€” a learner who leaves without asking and listening has not validated anything.

END OF SESSION 2

Next: Session 3 â€" Registration, Legal and Money Basics.

SESSION 03 OF 9

Registration Legal and Money Basics

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 03



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" BUSINESS & FREELANCING

SESSION 3 â€" REGISTRATION, LEGAL AND MONEY BASICS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	3 of 9
Session title	Registration, Legal and Money Basics
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Start Right (Foundations)
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with legal and money systems)
Prerequisite knowledge	The Session 2 Validation Notes (customer-problem statement, three conversations, competitor scan, decision). Learners must be able to type or write a few sentences. No prior legal or

Item	Detail
	accounting knowledge required.
Connection to previous work	In Session 2 you validated your idea â€" you have evidence that the problem is real and customers will pay. Today we put the foundation under that idea: a legal identity, a tax number, a separate bank account, and clean money habits. Without these, a business is a hobby with stress.
Preparation before class	Print the CAC steps summary (Section F.2) â€" labelled "example only â€" verify current requirements on cac.gov.ng"; print the money separation methods sheet; print the daily sales and expense sheet template; have the FastFix case pack ready; prepare a sample Google Sheets money tracker on the projector; confirm learners have a Gmail account (or help them create one at the break).

Instructor note on tone: Legal and money topics can feel intimidating or boring. Keep it practical and reassuring: you are not becoming a lawyer or an accountant â€" you are learning the basics that every business owner needs, and you are learning where to check current rules rather than memorising them. Emphasise that the course never asks learners to pay registration fees â€" they check the official site themselves.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** what CAC registration does and the difference between a **business name** and a **limited company**.
2. **Outline** the broad steps of CAC registration and state where to check current requirements and fees (cac.gov.ng) â€" never from memory or a roadside agent.
3. **Explain** what a **TIN** is, why clients and banks ask for it, and where to get one.
4. **Explain** why a **separate business bank account** matters and describe at least two practical money separation methods (two accounts, or an envelope system).
5. **Name** at least two permits or regulators that may apply to specific businesses (e.g., local government, NAFDAC for food) and state where to confirm them.
6. **Set up** a basic record-keeping sheet (daily sales and daily expenses) and make three example entries.
7. **Score at least 70%** on the Session 3 knowledge check (LO5).

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with a notes app) or an academy computer with Google Docs/Sheets.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.
- Notebook and pen (optional).

Software

- A simple text app: phone Notes, Google Docs or Microsoft Word.
- **Google Sheets** (free, via Gmail) for the money tracker â€" projected and, if possible, on learners' devices.
- The **daily sales and expense sheet template** (Section H) projected and printed.

Sample files

- Printed **CAC steps summary** (Section F.2) â€" clearly labelled "example only â€" verify on cac.gov.ng".
- Printed **money separation methods** sheet (Section F.4).
- A **sample Google Sheets money tracker** (instructor's own example â€" e.g., for FastFix) for the demonstration.
- The **FastFix case pack** (from Sessions 1â€"2).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 3.1 â€" "CAC Steps and Where to Check" (a table with steps and official sources).

- Worksheet 3.2 â€" "Money Separation Plan" (a plan for two accounts or an envelope system).
- Worksheet 3.3 â€" "Daily Sales and Expense Sheet" (a simple table for three days of entries).

Accounts

- A **Gmail account** is needed for Google Sheets. If any learner does not have one, help them create one at the break (this is a course requirement from this session onward).

Internet

- Useful but not required. If available, the instructor may show the CAC website (cac.gov.ng) to demonstrate where to check current fees. The session works fully offline with printed materials.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a notes app works. A learner who cannot type quickly may write by hand or dictate to a classmate; the skill is the **understanding and the habits**, not the typing.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two short "money stories" without labelling them.

- **Story A:** "Chidi from FastFix keeps all his money in his personal account. Business money and personal money are mixed. He does not know if he is making profit. Last month he spent â‚¦20,000 on business stock and â‚¦15,000 on family expenses â€" but he cannot tell which was which. A customer paid him â‚¦50,000, and he used â‚¦30,000 to fix his car. He has no idea what his business is actually earning."
- **Story B:** "Adaeze from Adaeze Fashion has a separate business account. Every payment from customers goes into it. Every business expense comes out of it. She keeps a simple record of sales and expenses. At the end of each week, she looks at her records and knows exactly how much the business made. Last week she saw that her fabric costs were too high, so she found a cheaper supplier."

What the instructor says:

> *"Two businesses. Hands up â€" which one would you rather run? â€¦ Story B, almost always. Why? Because Adaeze **knows** her numbers. She can see profit, she can find waste, she can make decisions. Chidi is flying blind â€" and most small businesses in Nigeria fly blind. Today we learn to see. We learn the legal basics â€" registration, TIN, permits â€" and the money basics â€" a separate account, money separation, and simple records. By the end of this session, you will have the foundation of a proper business."*

Expected learner response: Learners will say "B knows her money", "A is confused", "B can make decisions", "A will run out of money". Accept all answers and draw out the difference: **structure vs chaos**.

Then reveal the hook: Ask, "How many of you know a business that mixed personal and business money â€" and suffered for it?" Many hands go up. Say:

> *"That is not a failure of character â€" that is a failure of system. And a system is learnable. Today we build it."*

Why this opener works: It uses the running example (FastFix) and a contrasting example, it isolates structure as the variable, and it frames legal and money basics as practical tools rather than boring rules.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What is a customer-problem statement, and what makes a good one?"

- Expected answer: One sentence naming a specific customer and their specific problem. A good one is specific â€" not "everybody".

- Common gap: learners remember the term but not the specificity. Clarify: "A good statement could be tested by talking to real people."

Question 2: "What are the five open questions?"

- Expected answer: (1) Tell me about the last time you had this problem. (2) What did you do about it, and how much did it cost? (3) What was the most frustrating part? (4) If you could wave a magic wand, what would the solution look like? (5) How much would you expect to pay?
- Common gap: learners remember two or three. Clarify: "The five questions are your script â€" they work for any business."

Question 3: "What is the decision rule for validation?"

- Expected answer: Problem real? skill adequate? willingness to pay? competition survivable? â†' go / adjust / stop.
- Common gap: learners remember "go / adjust / stop" but not the four questions. Clarify: "The four questions are the evidence; the decision is the conclusion."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have validated your idea â€" you have evidence. Now we put the foundation under it. A business needs three things to be proper: a **legal identity** (so the government and customers know you exist), a **tax number** (so you can pay your share and prove you are legitimate), and **clean money habits** (so you know if you are making profit). Today we learn all three."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the five open questions, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing them on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why legal and money basics matter

The idea. A business can run for a while without registration, a TIN or a separate account â€" but it will hit a wall. The wall might be a customer who asks for your TIN, a bank that won't open an account without registration, a tax demand you did not expect, or your own confusion about whether you are making profit. The basics prevent the wall.

Plain-English definition. Legal and money basics are the minimum structure that makes a business **real** to the government, the bank, the customer â€" and to you.

Why they matter â€" four reasons:

1. **Customers trust a registered business.** A business name on your invoice, a TIN on your receipt â€" these signal that you are legitimate and can be held accountable.
2. **Banks require structure.** To open a business account, a bank will ask for registration and a TIN. Without them, you are stuck with a personal account.
3. **Taxes are easier when you are organised.** A registered business with records can plan for taxes. An unregistered business with no records is always at risk of a surprise demand.
4. **You can see profit.** A separate account and simple records tell you the truth about your money â€" the most important information in business.

Real-life comparison. Think of a driver. A driver can drive without a licence for a while â€" but they are always at risk of a fine, an accident they cannot claim for, or a police stop that ends their journey. Registration, a TIN and a separate account are the business licence â€" they let you drive properly.

Important limitation / misconception. "Registration makes my business successful." No â€" registration makes your business **legitimate**. Success still depends on your offer, your customers and your work. Registration is the foundation, not the house.

F.2 CAC registration â€" what it does and how it works

The idea. The **Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC)** is the government body that registers businesses in Nigeria. Registration gives your business a legal identity â€" a name that is officially yours.

What registration does:

- Gives your business a **legal name** that is recognised by government, banks and customers.
- Allows you to open a **business bank account**.
- Enables you to get a **TIN** (Tax Identification Number).
- Makes your business **visible** to customers and partners.
- Is often required for **government contracts, grants and support schemes**.

Business name vs limited company â€" the key difference:

- **Business name:** Simpler, cheaper, faster. Registered by one person (or a few). The owner and the business are legally the same â€" the owner is personally liable for the business's debts. Good for most small businesses and freelancers starting out.
- **Limited company:** More complex, more expensive, more formal. The company is a separate legal person â€" the owners are generally not personally liable for the company's debts. Requires more paperwork, annual returns, and often a lawyer or accountant. Good for businesses that plan to grow large, take on partners, or need limited liability.

The broad steps â€" teach them as a sequence (example only â€" verify current requirements on cac.gov.ng):

1. **Check name availability** â€" search the CAC portal to see if your chosen business name is available.
2. **Prepare your information** â€" you will need personal details (name, address, ID), the business name, the business address, and the nature of the business.
3. **Complete the application** â€" online via the CAC portal or at a CAC office.
4. **Pay the fee** â€" the current fee is checked on the official site (never from memory or a roadside agent).
5. **Receive your certificate** â€" the CAC issues a certificate of registration with your business name and registration number.

Where to check current requirements and fees:

- **Official CAC website:** cac.gov.ng
- **CAC office:** visit in person if you need help.
- **Never** rely on a WhatsApp forward, a roadside "agent" who promises to "do it fast", or a friend's memory of the fee. Requirements and fees change â€" check the official source.

Real-life comparison. Think of registration like a national ID card. You can live without one for a while â€" but you cannot open a bank account, vote, or prove who you are. A business registration is the ID card for your business.

Misconception to correct. "Registration is only for big companies." No â€" a sole trader selling at the market can and should register a business name. It is cheaper and simpler than most people think, and it opens doors.

Say this to the class:

> *"We are not asking you to register today. We are teaching you what registration is, why it matters, and where to check the current requirements. When you are ready â€" and only when you are ready â€" you will check the official site and decide. The course never asks you to pay a registration fee to anyone."*

F.3 TIN â€" your tax identification number

The idea. A **Tax Identification Number (TIN)** is a unique number assigned to you (or your business) for tax purposes. It is how the tax authority knows you exist and tracks your tax obligations.

What a TIN does:

- Identifies you to the **Federal Inland Revenue Service (FIRS)** and state tax authorities.
- Is required by many **banks** to open a business account.
- Is often requested by **corporate clients** who need to remit tax on your behalf (withholding tax).
- Allows you to **file tax returns** and stay compliant.

Why clients and banks ask for it:

- **Banks** need it to open a business account and to report your transactions to the tax authority.
- **Corporate clients** may need it to process your invoice and remit withholding tax â€" if you do not have a TIN, they may refuse to pay you or deduct a higher rate.
- **Government** uses it to track who is paying tax and who is not.

How to get a TIN:

- Apply through the **FIRS** (Federal Inland Revenue Service) or your **state tax authority**.
- The process and requirements change â€" check the official FIRS or state tax website for current information.
- A business name registration from CAC often makes the TIN process easier.

Real-life comparison. Think of a TIN like a phone number for tax. Just as people need your phone number to reach you, the tax authority needs your TIN to reach you â€" and you need it to prove you are a real, tax-compliant business.

Misconception to correct. "A TIN means I will pay a lot of tax." No â€" a TIN means you are **identified** and can **plan** for tax. Many small businesses have thresholds below which they pay little or nothing â€" but the threshold changes, and you check the current rules on the official site. The TIN is not a tax bill; it is an identity.

F.4 Money separation â€" the most important habit in small business

The idea. The single most common money mistake in small business is **mixing personal and business money**. When they are mixed, you cannot see profit, you cannot plan for tax, and you cannot make decisions. Money separation is the habit of keeping them apart.

Why it matters â€" three reasons:

1. **You can see profit.** If all business money is in one place, you can subtract expenses from income and see the truth.
2. **You can plan for tax.** When business money is separate, you can set aside a percentage for tax without touching your personal spending money.
3. **You can make decisions.** Clean records tell you which services are profitable, which customers pay on time, and where you are wasting money.

Method 1 â€" Two accounts (the best method):

- Open a **separate business bank account** (requires CAC registration and a TIN).
- All business income goes into the business account.
- All business expenses come out of the business account.
- You pay yourself a "salary" or "drawing" from the business account to your personal account â€" a fixed amount, on a fixed day.
- The business account is for the business; the personal account is for you. They never mix.

Method 2 â€" The envelope system (for businesses without a bank account):

- Use **separate physical envelopes, boxes, or pots** for business money and personal money.
- Label them clearly: "BUSINESS" and "PERSONAL".
- All business income goes into the BUSINESS envelope.
- All business expenses come out of the BUSINESS envelope.
- You move a fixed amount from BUSINESS to PERSONAL as your "salary" â€" on a fixed day.
- Keep a simple record of what goes in and out of each envelope.

The rules of money separation â€" say them slowly:

1. **Never** take business money for personal use without recording it as a "drawing".
2. **Never** pay business expenses from personal money without recording it as "owner's contribution".
3. **Always** record every movement of money â€" even â‚¦500.
4. **Review** your money every week â€" five minutes, same day, same time.

Real-life comparison. Think of a market trader with two pots. One pot is for the business â€" sales go in, stock comes out. The other pot is for the home â€" food, rent, school fees. At the end of the week, the trader looks at the business pot and knows: did I make profit? If the pots are mixed, the trader is guessing â€" and guessing is how businesses fail.

Misconception to correct. "I do not have enough money to separate." No â€" separation is not about the amount; it is about the habit. A trader selling â‚¦500 of pure water can keep two envelopes. The habit matters more than the amount.

F.5 Permits and regulators â€" check, don't guess

The idea. Beyond CAC registration and a TIN, some businesses need additional permits or must follow specific regulators. The key is to **check** â€" not to guess, and not to assume you need something you do not.

Common permits and regulators â€" examples (verify current requirements):

- **Local government:** Many businesses need a local government permit or levy to operate in their area. Check with your local government council.
- **NAFDAC:** Businesses that make, sell or distribute food, drugs, cosmetics and related products may need NAFDAC registration or approval.
- **Sector regulators:** Some sectors have specific regulators â€" e.g., telecommunications, finance, health. If your business is in a regulated sector, check the relevant regulator.
- **Signage and physical premises:** If you have a shop or signboard, your local government may have rules about signage and premises.

How to check:

- Ask your **local government office** what permits are required for your type of business.
- Check the **official website** of the relevant regulator (e.g., NAFDAC for food).
- Ask other business owners in your area what they have â€" but verify with the official source.
- When in doubt, ask a **licensed professional** (lawyer, accountant) â€" but remember, this course teaches awareness, not professional advice.

Real-life comparison. Think of driving again. You need a licence (CAC), a roadworthiness certificate (permits), and insurance (sector rules, if applicable). You do not need all of these for every car â€" but you need to know which ones apply to yours. The same is true for business.

Misconception to correct. "Permits are only for big shops." No â€" a food seller may need NAFDAC approval; a local government levy may apply to a market stall. The size of the business does not remove the need â€" it changes which permits apply.

F.6 Basic record-keeping â€" the daily sales and expense sheet

The idea. Record-keeping is not accounting â€" it is simply writing down what comes in and what goes out. A daily sales and expense sheet is the simplest record a business can keep.

What to record â€" every day:

- **Sales:** Every naira that comes in â€" cash, transfer, POS. Write the date, the customer (or job), and the amount.
- **Expenses:** Every naira that goes out â€" stock, transport, data, food, packaging, generator, rent. Write the date, what it was for, and the amount.

The simple sheet â€" teach the structure:

Date	Description	Sales (â‚¦)	Expenses (â‚¦)	Balance (â‚¦)
1 Oct	Screen repair â€" Customer A	5,000		5,000
1 Oct	Transport to market		500	4,500
2 Oct	Battery replacement â€" Customer B	3,000		7,500
2 Oct	New battery stock		2,000	5,500
3 Oct	Charger sale â€" Customer C	1,500		7,000
3 Oct	Data for WhatsApp		500	6,500

The weekly review â€" five minutes, every week:

- Add up the week's sales.
- Add up the week's expenses.
- Subtract: sales minus expenses = profit (or loss).
- Ask three questions: What sold well? What cost too much? What will I change next week?

Why this matters: The sheet turns your business from a feeling into a number. After four weeks, you can see: "I make â‚¦15,000 a week, but I spend â‚¦12,000 â€" my profit is only â‚¦3,000. I need to either sell more or spend less." That is a decision you can only make with records.

Real-life comparison. Think of a student tracking their pocket money. If they write down every naira received and every naira spent, they know exactly how much they have â€" and they can plan. If they do not, they run out mid-week and wonder why. A business is the same â€" just with bigger numbers.

Misconception to correct. "Record-keeping is for accountants." No â€" it is for anyone who wants to know the truth about their money. You do not need to be an accountant to write down what comes in and what goes out.

F.7 Summary of the session

- **Legal and money basics** make a business real to the government, the bank, the customer â€" and to you.
- **CAC registration** gives your business a legal identity. A **business name** is simpler and cheaper; a **limited company** is more formal and offers limited liability. Check current requirements on cac.gov.ng â€" never from memory.
- A **TIN** identifies you for tax. Banks and corporate clients ask for it. Check the official FIRS or state tax site for current information.
- **Money separation** â€" two accounts or an envelope system â€" is the most important habit in small business. It lets you see profit, plan for tax, and make decisions.
- **Permits and regulators** vary by business type and location. Check with your local government and the relevant regulator â€" do not guess.
- **Basic record-keeping** â€" a daily sales and expense sheet and a five-minute weekly review â€" turns your business from a feeling into a number.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Choose business name] --> B[Check CAC availability]
    B --> C[Register with CAC]
    C --> D[Get TIN]
    D --> E[Open business bank account]
    E --> F[Start operating legally]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Show the class how to set up a simple money tracker in Google Sheets and make example entries â€" live â€" so they can do it themselves.

Setup: Open a blank Google Sheet titled "Money Tracker â€" FastFix (Sample)". Have the daily sales and expense sheet template on the projector. Project both.

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A blank Google Sheet on the projector.
- The daily sales and expense sheet template.
- A set of example transactions for FastFix (below).

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" set up the sheet (4 minutes)

Say: "We will build a money tracker in Google Sheets. It is free, it is on your phone, and it takes five minutes."

Create the sheet on the projector, narrating each step:

Column A	Column B	Column C	Column D	Column E
Date	Description	Sales (â‚¦)	Expenses (â‚¦)	Balance (â‚¦)

Say: "Five columns. Date, description, sales, expenses, balance. That is it. You can add more later â€" but start with these five."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" make example entries (6 minutes)

Enter the following FastFix transactions, narrating each one:

Date	Description	Sales (â‚¦)	Expenses (â‚¦)	Balance (â‚¦)
1 Oct	Opening balance			10,000
1 Oct	Screen repair â€" Customer A	5,000		15,000
1 Oct	Transport to market		500	14,500
2 Oct	Battery replacement â€" Customer B	3,000		17,500
2 Oct	New battery stock		2,000	15,500
3 Oct	Charger sale â€" Customer C	1,500		17,000
3 Oct	Data for WhatsApp		500	16,500

Say: "Every transaction gets a row. Sales go in the sales column. Expenses go in the expenses column. The balance is the running total. At the end of the week, I add up sales and expenses â€" and I know my profit."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" the weekly review (3 minutes)

Say: "Every week â€" same day, same time â€" I do a five-minute review."

Show the review on the projector:

- **Total sales this week:** 5,000 + 3,000 + 1,500 = **â‚¦9,500**
- **Total expenses this week:** 500 + 2,000 + 500 = **â‚¦3,000**
- **Profit this week:** 9,500 âˆ' 3,000 = **â‚¦6,500**
- **What sold well:** Screen repairs (highest price).
- **What cost too much:** Battery stock (â‚¦2,000 â€" can I find a cheaper supplier?).
- **What I will change:** Order battery stock in bulk to reduce cost.

Say: "That is a weekly review. Five minutes. It turns records into decisions."

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€" the money separation plan (2 minutes)

Say: "Now the separation plan. FastFix does not have a separate account yet â€" so we use the envelope system."

Show the plan on the projector:

- **Envelope 1 â€" BUSINESS:** All sales go in. All business expenses come out.
- **Envelope 2 â€" PERSONAL:** Family expenses, food, transport for home.
- **Every Friday:** Move â‚¦2,000 from BUSINESS to PERSONAL as Chidi's "salary".
- **Record every movement:** Even â‚¦500.

Say: "When Chidi registers and opens a business account, he will switch to two accounts â€" but the habit is the same. Separate, record, review."

G.6 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Why do we record every transaction, even â‚¦500?" (Because small amounts add up â€" and because you cannot see profit without the full picture.)
- "What is the weekly review for?" (To turn records into decisions â€" what sold, what cost too much, what to change.)
- "What if I do not have a bank account?" (Use the envelope system â€" the habit is the same.)
- "When do I switch from envelopes to a bank account?" (When you register with CAC and get a TIN â€" then open a business account.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner sets up a money tracker (on paper or in Google Sheets), makes three example entries, and writes a money separation plan.

Starting materials: A pen and notebook or phone notes app; the daily sales and expense sheet template (projected and printed); a Google Sheets account (or paper alternative).

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name and today's date at the top of your workbook or notes app.
2. **Set up the tracker:** Draw the five columns (Date / Description / Sales / Expenses / Balance) â€" or open a Google Sheet with these columns. (Worksheet 3.3.)
3. **Make three example entries:** Use your own business idea (or FastFix's) and write three transactions â€" at least one sale and one expense. Calculate the balance after each.
4. **Pause and predict:** Ask yourself: "After these three transactions, is my balance higher or lower than I started? Why?"
5. **Weekly review:** Add up your sales and expenses. Calculate your profit (or loss). Write one sentence: "What I will change next week is _____."
6. **Money separation plan:** Write your plan â€" two accounts or the envelope system. (Worksheet 3.2.) State: which method you will use, how you will separate, and when you will review.
7. **Share:** Tell your partner your plan and one thing you learned from the example entries.
8. **Revise:** Based on your partner's feedback, revise your plan if needed.

Expected result: A money tracker with three example entries, a calculated profit/loss, and a written money separation plan.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 4: "Is your balance higher or lower? What does that tell you?"
- After step 5: "What will you change next week â€" and how do you know?"
- After step 7: "Does your partner's plan make sense? What would you suggest?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner's balance is wrong â†' Ask: "Check your addition. Did you subtract expenses correctly?"
- Learner has no sales â†' Ask: "What would you sell first? Write one sale â€" even a small one."
- Learner's plan is vague ("I will be careful") â†' Ask: "What exactly will you do? Two envelopes? Two accounts? When will you review?"
- Learner does not have a Gmail account â†' Help them create one now, or use the paper alternative.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Tracker set up with five columns
- ☐ Three example entries made (at least one sale, one expense)
- ☐ Balance calculated correctly after each entry
- ☐ Weekly review done â€" profit/loss calculated
- ☐ One sentence: what I will change next week
- ☐ Money separation plan written (method, separation, review)
- ☐ Plan shared with a partner

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Write a **CAC steps and money rules page** for a fictional business â€" "Mama Chika's Kitchen" â€" including the registration steps, the money separation plan, and a record-keeping routine.

Scenario. *Mama Chika* sells jollof rice and small chops from her home in Port Harcourt. She has been selling for six months to friends and neighbours. She has no registration, no TIN, no separate account, and no records. She keeps all money in her personal account and writes nothing down. She wants to "do things properly" but does not know where to start.

Requirements:

1. **CAC steps:** Write the broad steps Mama Chika should follow to register her business name â€" and state where she should check current requirements and fees. (Use the steps from Section F.2 â€" but write them in your own words.)
2. **TIN:** Explain in 2â€"3 sentences what a TIN is and why Mama Chika needs one.
3. **Money separation plan:** Write Mama Chika's plan â€" she does not have a bank account yet, so use the envelope system. State: how she will separate, what she will record, and when she will review.

4. **Record-keeping routine:** Write a simple daily routine â€" what she will write down every day, and what she will do every week.
5. **Permits:** Name one permit or regulator that may apply to Mama Chika's food business, and state where she should check.

Constraints:

- Write in simple English â€" Mama Chika is not a lawyer or accountant.
- All figures and requirements must be labelled "example only â€" verify on the official site" where appropriate.
- Do not invent specific fee amounts â€" state where to check.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- CAC steps are clear and in order, with the official source named.
- TIN explanation is correct and simple.
- Money separation plan is concrete (envelopes, recording, review).
- Record-keeping routine is daily and weekly.
- At least one permit/regulator is named with where to check.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For the CAC steps, use the five steps from Section F.2 â€" but write them as instructions for Mama Chika.
- Hint 2: For the TIN, think: why do banks and corporate clients ask for it?
- Hint 3: For the permits, think: what does Mama Chika sell, and who regulates that?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

CAC steps (in own words):

1. Mama Chika should go to the official CAC website (cac.gov.ng) and check if her chosen business name â€" "Mama Chika's Kitchen" â€" is available.
2. She should prepare her personal details (name, address, ID), the business name, her home address as the business address, and a description of what she sells.
3. She should complete the application â€" online or at a CAC office.
4. She should pay the fee â€" the current fee is checked on the official CAC website, not from memory or an agent.
5. She should receive her certificate of registration with her business name and registration number.

Where to check: The official CAC website â€" cac.gov.ng. She should never rely on a WhatsApp forward or a roadside agent for the current fee or requirements.

TIN explanation (2â€"3 sentences): A TIN is a Tax Identification Number â€" a unique number that identifies Mama Chika's business to the tax authority. She needs it to open a business account, to file tax returns, and to prove she is a legitimate business to corporate clients. She can apply through the FIRS or her state tax authority â€" the current process is checked on the official FIRS or state tax website.

Money separation plan (envelope system):

- Mama Chika will use two envelopes: one labelled "BUSINESS" and one labelled "HOME".
- All money from food sales goes into the BUSINESS envelope.
- All business expenses (ingredients, transport, data, packaging) come out of the BUSINESS envelope.
- Every Friday, she will move â‚¦3,000 from BUSINESS to HOME as her "salary".
- She will record every movement of money â€" even â‚¦200 â€" in a small notebook.

Record-keeping routine:

- **Every day:** Write down every sale (customer, item, amount) and every expense (what, amount, date).
- **Every week (Friday):** Add up the week's sales and expenses. Calculate profit (sales minus expenses). Ask: What sold well? What cost too much? What will I change next week?

Permits: Mama Chika sells food â€" so she may need approval from **NAFDAC** (the National Agency for Food and Drug Administration and Control) for some food products, and she may need a **local government permit** to operate from her home. She should check with her local government office and the NAFDAC website for current requirements â€" not guess.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- CAC steps clear and in order, official source named (2)
- TIN explanation correct and simple (2)
- Money separation plan concrete (2)
- Record-keeping routine daily and weekly (2)
- At least one permit/regulator named with where to check (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Ifeanyi* runs a small POS (point-of-sale) business in Port Harcourt. He has been running it for two years from a small stand near a market. He has no CAC registration, no TIN, and no separate account â€" all his POS transactions go into his personal account. He keeps no records. Last month, a bank officer told him he needs to regularise his account or it will be restricted. Ifeanyi is confused and worried. He does not know where to start.

Relevant facts.

- Ifeanyi processes about â‚¦50,000 a month in POS transactions.
- He has been using his personal account for both business and family money.
- He does not know if he is making profit â€" he just knows the money "comes and goes".
- The bank has asked for his TIN and business registration.

Decision point. What should Ifeanyi do first?

Possible approaches.

1. Ignore the bank â€" it is probably nothing.
2. Close the account and start fresh with a new bank.
3. Regularise: register his business name, get a TIN, open a separate business account, and start keeping records.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Ifeanyi's problem is not the bank â€" it is that he has been running a business without the foundation. The bank is simply the first place the missing structure shows up. Regularising will solve the bank issue and give him the foundation he should have had from the start.

Reasoning / example steps for Ifeanyi:

1. **Register his business name** with CAC â€" check the current process and fee on cac.gov.ng.
2. **Apply for a TIN** through FIRS or the state tax authority â€" check the official site for current requirements.
3. **Open a separate business account** â€" with his CAC certificate and TIN.
4. **Move business transactions to the new account** â€" all POS income goes in, all business expenses come out.
5. **Start keeping records** â€" a daily sales and expense sheet, and a weekly review.
6. **Separate his "salary"** â€" move a fixed amount from the business account to his personal account every week.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (ignore) risks account restriction, missed opportunities, and continued blindness about his profit.
- Approach 2 (close and start fresh) does not solve the underlying problem â€" the new account will have the same issues.
- Approach 3 (regularise) takes a few weeks and some effort â€" but it solves the bank issue, gives him a legal identity, and puts him in control of his money.

Professional connection. Every bank, every corporate client, and every government agency asks the same question: "Are you a legitimate business?" The answer is not a feeling â€" it is a registration number, a TIN, and a separate account. These are not burdens; they are the keys that open doors.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Mixing personal and business money

Symptoms: The learner cannot say whether they are making profit; money "disappears"; they feel confused about their finances. **Likely cause:** All money is in one account or one envelope â€" no separation. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Where does business money go? Where does personal money go? Can you tell me your business profit this month?" **Corrective steps:** Set up two accounts or two envelopes. Record every transaction. Review weekly. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can state their business profit for the last week. **Prevention:** Separate from day one â€" even if the amounts are small.

K.2 Quoting registration fees from memory

Symptoms: The learner says "CAC registration costs â‚¦50,000" or "I heard it is â‚¦100,000" â€" with no source. **Likely cause:** They heard it from a friend, a WhatsApp forward, or a roadside agent. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Where did you get that number? Is it from the official CAC website?" **Corrective steps:** Check the official CAC website (cac.gov.ng) for the current fee. Never quote from memory. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can name the official source and say "verify on cac.gov.ng". **Prevention:** The rule is simple: if it is not from the official site, it is not a fact.

K.3 Using a roadside "agent" for registration

Symptoms: The learner says "I have an agent who will do it for me" â€" at a price. **Likely cause:** They do not know the official process, so they trust someone who claims to. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What is the agent's name? What is their official accreditation? Have you checked the CAC website yourself?" **Corrective steps:** Do the registration yourself through the official CAC portal or office. If you need help, ask a licensed professional â€" not a roadside agent. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can explain the official steps and has checked the official site. **Prevention:** The official process is designed to be done by the business owner. An agent is optional â€" and often overpriced.

K.4 No records â€" "I will remember"

Symptoms: The learner has no sales or expense sheet; they guess at their profit. **Likely cause:** They think record-keeping is for accountants, or they are too busy. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What were your sales last week? What were your expenses? What was your profit?" **Corrective steps:** Start a daily sales and expense sheet â€" even on paper. Do a five-minute weekly review. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can state their sales, expenses and profit for the last week. **Prevention:** Record every transaction â€" even â‚¦500. The habit matters more than the amount.

K.5 Thinking a TIN means a big tax bill

Symptoms: The learner avoids getting a TIN because "I do not want to pay tax". **Likely cause:** They confuse identification with a tax bill. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What do you think a TIN is? What do you think it means for your taxes?" **Corrective steps:** Explain: a TIN is an identity, not a bill. It lets you plan for tax and proves you are legitimate. Check current thresholds on the official FIRS or state tax site. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can explain that a TIN is an identity and can name where to check current tax rules. **Prevention:** Repeat: a TIN is not a tax bill â€" it is a key that opens doors.

K.6 Assuming permits are not needed

Symptoms: The learner says "I do not need any permits â€" I am just small". **Likely cause:** They do not know which permits apply to their business type. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What do you sell? Where do you operate? Have you checked with your local government?" **Corrective steps:** Check with the local government and the relevant regulator (e.g., NAFDAC for food). Do not guess. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can name at least one permit or regulator that may apply and where to check. **Prevention:** Permits depend on the business type and location â€" check, don't guess.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it with the learner â€" ask them the investigation question and listen to the answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Money Rules â€" Separation Plan and Records Sheet"

Purpose: To practise the money separation habit and basic record-keeping â€" the two habits that let you see the truth about your business â€" and to build the money rules page that will support your capstone financial snapshot.

Realistic scenario. You have a business idea that you validated in Session 2. This week, you will set up the money foundation: a separation plan and a records sheet with three days of example entries.

Detailed instructions:

1. **Money separation plan:** Write your plan â€" two accounts or the envelope system. State: which method you will use, how you will separate, what you will record, and when you will review. (Worksheet 3.2.)
2. **Records sheet:** Set up a daily sales and expense sheet (on paper or in Google Sheets). Make **three days of example entries** â€" at least three sales and three expenses. Calculate the balance after each entry. (Worksheet 3.3.)
3. **Weekly review:** After the three days, add up your total sales and total expenses. Calculate your profit (or loss). Write one sentence: "What I will change next week is _____."
4. **CAC steps:** Write the broad steps for registering your business name â€" in your own words. State where you will check current requirements and fees. (Worksheet 3.1.)
5. **TIN:** Explain in 2â€"3 sentences what a TIN is and why you need one.
6. **Permits:** Name one permit or regulator that may apply to your business, and state where you should check.

Required deliverables:

- A money separation plan.
- A records sheet with three days of example entries and a weekly review.
- A CAC steps page, TIN explanation, and permit note.

Submission format: Save as a Google Doc or Google Sheet (or a clear photo of handwritten work) and upload to your Drive folder `CEA-Biz-YourName`, or show it to the instructor at the start of Session 4. You may also copy the text into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 4.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Money separation plan	4	Method stated, separation clear, review routine included
Records sheet with entries	5	Three days, at least three sales and three expenses, balances correct
Weekly review	3	Sales, expenses and profit calculated; one change stated
CAC steps	4	Steps in order, official source named, own words
TIN and permits	4	TIN explained simply; at least one permit named with where to check

Common mistakes to avoid: mixing personal and business money in the plan; no records or incomplete records; quoting fees from memory; no official source named; vague separation plan ("I will be careful").

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Money separation plan (model â€" for a fictional "Tobi's Phone Photography"):

- Method: Envelope system (Tobi does not have a bank account yet).
- Envelope 1 â€" BUSINESS: All photography payments go in. All business expenses (transport, data, editing apps) come out.
- Envelope 2 â€" PERSONAL: Family expenses, food, personal transport.
- Every Friday: Move â‚¦2,000 from BUSINESS to PERSONAL as Tobi's "salary".
- Record every movement in a small notebook â€" even â‚¦200.
- Review every Friday: add up the week's sales and expenses, calculate profit, decide one change.

Records sheet (model â€" three days):

Date	Description	Sales (â‚¦)	Expenses (â‚¦)	Balance (â‚¦)
1 Nov	Opening balance			5,000
1 Nov	Photo session â€" Customer A	5,000		10,000
1 Nov	Transport to client		500	9,500
2 Nov	Photo session â€" Customer B	3,000		12,500
2 Nov	Data for editing		500	12,000
3 Nov	Photo session â€" Customer C	4,000		16,000

Date	Description	Sales (â‚¦)	Expenses (â‚¦)	Balance (â‚¦)
3 Nov	Editing app subscription		1,000	15,000

Weekly review:

- Total sales: 5,000 + 3,000 + 4,000 = **â‚¦12,000**
- Total expenses: 500 + 500 + 1,000 = **â‚¦2,000**
- Profit: 12,000 â^' 2,000 = **â‚¦10,000**
- What I will change next week: "I will charge â‚¦5,000 for the next session because all three customers were happy and referred me to others."

CAC steps (model â€" own words):

1. Check if my business name is available on the official CAC website (cac.gov.ng).
2. Prepare my personal details, business name, address, and a description of my photography services.
3. Complete the application online or at a CAC office.
4. Pay the fee â€" checked on the official CAC website.
5. Receive my certificate of registration.

TIN (model): A TIN is a Tax Identification Number â€" a unique number that identifies my business to the tax authority. I need it to open a business account, to file tax returns, and to prove I am legitimate to corporate clients. I can apply through FIRS or my state tax authority â€" the current process is checked on the official website.

Permits (model): Tobi's Phone Photography is a service business â€" he may need a local government permit to operate, and he should check with his local government office. He does not sell food, so NAFDAC does not apply â€" but he should confirm with the local government.

A strong learner solution differs in content but ticks every rubric row.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What does CAC registration do for a business? What is the difference between a business name and a limited company?

Q2. Multiple choice. Where should you check the current CAC registration fee? a) A WhatsApp forward from a friend b) A roadside agent who promises to "do it fast" c) The official CAC website â€" cac.gov.ng d) A newspaper advertisement

Q3. Matching. Match each term to what it is: (1) CAC registration, (2) TIN, (3) business bank account, (4) money separation. a) A unique number that identifies you for tax b) Keeping business money and personal money apart c) A legal identity for your business d) A separate account for business transactions

Q4. True or false. "A TIN means you will pay a lot of tax."

Q5. Explain. Why is a separate business bank account important? Give two reasons.

Q6. Practical. A learner has â‚¦10,000 in sales and â‚¦7,000 in expenses this week. What is their profit? What should they do next week to make more profit?

Q7. Scenario. Your friend sells cakes from home and keeps all money in her personal account. She says "I do not need a separate account â€" I am just small." What would you tell her?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q7)

A1. CAC registration gives a business a legal identity â€" a name that is officially recognised by government, banks and customers. A business name is simpler, cheaper and faster â€" the owner and the business are legally the same. A limited company is more formal and expensive â€" the company is a separate legal person, and the owners are generally not personally liable for its debts.

A2. (c) The official CAC website â€" cac.gov.ng.

A3. (1) = c, (2) = a, (3) = d, (4) = b.

A4. False. A TIN is an identity, not a tax bill. It lets you plan for tax and proves you are legitimate. Many small businesses have thresholds below which they pay little or nothing â€" but the threshold changes, and you check the current rules on the official site.

A5. Two reasons: (1) You can see profit â€" all business income and expenses are in one place, so you can subtract and know the truth. (2) You can plan for tax â€" business money is separate, so you can set aside a percentage without touching personal spending money. (Also acceptable: customers and banks trust a business with a separate account; it looks professional.)

A6. Profit = 10,000 â^' 7,000 = **â‚¦3,000**. To make more profit next week, they could: sell more (find more customers, raise prices if the market allows), or spend less (find cheaper suppliers, reduce waste, cut unnecessary expenses). (Accept any sensible combination.)

A7. Separation is not about the amount â€" it is about the habit. Even a small business needs to know if it is making profit. A separate account (or two envelopes) lets her see profit, plan for tax, and make decisions. Without it, she is guessing â€" and guessing is how businesses fail. She can start with two envelopes today, and switch to a bank account when she registers.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that legal and money basics make a business real â€" to the government, the bank, the customer, and to you. You learned what CAC registration does, the difference between a business name and a limited company, and where to check current requirements (cac.gov.ng â€" never from memory). You learned what a TIN is and why banks and corporate clients ask for it. You learned why a separate business account matters and how to separate money â€" two accounts or the envelope system. You learned that permits vary by business type and location â€" and to check, not guess. And you learned basic record-keeping: a daily sales and expense sheet and a five-minute weekly review that turns records into decisions.

Five important takeaways:

1. **CAC registration** gives your business a legal identity â€" check current requirements on cac.gov.ng.
2. A **TIN** is your tax identity â€" it opens doors, it is not a tax bill.
3. **Money separation** â€" two accounts or two envelopes â€" is the most important habit in small business.
4. **Permits vary** â€" check with your local government and the relevant regulator.
5. **Record-keeping** â€" daily sales and expenses, weekly review â€" turns your business from a feeling into a number.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I explain what CAC registration does and where to check current fees?
- Can I explain what a TIN is and why it matters?
- Can I describe two money separation methods?
- Can I set up a daily sales and expense sheet?
- Can I name at least one permit that may apply to a specific business?

Connection to the next session. You now have a validated idea and a proper foundation â€" legal identity, tax number, money separation, and records. But there is one question you still cannot answer: **what should you charge?** Next session we learn pricing: how to cost a job completely, how to choose a pricing model, how to calculate profit and break-even, and how to write a clear quote in naira. Pricing is where most small businesses lose money â€" and where you will learn to stop losing it.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner explains CAC registration correctly and names the official source (cac.gov.ng).
- Learner distinguishes a business name from a limited company.
- Learner explains what a TIN is and why it matters â€" without calling it a tax bill.
- Learner describes a concrete money separation plan (two accounts or envelopes, with recording and review).
- Learner sets up a records sheet with correct entries and calculates profit.
- Learner names at least one permit or regulator and where to check.

- Learner labels all fee and requirement figures as "example only â€" verify on the official site".

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Registration is only for big companies." â†' A sole trader can and should register a business name.
- "I will check the fee from a friend or an agent." â†' Check the official CAC website â€" never from memory.
- "A TIN means I will pay a lot of tax." â†' A TIN is an identity, not a bill; check current thresholds on the official site.
- "I do not need a separate account â€" I am just small." â†' Separation is a habit, not an amount; start with two envelopes.
- "Record-keeping is for accountants." â†' It is for anyone who wants to know the truth about their money.
- "Permits are not needed for small businesses." â†' Permits depend on type and location â€" check, don't guess.
- "I will remember what I earned." â†' Write it down; the sheet is your memory.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **CAC steps ordering:** give five shuffled steps and ask the learner to put them in order and name the official source.
2. **Money separation setup:** give a scenario (e.g., "you earn â‚¦5,000 this week and spend â‚¦3,000 on business") and ask the learner to show how they would separate and record it.
3. **Records practice:** give three transactions and ask the learner to enter them in a sheet and calculate the balance and profit.
4. **TIN explanation:** ask the learner to explain a TIN to a friend in two sentences â€" then check for accuracy.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed records sheet (some entries already filled); learner adds the rest and calculates the balance. Provide a money separation plan template with prompts.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" full separation plan, records sheet, CAC steps, TIN and permits.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to research (with the instructor's help) one additional permit or regulator that applies to their specific business and write a short note on what it requires. Also ask them to compare the envelope system and two accounts â€" which is better for their situation and why.

Capstone links. This session's money rules page and records sheet feed directly into the capstone financial snapshot. The CAC steps and TIN explanation become part of the plan's "legal and money basics" section. The money separation plan and record-keeping routine are the habits behind the snapshot's numbers. In Session 9, the learner will show that their financial snapshot is not a guess â€" it is built on a foundation of separation, records and legal awareness.

Timing guidance. The priority is learners setting up a records sheet and writing a money separation plan (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten Section F.5 (permits) to the two most common examples (local government and NAFDAC), and limit the independent exercise to the separation plan and records sheet. Protect the practical time â€" a learner who leaves without a records sheet and a separation plan has no money foundation.

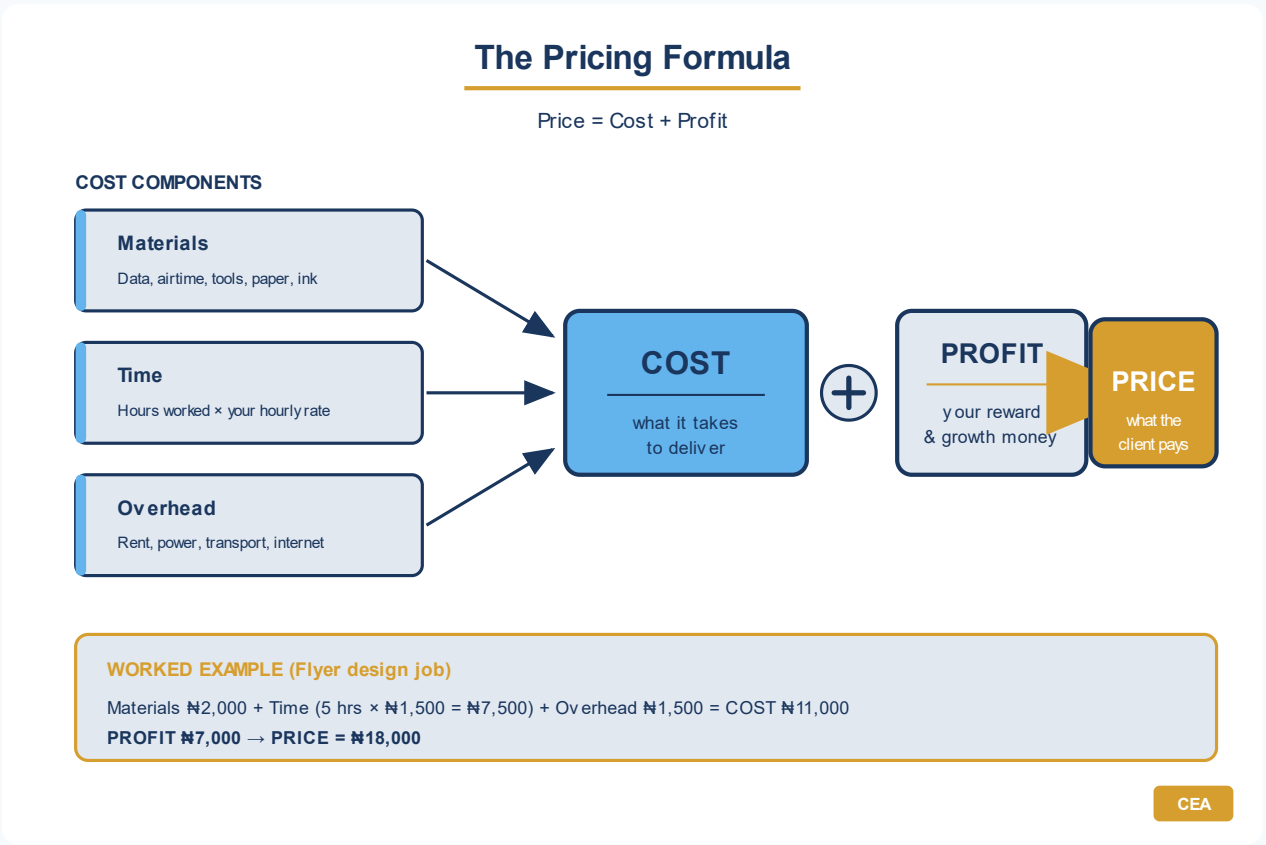
END OF SESSION 3

Next: Session 4 â€" Pricing Your Work and Costing.

SESSION 04 OF 9

Pricing Your Work and Costing

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 04



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" BUSINESS & FREELANCING

SESSION 4 â€" PRICING YOUR WORK AND COSTING

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	4 of 9
Session title	Pricing Your Work and Costing
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Win and Price Clients
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with costing and pricing)
Prerequisite knowledge	The Session 3 money separation plan and records sheet. Learners must be able to do basic arithmetic (addition, subtraction, multiplication). No prior pricing knowledge required.

Item	Detail
Connection to previous work	In Session 3 you set up the money foundation â€" separation, records, legal basics. Today we use that foundation to answer the most important question in business: **what should you charge?** Most small businesses price by guessing or copying â€" and lose money on every job. Today you learn to price from cost.
Preparation before class	Print the cost breakdown template (Section F.2); print the pricing models sheet (Section F.3); print the quote template (Section F.6); have the FastFix case pack ready; prepare a sample costed price list on the projector; bring a calculator (or use phone calculators).

Instructor note on tone: Many learners are afraid of pricing â€" afraid of charging too high (and losing customers) or too low (and losing money). Reassure them: pricing is not a guess, it is a calculation. When you know your cost, you can defend your price with confidence. Keep the mood practical and numbers-friendly.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Calculate** the full cost of a job, including materials, data, transport, tools, packaging, overhead share, waste allowance and their own time.
2. **Choose** a pricing model â€" per hour, per job/day, or package/retainer â€" and justify the choice with reasons.
3. **Compute** revenue, cost, profit and margin in naira.
4. **Calculate** break-even â€" how much sales value covers fixed costs.
5. **Write** a clear quote in naira: description, quantity, unit price, total, validity, payment terms and exclusions.
6. **Produce** a costed price list for three offers with break-even stated (LO6).
7. **Score at least 70%** on the Session 4 knowledge check.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with a calculator and notes app) or an academy computer with Google Docs/Sheets.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.
- Notebook and pen (optional).

Software

- A calculator (phone calculator is fine).
- A simple text app: phone Notes, Google Docs or Microsoft Word.
- The **cost breakdown template**, **pricing models sheet** and **quote template** (Sections F.2, F.3, F.6) projected and printed.

Sample files

- Printed **cost breakdown template** (Section F.2).
- Printed **pricing models sheet** (Section F.3).
- Printed **quote template** (Section F.6).
- A **sample costed price list** (instructor's own example â€" e.g., for FastFix) for the demonstration.
- The **FastFix case pack** (from Sessions 1â€"3).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 4.1 â€" "Full Cost of a Job" (a table for all cost components).
- Worksheet 4.2 â€" "Pricing Model Choice" (a table for comparing models).
- Worksheet 4.3 â€" "Profit, Margin and Break-Even" (a calculation sheet).
- Worksheet 4.4 â€" "Costed Price List" (three offers with cost, price, profit, margin).
- Worksheet 4.5 â€" "Quote Template" (a blank quote to fill in).

Accounts

- None required beyond what learners already have (Gmail for Google tools).

Internet

- Not required. The session works fully offline with printed templates and calculators.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a calculator and notes app works. A learner who struggles with arithmetic may use a calculator and work with a partner; the skill is the **understanding of cost components**, not mental maths.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two "price quotes" for the same job â€" a phone screen repair.

- **Quote A (weak):** "Screen repair: â‚¦3,000. Come today."
- **Quote B (strong):** "Screen repair for iPhone 11: â‚¦5,500. Includes: quality screen part, 1-hour labour, 30-day warranty. Valid for 7 days. 50% payment before repair, 50% on collection. Excludes: physical water damage, motherboard issues."

What the instructor says:

> *"Two quotes for the same job. Hands up â€" which one would you trust? â€¦ Quote B, almost always. Why? Because B tells you exactly what you get, what it costs, how long the price lasts, how you pay, and what is not included. A is a number with no meaning. Today we learn to write quotes like B â€" and to know what the number should be before you write it. That is costing and pricing."*

Expected learner response: Learners will say "B tells me what I get", "B has a warranty", "B says how to pay", "A is too cheap â€" maybe fake". Accept all answers and draw out the difference: **costed and clear vs guessed and vague**.

Then reveal the hook: Ask, "How many of you have ever charged too little for a job â€" and realised later you lost money?" Many hands go up. Say:

> *"That is not a failure of honesty â€" that is a failure of costing. When you do not know your cost, you cannot know your price. Today you learn to know both."*

Why this opener works: It uses a job everyone understands (phone repair), it isolates clarity and costing as the variables, and it frames pricing as a skill that protects you â€" not a trick to exploit customers.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the five columns of the money tracker from Session 3?"

- Expected answer: **Date / Description / Sales / Expenses / Balance.**
- Common gap: learners remember the tracker but not the columns. Clarify: "The tracker is where your cost information comes from â€" today we use it to price."

Question 2: "What is money separation, and why does it matter?"

- Expected answer: Keeping business money and personal money apart â€" so you can see profit, plan for tax, and make decisions.
- Common gap: learners remember the term but not the purpose. Clarify: "Separation gives you clean numbers â€" and clean numbers are what we price from today."

Question 3: "What is the weekly review?"

- Expected answer: Every week, add up sales and expenses, calculate profit, and decide one thing to change.

- Common gap: learners skip the review. Clarify: "The review is where you learn from your numbers â€" today we learn to price from them."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have clean money habits. Now we use them. Pricing is not a guess â€" it is a calculation. You add up everything a job costs, you add your profit, and that is your price. When you know your cost, you can defend your price, negotiate with confidence, and never lose money by accident. Let us learn to cost."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the five columns of the money tracker, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing the tracker on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why most small businesses lose money on pricing

The idea. Most small businesses in Nigeria price by guessing ("what feels right") or copying ("what the next shop charges"). Both methods lose money â€" because neither knows the actual cost of the job.

The three pricing mistakes:

1. **Guessing:** "I think a screen repair should be â‚¦3,000." But what if the part costs â‚¦2,500 and your time is worth â‚¦1,000? You just lost â‚¦500 â€" and you do not know it.
2. **Copying:** "The next shop charges â‚¦4,000, so I will charge â‚¦3,500 to be cheaper." But what if their cost is â‚¦2,000 and yours is â‚¦3,000? You are cheaper than them but still losing money.
3. **Forgetting costs:** "I charge â‚¦5,000 for a cake." But you forgot the transport, the data, the packaging, and your time. Your real cost is â‚¦5,500 â€" you are paying the customer to buy from you.

The fix â€" price from cost:

- Calculate the **full cost** of the job â€" everything.
- Add your **profit** â€" what you want to earn.
- That is your price.

Real-life comparison. Think of a market trader selling rice. If she does not know what she paid for the bag, the transport, and her time, she might sell at a loss and still think she is making profit. The trader who knows her cost â€" she can negotiate, she can plan, she can sleep well. Costing is the difference.

Important limitation / misconception. "If I price from cost, I will charge too much and lose customers." Not necessarily â€" if your cost is high because you are inefficient, the answer is to reduce cost, not to guess a lower price. And if your cost is fair, customers will pay a fair price â€" especially if you explain the value (warranty, speed, quality).

How a learner recognises a costed price: They can explain their price from its cost â€" "I charge â‚¦5,500 because the part is â‚¦3,500, my time is â‚¦1,500, and my profit is â‚¦500."

F.2 The full cost of a job â€" every component

The idea. The full cost of a job is everything you spend to deliver it â€" not just the obvious materials. Most beginners count only materials and forget the rest. The full cost has eight components.

The eight cost components â€" teach them one by one with a FastFix example (screen repair):

1. **Materials:** The physical items used in the job.
   - FastFix example: A replacement screen â€" â‚¦3,500.
2. **Data and communication:** The cost of data for research, communication, and online work.
   - FastFix example: Data to check the phone model and order the part â€" â‚¦200.
3. **Transport:** The cost of getting to the customer, the market, or the supplier.
   - FastFix example: Transport to buy the screen from the supplier â€" â‚¦500.

4. **Tools and equipment:** The cost of using your tools â€" even if you own them. A tool wears out and must be replaced.
    - FastFix example: Screwdrivers, spudgers, and other tools â€" a share of â‚¦100 per job.
5. **Packaging:** The cost of presenting the product or service.
    - FastFix example: A clean bag or box for the repaired phone â€" â‚¦100.
6. **Overhead share:** A share of your fixed costs â€" rent, electricity, generator, phone, internet â€" allocated to each job.
    - FastFix example: If monthly overhead is â‚¦10,000 and he does 20 jobs a month, the overhead share per job is â‚¦500.
7. **Waste allowance:** A small percentage for mistakes, damaged parts, or unexpected problems.
    - FastFix example: 5% of materials â€" â‚¦175 (for a screen that arrives damaged or is broken during repair).
8. **Your time (labour):** The value of your own work â€" what you would pay someone else to do it.
    - FastFix example: 1 hour of Chidi's time at â‚¦1,000/hour â€" â‚¦1,000.

The full cost calculation for FastFix's screen repair:

Component	Cost (â‚¦)
Materials (screen)	3,500
Data	200
Transport	500
Tools	100
Packaging	100
Overhead share	500
Waste allowance (5% of materials)	175
Your time (1 hour)	1,000
Total full cost	**6,075**

Say this: "â‚¦6,075 is the true cost of this repair. If Chidi charges â‚¦4,000 â€" what many shops charge â€" he is losing â‚¦2,075 on every repair. He is working hard and going backwards. That is the hidden crisis of small business."

Real-life comparison. Think of a baker. The flour and sugar are obvious. But what about the gas, the transport to the market, the wear on the baking tin, the time? A baker who counts only flour will price too low and wonder why there is no profit. The full cost is the truth.

Misconception to correct. "My time is free â€" I do not pay myself." Your time is not free â€" it is your most valuable resource. If you do not count it, you cannot know if the job is worth doing. A job that costs â‚¦6,075 and pays â‚¦6,075 is not a business â€" it is unpaid labour.

F.3 Three pricing models â€" choose the right one

The idea. A pricing model is how you structure your price. There are three common models â€" each fits different situations. Choosing the right one is part of your business strategy.

Model 1 â€" Per hour (time-based):

- **What it is:** You charge for the time you spend â€" â‚¦1,000 per hour, for example.
- **Best for:** Work where the time is uncertain or varies â€" repairs, consulting, tutoring, writing.
- **Pros:** You are paid for all your time; simple to explain.
- **Cons:** Customers may worry the clock is running; you earn less if you are fast (which is unfair).
- **FastFix example:** Chidi charges â‚¦1,000 per hour for software repairs that take unpredictable time.

Model 2 â€" Per job or per day (fixed price):

- **What it is:** You charge a fixed price for a defined job â€" â‚¦5,500 for a screen repair, regardless of how long it takes.
- **Best for:** Work with a clear scope and predictable time â€" repairs, design jobs, baking a cake, sewing a dress.

- **Pros:** The customer knows the cost upfront; you can earn more if you are fast; easy to quote.
- **Cons:** If the job takes longer than expected, you earn less per hour; scope must be clear.
- **FastFix example:** Chidi charges â‚¦5,500 for a screen repair â€" fixed, regardless of whether it takes 45 minutes or 1.5 hours.

Model 3 â€" Package or retainer (bundled):

- **What it is:** You bundle several services or a period of service into one price â€" a monthly retainer, a package deal.
- **Best for:** Ongoing work â€" monthly social media management, weekly cleaning, regular maintenance, a "3 repairs for the price of 2.5" package.
- **Pros:** Predictable income; encourages repeat customers; simpler for the customer.
- **Cons:** Requires trust and a clear scope; you must deliver consistently.
- **FastFix example:** Chidi offers a "Phone Care Package" â€" â‚¦10,000 per quarter for unlimited software support, one free screen protector, and 10% off repairs.

How to choose â€" a practical decision rule:

- If the **time is uncertain** â†' charge **per hour**.
- If the **scope is clear** â†' charge **per job**.
- If the work is **ongoing** â†' offer a **package or retainer**.
- Most businesses use a mix â€" a fixed price for standard jobs, per hour for uncertain work, and packages for loyal customers.

Real-life comparison. Think of a taxi driver. He can charge per trip (fixed), per hour (time-based), or a monthly contract with a company (retainer). Each model fits a different situation. A smart driver uses all three â€" and so does a smart business owner.

Misconception to correct. "One model fits all." No â€" the right model depends on the job, the customer and your business. A repair shop that charges per hour for a simple screen repair will lose customers to a shop that charges a fixed price. Choose deliberately.

F.4 Revenue, cost, profit and margin â€" the numbers that matter

The idea. Once you know your cost, you can calculate the numbers that tell you if your business is working. Four numbers matter: revenue, cost, profit and margin.

The four numbers â€" define each with a FastFix example:

1. **Revenue (sales):** The total money coming in from sales.
    - FastFix example: Chidi repairs 10 screens at â‚¦5,500 each â€" revenue = â‚¦55,000.
2. **Cost (total cost):** The total money going out to deliver the service.
    - FastFix example: Each repair costs â‚¦6,075 (from Section F.2) â€" total cost for 10 repairs = â‚¦60,750.
3. **Profit:** Revenue minus cost. The money you keep.
    - FastFix example: â‚¦55,000 â^' â‚¦60,750 = **â^'â‚¦5,750** (a loss!).
    - **Say this:** "Chidi is losing â‚¦5,750 this month. He is busy, he is working hard â€" and he is going backwards. This is what happens when you price without costing."
4. **Margin:** Profit as a percentage of revenue. It tells you how much of each naira you keep.
    - Formula: Margin = (Profit Ã· Revenue) Ã— 100
    - FastFix example (if he priced correctly at â‚¦7,000): Revenue = â‚¦70,000, Cost = â‚¦60,750, Profit = â‚¦9,250. Margin = (9,250 Ã· 70,000) Ã× 100 = **13.2%**.
    - **Say this:** "A 13% margin means for every â‚¦100 Chidi earns, he keeps â‚¦13. That is thin â€" he needs to either raise prices, reduce costs, or do more jobs."

What is a good margin? There is no single answer â€" it depends on the business. But a margin below 10% is dangerous (one bad week wipes you out). A margin of 20â€"30% is healthy for most small businesses. A margin above 50% is excellent â€" but check that you are not undercharging.

Real-life comparison. Think of a student selling pure water. If she sells 100 sachets at â‚¦20 each, revenue is â‚¦2,000. If her cost (bag of sachets, transport, table) is â‚¦1,500, profit is â‚¦500 and margin is 25%. She knows she is making money â€" and she knows how much. Without these numbers, she is guessing.

Misconception to correct. "Revenue is profit." No â€" revenue is what comes in; profit is what you keep after costs. A business with â‚¦100,000 revenue and â‚¦95,000 cost has only â‚¦5,000 profit. Revenue is vanity; profit is sanity.

F.5 Break-even â€" how much you must sell to cover your costs

The idea. Break-even is the point where your revenue exactly covers your cost â€" you are not making profit, but you are not losing money. Knowing your break-even tells you how much you must sell to survive.

The break-even formula:

- Break-even (in units) = Fixed costs Ã· (Price per unit âˆ' Variable cost per unit)
- **Fixed costs:** Costs that do not change with the number of jobs â€" rent, electricity, phone, internet.
- **Variable costs:** Costs that change with each job â€" materials, transport, packaging.

Worked example â€" FastFix:

- Fixed costs per month: â‚¦10,000 (rent, electricity, phone, internet).
- Variable cost per screen repair: â‚¦5,075 (materials â‚¦3,500 + data â‚¦200 + transport â‚¦500 + tools â‚¦100 + packaging â‚¦100 + waste â‚¦175 + time â‚¦1,000 â€" but time is fixed if Chidi works alone, so we exclude it from variable cost for this calculation; let us say variable cost = â‚¦4,075).
- Price per screen repair: â‚¦7,000.
- Contribution per repair = Price âˆ' Variable cost = 7,000 âˆ' 4,075 = â‚¦2,925.
- Break-even (in repairs) = 10,000 Ã· 2,925 = **3.4 repairs** â€" so Chidi must do at least 4 repairs a month to cover his fixed costs.

Say this: "If Chidi does 4 repairs at â‚¦7,000, he covers his rent, electricity and phone. Every repair after that is profit. If he does 10, he makes â‚¦9,250 profit. Break-even tells him the minimum â€" and the minimum is what keeps him alive."

Real-life comparison. Think of a bus driver. The bus has fixed costs (loan repayment, insurance, licence) and variable costs (fuel, maintenance per trip). The driver knows: I must do at least 10 trips a day to cover my fixed costs. Every trip after 10 is profit. Break-even is the driver's daily target.

Misconception to correct. "Break-even is the same as profit." No â€" break-even is the point where you stop losing money. Profit starts after break-even. A business that never reaches break-even is slowly dying.

F.6 Writing a clear quote â€" the document that prevents disputes

The idea. A **quote** is a written document that tells the customer exactly what you will do, what it will cost, and the terms. It is not a contract (that comes in Session 6) â€" but it is the foundation of trust and the prevention of disputes.

The seven parts of a clear quote â€" teach them one by one:

1. **Business name and contact:** Your name, phone number, and (if you have it) your business name and address.
2. **Date and quote number:** The date and a unique number (e.g., Quote 001) so you can reference it.
3. **Customer name:** Who the quote is for.
4. **Description of the job:** What you will do â€" in clear, specific language.
5. **Quantity and unit price:** How many, and the price per unit.
6. **Total price:** The full amount in naira.
7. **Terms:** Validity (how long the price lasts), payment terms (how and when to pay), and exclusions (what is not included).

Worked example â€" a clear quote for FastFix:

> ***FastFix Phone Repair*** *Mile 3 Market, Diobu, Port Harcourt Tel: 0803-XXX-XXXX*
>
> ***Quote 001*** *â€" Date: 10 October 2026 Customer: Mr. Emeka Obi*
>
> *Description: Screen repair for iPhone 11 Quantity: 1 Unit price: â‚¦5,500* ***Total: â‚¦5,500***
>
> *Terms:*
>
> - *This quote is valid for 7 days.*
> - *Payment: 50% before repair (â‚¦2,750), 50% on collection (â‚¦2,750).*
> - *Includes: quality screen part, 1-hour labour, 30-day warranty.*

- *Excludes: water damage, motherboard issues, physical damage beyond the screen.*

Say this: "This quote prevents three disputes: 'I thought it was cheaper' (no â€" it says â‚¹5,500), 'I thought the warranty was longer' (no â€" it says 30 days), 'I thought you would fix the water damage' (no â€" it is excluded). A clear quote is not distrust â€" it is clarity."

Real-life comparison. Think of a building contract. A builder who says "I will build your fence for â‚¹50,000" invites disputes. A builder who writes down the length, the materials, the timeline, the payment schedule and the exclusions â€" that builder sleeps well. A quote is the small version of that contract.

Misconception to correct. "A quote is just a price." No â€" a quote is a price **with context**. The context is what prevents disputes and builds trust.

F.7 Summary of the session

- Most small businesses lose money on pricing because they **guess** or **copy** â€" they do not know their cost.
- The **full cost** of a job has eight components: materials, data, transport, tools, packaging, overhead share, waste allowance and your time.
- Three **pricing models**: per hour (uncertain time), per job (clear scope), package/retainer (ongoing work). Choose deliberately.
- Four numbers that matter: **revenue, cost, profit, margin**. Revenue is vanity; profit is sanity.
- **Break-even** tells you the minimum you must sell to cover fixed costs.
- A **clear quote** has seven parts: business name, date/number, customer, description, quantity/unit price, total, and terms (validity, payment, exclusions).

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Cost of delivery] --> B[Add overhead]
    B --> C[Total cost]
    C --> D[Add profit margin]
    D --> E[Your price]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Show the class how to cost a job completely, choose a price, and write a clear quote â€" live â€" so they can do it themselves.

Setup: Open a blank Google Doc titled "Cost and Quote â€" FastFix Screen Repair". Have the cost breakdown template and quote template on the projector. Project both.

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A blank cost breakdown template on the projector.
- A blank quote template on the projector.
- A calculator.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" cost the job completely (5 minutes)

Say: "We will cost a screen repair for an iPhone 11. Watch me count everything â€" not just the screen."

Fill in the cost breakdown on the projector, narrating each component:

Component	Cost (â‚¹)	How I know
Materials (screen)	3,500	Price from supplier
Data	200	Data to check model and order

Component	Cost (â‚¦)	How I know
Transport	500	Bus to supplier and back
Tools	100	Share of screwdrivers, etc.
Packaging	100	Bag for the phone
Overhead share	500	â‚¦10,000 monthly overhead Ã· 20 jobs
Waste allowance (5%)	175	5% of â‚¦3,500
Your time (1 hour)	1,000	â‚¦1,000/hour
Total full cost	**6,075**	

Say: "â‚¦6,075 is the true cost. Now â€" what should Chidi charge?"

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" choose a price (3 minutes)

Say: "Chidi wants a profit of â‚¦1,500 per repair. So: cost â‚¦6,075 + profit â‚¦1,500 = â‚¦7,500. But the market will not pay â‚¦7,500 â€" the competitor charges â‚¦4,000â€"â‚¦6,000. So Chidi has three options:"

Write the options on the board:

1. **Charge â‚¦7,500** â€" risk losing customers to cheaper shops.
2. **Charge â‚¦6,500** â€" a smaller profit (â‚¦425) but competitive.
3. **Reduce cost** â€" find a cheaper screen supplier, reduce transport, or increase efficiency â€" then charge â‚¦6,000 with a fair profit.

Say: "The smart answer is option 3 â€" reduce cost. But for today, let us say Chidi charges â‚¦6,500. His profit is â‚¦425 per repair â€" thin, but he is learning. As he gets better, his cost drops and his profit grows."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" write the quote (5 minutes)

Say: "Now we write the quote. A clear quote prevents disputes."

Fill in the quote template on the projector:

> ***FastFix Phone Repair*** *Mile 3 Market, Diobu, Port Harcourt Tel: 0803-XXX-XXXX*
>
> ***Quote 001*** *â€" Date: 10 October 2026 Customer: Mr. Emeka Obi*
>
> *Description: Screen repair for iPhone 11 Quantity: 1 Unit price: â‚¦6,500* ***Total: â‚¦6,500***
>
> *Terms:*
>
> - *This quote is valid for 7 days.*
> - *Payment: 50% before repair (â‚¦3,250), 50% on collection (â‚¦3,250).*
> - *Includes: quality screen part, 1-hour labour, 30-day warranty.*
> - *Excludes: water damage, motherboard issues, physical damage beyond the screen.*

Say: "Seven parts. Business name, date/number, customer, description, quantity/unit price, total, and terms. This quote is clear, honest and professional."

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€" calculate profit and break-even (2 minutes)

Say: "Last â€" the numbers. If Chidi does 10 repairs at â‚¦6,500:"

- Revenue: 10 Ã— 6,500 = â‚¦65,000
- Cost: 10 Ã— 6,075 = â‚¦60,750
- Profit: 65,000 âˆ' 60,750 = â‚¦4,250
- Margin: (4,250 Ã· 65,000) Ã— 100 = 6.5%
- Break-even: Fixed costs â‚¦10,000 Ã· contribution per repair (6,500 âˆ' 4,075 = 2,425) = 4.1 â€" so 5 repairs to break even.

Say: "A 6.5% margin is thin â€" Chidi needs to either raise prices, reduce costs, or do more jobs. But now he knows. And knowing is the first step to fixing."

G.6 Questions to ask during the demo

- "What is the full cost of this repair?" (â‚¦6,075 â€" all eight components.)
- "Why is the price â‚¦6,500 and not â‚¦6,075?" (Because the price includes profit â€" â‚¦6,075 is the cost, â‚¦6,500 is the price.)
- "What prevents a dispute with this quote?" (The seven parts â€" especially the terms: validity, payment, exclusions.)
- "What is break-even?" (The minimum number of repairs to cover fixed costs â€" 5.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner costs a job completely, chooses a price, and writes a clear quote.

Starting materials: A pen and notebook or phone notes app; a calculator; the cost breakdown template and quote template (projected and printed).

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name and today's date at the top of your workbook or notes app.
2. **Choose a job:** Pick one job from your own business idea (or use FastFix's screen repair if you prefer).
3. **Cost the job completely:** Fill in the cost breakdown template (Worksheet 4.1) â€" all eight components. Use realistic naira figures for Port Harcourt.
4. **Pause and predict:** Ask yourself: "What is my total full cost? Is it higher or lower than I expected?"
5. **Choose a price:** Add your desired profit to the full cost. Write the price.
6. **Calculate profit and margin:** Revenue (if you did 10 jobs), total cost, profit, and margin. (Worksheet 4.3.)
7. **Calculate break-even:** Estimate your fixed costs and variable cost per job. Calculate how many jobs you need to break even.
8. **Write the quote:** Fill in the quote template (Worksheet 4.5) â€" all seven parts.
9. **Share:** Show your quote to your partner. Ask: "Is this clear? Would you know exactly what you are getting and what you are paying?"
10. **Revise:** Based on your partner's feedback, revise your quote if needed.

Expected result: A fully costed job, a chosen price, profit/margin/break-even calculations, and a clear written quote.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 4: "Is your full cost higher or lower than you expected? Why?"
- After step 6: "What is your margin? Is it healthy (20â€"30%) or thin (below 10%)?"
- After step 9: "Would a stranger understand this quote without you explaining?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner's cost is too low â†' Ask: "Did you count your time? Did you count transport? Did you count overhead?"
- Learner's price is too high â†' Ask: "What will the market pay? Can you reduce cost instead of raising price?"
- Learner's quote is vague â†' Ask: "What exactly is included? What is excluded? How long is the price valid?"
- Learner's margin is below 10% â†' Ask: "How can you improve? Raise price, reduce cost, or do more jobs?"
- Learner's break-even is very high â†' Ask: "Are your fixed costs too high? Can you reduce them?"

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Job chosen
- ☐ All eight cost components filled in
- ☐ Total full cost calculated
- ☐ Price chosen (cost + profit)
- ☐ Profit and margin calculated
- ☐ Break-even calculated
- ☐ Quote written with all seven parts

- ☐ Quote shared with a partner and revised

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Write a **costed price list for three offers** for a fictional business â€" "Mama Chika's Kitchen" â€" with break-even stated.

Scenario. *Mama Chika* sells jollof rice and small chops from her home in Port Harcourt. She has three offers:

1. **Single plate of jollof rice** â€" â‚¦1,500
2. **Party package (50 plates)** â€" â‚¦60,000
3. **Small chops tray (100 pieces)** â€" â‚¦15,000

Her fixed costs per month are â‚¦15,000 (rent, electricity, gas, phone). Her variable costs are:

- Single plate: rice and ingredients â‚¦600, packaging â‚¦100, transport â‚¦200, time â‚¦300 â†' total â‚¦1,200
- Party package: rice and ingredients â‚¦25,000, packaging â‚¦2,000, transport â‚¦3,000, time â‚¦5,000 â†' total â‚¦35,000
- Small chops tray: ingredients â‚¦8,000, packaging â‚¦1,000, transport â‚¦1,500, time â‚¦2,500 â†' total â‚¦13,000

Requirements:

1. For each offer, calculate: full cost, profit (price â^' cost), and margin (profit Ã· price Ã— 100).
2. Calculate the break-even for each offer (fixed costs Ã· contribution per unit).
3. Write a short note: "Which offer is most profitable? Which is most popular? What should Mama Chika focus on?"
4. Write one sentence: "Mama Chika's biggest pricing risk is _____, and she can manage it by _____."

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Full cost, profit and margin calculated for all three offers.
- Break-even calculated for all three offers.
- Note is realistic and specific.
- Risk sentence is realistic.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For margin, use the formula: (profit Ã· price) Ã— 100.
- Hint 2: For break-even, use: fixed costs Ã· (price â^' variable cost).
- Hint 3: For the note, compare the margins â€" which offer gives the best return for her time?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Calculations:

Offer	Price (â‚¦)	Full cost (â‚¦)	Profit (â‚¦)	Margin	Break-even
Single plate	1,500	1,200	300	20%	15,000 Ã· 300 = 50 plates
Party package	60,000	35,000	25,000	41.7%	15,000 Ã· 25,000 = 0.6 â†' 1 package
Small chops tray	15,000	13,000	2,000	13.3%	15,000 Ã· 2,000 = 7.5 â†' 8 trays

Note: The party package is the most profitable (41.7% margin, â‚¦25,000 profit per package) â€" but it requires upfront investment and may not sell every week. The single plate is the most popular (daily demand) but has the lowest profit per sale. The small chops tray is in between. Mama Chika should focus on the party package for big income, but keep selling single plates for steady cash flow and to build her reputation.

Risk sentence: "Mama Chika's biggest pricing risk is underpricing the party package â€" if she charges too little, she will work very hard for very little profit. She can manage it by calculating the full cost before quoting and never accepting a price below cost."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Full cost, profit and margin calculated for all three offers (4)

- Break-even calculated for all three offers (3)
- Note is realistic and specific (2)
- Risk sentence is realistic (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Blessing* is a tailor in Port Harcourt. She sews dresses, skirts and blouses for women. She has been sewing for three years â€" she learned from her mother. She prices by guessing: "I think a dress should be â‚¦8,000." She does not know her fabric cost, her transport cost, or the value of her time. She is busy â€" she sews 10â€"15 dresses a month â€" but she never seems to have money. She is thinking of giving up and getting a shop job.

Relevant facts.

- Blessing's time: about 6 hours per dress.
- Fabric and materials for a simple dress: about â‚¦3,500.
- Transport to the fabric market: â‚¦1,000 per trip (she buys fabric for 3â€"4 dresses per trip).
- She works from home â€" no rent, but she uses her electricity and her sewing machine (which needs occasional servicing).
- She charges â‚¦8,000 per dress â€" but she does not know if that is profit or loss.

Decision point. Is Blessing's problem that she is not a good tailor?

Possible approaches.

1. Give up sewing and get a shop job.
2. Raise prices dramatically â€" "I will charge â‚¦20,000 per dress."
3. Cost her work completely, price from cost, and keep records.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Blessing's problem is not her skill â€" it is her pricing. She does not know her cost, so she cannot know if she is making profit. She is busy and broke â€" the classic symptom of underpricing.

Reasoning / example costing for Blessing:

- Materials (fabric, thread, accessories): â‚¦3,500
- Transport (share per dress): â‚¦1,000 Ã· 3 = â‚¦333
- Tools (sewing machine servicing share): â‚¦200
- Overhead (electricity, phone): â‚¦300
- Waste allowance (5%): â‚¦175
- Time (6 hours Ã— â‚¦500/hour): â‚¦3,000
- **Full cost per dress: â‚¦7,508**
- **Price at â‚¦8,000: profit = â‚¦492 â€" margin 6.2% (very thin!)**
- **Better price: â‚¦10,000 â€" profit = â‚¦2,492 â€" margin 24.9% (healthy)**

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (give up) loses a skill and three years of experience.
- Approach 2 (raise prices dramatically) without costing â€" she might price herself out of the market.
- Approach 3 (cost and price properly) takes one afternoon of calculation â€" and transforms her business from busy-and-broke to busy-and-profitable.

Professional connection. The difference between a hobbyist and a professional is not talent â€" it is **knowing your numbers**. A professional tailor can explain their price from its cost. A hobbyist guesses. Blessing has the skill; she just needs the numbers.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Forgetting your own time

Symptoms: The learner's cost is too low; they are busy but have no money. **Likely cause:** They did not count their time as a cost. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How long does the job take? What is your time worth per hour?" **Corrective steps:** Add your time to the cost â€" at a realistic hourly rate (e.g., â‚¦500â€"â‚¦1,000/hour for a skilled beginner). **How to confirm resolved:** The learner's cost includes their time. **Prevention:** Always count your time â€" it is your most valuable resource.

K.2 Counting only materials

Symptoms: The learner's cost is "just the fabric" or "just the screen" â€" and they lose money on every job. **Likely cause:** They count only the obvious material cost. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What about transport? Data? Tools? Overhead? Packaging?" **Corrective steps:** Use the full cost breakdown â€" all eight components. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner's cost includes all eight components. **Prevention:** The eight components are a checklist â€" use it every time.

K.3 Pricing by copying the neighbour

Symptoms: The learner charges "what the next shop charges" â€" and does not know if they make profit. **Likely cause:** They do not know their own cost, so they copy a number. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What is your cost? Is it the same as the neighbour's?" **Corrective steps:** Cost your own job â€" your cost may be different from theirs. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can explain their price from their own cost. **Prevention:** Never copy a price without knowing your own cost.

K.4 A vague quote

Symptoms: The quote says "Screen repair: â‚¦5,000" â€" and disputes follow. **Likely cause:** The quote has no terms â€" no validity, no payment terms, no exclusions. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How long is this price valid? How do they pay? What is not included?" **Corrective steps:** Add the seven parts â€" especially the terms. **How to confirm resolved:** The quote has all seven parts. **Prevention:** Use the quote template every time.

K.5 A margin below 10%

Symptoms: The learner is busy but has no money; they are working for almost nothing. **Likely cause:** The price is too close to the cost â€" or the cost is too high. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What is your margin? What is your cost breakdown?" **Corrective steps:** Either raise the price (if the market allows) or reduce the cost (find cheaper suppliers, reduce waste, work more efficiently). **How to confirm resolved:** The margin is at least 20%. **Prevention:** Calculate margin before accepting a job â€" never price without knowing your margin.

K.6 Confusing revenue with profit

Symptoms: The learner says "I made â‚¦50,000 last month" â€" but has no money. **Likely cause:** They are counting revenue, not profit. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What were your costs? What is your profit?" **Corrective steps:** Subtract costs from revenue â€" that is profit. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can state their profit, not just their revenue. **Prevention:** Revenue is vanity; profit is sanity â€" always calculate both.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it with the learner â€" ask them the investigation question and listen to the answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Cost and Price Three Things â€" Full Cost Sheet, Price List and Quote"

Purpose: To practise costing completely, pricing from cost, and writing clear quotes â€" the skills that stop you losing money â€" and to build the costed price list that will feed your capstone financial snapshot.

Realistic scenario. You have a validated business idea and a money foundation. This week, you will cost three offers completely, price them from cost, and write one clear quote.

Detailed instructions:

1. **Choose three offers** from your business idea (or use FastFix's three services: screen repair, battery replacement, charging port repair).
2. **Cost each offer completely:** Use the full cost breakdown â€" all eight components. Use realistic naira figures for Port Harcourt. (Worksheet 4.1.)
3. **Price each offer:** Add your desired profit to the full cost. Write the price. (Worksheet 4.4.)

4. **Calculate profit, margin and break-even** for each offer. (Worksheet 4.3.)
5. **Write one clear quote** for one of the three offers â€" all seven parts. (Worksheet 4.5.)
6. **Write a short note** (5â€"8 sentences): "Which offer is most profitable? Which is most popular? What should I focus on in my first month?"
7. **Write one sentence:** "My biggest pricing risk is _____, and I can manage it by _____."

Required deliverables:

- A full cost sheet for three offers.
- A costed price list with profit, margin and break-even.
- One clear written quote.
- A short note and a risk sentence.

Submission format: Save as a Google Doc or Google Sheet (or a clear photo of handwritten work) and upload to your Drive folder `CEA-Biz-YourName`, or show it to the instructor at the start of Session 5. You may also copy the text into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 5.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Full cost â€" three offers	6	All eight components for each offer, realistic naira figures
Pricing from cost	4	Price = cost + profit, justified
Profit, margin, break-even	4	Calculated correctly for each offer
Clear quote	4	All seven parts, clear terms
Note and risk	2	Realistic, specific

Common mistakes to avoid: forgetting your time; counting only materials; copying prices; vague quotes; margins below 10%; confusing revenue with profit.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Model â€" for FastFix's three services:

Screen repair:

- Full cost: â‚¦6,075 (as calculated in Section F.2)
- Price: â‚¦6,500
- Profit: â‚¦425
- Margin: 6.5%
- Break-even: 5 repairs per month

Battery replacement:

- Materials (battery): â‚¦2,000
- Data: â‚¦100
- Transport: â‚¦300
- Tools: â‚¦50
- Packaging: â‚¦50
- Overhead share: â‚¦500
- Waste allowance (5%): â‚¦100
- Time (30 minutes): â‚¦500
- Full cost: â‚¦3,600
- Price: â‚¦4,500
- Profit: â‚¦900
- Margin: 20%
- Break-even: 12 repairs per month

Charging port repair:

- Materials (port): â‚¦1,500
- Data: â‚¦100
- Transport: â‚¦300
- Tools: â‚¦100
- Packaging: â‚¦50
- Overhead share: â‚¦500
- Waste allowance (5%): â‚¦75
- Time (1.5 hours): â‚¦1,500
- Full cost: â‚¦4,125
- Price: â‚¦5,500
- Profit: â‚¦1,375
- Margin: 25%
- Break-even: 8 repairs per month

Note (model): The charging port repair is the most profitable (25% margin, â‚¦1,375 profit) â€" but it is the most technical and may have lower demand. The screen repair is the most popular (highest demand) but has the lowest margin. The battery replacement is in between. Chidi should focus on screen repairs for volume and reputation, but promote charging port repairs for higher profit.

Risk sentence (model): "My biggest pricing risk is underpricing screen repairs because customers expect them to be cheap â€" I can manage it by explaining the quality of my parts and my 30-day warranty, and by offering a discount for repeat customers instead of lowering the base price."

A strong learner solution differs in content but ticks every rubric row.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What are the eight components of the full cost of a job?

Q2. Multiple choice. A learner's job costs â‚¦5,000 and they charge â‚¦5,000. What is their profit? a) â‚¦5,000 b) â‚¦10,000 c) â‚¦0 d) â‚¦2,500

Q3. Matching. Match each pricing model to its best use: (1) per hour, (2) per job, (3) package/retainer. a) A monthly social media management contract b) A screen repair with a clear scope c) A software problem that may take 30 minutes or 3 hours

Q4. True or false. "Revenue is the same as profit."

Q5. Explain. What is break-even, and why does a business owner need to know it?

Q6. Practical. A learner has fixed costs of â‚¦12,000 per month. Their price per job is â‚¦8,000 and their variable cost per job is â‚¦5,000. How many jobs do they need to break even?

Q7. Scenario. Your friend charges â‚¦3,000 for a service that costs â‚¦3,500 to deliver. She says "but I am getting customers!" What is wrong, and what should she do?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q7)

A1. The eight components: materials, data, transport, tools, packaging, overhead share, waste allowance, and your time (labour).

A2. (c) â‚¦0. Profit = revenue â^' cost = 5,000 â^' 5,000 = 0. The learner is working for free.

A3. (1) = c, (2) = b, (3) = a.

A4. False. Revenue is what comes in; profit is what you keep after costs. A business with â‚¦100,000 revenue and â‚¦95,000 cost has only â‚¦5,000 profit.

A5. Break-even is the point where revenue exactly covers cost â€" you are not making profit, but you are not losing money. A business owner needs to know it because it tells them the minimum they must sell to survive. Every sale after break-even is profit.

A6. Contribution per job = 8,000 â^' 5,000 = â,¦3,000. Break-even = 12,000 Ã· 3,000 = **4 jobs**.

A7. She is losing â,¦500 on every job â€" she is paying customers to buy from her. She should: (1) calculate her full cost (including her time), (2) raise her price to at least cost plus a profit (e.g., â,¦4,500â€"â,¦5,000), or (3) reduce her cost (find cheaper suppliers, reduce waste). Getting customers at a loss is not success â€" it is a slow failure.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that most small businesses lose money on pricing because they guess or copy â€" they do not know their cost. You learned the eight components of the full cost of a job: materials, data, transport, tools, packaging, overhead share, waste allowance and your time. You learned three pricing models â€" per hour, per job, and package/retainer â€" and how to choose the right one. You learned the four numbers that matter: revenue, cost, profit and margin. You learned break-even â€" the minimum you must sell to cover your fixed costs. And you learned to write a clear quote with seven parts â€" business name, date/number, customer, description, quantity/unit price, total, and terms. Pricing is not a guess â€" it is a calculation. And when you know your cost, you can defend your price with confidence.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Price from cost** â€" never guess, never copy.
2. The **full cost** has eight components â€" including your time.
3. Three **pricing models** â€" choose deliberately.
4. **Revenue is vanity; profit is sanity** â€" always calculate both.
5. A **clear quote** prevents disputes and builds trust.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I calculate the full cost of a job â€" all eight components?
- Can I choose a pricing model and justify it?
- Can I calculate profit, margin and break-even?
- Can I write a clear quote with all seven parts?
- Can I explain my price from its cost?

Connection to the next session. You now know what to charge â€" and you can defend it. But knowing your price is not the same as getting a customer to pay it. Next session we learn how to find your first customers and sell to them: referrals, networking, the 60-second pitch, WhatsApp and word of mouth, and the simple sales conversation. Selling is a skill â€" and you will learn it.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner calculates the full cost with all eight components â€" including their time.
- Learner chooses a pricing model and justifies it.
- Learner calculates profit, margin and break-even correctly.
- Learner writes a clear quote with all seven parts â€" especially the terms.
- Learner can explain their price from its cost.
- Learner's margin is at least 20% (or they can explain why it is thin and how to improve).

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "My time is free." â†' Your time is your most valuable resource â€" count it.
- "I will just charge what the neighbour charges." â†' Your cost may be different â€" cost your own job.
- "Revenue is profit." â†' Revenue is what comes in; profit is what you keep.
- "A quote is just a price." â†' A quote is a price with context â€" the context prevents disputes.
- "A low margin is fine if I am busy." â†' A margin below 10% is dangerous â€" one bad week wipes you out.
- "Break-even is the same as profit." â†' Break-even is where you stop losing money; profit starts after.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Cost component drill:** give a job and ask the learner to list all eight cost components â€" then check for missing ones (usually time, overhead or waste).
2. **Pricing model sorting:** give six mixed jobs and ask the learner to label each per hour, per job or package â€" and explain why.
3. **Quote writing practice:** give a simple job and ask the learner to write a full quote â€" then check for the seven parts.
4. **Margin calculation practice:** give three scenarios with different costs and prices â€" ask the learner to calculate margin and identify which is healthiest.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed cost breakdown (materials, data, transport already filled); learner adds the remaining components and calculates the total. Provide a quote template with prompts.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" full costing, pricing, profit/margin/break-even, and quote.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to cost and price a **package deal** (e.g., "3 repairs for the price of 2.5") and calculate the break-even for the package. Also ask them to compare two pricing models for the same job and explain which is better and why.

Capstone links. This session's costed price list and break-even calculation become the financial snapshot in the capstone. The quote becomes a supporting document in the capstone pack. The pricing model choice shapes the business model. In Session 9, the learner will defend their price in the viva â€" "Why this price?" â€" and the answer will be: "Because my cost is X, my profit is Y, and my margin is Z." That is the answer of a professional.

Timing guidance. The priority is learners costing a job completely and writing a clear quote (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten Section F.3 (pricing models) to per job and per hour only, and limit the independent exercise to one offer instead of three. Protect the costing time â€" a learner who leaves without a full cost breakdown cannot price properly.

END OF SESSION 4

Next: Session 5 â€" Finding Your First Customers and Selling.

SESSION 05 OF 9

Finding Your First Customers and Selling

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 05



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" BUSINESS & FREELANCING

SESSION 5 â€" FINDING YOUR FIRST CUSTOMERS AND SELLING

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	5 of 9
Session title	Finding Your First Customers and Selling
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Win and Price Clients
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with selling)
Prerequisite knowledge	The Session 4 costed price list and quote. Learners must be willing to speak and role-play in class. No prior sales experience required.

Item	Detail
Connection to previous work	In Session 4 you learned to cost and price your work â€" you know what to charge and can defend it. Today we get you customers: how to find them, how to pitch, how to sell, and how to follow up. A price without a customer is just a number.
Preparation before class	Print the 60-second pitch template (Section F.3); print the sales conversation steps (Section F.5); print the ten-name pipeline template (Section H); prepare scenario cards for the role-play (price objection, "I will think about it", a busy customer); have the FastFix case pack ready; arrange the room for pair role-play.

Instructor note on tone: Many learners are afraid of selling â€" they think it means being pushy or begging. Reframe it: selling is helping someone solve a problem they already have. If your offer is genuine, selling is service. Keep the mood encouraging and practical â€" everyone will practise, no one will be mocked.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** why most customers come from nearby â€" referrals, networking, word of mouth â€" and why these are cheaper than advertising.
2. **Ask** for referrals without begging, using a simple script.
3. **Build** a 60-second elevator pitch: who you serve, the problem, what you deliver, and what happens next.
4. **Plan** three referral/networking actions for the next week.
5. **Role-play** a full sales conversation: approach, ask, listen, propose, handle a price objection, agree a clear next step, and follow up.
6. **Explain** why most sales come on the second or third contact, and why silence is not always rejection.
7. **Produce** a written 60-second pitch script and a ten-name pipeline with planned approaches and follow-up dates (LO7).

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with a notes app) or an academy computer with Google Docs.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.
- Notebook and pen (optional).

Software

- A simple text app: phone Notes, Google Docs or Microsoft Word.
- The **60-second pitch template**, **sales conversation steps** and **ten-name pipeline template** (Sections F.3, F.5, H) projected and printed.

Sample files

- Printed **60-second pitch template** (Section F.3).
- Printed **sales conversation steps** (Section F.5).
- Printed **ten-name pipeline template** (Section H).
- **Scenario cards** for role-play: (1) price objection, (2) "I will think about it", (3) a busy customer, (4) a curious customer.
- The **FastFix case pack** (from Sessions 1â€"4).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 5.1 â€" "60-Second Pitch Script" (who / problem / deliverable / next step).
- Worksheet 5.2 â€" "Referral Ask Script" (a simple script for asking for referrals).
- Worksheet 5.3 â€" "Sales Conversation Practice" (approach / ask / listen / propose / handle objection / next step / follow up).

- Worksheet 5.4 â€" "Ten-Name Pipeline" (name / how I know them / planned approach / follow-up date).

Accounts

- None required beyond what learners already have.

Internet

- Not required. The session works fully offline with printed templates and role-play.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a notes app works. A learner who is uncomfortable speaking publicly may pair with a classmate and submit a written or recorded version; this must be declared to the instructor at the start.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two "customer-finding stories" without labelling them.

- **Story A:** "Chidi from FastFix waits for customers to come to his shop. He has a signboard, but it is old and faded. He does not ask happy customers for referrals. He does not talk to other shop owners. He posts on his personal Facebook page once a month. He wonders why business is slow."
- **Story B:** "Adaeze from Adaeze Fashion asks every happy customer: 'Do you know one other person who might need a dress like this?' She gives them a small discount on their next order for every referral. She talks to other business owners at the market and refers customers to them too. She posts on WhatsApp status every week with a clear photo and price. She has more orders than she can handle."

What the instructor says:

> *"Two businesses. Hands up â€" which one has more customers? â€¦ Story B, almost always. Why? Because Adaeze **goes to the customer** â€" she asks, she networks, she follows up. Chidi waits. Today we learn to be Adaeze. You will learn how to find customers nearby, how to pitch in 60 seconds, how to sell without being pushy, and how to follow up. Selling is a skill â€" and you will learn it."*

Expected learner response: Learners will say "B asks for referrals", "B is active", "A is waiting", "B helps others". Accept all answers and draw out the difference: **active vs passive**.

Then reveal the hook: Ask, "How many of you are afraid of selling â€" you think it means begging or being pushy?" Many hands go up. Say:

> *"Good â€" that means you have good character. Selling is not begging. Selling is helping someone solve a problem they already have. If your offer is genuine, the customer needs you as much as you need them. Today you learn to connect the two."*

Why this opener works: It uses the running example and a contrasting example, it isolates proactivity as the variable, and it reframes selling as service â€" which lowers the fear barrier.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the eight components of the full cost of a job?"

- Expected answer: Materials, data, transport, tools, packaging, overhead share, waste allowance, your time.
- Common gap: learners remember four or five. Clarify: "The eight components are your checklist â€" use it every time you cost a job."

Question 2: "What are the seven parts of a clear quote?"

- Expected answer: Business name, date/number, customer, description, quantity/unit price, total, terms (validity, payment, exclusions).
- Common gap: learners remember the price but not the terms. Clarify: "The terms are what prevent disputes â€" never skip them."

Question 3: "What is break-even?"

- Expected answer: The point where revenue covers cost â€" the minimum you must sell to survive.
- Common gap: learners confuse it with profit. Clarify: "Break-even is where you stop losing money; profit starts after."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You can cost, price and quote. Now you need customers. The best customers are not found through adverts â€" they are found through people. Referrals, networking, word of mouth â€" these are free and they work. Today you learn to use them, and you learn to sell when the customer is in front of you."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the eight cost components, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing them on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Where customers come from â€" the nearby principle

The idea. Most small business customers come from **nearby** â€" from people who know you, trust you, or are one introduction away. This is not a limitation â€" it is an advantage. Nearby customers are cheaper to reach, easier to trust, and more likely to return.

The four nearby sources â€" teach them one by one:

1. **Referrals:** Happy customers tell others. This is the cheapest and most trusted source â€" a recommendation from a friend is worth more than any advert.
2. **Networking:** Meeting people who can send customers to you â€" other business owners, community leaders, church groups, market associations, WhatsApp groups.
3. **Word of mouth:** What people say about you when you are not in the room. Good service creates word of mouth; bad service creates the opposite.
4. **Showing up where the customer already is:** Being present in the places your customer goes â€" the market, the church, the school, the WhatsApp group â€" so they can find you.

Why nearby beats advertising:

- **Cost:** Referrals and networking are free; adverts cost money.
- **Trust:** A recommendation from a friend is trusted; an advert is doubted.
- **Speed:** A referral can become a customer today; an advert takes weeks to work.
- **Fit:** Nearby customers are in your area, so you can serve them well.

Real-life comparison. Think of a market trader. The trader who knows her regular customers by name, asks about their families, and tells them when fresh stock arrives â€" that trader has customers for life. The trader who sits silently and waits â€" that trader hopes. The difference is not luck; it is relationship.

Important limitation / misconception. "I need social media adverts to get customers." No â€" adverts can help, but they are not the foundation. A business with no customers and no money should start with referrals and networking â€" free and fast. Adverts come later, when you have the money and the offer is proven.

How a learner recognises a nearby customer: They can name at least ten people who fit their customer description â€" and they know where those people are.

F.2 Asking for referrals â€" without begging

The idea. Most happy customers would refer you â€” if you asked. But most business owners never ask, because they feel it is begging. It is not. Asking for a referral is a service: you are connecting a friend to something they need.

The referral ask â€” a simple script:

1. **Ask for feedback first:** "Are you happy with the work I did for you?"
2. **If yes, ask for the referral:** "Do you know one other person who might need something like this?"
3. **Make it easy:** "Could you send them my number? Or could I call you when I am near them?"
4. **Offer a thank-you:** "Thank you â€” as a thank-you, I will give you 10% off your next order."

Why this works:

- You ask only when the customer is happy â€” so the referral is genuine.
- You make it easy â€ one person, one action.
- You give a thank-you â€ so the customer feels appreciated, not used.

Real-life comparison. Think of a doctor. A doctor does not beg for patients. A doctor asks a happy patient: "Do you know someone else with this problem?" The patient refers a friend â€ because the doctor helped them. The referral is a compliment, not a favour.

Misconception to correct. "Asking for referrals is begging." No â€ it is a normal part of business. A customer who is happy wants to help you. Asking gives them the chance.

Say this to the class:

> *"The most dangerous phrase in business is 'I do not want to bother people.' You are not bothering them â€ you are offering them a solution. A referral is a gift you give a friend: the gift of a good service. Ask with confidence."*

F.3 The 60-second elevator pitch â€ who, problem, deliverable, next step

The idea. An **elevator pitch** is a short, clear description of your business that you can deliver in 60 seconds â€ the time it takes to ride in an elevator with a potential customer. It is not a sales pitch; it is a conversation starter.

The four parts â€ teach them one by one:

1. **Who you serve:** A specific customer in a specific place.
    - FastFix example: "I help office workers and students around Mile 3 and Trans-Amadi."
2. **The problem:** What bothers them.
    - FastFix example: "whose phone screen or battery fails during the workday."
3. **What you deliver:** The solution and the outcome.
    - FastFix example: "I repair screens and batteries the same day, with a 30-day warranty."
4. **What happens next:** A clear, easy next step.
    - FastFix example: "Call or WhatsApp me, and I will tell you if I can fix your phone â€ free diagnosis."

The full 60-second pitch for FastFix (read it aloud):

> *"I help office workers and students around Mile 3 and Trans-Amadi whose phone screen or battery fails during the workday. I repair screens and batteries the same day, with a 30-day warranty. If your phone is giving you trouble, call or WhatsApp me â€ I will tell you if I can fix it, free. My name is Chidi, and I am at Mile 3 Market."*

Why 60 seconds? Because attention is short. If you cannot explain your business in 60 seconds, the customer will not understand it â€ and they will not buy. The pitch is not about saying everything; it is about saying enough to start a conversation.

Real-life comparison. Think of a market trader. A trader who says "I sell phones" gets ignored. A trader who says "I fix your phone screen today, with a warranty â€ bring it now" gets a customer. The difference is not the product â€ it is the pitch.

Misconception to correct. "A pitch is a speech." No â€ a pitch is a conversation starter. You deliver it, then you stop and listen. The customer's response tells you what to say next.

F.4 Networking and word of mouth â€” value first, with manners

The idea. Networking is meeting people who can send customers to you â€” and sending customers to them. Word of mouth is what people say about you when you are not in the room. Both are built the same way: **value first, with manners.**

The networking rules â€” teach them one by one:

1. **Go where the customer is:** Market associations, church groups, business groups, WhatsApp groups, community meetings.
2. **Give before you ask:** Help someone, share useful information, refer a customer to another business â€” before you ask for anything.
3. **Be consistent:** Show up regularly. A person who appears once is a stranger; a person who appears monthly is a contact.
4. **Be specific about what you do:** "I repair phones" is vague. "I repair phone screens and batteries with a 30-day warranty" is specific â€” people can refer you.
5. **Follow up:** After meeting someone, send a message: "Nice to meet you at the market meeting. I repair phones â€” if you ever need one fixed, call me."

Word of mouth â€” how to build it:

- **Deliver excellent service:** The foundation of word of mouth is a happy customer.
- **Ask for feedback:** "Are you happy with the work?" If yes, ask for a referral. If no, fix it.
- **Make it easy to talk about you:** A clear name, a clear offer, a clear price â€” so people can describe you accurately.
- **Say thank you:** A customer who refers someone deserves a thank-you â€” a discount, a small gift, or a sincere message.

Real-life comparison. Think of a church. A church member who helps in the kitchen, greets newcomers, and stays after the service to talk â€” that member has friends and influence. A member who arrives late, sits alone, and leaves immediately â€” that member is invisible. Networking is the same: show up, help, stay.

Misconception to correct. "Networking is using people." No â€” networking is building relationships. A network built on use collapses; a network built on value grows.

F.5 The sales conversation â€” seven steps from approach to follow-up

The idea. Selling is not a single moment â€” it is a conversation with seven steps. Most beginners skip steps and wonder why the customer says no. Learn the steps, and the conversation flows.

The seven steps â€” teach them one by one:

1. **Approach:** Start the conversation warmly. "Hello, I am [name]. I help [customer type] with [problem]."
2. **Ask:** Use open questions to understand the customer's situation. "Tell me about your phone â€” what is wrong with it?"
3. **Listen:** Listen more than you talk. The customer will tell you what they need â€” if you let them.
4. **Propose:** Offer your solution based on what you heard. "I can replace your screen today with a quality part and a 30-day warranty. It will cost â‚¦6,500."
5. **Handle objections:** When the customer says "it is too expensive" or "I will think about it", respond with value â€” not pressure. "I understand. The price includes a quality part and a 30-day warranty â€” if the screen fails again, I fix it free. Would that give you peace of mind?"
6. **Agree a next step:** Never end with "okay, call me." Agree a specific action. "So I will order the part tomorrow and text you when it arrives â€” is that okay?"
7. **Follow up:** Most sales are lost here. Contact the customer after the agreed time. "Hello, the part arrived â€” can you bring your phone tomorrow?"

Why most sales come on the second or third contact: The first contact builds awareness. The second builds trust. The third closes the sale. Most beginners give up after the first contact â€” and lose the sale to someone who followed up.

Real-life comparison. Think of a farmer. A farmer does not plant and harvest the same day. They plant (approach), water (ask and listen), nurture (propose and handle objections), and harvest (agree and follow up). Selling is the same â€” it is a process, not a moment.

Misconception to correct. "Silence means rejection." No â€” silence often means "I am thinking" or "I am busy." A customer who does not answer today may answer next week. Follow up â€” politely and persistently.

F.6 WhatsApp and word of mouth â€” selling without a shop

The idea. In Nigeria, WhatsApp is not just a messaging app â€” it is a business tool. Many small businesses find and serve customers entirely through WhatsApp. Learn to use it well.

The WhatsApp selling rules:

1. **Use WhatsApp Business** (we set it up in Session 8) â€” it has a profile, catalogue, and labels.
2. **Post on status regularly:** A clear photo, a clear price, and a clear call to action â€” "Call or WhatsApp to order."
3. **Reply fast:** A customer who waits hours for a reply will go to someone else. Reply within minutes, even if it is "I will get back to you in one hour."
4. **Use labels:** Label customers as "new", "quoted", "paid", "completed" â€” so you can follow up.
5. **Send a catalogue:** When a customer asks "what do you do?", send a clear catalogue â€” not a long voice note.
6. **Follow up with a message:** After a job, send a message: "I hope you are happy with the repair. If you know anyone else who needs a phone fixed, I will appreciate the referral."

Real-life comparison. Think of a market trader with a loudspeaker. The trader who announces her products clearly, answers questions quickly, and follows up with regular customers â€” that trader sells more. WhatsApp is the digital loudspeaker.

Misconception to correct. "WhatsApp is for friends, not business." No â€” WhatsApp is where your customers are. A business that ignores WhatsApp is invisible to its own market.

F.7 Summary of the session

- Most customers come from **nearby** â€” referrals, networking, word of mouth, showing up where the customer is.
- **Ask for referrals** without begging â€” ask when the customer is happy, make it easy, say thank you.
- The **60-second pitch** has four parts: who, problem, deliverable, next step.
- **Networking** is value first, with manners â€” give before you ask, be consistent, follow up.
- The **sales conversation** has seven steps: approach, ask, listen, propose, handle objections, agree a next step, follow up.
- Most sales come on the **second or third contact** â€” follow up.
- **WhatsApp** is a business tool â€” reply fast, use labels, follow up.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Your network] --> B[Referrals]
    A --> C[WhatsApp broadcasts]
    A --> D[Church/mosque community]
    A --> E[Local business groups]
    B --> F[First paying client]
    C --> F
    D --> F
    E --> F
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Show the class how to deliver a 60-second pitch and run a sales conversation â€” live â€” so they can do it themselves.

Setup: Open a blank Google Doc titled "60-Second Pitch â€” FastFix". Have the sales conversation steps on the projector. Invite a volunteer to play a customer.

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A blank pitch template on the projector.
- The sales conversation steps on the projector.
- A volunteer briefed to play a customer with a phone problem.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€” the 60-second pitch (3 minutes)

Say: "I will deliver the FastFix pitch in 60 seconds. Watch the four parts."

Deliver the pitch aloud, timing it:

> *"I help office workers and students around Mile 3 and Trans-Amadi whose phone screen or battery fails during the workday. I repair screens and batteries the same day, with a 30-day warranty. If your phone is giving you trouble, call or WhatsApp me â€" I will tell you if I can fix it, free. My name is Chidi, and I am at Mile 3 Market."*

Say: "Four parts: who (office workers and students), problem (screen or battery fails), deliverable (same-day repair with warranty), next step (call or WhatsApp for a free diagnosis). Sixty seconds. Clear. Easy to remember."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" the sales conversation (8 minutes)

Say: "Now the sales conversation. I will play the seller; my volunteer will play a customer with a broken phone. Watch the seven steps."

Step 1 â€" Approach: "Hello, I am Chidi from FastFix. I help people with phone repairs. What seems to be the problem with your phone?"

Step 2 â€" Ask: "Tell me about it â€" when did it start? What happened?"

Volunteer (customer): "My screen cracked yesterday when I dropped it. I need it fixed, but I am worried about the cost."

Step 3 â€" Listen: (Nod, do not interrupt.) "I understand â€" a cracked screen is stressful, especially when you need your phone for work."

Step 4 â€" Propose: "I can replace your screen today with a quality part and a 30-day warranty. It will cost â‚¦6,500. I can have it ready by 5 p.m."

Step 5 â€" Handle objection: "That is more than I expected."

Instructor: "I understand. The price includes a quality part and a 30-day warranty â€" if the screen fails again within 30 days, I fix it free. Would that give you peace of mind?"

Volunteer: "Okay, that sounds fair."

Step 6 â€" Agree a next step: "So I will order the part tomorrow morning and text you when it arrives. Can you bring your phone tomorrow afternoon?"

Volunteer: "Yes, that works."

Step 7 â€" Follow up: "Thank you. I will text you tomorrow when the part arrives. If you have any questions before then, call me."

Say to the class: "Seven steps. Approach, ask, listen, propose, handle the objection, agree a next step, follow up. Notice what I did not do: I did not pressure. I did not beg. I asked, listened, proposed, and agreed a clear next step. That is selling."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" the referral ask (2 minutes)

Say: "After the job is done and the customer is happy, I ask for a referral."

Instructor (to volunteer): "I hope you are happy with the repair. Do you know one other person who might need a phone fixed?"

Volunteer: "Yes, my colleague has a battery problem."

Instructor: "Could you send them my number? And as a thank-you, I will give you 10% off your next repair."

Say: "Ask when the customer is happy. Make it easy â€" one person. Say thank you. That is the referral ask."

G.5 Questions to ask during the demo

- "What are the four parts of the pitch?" (Who, problem, deliverable, next step.)
- "What are the seven steps of the sales conversation?" (Approach, ask, listen, propose, handle objection, agree next step, follow up.)
- "What did I do when the customer said 'that is more than I expected'?" (I acknowledged the concern, then offered value â€" the warranty â€" not pressure.)
- "Why is follow-up important?" (Most sales come on the second or third contact â€" follow-up is where the sale is won.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner writes a 60-second pitch, practises it with a partner, and role-plays a sales conversation.

Starting materials: A pen and notebook or phone notes app; the pitch template and sales conversation steps (projected and printed).

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name and today's date at the top of your workbook or notes app.
2. **Write your 60-second pitch:** Use the template (Worksheet 5.1) â€" who, problem, deliverable, next step. (Worksheet 5.1.)
3. **Practise your pitch:** Stand up and deliver your pitch to your partner. Time it â€" 60 seconds or less.
4. **Partner feedback:** Your partner says one thing that is clear and one question they have.
5. **Revise your pitch** based on the feedback.
6. **Role-play the sales conversation:** You play the seller; your partner plays a customer with a problem. Use the seven steps (Worksheet 5.3). Your partner uses one of the scenario cards (price objection, "I will think about it", busy customer, curious customer).
7. **Swap roles:** Your partner now plays the seller; you play the customer.
8. **Debrief:** Tell your partner one thing they did well and one thing to improve.
9. **Write your referral ask:** Write your own referral ask script (Worksheet 5.2) â€" based on the model in Section F.2.

Expected result: A written 60-second pitch, a practised sales conversation, and a referral ask script.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 3: "Was your pitch 60 seconds or less? Was it clear?"
- After step 6: "Which step was hardest? Why?"
- After step 8: "What did your partner do well? What could they improve?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner's pitch is too long â†' Ask: "What is the one thing the customer needs to know? Cut everything else."
- Learner's pitch is vague â†' Ask: "Who is the customer? What is the problem? What do they get?"
- Learner skips steps in the role-play â†' Stop them. "You jumped from approach to propose. Go back â€" ask and listen first."
- Learner pressures the customer â†' Remind them: "Selling is helping, not pressuring. Acknowledge the concern, then offer value."
- Learner does not follow up â†' Ask: "What is the next step? When will you contact them?"

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ 60-second pitch written with all four parts
- ☐ Pitch delivered in 60 seconds or less
- ☐ Pitch revised based on partner feedback
- ☐ Sales conversation role-played with all seven steps
- ☐ Referral ask script written
- ☐ Debrief completed with partner

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Write a **ten-name pipeline** â€" ten named potential customers with a planned approach and follow-up date for each.

Scenario. You have a business idea and a 60-second pitch. Now you need to find your first ten customers. These are not strangers â€" they are people you know or can reach through your network: family, friends, classmates, church members, market contacts, WhatsApp groups, other business owners.

Requirements:

1. Write down **ten names** â€" real people you know or can reach. (If you cannot think of ten, write five and explain how you will find five more.)
2. For each person, write:
    - **Name**
    - **How you know them** (family, church, school, market, WhatsApp group)
    - **Planned approach** (how you will contact them â€" call, WhatsApp, visit, message)
    - **Follow-up date** (when you will contact them again if they do not respond)
3. Write one sentence: "My first three customers will most likely come from _____, because _____."
4. Write one sentence: "One networking action I will take this week is _____, because _____."

Constraints:

- The ten names must be real people â€" not "everybody" or "people on the street".
- The planned approach must be specific â€" not "I will tell them about my business".
- The follow-up date must be a real date â€" not "someday".

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Ten names (or five with a plan for five more).
- Each name has a planned approach and follow-up date.
- The two sentences are realistic and specific.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: Start with people who already know and trust you â€" family, friends, church members.
- Hint 2: Think of people who have referred you before â€" they are likely to do it again.
- Hint 3: For the networking action, think of one group you can join or one event you can attend this week.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Ten-name pipeline (model â€" for a fictional "Tobi's Phone Photography for Food Sellers"):

#	Name	How I know them	Planned approach	Follow-up date
1	My aunt (food seller)	Family	Call her, offer a free photo session	15 Oct
2	My cousin (caterer)	Family	WhatsApp her, show my portfolio	15 Oct
3	Mama Chika (food seller)	Church	Visit her stall, show my portfolio	16 Oct
4	My roommate's mother (food seller)	Friend's family	Ask my roommate to introduce me	17 Oct
5	Food seller at my market	Market	Visit her stall, show my portfolio	18 Oct
6	My church's women's leader	Church	Ask her to announce my service	19 Oct
7	My former classmate (event planner)	School	WhatsApp her, offer a partnership	20 Oct
8	My uncle (caterer)	Family	Call him, offer a discount for first job	21 Oct
9	Food seller on my street	Neighbourhood	Visit her stall, show my portfolio	22 Oct
10	My WhatsApp group admin	WhatsApp group	Ask her to share my service in the group	23 Oct

First three customers sentence: "My first three customers will most likely come from my family and church, because they already trust me and can confirm my work."

Networking action sentence: "One networking action I will take this week is to join the Port Harcourt Food Sellers WhatsApp group, because that is where my customers are."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Ten names (or five with a plan) (3)
- Each name has a planned approach (3)
- Each name has a follow-up date (2)

- Two sentences are realistic and specific (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Kelechi* is a barber in Port Harcourt. He works in a small shop near a busy junction. He is good at his work â€” his cuts are clean and his customers are happy. But he has the same problem every month: not enough customers. He sits in his shop and waits. He does not ask for referrals. He does not talk to other business owners. He posts on his personal Facebook page once a month â€” a photo of a haircut with the caption "Fresh cut." He wonders why he is not busier.

Relevant facts.

- Kelechi cuts 10â€“15 heads a week.
- His shop is near a market, a church, and a bus stop â€” lots of foot traffic.
- He has been cutting hair for three years â€” he is skilled.
- He charges â‚¦1,500 per cut â€” a fair price.
- His customers are happy â€” but he never asks them for referrals.

Decision point. What is Kelechi's real problem?

Possible approaches.

1. Lower his prices â€ "maybe I am too expensive."
2. Move to a bigger shop â€ "maybe my location is the problem."
3. Become active: ask for referrals, network with nearby businesses, post on WhatsApp status regularly, follow up with customers.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Kelechi's problem is not his skill, his price, or his location â€ it is that he is passive. He waits for customers instead of going to them. A barber who asks every happy customer "Do you know one other person who needs a haircut?" and offers a small discount for referrals â€ that barber doubles his customers without spending a naira.

Reasoning / example actions for Kelechi:

- **Referral ask:** After every cut, ask: "Are you happy with your haircut? Do you know one other person who needs a cut? Send them my number â€ and I will give you â‚¦200 off your next cut."
- **WhatsApp status:** Post a photo of a fresh cut every week â€ with a clear price and a clear call to action: "Fresh cut â€ â‚¦1,500. Call or WhatsApp to book."
- **Networking:** Talk to the tailor next door, the phone accessories seller, and the food vendor â€ refer customers to them, and ask them to refer to you.
- **Follow up:** Keep a list of customers and text them every 3â€“4 weeks: "It has been a while â€ time for a fresh cut? Call me."

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (lower prices) reduces his income without increasing customers â€ he will be busier and poorer.
- Approach 2 (move to a bigger shop) costs money and does not solve the real problem â€ a bigger shop with the same passivity will still be empty.
- Approach 3 (become active) costs nothing but effort â€ and it solves the real problem.

Professional connection. The difference between a busy barber and an empty barber is not talent â€ it is **customer relationship management**. A barber who knows his customers by name, asks about their families, and texts them when it is time for a cut â€ that barber has customers for life. Selling is not a single skill â€ it is a set of habits.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Waiting for customers

Symptoms: The learner sits and waits; business is slow; they wonder why. **Likely cause:** They are passive â€ they do not ask, network, or follow up. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What did you do this week to find customers? Did you ask for referrals? Did

you follow up?" **Corrective steps:** Become active â€" ask for referrals, network, post on WhatsApp, follow up. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can name three actions they took this week to find customers. **Prevention:** Customers do not come to you â€" you go to them.

K.2 Pitching instead of asking

Symptoms: The learner talks about their business non-stop; the customer looks uncomfortable. **Likely cause:** They are pitching instead of having a conversation. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What questions did you ask? What did the customer say?" **Corrective steps:** Use the seven steps â€" approach, ask, listen, propose. Ask more than you talk. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner asks open questions and listens. **Prevention:** Selling is a conversation, not a speech.

K.3 Pressuring the customer

Symptoms: The learner pushes the customer to buy; the customer feels uncomfortable and leaves. **Likely cause:** They are desperate, not helpful. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What did you say when the customer hesitated?" **Corrective steps:** Acknowledge the concern, offer value, and give the customer space. "I understand â€" take your time. Here is my number if you have questions." **How to confirm resolved:** The learner handles objections with value, not pressure. **Prevention:** Selling is helping, not pressuring.

K.4 No follow-up

Symptoms: The learner meets a potential customer, gives their number, and never hears from them again. **Likely cause:** They did not follow up â€" they waited for the customer to call. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Did you agree a next step? Did you follow up?" **Corrective steps:** Agree a specific next step and follow up on the agreed date. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can state when they will follow up and with whom. **Prevention:** Most sales come on the second or third contact â€" follow up.

K.5 A vague pitch

Symptoms: The learner says "I do hair" or "I sell phones" â€" and the customer does not understand. **Likely cause:** The pitch has no structure â€" no who, problem, deliverable, next step. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What is your 60-second pitch? Can you deliver it now?" **Corrective steps:** Use the four parts â€" who, problem, deliverable, next step. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can deliver a clear 60-second pitch. **Prevention:** The pitch is a structure â€" use it every time.

K.6 Not asking for referrals

Symptoms: The learner has happy customers but never gets referrals. **Likely cause:** They feel it is begging â€" so they never ask. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Have you asked any happy customer for a referral?" **Corrective steps:** Use the referral ask script â€" ask when the customer is happy, make it easy, say thank you. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner has asked at least one customer for a referral. **Prevention:** A referral is a gift you give a friend â€" ask with confidence.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it with the learner â€" ask them the investigation question and listen to the answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Pitch and Pipeline â€" 60-Second Pitch and Ten-Name Pipeline"

Purpose: To practise the 60-second pitch and build a concrete customer pipeline â€" the two tools that turn a business idea into real customers â€" and to build the pitch script that will become the capstone pitch.

Realistic scenario. You have a validated, costed and priced business idea. This week, you will write your 60-second pitch, practise it, and build a ten-name pipeline of potential customers.

Detailed instructions:

1. **60-second pitch:** Write your pitch using the four parts â€" who, problem, deliverable, next step. (Worksheet 5.1.) Practise delivering it aloud â€" 60 seconds or less.
2. **Referral ask script:** Write your own referral ask â€" based on the model in Section F.2. (Worksheet 5.2.)
3. **Ten-name pipeline:** Write down ten named potential customers. For each: name, how you know them, planned approach, follow-up date. (Worksheet 5.4.)

4. **Three networking actions:** List three specific networking actions you will take in the next week â€" e.g., join a WhatsApp group, attend a market meeting, talk to a specific business owner.
5. **Reflection:** Write 3â€"5 sentences: "What I learned about selling this week is _____. What I will do differently is _____."

Required deliverables:

- A written 60-second pitch.
- A referral ask script.
- A ten-name pipeline with approaches and follow-up dates.
- Three networking actions.
- A short reflection.

Submission format: Save as a Google Doc (or a clear photo of handwritten work) and upload to your Drive folder `CEA-Biz-YourName`, or show it to the instructor at the start of Session 6. You may also copy the text into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 6.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
60-second pitch	5	All four parts, clear, 60 seconds or less
Referral ask script	3	Based on the model, specific
Ten-name pipeline	6	Ten names, each with approach and follow-up date
Three networking actions	3	Specific and realistic
Reflection	3	Honest and specific

Common mistakes to avoid: a vague pitch; no referral ask; a pipeline with no follow-up dates; networking actions that are not specific; no reflection.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

60-second pitch (model â€" for a fictional "Adaeze's Sewing"): "I help working women in Port Harcourt who need clothes that fit well without a boutique price. I sew dresses, skirts and blouses to your size, with quality fabric and a 7-day fitting guarantee. If you need something sewn, call or WhatsApp me â€" I will give you a free quote. My name is Adaeze, and I am at Trans-Amadi."

Referral ask script (model): "Are you happy with your dress? Do you know one other person who might need something sewn? Could you send them my number? And as a thank-you, I will give you 10% off your next order."

Ten-name pipeline (model):

#	Name	How I know them	Planned approach	Follow-up date
1	My sister	Family	Call her, show my portfolio	15 Oct
2	My roommate	School	Show her my work, ask for referrals	15 Oct
3	My church friend	Church	WhatsApp her, show my portfolio	16 Oct
4	My former classmate	School	Ask her to share my service in her group	17 Oct
5	My neighbour	Neighbourhood	Visit her, show my portfolio	18 Oct
6	My aunt	Family	Call her, offer a discount for first order	19 Oct
7	My church's women's leader	Church	Ask her to announce my service	20 Oct
8	My WhatsApp group admin	WhatsApp group	Ask her to share my service	21 Oct
9	My cousin's friend	Family	Ask my cousin to introduce me	22 Oct
10	My market contact	Market	Visit her stall, show my portfolio	23 Oct

Three networking actions (model):

1. Join the Port Harcourt Fashion WhatsApp group and introduce myself.

2. Attend my church's women's meeting and tell them about my sewing.
3. Talk to the tailor at my market and offer to refer customers to each other.

Reflection (model): "What I learned about selling this week is that asking for referrals is not begging â€" it is helping. What I will do differently is to ask every happy customer for a referral, and to follow up with customers every few weeks instead of waiting for them to call."

A strong learner solution differs in content but ticks every rubric row.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What are the four nearby sources of customers?

Q2. Multiple choice. What is the best way to ask for a referral? a) "Please tell everyone about my business." b) "Are you happy with the work? Do you know one other person who might need this?" c) "I need customers â€" can you help me?" d) "Tell your friends or I will not serve you again."

Q3. Matching. Match each part of the pitch to what it is: (1) who, (2) problem, (3) deliverable, (4) next step. a) "Call or WhatsApp me for a free quote" b) "Office workers around Mile 3" c) "whose phone screen fails during the workday" d) "I repair screens the same day with a 30-day warranty"

Q4. True or false. "Most sales come on the first contact."

Q5. Explain. What are the seven steps of the sales conversation?

Q6. Practical. A customer says "it is too expensive." Write one sentence you would say in response â€" using value, not pressure.

Q7. Scenario. Your friend has a business but never asks for referrals and never follows up with customers. What two things should she start doing?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q7)

A1. The four nearby sources: referrals, networking, word of mouth, and showing up where the customer already is.

A2. (b) "Are you happy with the work? Do you know one other person who might need this?" â€" ask when the customer is happy, make it easy, one person.

A3. (1) = b, (2) = c, (3) = d, (4) = a.

A4. False. Most sales come on the second or third contact â€" follow up.

A5. The seven steps: approach, ask, listen, propose, handle objections, agree a next step, follow up.

A6. Any sentence that acknowledges the concern and offers value â€" e.g., "I understand. The price includes a quality part and a 30-day warranty â€" if it fails again, I fix it free. Would that give you peace of mind?" (Must acknowledge the concern and offer value â€" not pressure or a discount.)

A7. Two things: (1) Ask every happy customer for a referral â€" "Do you know one other person who might need this?" (2) Follow up with customers â€" agree a next step and contact them on the agreed date. (Accept any two sensible actions from the session content.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that most customers come from nearby â€" referrals, networking, word of mouth, and showing up where the customer is. You learned to ask for referrals without begging â€" ask when the customer is happy, make it easy, say thank you. You learned the 60-second pitch: who, problem, deliverable, next step. You learned that networking is value first, with manners â€" give before you ask, be consistent, follow up. You learned the seven steps of the sales conversation: approach, ask, listen, propose, handle objections, agree a next step, follow up. You learned that most sales come on the second or third contact â€" follow up. And you learned that WhatsApp is a business tool â€" reply fast, use labels, follow up.

Five important takeaways:

1. Customers come from **nearby** â€" referrals, networking, word of mouth.
2. **Ask for referrals** â€" it is a gift, not a favour.
3. The **60-second pitch**: who, problem, deliverable, next step.
4. The **sales conversation** has seven steps â€" follow them.
5. **Follow up** â€" most sales come on the second or third contact.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I name four nearby sources of customers?
- Can I ask for a referral without begging?
- Can I deliver a 60-second pitch with all four parts?
- Can I run a sales conversation with all seven steps?
- Can I build a ten-name pipeline with follow-up dates?

Connection to the next session. You can find customers and sell to them. But what happens after the sale? How do you manage the customer, set expectations, handle scope creep, and deal with difficult clients? Next session we learn customer service and managing clients â€" the skills that turn a first customer into a repeat customer and a referral source.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner names four nearby sources of customers.
- Learner asks for referrals using the script â€" when the customer is happy, one person, with a thank-you.
- Learner delivers a 60-second pitch with all four parts â€" who, problem, deliverable, next step.
- Learner role-plays a sales conversation with all seven steps.
- Learner builds a ten-name pipeline with specific approaches and follow-up dates.
- Learner handles objections with value, not pressure.
- Learner explains why follow-up matters.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "I need adverts to get customers." â†' Start with referrals and networking â€" free and fast.
- "Asking for referrals is begging." â†' It is a gift you give a friend â€" ask with confidence.
- "A pitch is a speech." â†' A pitch is a conversation starter â€" deliver it, then listen.
- "Selling is pressuring." â†' Selling is helping â€" acknowledge concerns, offer value.
- "Silence means rejection." â†' Silence often means "I am thinking" â€" follow up.
- "One contact is enough." â†' Most sales come on the second or third contact.
- "WhatsApp is for friends." â†' WhatsApp is a business tool â€" reply fast, use labels.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Pitch timing drill:** ask the learner to deliver their pitch â€" time it. If over 60 seconds, cut until it fits.
2. **Referral ask practice:** role-play a happy customer and ask the learner to make the referral ask â€" check for the three parts (ask when happy, one person, thank-you).
3. **Sales conversation step sorting:** give seven shuffled steps and ask the learner to put them in order.
4. **Pipeline building:** help the learner list ten names â€" start with family, friends, church, school â€" and add a follow-up date for each.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed pitch template (who and problem already filled); learner writes the deliverable and next step. Provide a referral ask script to copy and adapt.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" full pitch, referral ask, sales conversation role-play, ten-name pipeline.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to write a **follow-up message** for a customer who has not responded in two weeks â€" polite, specific, and with a clear next step. Also ask them to plan a **referral incentive** (e.g., a discount or a small gift) and

explain why it works.

Capstone links. This session's 60-second pitch becomes the capstone pitch. The ten-name pipeline becomes the "first customers" plan in the capstone. The sales conversation skills are practised in the Session 7 simulation. The referral ask and networking actions become part of the marketing plan in Session 8. In Session 9, the learner will deliver the pitch live â€" and the pitch they deliver will be the one they wrote and practised today.

Timing guidance. The priority is learners writing and practising the 60-second pitch and role-playing the sales conversation (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten Section F.4 (networking) to the two most important rules (give before you ask, follow up), and limit the independent exercise to the pitch and pipeline (the referral ask becomes optional). Protect the role-play time â€" a learner who leaves without practising the sales conversation has not learned to sell.

END OF SESSION 5

Next: Session 6 â€" Customer Service and Managing Clients.

SESSION 06 OF 9

Customer Service and Managing Clients

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 06



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" BUSINESS & FREELANCING

SESSION 6 â€" CUSTOMER SERVICE AND MANAGING CLIENTS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	6 of 9
Session title	Customer Service and Managing Clients
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Win and Price Clients
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with client management)
Prerequisite knowledge	The Session 5 pitch and pipeline. Learners must be willing to role-play difficult conversations in class. No prior customer service experience required.

Item	Detail
Connection to previous work	In Session 5 you learned to find customers and sell to them. Today we keep them: how to communicate clearly, set expectations, define scope, write a one-page agreement, and handle difficult clients. Keeping a customer is cheaper than finding one â€” and a happy customer is your best marketing.
Preparation before class	Print the communication standards sheet (Section F.2); print the scope and exclusions template (Section F.3); print the one-page agreement template (Section F.5); prepare difficult-client scenario cards (scope creep, unrealistic deadline, late payer, complaint, free-work-for-exposure); have the FastFix case pack ready.

Instructor note on tone: Many learners think "difficult clients" are rare â€” they are not. Most small business owners have at least one difficult client story. Normalise it: difficult clients are a normal part of business, and they can be managed â€ or walked away from â€ professionally. Keep the mood practical and calm.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Apply** four communication standards: reply fast, confirm in writing, use plain language, never leave a customer guessing.
2. **Define** scope â€ what is included, what is excluded â€ and explain why most "difficult client" stories are scope failures.
3. **Set** expectations in writing: price, timeline, update points, and what they need from the customer.
4. **Write** a one-page client agreement: parties, scope, price, timeline, payment schedule, cancellation, signatures.
5. **Respond** correctly to at least three difficult-client situations: scope creep, unrealistic deadline, late payment, complaint, and free-work-for-"exposure".
6. **Explain** when to walk away from a client professionally.
7. **Score at least 70%** on the Session 6 knowledge check (LO8).

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with a notes app) or an academy computer with Google Docs.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.
- Notebook and pen (optional).

Software

- A simple text app: phone Notes, Google Docs or Microsoft Word.
- The **communication standards sheet**, **scope template**, and **one-page agreement template** (Sections F.2, F.3, F.5) projected and printed.

Sample files

- Printed **communication standards sheet** (Section F.2).
- Printed **scope and exclusions template** (Section F.3).
- Printed **one-page client agreement template** (Section F.5).
- **Difficult-client scenario cards** (Section I): (1) scope creep, (2) unrealistic deadline, (3) late payer, (4) complaint, (5) free-work-for-"exposure".
- The **FastFix case pack** (from Sessions 1â€“5).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 6.1 â€ "Communication Standards Checklist" (a tick-list for a customer message).
- Worksheet 6.2 â€ "Scope and Exclusions" (included / excluded / how to price a change).
- Worksheet 6.3 â€ "Expectations Setting" (price, timeline, updates, what I need from the customer).

- Worksheet 6.4 â€" "One-Page Client Agreement" (a blank agreement to fill in).
- Worksheet 6.5 â€" "Difficult Client Responses" (responses to three scenarios).

Accounts

- None required beyond what learners already have.

Internet

- Not required. The session works fully offline with printed templates and role-play.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a notes app works. A learner who is uncomfortable role-playing may write their responses instead of speaking them; the skill is the **thinking and the response**, not the performance.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two "customer stories" without labelling them.

- **Story A:** "Chidi from FastFix repaired a customer's phone screen. The customer said 'while you are at it, can you also fix my speaker and clean my phone?' Chidi said 'okay' â€" but did not agree a price or a timeline. He fixed the speaker for free because he did not know how to say no. The customer was happy â€" but Chidi lost money and time. The next customer asked for the same 'extra' â€" and Chidi was confused about what he should charge."
- **Story B:** "Adaeze from Adaeze Fashion sewed a dress for a customer. The customer said 'can you also make a matching headwrap?' Adaeze said 'of course â€" the headwrap will be â‚¦2,000, and I will deliver the whole order on Friday.' The customer agreed. Adaeze made the headwrap, charged for it, and delivered on time. The customer was happy â€" and Adaeze was paid for her work."

What the instructor says:

> *"Two businesses. Hands up â€" which one handled the situation better? â€¦ Story B, almost always. Why? Because Adaeze **defined the scope** â€" she said what was included, what was extra, and what the extra cost. Chidi did not â€" so he gave away his work. Today we learn to be Adaeze. You will learn to set expectations, define scope, write a simple agreement, and handle difficult clients without losing money or sleep."*

Expected learner response: Learners will say "B charged for the extra", "A was clear", "Chidi was too nice", "Adaeze said the price". Accept all answers and draw out the difference: **clear vs unclear**.

Then reveal the hook: Ask, "How many of you have ever done extra work for a customer â€" and not been paid for it?" Many hands go up. Say:

> *"That is not a failure of kindness â€" that is a failure of scope. And scope is learnable. Today you learn it."*

Why this opener works: It uses a situation everyone recognises (the customer who asks for "one small thing"), it isolates clarity as the variable, and it frames scope management as a skill that protects both you and the customer.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the four parts of the 60-second pitch?"

- Expected answer: Who, problem, deliverable, next step.
- Common gap: learners remember the pitch but not the parts. Clarify: "The pitch gets the customer â€" today we keep them."

Question 2: "What are the seven steps of the sales conversation?"

- Expected answer: Approach, ask, listen, propose, handle objections, agree a next step, follow up.

- Common gap: learners remember four or five. Clarify: "The seven steps are your script â€” the last two are where most sales are won."

Question 3: "Why is follow-up important?"

- Expected answer: Most sales come on the second or third contact â€” follow-up is where the sale is won.
- Common gap: learners think follow-up is pushy. Clarify: "Follow-up is service â€” you are helping the customer decide."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You can find customers and sell to them. Now you keep them. Keeping a customer is cheaper than finding one â€" and a happy customer is your best marketing. Today you learn to communicate clearly, set expectations, define scope, write a simple agreement, and handle difficult clients. These are the skills that turn a first customer into a repeat customer and a referral source."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the seven steps, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing them on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why keeping a customer is cheaper than finding one

The idea. Most small business owners spend all their time finding new customers and almost no time keeping the ones they have. This is backwards. Keeping a customer is cheaper, easier, and more profitable than finding a new one.

The economics â€” say them slowly:

- **Finding a new customer** takes time, effort and often money â€” marketing, pitching, following up.
- **Keeping a customer** takes good service, clear communication, and follow-up â€" almost no money.
- **A happy customer** refers others â€" so one good customer can become three.
- **An unhappy customer** tells others â€" so one bad experience can cost you five customers.

The maths of retention:

- If you keep 10 customers happy, they refer 3 more â€" you now have 13.
- If you lose 5 customers and have to find 5 new ones, you have spent more time and money to end up where you started.
- The business that keeps customers grows faster â€" and spends less.

Real-life comparison. Think of a bucket with holes. Finding new customers is pouring water in the top. Keeping customers is plugging the holes. A business that pours water but does not plug holes stays empty. A business that plugs holes and pours steadily fills up.

Important limitation / misconception. "Customer service is being nice." No â€" customer service is a system: clear communication, defined scope, written agreements, and professional handling of problems. Being nice is part of it â€" but the system is what makes it work.

How a learner recognises good customer service: They can point to a written agreement, a clear scope, and a professional response to a difficult situation.

F.2 Communication standards â€" the four rules

The idea. Most customer problems are communication problems. The customer is confused, feels ignored, or does not know what is happening. Four communication standards prevent most problems.

The four standards â€" teach them one by one:

1. **Reply fast:** Respond to every message within a few hours â€" even if it is "I will get back to you in one hour." A fast "I am on it" is better than a slow perfect answer.
    - FastFix example: Chidi receives a WhatsApp message: "Is my phone ready?" He replies in 5 minutes: "Yes â€" ready for collection after 4 p.m." The customer is reassured.

2. **Confirm in writing:** Never rely on a verbal agreement. Confirm every agreement, price, and timeline in writing â€" a WhatsApp message, an email, or a note.
    - FastFix example: After a phone call, Chidi sends a WhatsApp message: "Confirming: screen repair for iPhone 11, â‚¦6,500, ready by 5 p.m. tomorrow. Payment: 50% now, 50% on collection." The customer replies "Confirmed."
3. **Use plain language:** Write so a customer can understand â€" no jargon, no ambiguity, no assumptions.
    - FastFix example: Instead of "The LCD module is faulty," Chidi writes: "Your phone screen is damaged. I will replace it with a new screen â€" it will look and work like new."
4. **Never leave a customer guessing:** If there is a delay, a problem, or a change â€" tell the customer before they have to ask.
    - FastFix example: The screen part arrives a day late. Chidi messages the customer: "The part arrived a day late â€" I am sorry. Your phone will be ready by 5 p.m. tomorrow, not today. I will give you a 10% discount for the wait." The customer appreciates the honesty.

Real-life comparison. Think of a doctor's office. A good doctor's office calls you before the appointment, explains what will happen, tells you if the doctor is running late, and follows up after the visit. A bad office keeps you waiting and guessing. Patients stay with the first â€" and leave the second.

Misconception to correct. "The customer should understand my process." No â€" it is your job to communicate in a way the customer understands. If they are confused, the communication failed â€" not the customer.

F.3 Scope â€" what is included, what is excluded, and how to price a change

The idea. Scope is exactly what you will do for the customer â€" and what you will not do. Most "difficult client" stories are scope failures: the customer expected something that was never agreed, or the business owner did something that was never paid for.

The three parts of scope â€" teach them one by one:

1. **What is included:** The specific deliverables you have agreed to provide.
    - FastFix example: "Screen repair includes: replacement screen, labour, 30-day warranty, and return of the old screen."
2. **What is excluded:** The specific things you will not do â€" unless the customer pays extra.
    - FastFix example: "Excludes: water damage, motherboard issues, physical damage beyond the screen, and software problems."
3. **How to price a change:** When the customer asks for something outside the scope, you have a clear answer â€" you quote for the change.
    - FastFix example: The customer says "while you are at it, can you fix my speaker?" Chidi replies: "The speaker is not included in the screen repair â€" I can fix it for an additional â‚¦1,500, and it will add one more day. Would you like me to include it?"

The scope creep trap â€" and how to avoid it:

- **Scope creep** is when the customer gradually asks for more and more â€" and you do more and more â€" without a clear price.
- The trap: you want to be helpful, so you say "okay" to small extras â€" and they add up to a big loss.
- The fix: every time the customer asks for something extra, you say: "That is not included in the original agreement â€" I can do it for an additional â‚¦X. Would you like me to include it?"
- This is not rude â€" it is professional. The customer knows exactly what they are paying for.

Real-life comparison. Think of a building contract. A builder who says "I will build your fence for â‚¦50,000" and then adds "and I will also paint it, and add a gate, and extend it by two metres" â€" all for free â€" that builder will go broke. A builder who says "painting is â‚¦5,000 extra, the gate is â‚¦10,000 extra, and the extension is â‚¦15,000 extra" â€" that builder stays in business.

Misconception to correct. "Saying no to extra work loses customers." No â€" it protects your relationship. A customer who respects your boundaries will stay; a customer who does not will leave â€" and you are better off without them.

F.4 Setting expectations â€" price, timeline, updates, and what you need

The idea. Most customer anger comes from unmet expectations â€" not from bad work. If the customer expects the job tomorrow and you deliver it next week, they are angry â€" even if the work is excellent. Setting expectations prevents this.

The four expectations â€" teach them one by one:

1. **Price:** The exact price â€" in writing â€" before the work starts.
   - FastFix example: "The screen repair is â‚¦6,500 â€" 50% before I order the part, 50% on collection."
2. **Timeline:** The exact delivery date â€" and what happens if there is a delay.
   - FastFix example: "Your phone will be ready by 5 p.m. on Friday. If the part arrives late, I will tell you immediately and give you a new date."
3. **Update points:** When and how you will update the customer during the work.
   - FastFix example: "I will message you when the part arrives, when I start the repair, and when it is ready for collection."
4. **What you need from the customer:** The information, access, or materials you need from them â€" and by when.
   - FastFix example: "I need your phone by 10 a.m. on Friday, and I need you to back up your data before handing it over."

Real-life comparison. Think of a restaurant. A good restaurant tells you: "Your food will be ready in 15 minutes. We will bring it to your table. If it takes longer, we will tell you." A bad restaurant makes you wait 40 minutes with no explanation. You are happier with the first â€" even if the food is the same.

Misconception to correct. "The customer should know what to expect." No â€" it is your job to tell them. If they are surprised, you did not set expectations.

F.5 The one-page client agreement â€" your protection and their clarity

The idea. A **one-page client agreement** is a simple written document that both you and the customer sign. It is not a legal contract (that comes later) â€" but it is a clear record of what you agreed. It protects both sides.

The seven parts of a one-page agreement â€" teach them one by one:

1. **Parties:** Who is involved â€" your name and the customer's name.
   - FastFix example: "This agreement is between FastFix Phone Repair (Chidi Okonkwo) and Mr. Emeka Obi."
2. **Scope:** What you will do â€" the specific deliverables.
   - FastFix example: "FastFix will replace the screen of an iPhone 11 with a quality screen, including labour and a 30-day warranty."
3. **Price:** The exact price in naira.
   - FastFix example: "The total price is â‚¦6,500."
4. **Timeline:** The delivery date.
   - FastFix example: "The repair will be completed by 5 p.m. on Friday, 17 October 2026."
5. **Payment schedule:** How and when the customer pays.
   - FastFix example: "Payment: 50% (â‚¦3,250) before the repair, 50% (â‚¦3,250) on collection."
6. **Cancellation:** What happens if either side cancels.
   - FastFix example: "If the customer cancels after the part is ordered, the 50% deposit is not refundable. If FastFix cancels, the deposit is fully refunded."
7. **Signatures:** Both parties sign and date.
   - FastFix example: "Chidi Okonkwo (FastFix) â€" Signature: _____ Date: _____. Mr. Emeka Obi (Customer) â€" Signature: _____ Date: _____."

Why this matters:

- **For you:** It prevents disputes â€" the customer cannot say "I thought it was cheaper" or "I did not know when it would be ready."
- **For the customer:** It gives them confidence â€" they know exactly what they are getting and what they are paying.
- **For both:** It is professional â€" it shows you are a real business.

Real-life comparison. Think of a hire purchase agreement. A person buying a fridge on hire purchase signs an agreement that says: the price, the monthly payments, the timeline, and what happens if they miss a payment. Both sides know the rules. A one-page agreement is the small version of that.

Misconception to correct. "A signed agreement is only for big contracts." No â€” it is for any job where money and time are involved. A â¦5,000 job deserves a one-page agreement as much as a â¦500,000 job.

F.6 Difficult clients â€” five situations and how to handle them

The idea. Difficult clients are not rare â€” they are a normal part of business. The good news: most difficult situations can be managed with a clear, professional response. The even better news: some clients should be walked away from â€” professionally.

The five situations â€” teach each with a response:

Situation 1 â€” Scope creep: The customer keeps asking for extras without paying.

- **Response:** "I am happy to help with that â€” it is not included in our agreement, so it will be an additional â¦X. Would you like me to include it?"
- **Why it works:** You are not refusing â€” you are quoting. The customer decides.

Situation 2 â€” Unrealistic deadline: The customer wants it done in an impossible time.

- **Response:** "I understand you need it urgently. I can do it by [realistic date] â€ or I can do a basic version by [earlier date] if that helps. Which would you prefer?"
- **Why it works:** You are offering options â€ not just saying no.

Situation 3 â€” Late payment: The customer does not pay on the agreed date.

- **Response:** Use the payment-chasing sequence (Session 7): friendly reminder on the due date â†' follow-up call â†' firm written message with the invoice attached â†' documented escalation.
- **Why it works:** You are polite but firm â€ you give the customer a chance to pay, but you do not let it slide.

Situation 4 â€” Complaint: The customer is unhappy with the work.

- **Response:** "I am sorry you are not happy. Tell me exactly what is wrong â€ I will put it right." Then listen, apologise, and fix it.
- **Why it works:** You take responsibility and fix the problem â€ you do not argue.

Situation 5 â€” Free work for "exposure": The customer asks you to work for free "for the exposure".

- **Response:** "Thank you for thinking of me. I do not work for free â€ but I can offer you a 10% discount if you pay now, and I will share the work on my page with a link to yours."
- **Why it works:** You are not rude â€ you are professional. You offer a paid alternative, not a free one.

When to walk away professionally:

- The customer is abusive, disrespectful, or threatening.
- The customer refuses to pay after multiple reminders.
- The customer demands work far outside the scope â€ and refuses to pay for it.
- **How to walk away:** "I am sorry we cannot work together on this. I will complete the work we agreed and deliver it â€ but I will not be able to continue with additional requests. I wish you well."
- **Why it works:** You are firm, professional, and you do not burn the bridge.

Real-life comparison. Think of a doctor. A doctor cannot refuse emergency care â€ but a doctor can refuse a patient who is abusive or refuses to pay. Walking away is not failure â€ it is professional boundaries.

Misconception to correct. "The customer is always right." No â€ the customer is always the customer, but they are not always right. A business owner has the right to set boundaries, charge for work, and walk away from abuse.

F.7 Summary of the session

- **Keeping a customer is cheaper than finding one** â€ and a happy customer is your best marketing.
- Four **communication standards**: reply fast, confirm in writing, use plain language, never leave a customer guessing.
- **Scope** is what is included, what is excluded, and how to price a change â€ most difficult clients are scope failures.
- **Setting expectations**: price, timeline, update points, and what you need from the customer.
- A **one-page agreement** has seven parts: parties, scope, price, timeline, payment schedule, cancellation, signatures.

- Five **difficult-client situations**: scope creep, unrealistic deadline, late payment, complaint, free-work-for-exposure â€” each has a clear professional response.
- **Walk away professionally** when the customer is abusive, refuses to pay, or demands free work.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Enquiry] --> B[Quote]
    B --> C[Agreement]
    C --> D[Do the work]
    D --> E[Invoice]
    E --> F[Get paid]
    F --> G[Follow up]
    G --> B
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Show the class how to set scope, write a one-page agreement, and handle a difficult client â€” live â€” so they can do it themselves.

Setup: Open a blank Google Doc titled "One-Page Agreement â€” FastFix". Have the scope template and difficult-client scenarios on the projector. Invite a volunteer to play a difficult customer.

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A blank agreement template on the projector.
- The scope template on the projector.
- A volunteer briefed to play a difficult customer (scope creep).

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€” set the scope (3 minutes)

Say: "Before we write the agreement, we set the scope â€” what is included and what is not."

Fill in the scope template on the projector:

FastFix Screen Repair â€” Scope

Included	Excluded	How to price a change
Replacement screen	Water damage	Speaker repair: +â,¦1,500
Labour (1 hour)	Motherboard issues	Data recovery: +â,¦2,000
30-day warranty	Physical damage beyond screen	Software update: +â,¦1,000
Return of old screen	Software problems	â€”

Say: "This is the scope. When the customer asks for something extra, I look at this table â€” and I know exactly what to say."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€” write the one-page agreement (5 minutes)

Say: "Now the agreement. Seven parts â€” parties, scope, price, timeline, payment schedule, cancellation, signatures."

Fill in the agreement template on the projector:

> ***One-Page Client Agreement***
>
> ***Parties:*** *This agreement is between FastFix Phone Repair (Chidi Okonkwo) and Mr. Emeka Obi.*
>
> ***Scope:*** *FastFix will replace the screen of an iPhone 11 with a quality screen, including labour and a 30-day warranty. Excludes: water damage, motherboard issues, physical damage beyond the screen.*
>
> ***Price:*** *The total price is â,¦6,500.*
>
> ***Timeline:*** *The repair will be completed by 5 p.m. on Friday, 17 October 2026.*

Payment schedule: *50% (â,¦3,250) before the repair, 50% (â,¦3,250) on collection.*

Cancellation: *If the customer cancels after the part is ordered, the 50% deposit is not refundable. If FastFix cancels, the deposit is fully refunded.*

Signatures: *Chidi Okonkwo (FastFix) â€" _____ Date: _____. Mr. Emeka Obi (Customer) â€" _____ Date: _____.*

Say: "Seven parts. One page. Clear. Professional. This agreement prevents disputes â€" and it makes both sides feel safe."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" handle a difficult client (5 minutes)

Say: "Now a difficult customer. My volunteer will ask for something outside the scope â€" watch how I respond."

Volunteer (customer): "While you are fixing my screen, can you also fix my speaker? It has been sounding funny."

Instructor: "I can help with the speaker â€" it is not included in the screen repair, so it will be an additional â,¦1,500. It will also add one more day to the repair. Would you like me to include it?"

Volunteer: "Oh, I thought it would be included. Never mind, just fix the screen."

Instructor: "Of course â€" just the screen, â,¦6,500, ready Friday. I will confirm everything in a message after this call."

Say to the class: "I did not refuse â€" I quoted. The customer decided. That is how you handle scope creep: quote, don't refuse â€" and don't do it for free."

G.5 Questions to ask during the demo

- "What are the seven parts of the agreement?" (Parties, scope, price, timeline, payment schedule, cancellation, signatures.)
- "What did I say when the customer asked for the speaker?" (I quoted an additional â,¦1,500 â€" I did not refuse and I did not do it for free.)
- "Why confirm the agreement in a message after the call?" (Verbal agreements are forgotten â€" written agreements prevent disputes.)
- "When should you walk away from a client?" (When they are abusive, refuse to pay, or demand free work â€" walk away professionally.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner writes a scope, sets expectations, and drafts a one-page agreement for their own business.

Starting materials: A pen and notebook or phone notes app; the scope template and agreement template (projected and printed).

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name and today's date at the top of your workbook or notes app.
2. **Choose a job:** Pick one job from your business idea (or use FastFix's screen repair).
3. **Set the scope:** Fill in the scope template (Worksheet 6.2) â€" included, excluded, how to price a change.
4. **Pause and predict:** Ask yourself: "If a customer asked for something extra, would I know what to say?"
5. **Set expectations:** Fill in the expectations template (Worksheet 6.3) â€" price, timeline, update points, what you need from the customer.
6. **Write the one-page agreement:** Fill in the agreement template (Worksheet 6.4) â€" all seven parts.
7. **Share:** Show your agreement to your partner. Ask: "Is this clear? Would you know exactly what you are getting and what you are paying?"
8. **Revise:** Based on your partner's feedback, revise your agreement if needed.
9. **Practise a difficult-client response:** Your partner reads you one of the five difficult-client situations (from a scenario card). You respond out loud. Your partner gives feedback.

Expected result: A scope, a set of expectations, a one-page agreement, and a practised difficult-client response.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 4: "Would you know what to say if a customer asked for something extra?"

- After step 7: "Would a stranger understand this agreement without you explaining?"
- After step 9: "Did your response acknowledge the concern and offer a solution?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner's scope is vague â†' Ask: "What exactly is included? What exactly is not?"
- Learner's agreement is missing parts â†' Check against the seven parts.
- Learner's difficult-client response is rude â†' Remind them: "Acknowledge the concern, offer a solution â€" do not argue."
- Learner's difficult-client response is too soft â†' Remind them: "Quote for extras â€" do not do them for free."

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Scope set â€" included, excluded, how to price a change
- ☐ Expectations set â€" price, timeline, updates, what you need
- ☐ One-page agreement written â€" all seven parts
- ☐ Agreement shared with a partner and revised
- ☐ Difficult-client response practised

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Write responses to **three difficult-client scenarios** and explain when you would walk away.

Scenario. You run a small business. Below are three situations that happen in the first month. For each, write your response â€" and explain your reasoning.

Situation 1 â€" Scope creep: A customer asks you to fix their phone screen and "while you are at it, clean the inside of the phone and update the software." Your agreement only covers the screen repair.

Situation 2 â€" Unrealistic deadline: A customer needs a dress for a wedding on Saturday. Today is Thursday. Your normal timeline is 7 days. The customer says "I will pay extra if you can do it by Saturday."

Situation 3 â€" Free work for "exposure": A customer asks you to design a flyer for their event "for free â€" it will be good exposure for you, and I will tell all my friends."

Requirements:

1. For each situation, write your response â€" what you would say to the customer.
2. For each situation, explain your reasoning in 2â€"3 sentences.
3. For one situation, explain when you would walk away â€" and how you would do it professionally.

Constraints:

- Responses must be polite and professional â€" not rude, not aggressive.
- Responses must protect your business â€" not give away work for free.
- Do not copy the examples from the lecture â€" write your own responses.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- All three responses are polite and professional.
- All three responses protect the business.
- Reasoning is clear and specific.
- One walk-away scenario is explained.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For scope creep â€" quote for the extras, don't refuse and don't do them for free.
- Hint 2: For unrealistic deadlines â€" offer options, not just yes or no.
- Hint 3: For free work â€" offer a paid alternative, not a flat refusal.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Situation 1 â€" Scope creep: Response: "I am happy to clean the inside and update the software â€" but those are not included in the screen repair. Cleaning is â‚¦1,000 and a software update is â‚¦1,000. Would you like me to include them? If so, I will update

the agreement and the total will be â‚¦8,500." Reasoning: I quoted for the extras instead of refusing or doing them for free. This protects my income and keeps the customer informed. The customer can decide â€" and I respect their choice either way.

Situation 2 â€" Unrealistic deadline: Response: "I understand the wedding is on Saturday â€" I wish I could do the full dress in two days, but I cannot do it well in that time. I can do a simple, ready-to-wear dress by Saturday for â‚¦8,000 â€" or I can do a full custom dress by next Friday for â‚¦12,000. Which would you prefer?" Reasoning: I offered two options â€" a faster, simpler dress at a lower price, or the full dress at the normal timeline. This is honest â€" I did not promise something I cannot deliver â€" and it gives the customer a choice.

Situation 3 â€" Free work for "exposure": Response: "Thank you for thinking of me â€" I appreciate it. I do not work for free, but I can offer you a 20% discount if you pay now. And I will share the flyer on my page with a link to your event â€" so you still get visibility." Reasoning: I did not refuse rudely â€" I offered a paid alternative (a discount) and a genuine benefit (sharing on my page). This keeps the relationship positive while protecting my income.

Walk-away scenario: I would walk away if a customer became abusive or threatening â€" for example, if they insulted me or threatened me because of a delay. I would say: "I am sorry we cannot work together on this. I will complete the work we agreed and deliver it â€" but I will not be able to continue with additional requests. I wish you well." Then I would complete the agreed work, deliver it, and not take any more jobs from that customer.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Situation 1 response â€" polite, professional, protects business (3)
- Situation 2 response â€" polite, professional, offers options (3)
- Situation 3 response â€" polite, professional, offers paid alternative (3)
- Walk-away scenario explained (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Uche* is a freelance writer in Port Harcourt. He writes CVs, cover letters and business proposals for clients. He has been doing this for six months. He has a problem: a client, "Mr. O," hired him to write a business proposal for â‚¦15,000. Uche wrote the proposal and delivered it. Mr. O said "it is good, but can you also write a one-page summary and a PowerPoint presentation?" Uche said "okay" â€" and did both, assuming they were included. Mr. O then said "and can you present it to my partner on Monday?" Uche said "okay" again. After all this, Mr. O paid only â‚¦15,000 â€" and said "the extras were just small things." Uche is frustrated and feels used.

Relevant facts.

- Uche's agreement was for "one business proposal" â€" â‚¦15,000.
- The summary, PowerPoint, and presentation were never discussed in terms of price or scope.
- Uche did not confirm the agreement in writing â€" it was a WhatsApp conversation.
- Uche did not quote for the extras â€" he assumed they were included.

Decision point. What is Uche's real problem?

Possible approaches.

1. Accept it â€" "I will be more careful next time."
2. Confront Mr. O â€" "You owe me more money."
3. Learn from it: set scope, confirm in writing, quote for extras â€" and if Mr. O refuses to pay for the extras, walk away professionally.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Uche's problem is not Mr. O â€" it is that Uche did not set scope, confirm in writing, or quote for extras. He assumed â€" and assumptions are expensive. The lesson is not to confront Mr. O (though he could ask for a fair price for the extras) â€" the lesson is to never let it happen again.

Reasoning / example actions for Uche:

- **Set scope:** "The proposal includes: one written business proposal, up to 2 revisions. Any additional work â€" summary, presentation, etc. â€" is quoted separately."
- **Confirm in writing:** Send a WhatsApp message after every agreement: "Confirming: one business proposal, â‚¦15,000, delivered by Friday. Payment: 50% now, 50% on delivery."

- **Quote for extras:** When the customer asks for something extra, reply: "That is not included in our agreement â€" I can do it for an additional â‚¦X. Would you like me to include it?"
- **Walk away if needed:** If the customer refuses to pay for extras or becomes abusive, say: "I am sorry we cannot work together on this. I will complete the work we agreed and deliver it â€" but I will not be able to continue with additional requests."

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (accept it) loses money and learns nothing â€" the same thing will happen again.
- Approach 2 (confront) may get the money â€" but it is stressful, and the relationship is damaged.
- Approach 3 (learn from it) does not recover this money â€" but it prevents the next loss, which is worth more.

Professional connection. The difference between a hobbyist and a professional is not talent â€" it is **systems**. A professional writer has a scope, a written agreement, and a process for extras. A hobbyist assumes â€" and assumes are expensive. Uche has the skill; he just needs the system.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 No scope â€" "I will just do it"

Symptoms: The customer asks for extras; the learner does them for free; the learner loses money. **Likely cause:** There is no defined scope â€" so everything feels included. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What exactly did you agree to do? What is included and what is not?" **Corrective steps:** Set the scope before the work starts â€" included, excluded, how to price a change. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can state the scope clearly. **Prevention:** Never start work without a clear scope.

K.2 No written agreement

Symptoms: The customer says "I thought it was cheaper" or "I did not know when it would be ready." **Likely cause:** The agreement was verbal â€" and verbal agreements are forgotten. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Did you confirm the agreement in writing? Can you show me?" **Corrective steps:** Confirm every agreement in writing â€" a WhatsApp message, an email, or a note. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner has a written agreement for every job. **Prevention:** Verbal agreements are not agreements â€" write them down.

K.3 Doing extras for free

Symptoms: The customer asks for "one small thing"; the learner does it; the learner is not paid. **Likely cause:** The learner wants to be helpful â€" and does not know how to quote for extras. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What did the customer ask for? What did you say? What did you charge?" **Corrective steps:** Quote for every extra â€" "That is not included â€" it will be â‚¦X." **How to confirm resolved:** The learner quotes for extras instead of doing them for free. **Prevention:** Every extra has a price â€" always.

K.4 Not setting expectations

Symptoms: The customer is angry about the timeline â€" even though the work is good. **Likely cause:** The timeline was never clearly agreed â€" the customer assumed it would be faster. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What did you tell the customer about the timeline? When did you say it would be ready?" **Corrective steps:** Set the timeline in writing â€" and update the customer if there is a delay. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can state the agreed timeline and update process. **Prevention:** Set expectations before the work starts â€" and update if anything changes.

K.5 Arguing with a complaint

Symptoms: The customer complains; the learner argues; the relationship breaks. **Likely cause:** The learner takes the complaint personally. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What was the complaint? What did you say?" **Corrective steps:** Listen, apologise, and fix the problem â€" do not argue. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner responds to complaints with listening and fixing. **Prevention:** A complaint is an opportunity to improve â€" not a personal attack.

K.6 Never walking away

Symptoms: The learner keeps working with abusive or non-paying clients â€" and feels trapped. **Likely cause:** The learner thinks they need every customer â€" even bad ones. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How does this client make you feel? Do they pay on

time? Do they respect you?" **Corrective steps:** Set boundaries â€" and walk away professionally from clients who cross them. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can name when they would walk away and how. **Prevention:** Not every customer is a good customer â€" walking away is a professional skill.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it with the learner â€" ask them the investigation question and listen to the answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Scope and Agreement â€" One-Page Agreement and Difficult-Client Responses"

Purpose: To practise setting scope, writing a one-page agreement, and handling difficult clients â€" the skills that protect your income and your peace of mind â€" and to build the agreement that will be a supporting document in the capstone pack.

Realistic scenario. You have a business, customers, and a price. This week, you will write a one-page agreement for a real or fictional job, and you will write responses to three difficult-client situations.

Detailed instructions:

1. **Choose a job:** Pick one job from your business idea (or use FastFix's screen repair).
2. **Set the scope:** Write what is included, what is excluded, and how to price a change. (Worksheet 6.2.)
3. **Write the one-page agreement:** Fill in all seven parts â€" parties, scope, price, timeline, payment schedule, cancellation, signatures. (Worksheet 6.4.)
4. **Three difficult-client responses:** Write your response to three situations: (a) scope creep, (b) a customer who refuses to pay on time, (c) a customer who asks for free work "for exposure". (Worksheet 6.5.)
5. **Walk-away scenario:** Write one paragraph: "I would walk away from a client if _____. I would do it by saying _____."
6. **Reflection:** Write 3â€"5 sentences: "What I learned about managing clients this week is _____. What I will do differently is _____."

Required deliverables:

- A scope statement.
- A one-page agreement.
- Three difficult-client responses.
- A walk-away scenario.
- A short reflection.

Submission format: Save as a Google Doc (or a clear photo of handwritten work) and upload to your Drive folder `CEA-Biz-YourName`, or show it to the instructor at the start of Session 7. You may also copy the text into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 7.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Scope statement	4	Included, excluded, how to price a change â€" all clear
One-page agreement	6	All seven parts, specific, realistic
Three difficult-client responses	6	Polite, professional, protect the business
Walk-away scenario	2	Clear, professional
Reflection	2	Honest and specific

Common mistakes to avoid: no scope; no written agreement; doing extras for free; not setting expectations; arguing with complaints; never walking away.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Scope (model â€" for a fictional "Tobi's Phone Photography for Food Sellers"):

- Included: 10 professional food photos, edited and delivered by WhatsApp within 2 days, one round of revisions.

- Excluded: Video shoots, social media management, same-day delivery.
- How to price a change: Video shoot +â,¦5,000; social media management +â,¦10,000/month; same-day delivery +â,¦2,000.

One-page agreement (model):

> ***One-Page Client Agreement***
>
> ***Parties:*** *This agreement is between Tobi's Phone Photography (Tobi) and Mama Chika's Kitchen.*
>
> ***Scope:*** *Tobi will take 10 professional food photos, edit them, and deliver them by WhatsApp within 2 days. Includes one round of revisions. Excludes: video shoots, social media management, same-day delivery.*
>
> ***Price:*** *The total price is â,¦3,000.*
>
> ***Timeline:*** *The photos will be delivered within 2 days of the photo session.*
>
> ***Payment schedule:*** *100% (â,¦3,000) on delivery.*
>
> ***Cancellation:*** *If the customer cancels after the photo session, the full price is payable. If Tobi cancels, the session is rescheduled free.*
>
> ***Signatures:*** *Tobi â€" _____ Date: _____. Mama Chika â€" _____ Date: _____.*

Three difficult-client responses (model): (a) Scope creep: "I can also shoot a short video â€" it is not included in the photo package, so it will be an additional â,¦5,000. Would you like me to include it?" (b) Late payment: "I hope you are well. I wanted to check on the payment of â,¦3,000 for the photos, which was due yesterday. Could you send it today or tomorrow? If there is a problem, please let me know." (c) Free work for exposure: "Thank you for thinking of me â€" I appreciate it. I do not work for free, but I can offer you a 20% discount if you pay now. And I will share the photos on my page with a link to your business."

Walk-away scenario (model): "I would walk away from a client if they became abusive or threatening â€" for example, if they insulted me because of a delay. I would say: 'I am sorry we cannot work together on this. I will complete the work we agreed and deliver it â€" but I will not be able to continue with additional requests. I wish you well.' Then I would complete the agreed work, deliver it, and not take any more jobs from that client."

Reflection (model): "What I learned about managing clients this week is that being nice is not the same as being professional â€" I can be kind and still quote for extras. What I will do differently is to always set scope and confirm in writing before I start work."

A strong learner solution differs in content but ticks every rubric row.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What are the four communication standards?

Q2. Multiple choice. A customer asks you to do something outside the agreed scope. What is the best response? a) "Okay, I will do it for free." b) "That is not included â€" I can do it for an additional â,¦X. Would you like me to include it?" c) "No, I cannot help you." d) "I will do it, but I will not tell you the price."

Q3. Matching. Match each part of the agreement to what it is: (1) parties, (2) scope, (3) price, (4) timeline. a) "The repair will be completed by 5 p.m. on Friday" b) "This agreement is between FastFix and Mr. Obi" c) "The total price is â,¦6,500" d) "FastFix will replace the screen with a quality screen"

Q4. True or false. "A verbal agreement is enough â€" you do not need to write it down."

Q5. Explain. What are the seven parts of a one-page client agreement?

Q6. Practical. A customer complains that your work is not good. What are the first two things you should do?

Q7. Scenario. A customer has not paid you 14 days after the agreed date. You have sent two messages with no response. What do you do?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q7)

A1. The four communication standards: reply fast, confirm in writing, use plain language, never leave a customer guessing.

A2. (b) "That is not included â€" I can do it for an additional â,¦X. Would you like me to include it?" â€" you quote for extras, you don't refuse and you don't do them for free.

A3. (1) = b, (2) = d, (3) = c, (4) = a.

A4. False. A verbal agreement is not enough â€" it is forgotten or misunderstood. Always confirm in writing.

A5. The seven parts: parties, scope, price, timeline, payment schedule, cancellation, signatures.

A6. First: listen â€" "Tell me exactly what is wrong." Second: apologise and fix it â€" "I am sorry â€" I will put it right." Do not argue.

A7. Escalate: send a firm written message with the invoice attached, stating a final deadline and the consequences of non-payment (e.g., "If I do not receive payment by [date], I will have to stop any further work and may need to take further steps"). If there is still no response, consider walking away professionally â€" complete any work already paid for, and do not start new work for that customer.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that keeping a customer is cheaper than finding one â€" and a happy customer is your best marketing. You learned the four communication standards: reply fast, confirm in writing, use plain language, never leave a customer guessing. You learned that scope is what is included, what is excluded, and how to price a change â€" and that most difficult clients are scope failures. You learned to set expectations: price, timeline, update points, and what you need from the customer. You learned to write a one-page agreement with seven parts: parties, scope, price, timeline, payment schedule, cancellation, signatures. And you learned to handle five difficult-client situations â€" scope creep, unrealistic deadline, late payment, complaint, and free-work-for-exposure â€" and when to walk away professionally.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Keeping a customer is cheaper than finding one.**
2. Four **communication standards** â€" reply fast, confirm in writing, use plain language, never guess.
3. **Scope** prevents most disputes â€" included, excluded, priced changes.
4. A **one-page agreement** protects both sides.
5. **Difficult clients** can be managed â€" or walked away from â€" professionally.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I name the four communication standards?
- Can I define scope â€" included, excluded, priced changes?
- Can I write a one-page agreement with all seven parts?
- Can I respond to a difficult client professionally?
- Can I explain when to walk away?

Connection to the next session. You can find customers, sell to them, and manage them. But how do you get paid properly? How do you invoice, track money, chase late payments, and handle taxes? Next session we learn invoicing, getting paid and basic accounting â€" the skills that turn your work into money in the bank.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner names the four communication standards and applies them.
- Learner sets a clear scope â€" included, excluded, priced changes.
- Learner writes a one-page agreement with all seven parts.
- Learner responds to difficult clients professionally â€" quoting for extras, offering options, not arguing.
- Learner can explain when and how to walk away.
- Learner confirms agreements in writing.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "The customer is always right." â†' The customer is always the customer, but not always right â€" set boundaries.
- "A verbal agreement is enough." â†' Verbal agreements are forgotten â€" write them down.
- "I should do extras to be nice." â†' Quote for extras â€" doing them for free loses money.
- "I should never walk away." â†' Walking away from abusive or non-paying clients is professional.
- "A complaint is a personal attack." â†' A complaint is an opportunity to improve â€" listen and fix.
- "The agreement is only for big jobs." â†' Any job with money and time deserves a one-page agreement.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Scope writing practice:** give a job and ask the learner to write the scope â€" included, excluded, priced changes â€" then check for clarity.
2. **Agreement completion:** give a partially completed agreement and ask the learner to fill in the missing parts.
3. **Difficult-client role-play:** give a scenario and ask the learner to respond â€" check for professionalism and business protection.
4. **Communication standards check:** give a customer message and ask the learner to check it against the four standards.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed agreement template (parties and scope already filled); learner adds the rest. Provide a list of difficult-client responses to choose from.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" full scope, agreement, difficult-client responses.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to write a **cancellation policy** for their business â€" what happens if the customer cancels at different stages (before work starts, during work, after completion) â€" and explain why each stage has a different rule.

Capstone links. This session's one-page agreement becomes a supporting document in the capstone pack. The difficult-client responses are practised in the Session 7 simulation. The scope and agreement skills are used in the Session 9 viva â€" the learner will be asked to explain how they would manage a difficult client. The communication standards are used throughout the course â€" and throughout the learner's business life.

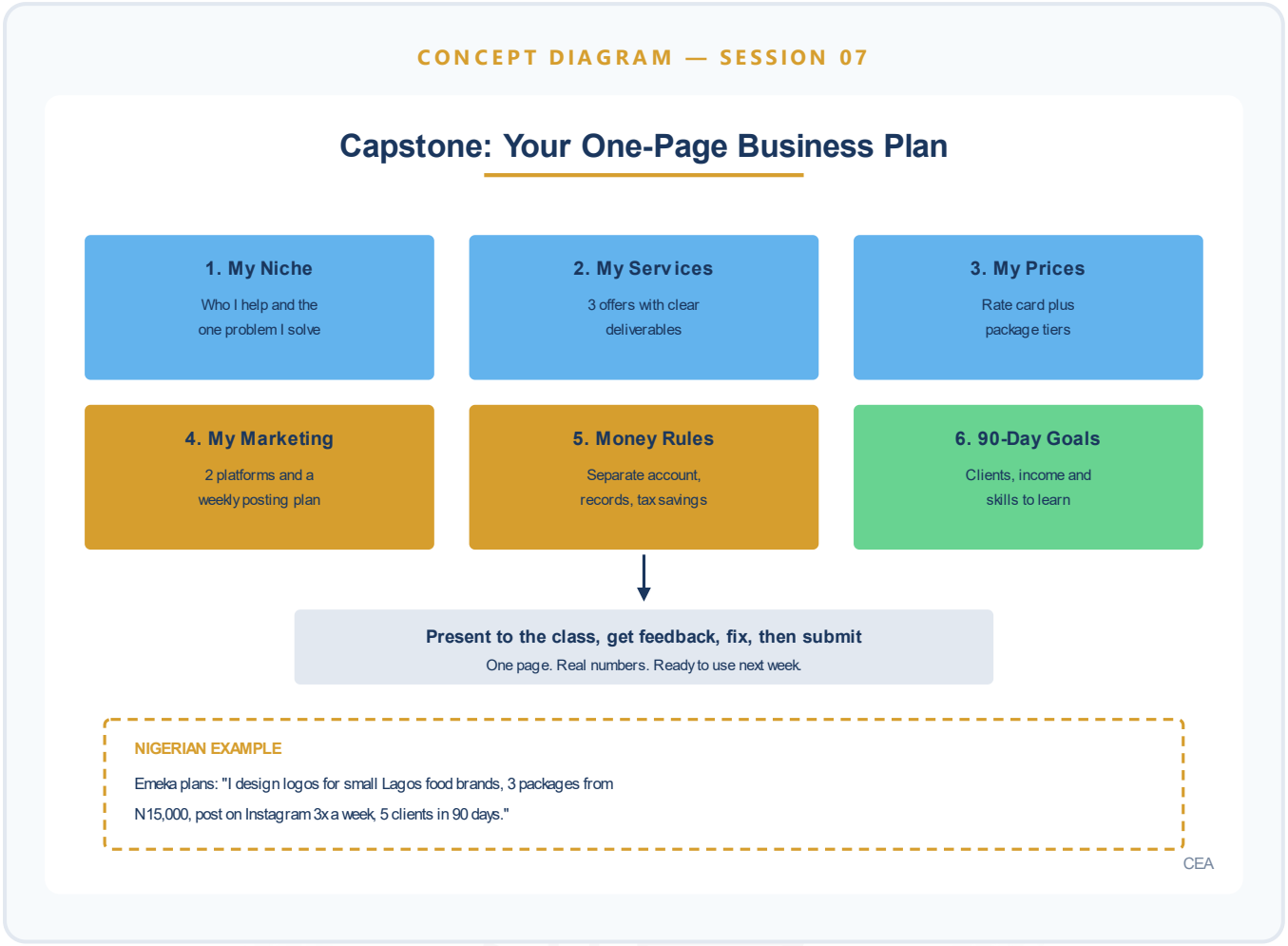
Timing guidance. The priority is learners writing a scope and a one-page agreement, and practising a difficult-client response (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten Section F.6 (difficult clients) to three situations (scope creep, late payment, complaint), and limit the independent exercise to two responses instead of three. Protect the agreement-writing time â€" a learner who leaves without a written agreement has no protection.

END OF SESSION 6

Next: Session 7 â€" Invoicing, Getting Paid and Basic Accounting.

SESSION 07 OF 9

Invoicing Getting Paid and Basic Accounting



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" BUSINESS & FREELANCING

SESSION 7 â€" INVOICING, GETTING PAID AND BASIC ACCOUNTING

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	7 of 9
Session title	Invoicing, Getting Paid and Basic Accounting
Week / Module	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Run and Grow
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with invoicing and accounting)
Prerequisite knowledge	The Session 6 one-page agreement and scope. Learners must be able to do basic arithmetic. No prior accounting knowledge required.

Item	Detail
Connection to previous work	In Session 6 you learned to manage clients and write agreements. Today we handle the money: quotes vs invoices vs receipts, what a complete invoice contains, how to track income and expenses in Google Sheets, how to chase late payments politely, and how to handle taxes in plain terms. Getting paid is the whole point of business.
Preparation before class	Print the invoice template (Section F.2); print the payment-chasing sequence (Section F.5); print the income/expense tracker template (Section F.3); have the FastFix case pack ready; prepare a sample Google Sheets tracker on the projector; bring a sample invoice from a real-shaped job. Print the **SIMULATION â€" THE FIRST CLIENT** enquiry script (Section J) and set a 15-minute timer â€" today's simulation is **15% of the course**.

Instructor note on tone: Many learners feel shy about chasing money â€" they think it is rude or desperate. Reframe it: chasing payment is professional. You did the work, you agreed a price, and you deserve to be paid. A polite chase is not rude â€" it is how a real business operates. Keep the mood practical and confidence-building.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Distinguish** between a quote, an invoice and a receipt â€" and explain when each is used.
2. **Produce** a complete invoice: business name, date, invoice number, customer, description, quantity, unit price, total, payment details and terms.
3. **Set up** an income and expense tracker in Google Sheets and record transactions correctly.
4. **Follow** a polite payment-chasing sequence: friendly reminder on due date, follow-up call, firm written message with the invoice attached, documented escalation.
5. **Explain** in simple terms the taxes a small Nigerian business must consider (income tax, withholding tax, VAT awareness) and why to check current rules on official FIRS/state sources.
6. **Develop** the habit of setting aside a fixed percentage of every payment for tax.
7. **Raise** a complete invoice and start a working tracker (LO9).

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with a calculator and Google Sheets) or an academy computer with Google Sheets.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.
- Notebook and pen (optional).

Software

- **Google Sheets** (free, via Gmail) â€" the main tool for this session.
- A simple text app: phone Notes, Google Docs or Microsoft Word.
- The **invoice template**, **tracker template**, and **payment-chasing sequence** (Sections F.2, F.3, F.5) projected and printed.

Sample files

- Printed **invoice template** (Section F.2).
- Printed **income/expense tracker template** (Section F.3).
- Printed **payment-chasing sequence** (Section F.5).
- A **sample completed invoice** (instructor's own example â€" e.g., for FastFix) for the demonstration.
- The **FastFix case pack** (from Sessions 1â€"6).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 7.1 â€" "Quote vs Invoice vs Receipt" (a comparison table).
- Worksheet 7.2 â€" "Complete the Invoice" (a blank invoice to fill in).

- Worksheet 7.3 â€" "Income and Expense Tracker" (a Google Sheets template to set up).
- Worksheet 7.4 â€" "Payment-Chasing Sequence" (a script for each step).
- Worksheet 7.5 â€" "Tax in Plain Terms" (a simple explanation and a set-aside calculation).

Accounts

- A **Gmail account** is required for Google Sheets. Confirm all learners have one.

Internet

- Useful but not required. If available, the instructor may show the FIRS website (firs.gov.ng) to demonstrate where to check current tax information. The session works fully offline with printed materials.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with Google Sheets (or a notes app) works. A learner who cannot use Google Sheets may use a paper tracker; the skill is the **understanding of income and expenses**, not the software.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two "payment stories" without labelling them.

- **Story A:** "Chidi from FastFix repaired a customer's phone. He did not give an invoice â€" he just told the customer the price. The customer paid cash. Two weeks later, the customer came back and said 'I already paid you' â€" but Chidi had no record. They argued. The customer was angry. Chidi lost the customer and his reputation."
- **Story B:** "Adaeze from Adaeze Fashion sewed a dress. She gave the customer an invoice â€" clear, with the price, the payment terms, and her bank details. The customer paid by transfer. Adaeze recorded the payment in her tracker. Two weeks later, the customer came back for another dress â€" and brought a friend. Adaeze has a record, the customer has a receipt, and both are happy."

What the instructor says:

> *"Two businesses. Hands up â€" which one got paid properly and kept the customer? â€¦ Story B, almost always. Why? Because Adaeze had a **system** â€" an invoice, a record, a receipt. Chidi had nothing â€" and when there is a dispute, nothing means no proof. Today we learn to be Adaeze. You will learn the difference between a quote, an invoice and a receipt, how to write a complete invoice, how to track your money, how to chase late payments politely, and how to handle taxes in plain terms. Getting paid is the whole point of business â€" today you learn to do it properly."*

Expected learner response: Learners will say "B had an invoice", "A had no proof", "B kept records", "A argued with the customer". Accept all answers and draw out the difference: **system vs no system**.

Then reveal the hook: Ask, "How many of you have ever done work and not been paid â€" or been paid late?" Many hands go up. Say:

> *"That is not a failure of kindness â€" that is a failure of paperwork. And paperwork is learnable. Today you learn it."*

Why this opener works: It uses a situation everyone recognises (payment disputes), it isolates documentation as the variable, and it frames invoicing and records as protection â€" not bureaucracy.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the seven parts of a one-page agreement?"

- Expected answer: Parties, scope, price, timeline, payment schedule, cancellation, signatures.
- Common gap: learners remember four or five. Clarify: "The agreement is what you agreed â€" the invoice is how you get paid."

Question 2: "What are the four communication standards?"

- Expected answer: Reply fast, confirm in writing, use plain language, never leave a customer guessing.
- Common gap: learners remember two or three. Clarify: "The communication standards apply to payment messages too â€" reply fast, confirm in writing."

Question 3: "What is scope creep, and how do you handle it?"

- Expected answer: When the customer asks for extras beyond the agreed scope. You quote for the extra â€" you do not do it for free.
- Common gap: learners remember "quote for extras" but not the term. Clarify: "Scope creep is the customer asking for more â€" your response is always: quote, don't refuse, don't do it for free."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You can manage clients and write agreements. Now you get paid. The agreement says what you will do and what you will charge â€" the invoice is how you ask for the money, and the receipt is how you prove you were paid. Today we learn all three â€" plus how to track your money, chase late payments, and handle taxes."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the seven parts of the agreement, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing them on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 The paperwork of getting paid â€" quote, invoice, receipt

The idea. Three documents matter in getting paid: a **quote** (before the job), an **invoice** (after or at a stage), and a **receipt** (proof of payment). Most beginners use one word for all three â€" and cause confusion. Learn the difference.

The three documents â€" teach them one by one:

1. **Quote (before the job):**
   - **What it is:** A written estimate of what the job will cost â€" given before you start work.
   - **When to use it:** When the customer asks "how much will this cost?" â€" you send a quote.
   - **What it contains:** Description, quantity, unit price, total, validity (e.g., 7 days), payment terms, exclusions.
   - **FastFix example:** Chidi sends a quote: "Screen repair for iPhone 11 â€" â‚¦6,500. Valid for 7 days. 50% before repair, 50% on collection."
   - **Say this:** "A quote is an offer â€" the customer can accept it, negotiate it, or walk away. It is not a demand for payment."
2. **Invoice (after or at a stage):**
   - **What it is:** A formal request for payment â€" given when the job is done (or at an agreed stage).
   - **When to use it:** When the job is complete â€" or when you need a stage payment (e.g., 50% before, 50% on delivery).
   - **What it contains:** Business name, date, invoice number, customer name, description, quantity, unit price, total, payment details (bank account), payment terms (due date), and a thank-you.
   - **FastFix example:** After the repair, Chidi sends an invoice: "Invoice 001 â€" Screen repair for iPhone 11 â€" â‚¦6,500. Payment due by 17 October. Bank: GTB 0123456789 â€" Chidi Okonkwo."
   - **Say this:** "An invoice is a request for payment â€" it is the most important document in getting paid. No invoice, no payment."
3. **Receipt (proof of payment):**
   - **What it is:** A document that proves the customer has paid.
   - **When to use it:** When the customer pays â€" you send a receipt.
   - **What it contains:** Business name, date, receipt number, customer, description, amount paid, payment method (cash, transfer, POS), and a thank-you.
   - **FastFix example:** After payment, Chidi sends a receipt: "Receipt 001 â€" Payment for Invoice 001 â€" â‚¦6,500 â€" received by transfer on 17 October. Thank you."

- **Say this:** "A receipt is proof â€” it protects both sides. If the customer later says 'I did not pay', you have proof. If you later say 'I did not receive payment', the customer has proof."

Real-life comparison. Think of a market trader. A trader who writes nothing â€” no price, no record, no receipt â€” is helpless when there is a dispute. A trader who writes the price, gives a receipt, and keeps a record â€” that trader is protected. The paperwork is not bureaucracy â€” it is protection.

Misconception to correct. "An invoice is the same as a quote." No â€” a quote is before the job (an offer), an invoice is after the job (a request for payment). Using them correctly prevents confusion and disputes.

F.2 What a complete invoice contains

The idea. An incomplete invoice causes late payment â€” the customer does not know how much to pay, how to pay, or when to pay. A complete invoice has ten parts.

The ten parts â€” teach them one by one:

1. **Business name and contact:** Your name, phone number, and (if you have it) your business name and address.
   - FastFix example: "FastFix Phone Repair â€” Mile 3 Market, Diobu, Port Harcourt â€” 0803-XXX-XXXX."
2. **Date:** The date the invoice is issued.
   - FastFix example: "Date: 10 October 2026."
3. **Invoice number:** A unique number for each invoice â€” so you can reference it.
   - FastFix example: "Invoice 001."
4. **Customer name:** Who the invoice is for.
   - FastFix example: "Customer: Mr. Emeka Obi."
5. **Description of the job:** What you did â€” in clear language.
   - FastFix example: "Screen repair for iPhone 11."
6. **Quantity and unit price:** How many, and the price per unit.
   - FastFix example: "Quantity: 1 â€” Unit price: â‚¦6,500."
7. **Total amount:** The full amount in naira.
   - FastFix example: "Total: â‚¦6,500."
8. **Payment details:** How the customer can pay â€” bank name, account number, account name.
   - FastFix example: "Bank: GTB â€” Account: 0123456789 â€” Name: Chidi Okonkwo."
9. **Payment terms:** When the payment is due.
   - FastFix example: "Payment due by: 17 October 2026."
10. **Thank-you and terms:** A polite note and any terms (e.g., late payment fee).
    - FastFix example: "Thank you for your business. Please pay by the due date. A 5% late fee applies after 7 days."

Say this: "Ten parts. If any part is missing, the invoice is incomplete â€” and an incomplete invoice is a late invoice. Write a complete invoice every time."

Real-life comparison. Think of a restaurant bill. A good bill has the restaurant name, the date, the items, the prices, the total, and how to pay. A bad bill says "â‚¦5,000" on a piece of paper â€” and you wonder what you are paying for. An invoice is the business version of the good bill.

Misconception to correct. "An invoice is just the amount." No â€” an invoice is the amount **plus the context** â€” what, how, when, where. The context is what makes payment easy.

F.3 The income and expense tracker â€” your money memory

The idea. The tracker is where you record every naira that comes in and every naira that goes out. It is your money memory â€” without it, you are guessing.

The simple tracker â€” teach the structure:

Date	Description	Type	Income (â‚¦)	Expense (â‚¦)	Balance (â‚¦)
10 Oct	Screen repair â€" Customer A	Income	6,500		16,500
10 Oct	New screen stock	Expense		3,500	13,000
11 Oct	Battery replacement â€" Customer B	Income	4,500		17,500
11 Oct	Transport	Expense		500	17,000
12 Oct	Charger sale â€" Customer C	Income	1,500		18,500
12 Oct	Data for WhatsApp	Expense		500	18,000

The rules of the tracker:

1. **Record every transaction** â€" even â‚¦500.
2. **Use the right column** â€" income in the income column, expense in the expense column.
3. **Calculate the balance** after each transaction.
4. **Review weekly** â€" add up income and expenses, calculate profit, decide one change.

The weekly review â€" five minutes:

- Total income this week: 6,500 + 4,500 + 1,500 = â‚¦12,500
- Total expenses this week: 3,500 + 500 + 500 = â‚¦4,500
- Profit this week: 12,500 â^' 4,500 = â‚¦8,000
- What sold well: Screen repairs (highest price).
- What cost too much: Screen stock (â‚¦3,500 â€" can I find a cheaper supplier?).
- What I will change: Order screen stock in bulk to reduce cost.

Real-life comparison. Think of a student tracking pocket money. If they write down every naira received and every naira spent, they know exactly how much they have â€" and they can plan. If they do not, they run out mid-week and wonder why. A business is the same â€" just with bigger numbers.

Misconception to correct. "I will remember what I earned." No â€" you will forget. Write it down. The tracker is your memory.

F.4 The polite payment-chasing sequence

The idea. Late payment is the most common cash-flow problem in small business. The fix is a polite, persistent sequence â€" not anger, not silence. Most late payments are not dishonesty â€" they are forgetfulness or cash-flow problems on the customer's side.

The four-step sequence â€" teach them one by step:

1. **Friendly reminder (on the due date):**
   - **When:** The day the payment is due.
   - **What to say:** "Hello [name], I hope you are well. I wanted to remind you that the payment of â‚¦6,500 for Invoice 001 is due today. Please let me know if you have any questions. Thank you."
   - **Why it works:** It is polite, it assumes the customer forgot, and it gives them an easy way to respond.
2. **Follow-up call (2â€"3 days after the due date):**
   - **When:** 2â€"3 days after the due date, if no payment.
   - **What to say:** "Hello [name], I sent a reminder about Invoice 001 â€" I wanted to check if you received it. Is everything okay with the payment?"
   - **Why it works:** A call is harder to ignore than a message â€" and it shows you are serious.
3. **Firm written message (7 days after the due date):**
   - **When:** 7 days after the due date, if still no payment.
   - **What to say:** "Hello [name], I am writing about Invoice 001 â€" â‚¦6,500, due on 17 October. I have not received payment. Please pay by 25 October. If I do not hear from you, I will have to [stop further work / take further steps]. I hope we can resolve this quickly. Thank you."
   - **Attach the invoice** to the message â€" so the customer has everything they need.

- **Why it works:** It is firm but professional â€" and it documents your effort.

4. **Documented escalation (14+ days after the due date):**
    - **When:** 14+ days after the due date, if still no payment.
    - **What to do:** Send a final message with a clear deadline and consequence. If the amount is large, consider a formal demand letter (from a lawyer) or a small claims process. For small amounts, weigh the cost of chasing against the amount â€" sometimes the lesson is worth more than the money.
    - **Why it works:** It shows you are serious â€" and it protects your rights.

The golden rule of chasing payment: The first message should never be angry. Anger makes the customer defensive â€" and defensive customers do not pay. Be polite, be firm, be persistent.

Real-life comparison. Think of a landlord. A landlord who shouts at a tenant on the first day of late payment gets anger â€" not rent. A landlord who sends a polite reminder, then a call, then a firm letter â€" that landlord gets paid. The sequence works because it is polite, firm and documented.

Misconception to correct. "Chasing payment is rude." No â€" you did the work, you agreed a price, and you deserve to be paid. A polite chase is not rude â€" it is professional.

F.5 Taxes in plain terms â€" what every small business owner must know

The idea. Taxes are one of the most feared and misunderstood parts of business. The good news: for a small beginner, the obligations are simple â€" and the rules change, so you check, you do not memorise.

The three taxes to be aware of â€" teach them in plain terms:

1. **Income tax:** Tax on the profit your business makes. If your business is registered and making profit, you may have an income tax obligation. The rate and thresholds change â€" check the current rules on the official FIRS or state tax website.
    - **Say this:** "Income tax is on profit â€" not on sales. If you make no profit, you may pay nothing. But you must check the current rules."
2. **Withholding tax (WHT):** When a corporate client pays you, they may deduct a percentage (currently around 5â€"10% â€" verify the current rate) and remit it to the tax authority on your behalf. This is not an extra cost to you â€" it is a prepayment of your tax. Keep records of all WHT deductions â€" they count toward your tax obligation.
    - **Say this:** "Withholding tax is not a penalty â€" it is a prepayment. If a corporate client deducts it, they give you a WHT credit note â€" keep it safe."
3. **VAT (Value Added Tax):** VAT is a tax on goods and services, currently at 7.5% (verify the current rate). Businesses above a certain turnover threshold are required to charge VAT and remit it. Small businesses below the threshold may not need to charge VAT â€" but you must check the current threshold.
    - **Say this:** "VAT is not your money â€" it is collected for the government. If you are required to charge it, you must remit it. If you are not, you do not charge it. Check the current threshold."

The habit of setting aside for tax:

- Every time you receive a payment, set aside a fixed percentage (e.g., 10%) for tax.
- Put it in a separate envelope or account â€" do not spend it.
- When tax is due, you have the money ready.
- **Say this:** "The habit of setting aside is more important than the exact percentage. The percentage changes â€" the habit does not."

Where to check current tax information:

- **FIRS (Federal Inland Revenue Service):** firs.gov.ng
- **State tax authority:** your state's official tax website
- **Never** rely on a friend's memory, a WhatsApp forward, or a roadside "tax consultant". Check the official source â€" or ask a licensed tax professional.

Real-life comparison. Think of a market trader. A trader who sets aside 10% of every sale for tax never has a tax problem â€" the money is always there. A trader who spends everything and hopes for the best â€" that trader has a crisis when the tax officer comes. The habit is the difference.

Misconception to correct. "Taxes are only for big companies." No â€" if you are making profit, you have tax obligations. But the obligations are small for small businesses â€" and they change. Check, do not guess.

Say this to the class:

> *"We are not teaching you to be a tax consultant. We are teaching you three things: (1) taxes exist and you should know about them, (2) the rules change â€" check the official source, and (3) set aside a percentage of every payment â€" the habit is what matters. When you are ready, talk to a licensed tax professional for advice on your specific situation."*

F.6 Summary of the session

- Three documents: a **quote** (before), an **invoice** (after or at a stage), a **receipt** (proof of payment).
- A complete **invoice** has ten parts â€" business name, date, invoice number, customer, description, quantity/unit price, total, payment details, terms, thank-you.
- The **income and expense tracker** is your money memory â€" record everything, review weekly.
- The **payment-chasing sequence**: friendly reminder, follow-up call, firm written message, documented escalation â€" the first message should never be angry.
- **Taxes in plain terms**: income tax (on profit), withholding tax (prepayment), VAT (for some businesses). Check current rules on official sources. Set aside a percentage of every payment.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Invoice sent] --> B[Customer pays]
    B --> C[Record income]
    C --> D[Set aside tax 10%]
    D --> E[Pay costs]
    E --> F[Keep profit]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Show the class how to write a complete invoice, set up a tracker, and chase a late payment â€" live â€" so they can do it themselves.

Setup: Open a blank Google Doc titled "Invoice â€" FastFix". Open a blank Google Sheet titled "Tracker â€" FastFix". Have the payment-chasing sequence on the projector. Project both.

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A blank invoice template on the projector.
- A blank tracker template on the projector.
- The payment-chasing sequence on the projector.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" write a complete invoice (5 minutes)

Say: "We will write a complete invoice for a FastFix screen repair. Ten parts â€" watch."

Fill in the invoice template on the projector, narrating each part:

> ***FastFix Phone Repair*** *Mile 3 Market, Diobu, Port Harcourt Tel: 0803-XXX-XXXX*
>
> ***Invoice 001*** *â€" Date: 10 October 2026 Customer: Mr. Emeka Obi*
>
> *Description: Screen repair for iPhone 11 Quantity: 1 Unit price: â,¦6,500* ***Total: â,¦6,500***
>
> *Payment details: Bank: GTB â€" Account: 0123456789 â€" Name: Chidi Okonkwo Payment terms: Payment due by 17 October 2026. A 5% late fee applies after 7 days.*

Thank you for your business.

Say: "Ten parts. Business name, date, invoice number, customer, description, quantity/unit price, total, payment details, terms, thank-you. Complete. Professional. This invoice makes payment easy."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" set up the tracker (5 minutes)

Say: "Now the tracker. We will set it up in Google Sheets â€" free, on your phone."

Create the tracker on the projector, narrating each step:

Date	Description	Type	Income (â‚¦)	Expense (â‚¦)	Balance (â‚¦)
10 Oct	Screen repair â€" Customer A	Income	6,500		16,500
10 Oct	New screen stock	Expense		3,500	13,000
11 Oct	Battery replacement â€" Customer B	Income	4,500		17,500
11 Oct	Transport	Expense		500	17,000
12 Oct	Charger sale â€" Customer C	Income	1,500		18,500
12 Oct	Data for WhatsApp	Expense		500	18,000

Say: "Six transactions. Income in the income column, expenses in the expense column, balance after each. At the end of the week, I review: total income â‚¦12,500, total expenses â‚¦4,500, profit â‚¦8,000. That is the tracker."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" chase a late payment (3 minutes)

Say: "Now a late payment. The customer has not paid Invoice 001 â€" due 17 October. Today is 20 October. I will use the sequence."

Step 1 â€" Friendly reminder (due date, 17 October):

> *"Hello Mr. Obi, I hope you are well. I wanted to remind you that the payment of â‚¦6,500 for Invoice 001 is due today. Please let me know if you have any questions. Thank you. â€" Chidi"*

Step 2 â€" Follow-up call (19 October):

> *"Hello Mr. Obi, I sent a reminder about Invoice 001 â€" I wanted to check if you received it. Is everything okay with the payment? â€" Chidi"*

Step 3 â€" Firm written message (24 October):

> *"Hello Mr. Obi, I am writing about Invoice 001 â€" â‚¦6,500, due on 17 October. I have not received payment. Please pay by 25 October. If I do not hear from you, I will have to stop further work. I hope we can resolve this quickly. Thank you. â€" Chidi" (Attach the invoice.)*

Step 4 â€" Documented escalation (27 October):

> *"Hello Mr. Obi, this is my final message about Invoice 001. I have not received payment. Please pay by 30 October or I will have to take further steps. I would prefer to resolve this amicably. â€" Chidi"*

Say: "Four steps. Polite, firm, documented. The first message is never angry â€" anger makes the customer defensive. Be polite, be firm, be persistent."

G.5 Questions to ask during the demo

- "What are the ten parts of a complete invoice?" (Business name, date, invoice number, customer, description, quantity/unit price, total, payment details, terms, thank-you.)
- "What is the difference between a quote and an invoice?" (A quote is before the job â€" an offer. An invoice is after the job â€" a request for payment.)
- "What are the four steps of the payment-chasing sequence?" (Friendly reminder, follow-up call, firm written message, documented escalation.)
- "Why should the first message never be angry?" (Anger makes the customer defensive â€" and defensive customers do not pay.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner writes a complete invoice, sets up a tracker, and practises the payment-chasing sequence.

Starting materials: A pen and notebook or phone notes app; a Google Sheets account; the invoice template and tracker template (projected and printed).

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name and today's date at the top of your workbook or notes app.
2. **Choose a job:** Pick one job from your business idea (or use FastFix's screen repair).
3. **Write a complete invoice:** Fill in the invoice template (Worksheet 7.2) â€" all ten parts. Use realistic naira figures.
4. **Pause and predict:** Ask yourself: "If a customer received this invoice, would they know exactly what to pay, how to pay, and when to pay?"
5. **Set up the tracker:** Open a Google Sheet (or draw the table on paper). Add the five columns â€" Date, Description, Type, Income, Expense, Balance. (Worksheet 7.3.)
6. **Make three example entries:** Record two income transactions and one expense transaction. Calculate the balance after each.
7. **Weekly review:** Add up your income and expenses. Calculate your profit. Write one sentence: "What I will change next week is _____."
8. **Practise the payment-chasing sequence:** Write the four messages for a customer who has not paid â€" friendly reminder, follow-up call, firm written message, documented escalation. (Worksheet 7.4.)
9. **Share:** Show your invoice to your partner. Ask: "Is this complete? Is it clear?"
10. **Revise:** Based on your partner's feedback, revise your invoice if needed.

Expected result: A complete invoice, a tracker with three entries and a weekly review, and a payment-chasing sequence.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 4: "Would a customer know what to pay, how to pay, and when to pay?"
- After step 7: "What will you change next week â€" and how do you know?"
- After step 9: "Is your partner's invoice complete? What is missing?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner's invoice is missing parts â†' Check against the ten parts â€" what is missing?
- Learner's tracker is wrong â†' Ask: "Did you use the right columns? Is the balance correct?"
- Learner's chasing messages are angry â†' Remind them: "The first message is never angry. Be polite, be firm, be persistent."
- Learner's weekly review is vague â†' Ask: "What is your profit? What will you change?"

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Invoice written with all ten parts
- ☐ Tracker set up with five columns
- ☐ Three example entries made (two income, one expense)
- ☐ Balance calculated correctly after each entry
- ☐ Weekly review done â€" profit calculated
- ☐ Payment-chasing sequence written â€" all four messages

- ☐ Invoice shared with a partner and revised

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Write a **tax explanation and set-aside plan** for a fictional business â€" including the three taxes, where to check, and a set-aside calculation.

Scenario. *Mama Chika* sells jollof rice and small chops from her home in Port Harcourt. She has been making profit for three months but has not thought about tax. She has heard that "tax is complicated" and is worried. She earns about â‚¦40,000 a month in profit.

Requirements:

1. **Explain the three taxes in plain terms:** income tax, withholding tax, and VAT. For each, write 2â€"3 sentences in simple English â€" what it is, who it applies to, and where Mama Chika should check the current rules.
2. **Set-aside calculation:** If Mama Chika sets aside 10% of her â‚¦40,000 monthly profit for tax, how much is that per month? Per week?
3. **Write one sentence:** "Mama Chika's tax habit is _____."
4. **Write one sentence:** "Where Mama Chika should check current tax rules is _____."

Constraints:

- Write in simple English â€" Mama Chika is not a lawyer or accountant.
- Do not invent specific tax rates or thresholds â€" state where to check.
- Label all figures as "example only â€" verify on the official site" where appropriate.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Three taxes explained in plain terms.
- Set-aside calculation correct.
- Two sentences are realistic and specific.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For income tax â€" it is on profit, not sales. For withholding tax â€" it is a prepayment. For VAT â€" it is for some businesses, check the threshold.
- Hint 2: For the set-aside â€" 10% of â‚¦40,000 is â‚¦4,000 per month. Per week is â‚¦4,000 Ã· 4 = â‚¦1,000.
- Hint 3: For the tax habit â€" think about setting aside a percentage of every payment.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Three taxes explained:

1. **Income tax:** Income tax is a tax on the profit your business makes â€" not on your sales. If Mama Chika makes â‚¦40,000 profit in a month, she may have an income tax obligation. The rate and thresholds change â€" she should check the current rules on the official FIRS or state tax website.
2. **Withholding tax (WHT):** When a corporate client pays Mama Chika, they may deduct a percentage and remit it to the tax authority on her behalf. This is not an extra cost â€" it is a prepayment of her tax. She should keep records of all WHT deductions â€" they count toward her tax obligation.
3. **VAT (Value Added Tax):** VAT is a tax on goods and services, currently at 7.5% (verify the current rate). Businesses above a certain turnover threshold are required to charge VAT and remit it. Small businesses below the threshold may not need to charge VAT â€" Mama Chika should check the current threshold on the official FIRS website.

Set-aside calculation:

- 10% of â‚¦40,000 = â‚¦4,000 per month.
- Per week: â‚¦4,000 Ã· 4 = â‚¦1,000 per week.

Tax habit sentence: "Mama Chika's tax habit is to set aside 10% of every payment she receives â€" so the money is always there when tax is due."

Where to check sentence: "Where Mama Chika should check current tax rules is the official FIRS website (firs.gov.ng) or her state tax authority's official website â€" never from memory or a WhatsApp forward."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Income tax explained in plain terms (2)
- Withholding tax explained in plain terms (2)
- VAT explained in plain terms (2)
- Set-aside calculation correct (2)
- Two sentences realistic and specific (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Timing: 3 minutes. Run this as a rapid decision drill â€" read the situation, take the decision, name the recommended approach. The reasoning, trade-offs and professional connection below are your live-troubleshooting talking points (Â§K) â€" do not lecture them. The time saved here â€" and in Â§F, compressed per the Part 4 Â§3 rule (protect Â§H and Â§I; compress Â§F and Â§J) â€" goes to the **SIMULATION â€" THE FIRST CLIENT** block below, which is worth **15% of the course**.

Situation. *Emeka* is a freelance graphic designer in Port Harcourt. He designs flyers, logos and social media graphics for small businesses. He has been doing this for a year. A corporate client hired him to design a logo for â‚¦50,000. The client asked for his TIN and a proper invoice. Emeka did not have a TIN â€" and he did not know how to write a proper invoice. He sent a WhatsApp message: "Logo design â€" â‚¦50,000. Please pay to GTB 0123456789." The client replied: "We need a proper invoice with your TIN to process payment. Please send it." Emeka was stuck â€" he did not have a TIN, and his "invoice" was just a WhatsApp message.

Relevant facts.

- Emeka has been earning about â‚¦80,000 a month for the past six months.
- He has no TIN, no business registration, and no proper invoicing system.
- The corporate client is willing to pay â€" but only with a proper invoice and TIN.
- Emeka is worried that getting a TIN means he will pay a lot of tax.

Decision point. What should Emeka do?

Possible approaches.

1. Ignore the corporate client â€" "they are too complicated."
2. Try to write a proper invoice without a TIN â€" "maybe they will accept it."
3. Get a TIN, write a proper invoice, and build a system for the future.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Emeka's problem is not the corporate client â€" it is that he has been operating without the foundation. The corporate client is simply the first place the missing structure shows up. Getting a TIN and writing a proper invoice will solve this problem â€" and open doors to more corporate clients.

Reasoning / example actions for Emeka:

1. **Get a TIN:** Apply through FIRS or the state tax authority â€" check the official website for the current process. It is not as hard as he thinks â€" and it is not a tax bill.
2. **Write a proper invoice:** Use the ten parts â€" business name, date, invoice number, customer, description, quantity/unit price, total, payment details, terms, thank-you. Include his TIN on the invoice.
3. **Set up a tracker:** Record all income and expenses in a Google Sheet. Review weekly.
4. **Set aside for tax:** Set aside 10% of every payment â€" so the money is always there.
5. **Learn about withholding tax:** The corporate client may deduct WHT â€" keep the credit note, and it counts toward his tax.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (ignore) loses a â‚¦50,000 client â€" and all future corporate clients.
- Approach 2 (try without a TIN) will fail â€" the corporate client has already said they need it.
- Approach 3 (build the system) takes a few days of effort â€" and opens a whole new market.

Professional connection. Corporate clients are the best clients for freelancers â€" they pay well, on time, and repeatedly. But they demand professionalism â€" a TIN, a proper invoice, and clean records. The freelancer who has these things gets the

corporate work; the freelancer who does not stays in the informal market. The foundation is not a burden â€" it is the key.

SIMULATION â€" THE FIRST CLIENT (15%)

Status: this is the course simulation â€" 15% of the final grade. It runs in this session, immediately after Â§J. Allow **~20 minutes** (2 minutes brief Â· 15 minutes working Â· 3 minutes to submit and collect). Marking: **marks Ã· 20 Ã— 15**. A printable copy of the brief and rubric also lives in Part 5 ("Template: Simulation Brief and Marking Rubric") and is summarised in Part 4 Â§7.3.

Why it exists. Everything up to now has been practice on documents. This is the first time the whole sequence â€" enquiry â†' quote â†' scope â†' invoice â€" is done under mild time pressure, the way it happens with a real first customer.

Setup (1 minute): Work in pairs. Partner A is the freelancer; Partner B is the customer â€" they read the enquiry script below and may push back on price **once**. Partner B marks with the rubric while Partner A works; then swap if time allows, or run half the room now and half during the break/next slot.

Read to learners: *"One customer enquiry arrives on this script. In 15 minutes, working alone: reply and qualify the job â†' send a written quote â†' agree the scope in writing â†' raise the invoice. Your partner plays the customer and may push back on price once. Submit all four artefacts."*

Customer enquiry script (Partner B reads this â€" do not show the whole class in advance):

> *"Hello, I got your number from a friend. My phone screen is cracked â€" iPhone 11. How much will it cost? I need it today if possible. My budget is about â‚¦6,000."*

Push-back card (Partner B uses it once, if the quote is above budget): *"â‚¦6,500? That is too much. My guy on Aba Road said he can do it for â‚¦5,000."*

What each learner must produce in 15 minutes â€" four artefacts, all in writing:

1. **Reply and qualify** â€" polite, fast, asks what the job is (device, damage, when they need it) â€" **never a price first**.
2. **Written quote** â€" scope, timeline, price, validity, payment terms (T6).
3. **Scope agreement in writing** â€" what is included **and** excluded (T9).
4. **Complete 10-part invoice** â€" matches the quote (T11).

Marking rubric (/20):

Criterion	Marks	What a strong answer shows
Reply and qualify	3	Fast, polite, asks what the job is â€" never a price first
Quote	5	Scope, timeline, price, validity, payment terms
Scope agreement	4	Included **and** excluded, in writing
Invoice	5	Complete 10-part, matches the quote
Tone and pace	3	Finished in time; no anger; customer never pressured
Total	**20**	**Marks Ã· 20 Ã— 15 = the simulation mark (out of 15%)**

Marking notes:

- The reply must ask what the job is before giving a price â€" a price-first reply loses the "qualify" marks even if the invoice is perfect.
- If the quote and the invoice disagree on price or scope, mark it where it broke: the quote earns its marks, the invoice loses them.
- Accept handwriting, a Google Doc, or a WhatsApp-style message thread â€" capability is assessed, not typing speed.
- Level 1 support: supply the four artefacts as partially completed scaffolds (business name and total pre-filled). Level 3 challenge: the customer also asks for a screen protector fitted "while you are at it" â€" the learner must quote for the extra, not absorb it.

Where the 20 minutes come from: Â§J runs in 3 minutes (decision drill), Â§F is compressed per the Part 4 Â§3 rule (protect Â§H and Â§I; compress Â§F and Â§J â€" teach F.1â€"F.5 tight and use Â§N as the F.6 recap), and Â§K runs live while you circulate during the simulation. If the clock slips, self-mark Â§M against the key at the break â€" but never cut the simulation or the invoice-writing time.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Confusing quote, invoice and receipt

Symptoms: The learner sends a quote when they should send an invoice â€" or does not give a receipt. **Likely cause:** They use the words interchangeably â€" and do not know the difference. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What did you send â€" a quote, an invoice, or a receipt? When should each be used?" **Corrective steps:** Quote before the job (offer), invoice after (request for receipt), receipt (proof of payment). **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can explain when each document is used. **Prevention:** The three documents are a sequence â€" quote, invoice, receipt â€" use them in order.

K.2 An incomplete invoice

Symptoms: The invoice says "â,¦6,500" â€" and the customer does not know what for, how to pay, or when. **Likely cause:** The invoice is missing parts â€" no description, no payment details, no terms. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Does your invoice have all ten parts? What is missing?" **Corrective steps:** Use the ten-part invoice template â€" every time. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner's invoice has all ten parts. **Prevention:** An incomplete invoice is a late invoice â€" write a complete invoice every time.

K.3 No tracker â€" "I will remember"

Symptoms: The learner has no record of income or expenses â€" they guess at their profit. **Likely cause:** They think record-keeping is for accountants. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What were your sales last week? What were your expenses? What was your profit?" **Corrective steps:** Set up a tracker â€" record everything, review weekly. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can state their sales, expenses and profit for the last week. **Prevention:** The tracker is your money memory â€" record everything.

K.4 Angry first message

Symptoms: The learner's first chasing message is angry â€" "You owe me money! Pay now!" **Likely cause:** They are frustrated â€" and let it show. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What did your first message say? Was it polite?" **Corrective steps:** Rewrite the first message â€" be polite, be firm, be persistent. The first message is never angry. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner's first message is polite. **Prevention:** Anger makes the customer defensive â€" and defensive customers do not pay.

K.5 No follow-up

Symptoms: The learner sends one message â€" and waits. The customer does not respond. **Likely cause:** They think one message is enough. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How many times have you followed up? When?" **Corrective steps:** Use the four-step sequence â€" reminder, call, firm message, escalation. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner has followed the full sequence. **Prevention:** Most late payments need more than one contact â€" follow the sequence.

K.6 No tax habit â€" "I will deal with it later"

Symptoms: The learner has not set aside any money for tax â€" and worries about a surprise bill. **Likely cause:** They think tax is complicated â€" so they avoid it. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Have you set aside any money for tax? Do you know your tax obligations?" **Corrective steps:** Set aside a percentage of every payment. Check current rules on the official site. Talk to a licensed tax professional if needed. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner has a set-aside habit and knows where to check. **Prevention:** The habit of setting aside is more important than the exact percentage â€" start today.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it with the learner â€" ask them the investigation question and listen to the answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Invoice and Track â€" Sample Invoice, Tracker and Payment-Chasing Sequence"

Purpose: To practise writing a complete invoice, setting up a working tracker, and chasing a late payment â€" the skills that turn work into money in the bank â€" and to build the invoice and tracker that will feed the capstone pack.

Realistic scenario. You have a business, customers, and agreements. This week, you will write a complete invoice for a real-shaped job, set up a working tracker with entries, and write the payment-chasing sequence for a customer who is seven days late.

Detailed instructions:

1. **Choose a job:** Pick one job from your business idea (or use FastFix's screen repair).
2. **Write a complete invoice:** Fill in all ten parts â€" business name, date, invoice number, customer, description, quantity/unit price, total, payment details, terms, thank-you. (Worksheet 7.2.)
3. **Set up the tracker:** Open a Google Sheet (or draw the table on paper). Add the six columns â€" Date, Description, Type, Income, Expense, Balance. Record at least five transactions â€" three income and two expenses. Calculate the balance after each. (Worksheet 7.3.)
4. **Weekly review:** Add up your total income and total expenses. Calculate your profit. Write one sentence: "What I will change next week is _____."
5. **Payment-chasing sequence:** Write the four messages for a customer who is seven days late on the invoice you wrote. Use the sequence â€" friendly reminder, follow-up call, firm written message, documented escalation. (Worksheet 7.4.)
6. **Tax habit:** Write your tax set-aside plan â€" what percentage you will set aside, and where you will check current tax rules. (Worksheet 7.5.)
7. **Reflection:** Write 3â€"5 sentences: "What I learned about getting paid this week is _____. What I will do differently is _____."

Required deliverables:

- A complete invoice.
- A tracker with at least five entries and a weekly review.
- A payment-chasing sequence â€" four messages.
- A tax set-aside plan.
- A short reflection.

Submission format: Save as a Google Doc or Google Sheet (or a clear photo of handwritten work) and upload to your Drive folder `CEA-Biz-YourName`, or show it to the instructor at the start of Session 8. You may also copy the text into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 8.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Complete invoice	5	All ten parts, clear, professional
Tracker with entries	5	At least five entries, balances correct, weekly review
Payment-chasing sequence	4	Four messages, polite, firm, documented
Tax set-aside plan	3	Percentage stated, official source named
Reflection	3	Honest and specific

Common mistakes to avoid: an incomplete invoice; no tracker or incomplete tracker; angry first message; no follow-up; no tax habit.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Complete invoice (model â€" for FastFix screen repair):

> ***FastFix Phone Repair*** *Mile 3 Market, Diobu, Port Harcourt Tel: 0803-XXX-XXXX*
>
> ***Invoice 001*** *â€" Date: 10 October 2026 Customer: Mr. Emeka Obi*
>
> *Description: Screen repair for iPhone 11 Quantity: 1 Unit price: â,¦6,500* ***Total: â,¦6,500***
>
> *Payment details: Bank: GTB â€" Account: 0123456789 â€" Name: Chidi Okonkwo Payment terms: Payment due by 17 October 2026. A 5% late fee applies after 7 days.*

Thank you for your business.

Tracker (model â€" five entries):

Date	Description	Type	Income (â‚¦)	Expense (â‚¦)	Balance (â‚¦)
10 Oct	Screen repair â€" Customer A	Income	6,500		16,500
10 Oct	New screen stock	Expense		3,500	13,000
11 Oct	Battery replacement â€" Customer B	Income	4,500		17,500
11 Oct	Transport	Expense		500	17,000
12 Oct	Charger sale â€" Customer C	Income	1,500		18,500

Weekly review: Total income â‚¦12,500, total expenses â‚¦4,000, profit â‚¦8,500. "What I will change next week is to order screen stock in bulk to reduce cost."

Payment-chasing sequence (model â€" customer seven days late):

1. Friendly reminder (due date): "Hello Mr. Obi, I hope you are well. I wanted to remind you that the payment of â‚¦6,500 for Invoice 001 is due today. Please let me know if you have any questions. Thank you. â€" Chidi"
2. Follow-up call (2 days late): "Hello Mr. Obi, I sent a reminder about Invoice 001 â€" I wanted to check if you received it. Is everything okay with the payment? â€" Chidi"
3. Firm written message (7 days late): "Hello Mr. Obi, I am writing about Invoice 001 â€" â‚¦6,500, due on 17 October. I have not received payment. Please pay by 25 October. If I do not hear from you, I will have to stop further work. I hope we can resolve this quickly. Thank you. â€" Chidi" (Attach the invoice.)
4. Documented escalation (14 days late): "Hello Mr. Obi, this is my final message about Invoice 001. I have not received payment. Please pay by 30 October or I will have to take further steps. I would prefer to resolve this amicably. â€" Chidi"

Tax set-aside plan (model): "I will set aside 10% of every payment I receive for tax. I will put the money in a separate envelope and not spend it. I will check current tax rules on the official FIRS website (firs.gov.ng) or my state tax authority's official website. When I am ready, I will talk to a licensed tax professional for advice on my specific situation."

Reflection (model): "What I learned about getting paid this week is that an invoice is not just a price â€" it is a request for payment with context. What I will do differently is to always write a complete invoice, record every transaction, and follow the payment-chasing sequence politely and persistently."

A strong learner solution differs in content but ticks every rubric row.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is the difference between a quote, an invoice and a receipt?

Q2. Multiple choice. Which of these is a complete invoice? a) "â‚¦6,500 â€" pay now." b) "Invoice 001 â€" Date: 10 Oct â€" Customer: Mr. Obi â€" Screen repair â€" â‚¦6,500 â€" GTB 0123456789 â€" due 17 Oct." c) "I repaired your phone. Please pay." d) "Payment due: â‚¦6,500."

Q3. Matching. Match each tax to what it is: (1) income tax, (2) withholding tax, (3) VAT. a) A tax on goods and services, for some businesses b) A tax on profit c) A prepayment deducted by corporate clients

Q4. True or false. "The first payment-chasing message should be angry â€" to show you are serious."

Q5. Explain. What are the four steps of the payment-chasing sequence?

Q6. Practical. A customer has not paid â‚¦5,000 â€" due 15 October. Today is 22 October. Write the first two messages you would send.

Q7. Scenario. Your friend earns â‚¦30,000 a month and has never set aside money for tax. What two things should they start doing?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q7)

A1. A quote is given before the job (an offer of what it will cost). An invoice is given after the job or at a stage (a formal request for payment). A receipt is given when payment is received (proof of payment).

A2. (b) â€” it has the business name, date, invoice number, customer, description, total, payment details and terms.

A3. (1) = b, (2) = c, (3) = a.

A4. False. The first message should never be angry â€” anger makes the customer defensive. Be polite, be firm, be persistent.

A5. The four steps: (1) friendly reminder on the due date, (2) follow-up call 2â€“3 days after, (3) firm written message with the invoice attached 7 days after, (4) documented escalation 14+ days after.

A6. Message 1 (on due date, 15 Oct): "Hello [name], I hope you are well. I wanted to remind you that the payment of â‚¦5,000 is due today. Please let me know if you have any questions. Thank you." Message 2 (follow-up call, 17â€“18 Oct): "Hello [name], I sent a reminder about the payment â€” I wanted to check if you received it. Is everything okay with the payment?" (Accept any polite, specific messages that follow the sequence.)

A7. Two things: (1) Set aside a percentage of every payment for tax â€” so the money is always there. (2) Check current tax rules on the official FIRS website or their state tax authority's official website â€” never from memory or a WhatsApp forward. (Also acceptable: talk to a licensed tax professional.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned the paperwork of getting paid: a quote before the job, an invoice after (or at a stage), and a receipt as proof of payment. You learned that a complete invoice has ten parts â€” and that an incomplete invoice is a late invoice. You learned to set up an income and expense tracker in Google Sheets â€” record everything, review weekly. You learned the polite payment-chasing sequence: friendly reminder, follow-up call, firm written message, documented escalation â€” the first message should never be angry. And you learned taxes in plain terms: income tax (on profit), withholding tax (a prepayment), VAT (for some businesses) â€” check current rules on official sources, and set aside a percentage of every payment.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Quote, invoice, receipt** â€” three documents, three moments, three purposes.
2. A complete **invoice** has ten parts â€” an incomplete invoice is a late invoice.
3. The **tracker** is your money memory â€” record everything, review weekly.
4. **Chase payment politely** â€” reminder, call, firm message, escalation.
5. **Taxes are manageable** â€” check official sources, set aside a percentage.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I explain the difference between a quote, an invoice and a receipt?
- Can I write a complete invoice with all ten parts?
- Can I set up a tracker and record transactions?
- Can I chase a late payment politely?
- Can I explain the three taxes in plain terms?

Connection to the next session. You can get paid and manage money. But how do customers find you in the first place â€” without spending money on adverts? Next session we learn digital presence and free marketing: WhatsApp Business, Google Business Profile, choosing one social platform, building trust, and planning seven days of free marketing. Being found is half the battle.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner distinguishes a quote, an invoice and a receipt — and uses each at the right time.
- Learner writes a complete invoice with all ten parts.

- Learner sets up a tracker and records transactions correctly.
- Learner follows the payment-chasing sequence â€" polite, firm, persistent.
- Learner explains the three taxes in plain terms and names where to check.
- Learner has a tax set-aside habit.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "An invoice is the same as a quote." â†' A quote is before (offer), an invoice is after (request for payment).
- "I will remember what I earned." â†' Write it down â€" the tracker is your memory.
- "Chasing payment is rude." â†' You did the work â€" a polite chase is professional.
- "The first message should be angry." â†' Anger makes the customer defensive â€" be polite, be firm.
- "Taxes are only for big companies." â†' If you make profit, you have obligations â€" check the official source.
- "I will deal with tax later." â†' Set aside a percentage today â€" the habit matters.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Invoice completion:** give a partially completed invoice and ask the learner to fill in the missing parts â€" then check against the ten parts.
2. **Tracker practice:** give three transactions and ask the learner to record them in a tracker and calculate the balance and profit.
3. **Chasing message rewrite:** give an angry first message and ask the learner to rewrite it politely.
4. **Tax explanation:** ask the learner to explain the three taxes to a friend in plain language â€" then check for accuracy.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed invoice template (business name, date, total already filled); learner adds the rest. Provide a tracker with some entries already made; learner adds the rest.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" full invoice, tracker, chasing sequence, tax explanation.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to write a **payment terms policy** for their business â€" what terms they will offer (e.g., 50/50, net 7, net 30), what late fee they will charge, and how they will handle non-payment. Also ask them to calculate their **monthly tax set-aside** based on their actual or estimated monthly profit.

Capstone links. This session's invoice and tracker become the money-admin section of the capstone pack. The payment-chasing sequence is practised in the Session 7 simulation (the first-client scenario). The tax set-aside habit feeds the financial snapshot. In Session 9, the learner will show that their financial snapshot is not a guess â€" it is built on a foundation of invoices, records and tax awareness.

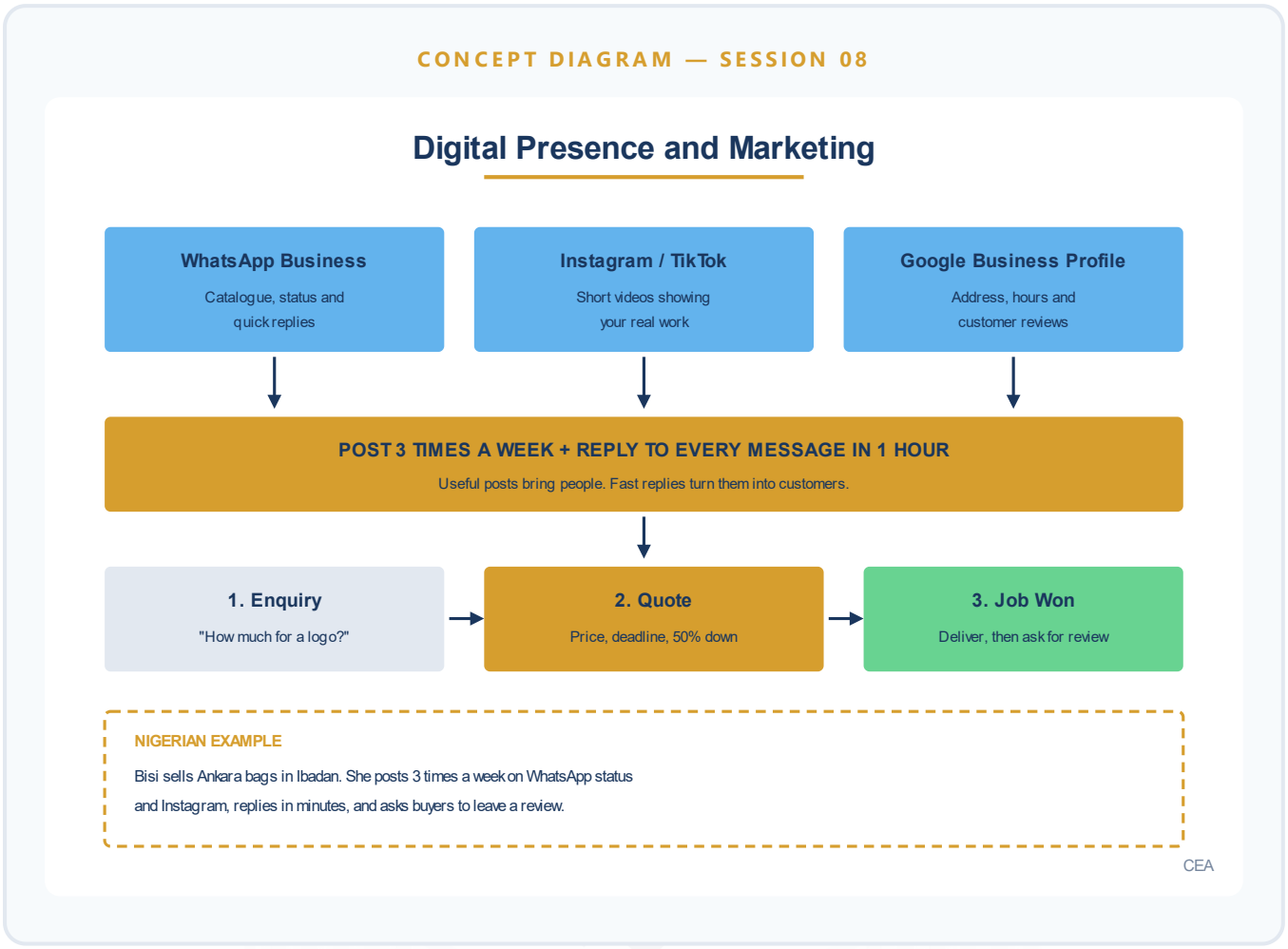
Timing guidance. The priority is learners writing a complete invoice and setting up a tracker (Sections H and the assignment). **The SIMULATION â€" THE FIRST CLIENT (15%) also runs today â€" protect its ~20 minutes.** Â§J runs in 3 minutes and Â§F is compressed to make room (see the simulation block and the Part 4 Â§3 rule). If the room is slow, shorten Section F.5 (taxes) to the three taxes in one sentence each, and limit the independent exercise to the set-aside calculation; if the clock still slips, self-mark Â§M against the key at the break. Protect the invoice-writing time â€" a learner who leaves without a complete invoice cannot get paid properly.

END OF SESSION 7

Next: Session 8 â€" Digital Presence and Marketing for Small Business.

SESSION 08 OF 9

Digital Presence and Marketing for Small Business



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" BUSINESS & FREELANCING

SESSION 8 â€" DIGITAL PRESENCE AND MARKETING FOR SMALL BUSINESS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	8 of 9
Session title	Digital Presence and Marketing for Small Business
Week / Module	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Run and Grow
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with digital marketing)

Item	Detail
Prerequisite knowledge	The Session 7 invoice and tracker. Learners must have a smartphone with WhatsApp. No prior marketing knowledge required.
Connection to previous work	In Session 7 you learned to get paid and manage money. Today we get you found: how to build a free digital presence, set up WhatsApp Business, create a Google Business Profile, choose one social platform, build trust, and plan seven days of free marketing. Being found is half the battle â€" and it can cost nothing.
Preparation before class	Print the WhatsApp Business setup checklist (Section F.2); print the Google Business Profile steps (Section F.3); print the seven-day marketing plan template (Section F.6); have the FastFix case pack ready; prepare a sample WhatsApp Business profile on the projector; bring a sample seven-day marketing plan.

Instructor note on tone: Many learners think marketing means paying for adverts or being an "influencer". Reframe it: marketing is simply being findable and trustworthy. A small business can be found and trusted with a phone, free tools, and consistency. Keep the mood practical and encouraging â€" everyone can do this.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** why being found online matters for a small business â€" and why it can be free.
2. **Set up** a complete WhatsApp Business profile: profile photo or logo, clear description, business hours, catalogue of at least three items, greeting message, customer labels and broadcast lists.
3. **Describe** the steps to create a Google Business Profile â€" and why "near me" searches matter.
4. **Choose** one social platform to maintain well â€" and explain why one platform done well beats five done poorly.
5. **Plan** seven days of free marketing: real photos, prices, before/after, customer feedback, availability.
6. **Apply** trust-building principles: consistent name and logo, fast replies, honest descriptions, no fake testimonials.
7. **Produce** a complete WhatsApp Business profile and a seven-day free marketing plan (LO10).

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with WhatsApp and a browser) or an academy computer.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.
- Notebook and pen (optional).

Software

- **WhatsApp Business** (free app) â€" the main tool for this session.
- A browser (Chrome) for Google Business Profile.
- The **WhatsApp Business setup checklist**, **Google Business Profile steps**, and **seven-day marketing plan template** (Sections F.2, F.3, F.6) projected and printed.

Sample files

- Printed **WhatsApp Business setup checklist** (Section F.2).
- Printed **Google Business Profile steps** (Section F.3).
- Printed **seven-day marketing plan template** (Section F.6).
- A **sample WhatsApp Business profile** (instructor's own example â€" e.g., for FastFix) for the demonstration.
- A **sample seven-day marketing plan** (instructor's own example).
- The **FastFix case pack** (from Sessions 1â€"7).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 8.1 â€" "WhatsApp Business Profile Checklist" (a tick-list for setup).
- Worksheet 8.2 â€" "Google Business Profile Steps" (a step-by-step list).
- Worksheet 8.3 â€" "Choose One Platform" (a decision table).
- Worksheet 8.4 â€" "Trust Signals" (a checklist of trust-building actions).
- Worksheet 8.5 â€" "Seven-Day Free Marketing Plan" (a day-by-day plan).

Accounts

- A **WhatsApp Business** account (learners will set this up in the practical).
- A **Gmail account** for Google Business Profile.

Internet

- Required for the WhatsApp Business setup and Google Business Profile steps. If internet is limited, the instructor may demonstrate on the projector while learners follow on paper.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with WhatsApp works. A learner who cannot set up WhatsApp Business in class may complete the checklist on paper and set it up at home; the skill is the **understanding of the profile**, not the app installation.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two "findability stories" without labelling them.

- **Story A:** "Chidi from FastFix has a personal Facebook page he rarely updates. He has no WhatsApp Business profile. When someone searches 'phone repair near me' on Google, Chidi does not appear. When someone asks in a WhatsApp group 'who can fix my phone?', Chidi does not see the message. He is invisible â€" even though he is good at his work."
- **Story B:** "Adaeze from Adaeze Fashion has a complete WhatsApp Business profile â€" a clear photo, a description, a catalogue of her dresses, and a greeting message. She has a Google Business Profile â€" when someone searches 'fashion designer Port Harcourt', she appears. She posts on WhatsApp status every week â€" a clear photo, a clear price, a clear call to action. She is findable â€" and she is busy."

What the instructor says:

> *"Two businesses. Hands up â€" which one gets found by customers? â€¦ Story B, almost always. Why? Because Adaeze is **findable** â€" she has a WhatsApp Business profile, a Google Business Profile, and a regular presence. Chidi is invisible â€" even though he is just as skilled. Today we learn to be Adaeze. You will learn to set up WhatsApp Business, create a Google Business Profile, choose one social platform, build trust, and plan seven days of free marketing. Being found is half the battle â€" and it can cost nothing."*

Expected learner response: Learners will say "B is findable", "A is invisible", "B has a profile", "B posts regularly". Accept all answers and draw out the difference: **visible vs invisible**.

Then reveal the hook: Ask, "How many of you have searched for a business on Google or WhatsApp â€" and could not find it?" Many hands go up. Say:

> *"That is the experience your customers are having with you. Today you change that."*

Why this opener works: It uses the running example and a contrasting example, it isolates visibility as the variable, and it frames digital presence as a practical necessity â€" not a luxury.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the ten parts of a complete invoice?"

- Expected answer: Business name, date, invoice number, customer, description, quantity/unit price, total, payment details, terms, thank-you.
- Common gap: learners remember five or six. Clarify: "The invoice gets you paid â€" today we get you found."

Question 2: "What are the four steps of the payment-chasing sequence?"

- Expected answer: Friendly reminder, follow-up call, firm written message, documented escalation.
- Common gap: learners remember two or three. Clarify: "The chasing sequence is how you get paid â€" today we learn how to get found."

Question 3: "What are the three taxes to be aware of?"

- Expected answer: Income tax (on profit), withholding tax (prepayment), VAT (for some businesses).
- Common gap: learners remember one or two. Clarify: "Taxes are part of money management â€" today we learn visibility."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You can get paid and manage money. Now you get found. A business that cannot be found does not exist â€" no matter how good the work. Today you learn to be findable: WhatsApp Business, Google Business Profile, one social platform, trust-building, and a seven-day free marketing plan. All free. All with your phone."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the ten parts of an invoice, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing them on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why being found online matters â€" and why it is free

The idea. Customers now search before they buy. They search Google for "phone repair near me", they ask in WhatsApp groups, they check Instagram for photos. If you are not findable, you do not exist â€" no matter how good your work is.

The three places customers look:

1. **Google:** When they search for a service â€" "phone repair Port Harcourt", "fashion designer near me".
2. **WhatsApp:** When they ask for recommendations in groups, or when they check your profile before calling.
3. **Social media:** When they look at your photos, your prices, your customer feedback.

Why it is free:

- **WhatsApp Business** is a free app â€" no monthly fee.
- **Google Business Profile** is free â€" no cost to create or maintain.
- **Social media** (Instagram, Facebook, TikTok) is free to join and post.
- The only cost is your time â€" a few hours to set up, and a few minutes a week to maintain.

Real-life comparison. Think of a market stall. A stall with a clear signboard, a clean display, and a friendly trader â€" that stall gets customers. A stall with no sign, a messy display, and a silent trader â€" that stall is invisible. Digital presence is the signboard, the display, and the friendly trader â€" online.

Important limitation / misconception. "I need to pay for adverts to be found." No â€" adverts can help, but they are not the foundation. A business with a complete WhatsApp Business profile, a Google Business Profile, and regular social media posts â€" that business is findable without spending a naira. Adverts come later, when you have the money and the offer is proven.

How a learner recognises a findable business: They can point to a complete WhatsApp Business profile, a Google Business Profile, and a regular social media presence.

F.2 WhatsApp Business â€" your digital shopfront

The idea. WhatsApp Business is a free app that turns your WhatsApp into a business tool. It has a profile, a catalogue, labels, and a greeting message â€" so customers can find you, learn about you, and contact you easily.

The seven parts of a complete WhatsApp Business profile â€" teach them one by one:

1. **Profile photo or logo:** A clear photo of you, your logo, or your work â€” so customers know who they are dealing with.
    - FastFix example: A photo of Chidi repairing a phone, or a simple logo with "FastFix Phone Repair".
2. **Business name:** Your business name â€” consistent with your other profiles.
    - FastFix example: "FastFix Phone Repair".
3. **Description:** A clear, short description of what you do, where you are, and what makes you different.
    - FastFix example: "Phone repair and accessories at Mile 3 Market, Diobu, Port Harcourt. Same-day screen and battery repair with 30-day warranty. Call or WhatsApp 0803-XXX-XXXX."
4. **Business hours:** When you are open â€” so customers know when to contact you.
    - FastFix example: "Monâ€“Sat: 8 a.m.â€“6 p.m. Sun: Closed."
5. **Catalogue:** At least three items with photos, prices and descriptions â€” so customers can see what you offer.
    - FastFix example: (1) Screen repair â€” â‚¦4,000â€“â‚¦7,000. (2) Battery replacement â€” â‚¦2,500â€“â‚¦4,000. (3) Phone case â€” â‚¦1,500â€“â‚¦3,000.
6. **Greeting message:** An automatic message that greets customers who contact you.
    - FastFix example: "Hello! Thank you for contacting FastFix Phone Repair. How can I help you today? Please describe your phone problem."
7. **Customer labels and broadcast lists:** Labels to organise customers (new, quoted, paid, completed) and broadcast lists to send messages to many customers at once â€” with permission.
    - FastFix example: Labels: "New enquiry", "Quoted", "Paid", "Completed". Broadcast list: "Happy customers" â€” for occasional updates and offers.

Real-life comparison. Think of a shop. A shop with a clear signboard, a clean window display, a price list, and a friendly greeting â€” that shop gets customers. A shop with no sign, a messy window, no prices, and a silent trader â€” that shop is invisible. WhatsApp Business is the digital version of the good shop.

Misconception to correct. "WhatsApp Business is only for big companies." No â€” it is for any business that wants to be findable and professional. A phone repairer, a tailor, a food seller â€” all benefit from a complete profile.

F.3 Google Business Profile â€” when customers search "near me"

The idea. A **Google Business Profile** is a free listing that appears when someone searches for your business or service on Google. It shows your name, address, hours, photos, and reviews â€” so customers can find you and trust you.

Why "near me" searches matter:

- When someone searches "phone repair near me" on Google, Google shows businesses with a Google Business Profile.
- If you do not have a profile, you do not appear â€” and the customer goes to your competitor.
- A complete profile with photos and reviews builds trust before the customer even calls you.

The steps to create a Google Business Profile â€” teach them one by one:

1. **Go to Google Business Profile:** Search "Google Business Profile" on Google, or go to business.google.com.
2. **Sign in with your Gmail account.**
3. **Enter your business name:** The name customers know you by.
4. **Choose your business category:** E.g., "Phone repair shop", "Fashion designer", "Restaurant".
5. **Add your location:** Your address â€” or the area you serve if you work from home.
6. **Add your contact information:** Phone number, website (if you have one), and WhatsApp link.
7. **Add your business hours:** When you are open.
8. **Add photos:** A photo of you, your work, your products, and your location.
9. **Verify your business:** Google will send a verification code â€” by phone, email, or postcard. Enter the code to confirm you are real.
10. **Keep it updated:** Update your hours, photos, and offers regularly.

Real-life comparison. Think of a phone book. A business listed in the phone book with a clear address, phone number, and description â€” that business gets calls. A business not listed â€” that business is invisible. Google Business Profile is the digital phone book.

Misconception to correct. "Google Business Profile is only for shops with a physical location." No â€" if you work from home or serve customers at their location, you can list your service area instead of your address. The profile is for any business that wants to be found.

F.4 Choose one social platform â€" and do it well

The idea. You do not need to be on every social platform. You need to be on **one** platform â€" and do it well. One platform done well beats five done poorly.

How to choose â€" a practical decision rule:

- **Where is your customer?** If your customer is on Instagram, choose Instagram. If on Facebook, choose Facebook. If on TikTok, choose TikTok.
- **What content can you create easily?** If you can take good photos, choose Instagram or Facebook. If you can make short videos, choose TikTok or Instagram Reels.
- **Where are you most comfortable?** Choose the platform you enjoy â€" because you will maintain it better.

The one-platform rule:

- Choose one platform.
- Post regularly â€" at least 3â€"4 times a week.
- Use real photos of real work.
- Include a clear price and a clear call to action.
- Engage with comments and messages â€" reply fast.

Real-life comparison. Think of a market trader. A trader who sets up in one market, with a clear display and a friendly manner â€" that trader has customers. A trader who runs between five markets, with no display and no manner â€" that trader is exhausted and invisible. One market done well beats five done poorly.

Misconception to correct. "I need to be on every platform." No â€" you need to be on one platform, consistently. A business with a strong Instagram presence and no Facebook â€" that business is findable. A business with five weak profiles â€" that business is invisible everywhere.

F.5 Building trust â€" the signals that make customers choose you

The idea. Being found is not enough â€" customers must also **trust** you. Trust is built through consistent signals: a consistent name and logo, fast replies, honest descriptions, and real customer feedback.

The six trust signals â€" teach them one by one:

1. **Consistent name and logo:** Use the same name and logo on WhatsApp Business, Google Business Profile, and social media â€" so customers know it is the same business.
    - FastFix example: "FastFix Phone Repair" with the same logo everywhere.
2. **Fast replies:** Respond to messages within minutes â€" even if it is "I will get back to you in one hour." A fast reply signals reliability.
    - FastFix example: Chidi replies to every WhatsApp message within 15 minutes.
3. **Honest descriptions:** Describe your work honestly â€" do not promise what you cannot deliver. An honest description builds trust; a false one destroys it.
    - FastFix example: "Same-day screen repair with a 30-day warranty" â€" and Chidi delivers exactly that.
4. **Real photos of real work:** Use real photos of your actual work â€" not stock photos or a competitor's work. Real photos prove you exist and can deliver.
    - FastFix example: Photos of actual phones Chidi has repaired.
5. **Customer feedback:** Ask happy customers for a testimonial â€" and share it (with permission). Real feedback is the strongest trust signal.
    - FastFix example: "Chidi fixed my screen in 2 hours. It looks brand new. I recommend him." â€" Mr. Obi.
6. **No fake testimonials:** Never invent testimonials or reviews. Fake trust is worse than no trust â€" because when it is discovered, it destroys your reputation permanently.

- **Say this:** "A fake testimonial is a lie â€” and lies are always discovered. Real work builds real trust."

Real-life comparison. Think of a doctor. A doctor with a clear signboard, a clean office, a friendly manner, and real patient testimonials â€” that doctor gets patients. A doctor with a fake degree, a dirty office, and invented testimonials â€” that doctor is discovered and destroyed. Trust is the same in business.

Misconception to correct. "I need many testimonials to be trusted." No â€” you need a few real ones. Three honest testimonials are worth more than thirty fake ones.

F.6 Seven days of free marketing â€” a plan that works

The idea. Marketing is not a one-off event â€” it is a regular habit. A seven-day plan gives you a week of content that builds visibility and trust â€” without spending money.

The seven-day plan â€” teach it day by day:

- **Day 1 â€” Real work photo:** Post a photo of your actual work â€ a repaired phone, a sewn dress, a plate of food. Include a clear price and a call to action.
- **Day 2 â€ Before and after:** Post a before-and-after photo â€ the problem and the solution. This shows your skill and the value you provide.
- **Day 3 â€ Customer feedback:** Share a real testimonial (with permission). This builds trust.
- **Day 4 â€ Price list:** Post your price list â€ clear, honest, and easy to read. This attracts customers who are ready to buy.
- **Day 5 â€ Availability:** Post your availability â€ "I am taking orders for this week. Call or WhatsApp to book." This creates urgency.
- **Day 6 â€ Behind the scenes:** Post a photo of you working â€ your workspace, your tools, your process. This builds connection and trust.
- **Day 7 â€ Offer or reminder:** Post a special offer (e.g., "10% off this week") or a reminder of your services. This encourages action.

The rules of the seven-day plan:

1. **Use real photos** â€ of your real work.
2. **Include a clear price** â€ so customers know what to expect.
3. **Include a clear call to action** â€ "Call or WhatsApp to order."
4. **Post at a consistent time** â€ so customers know when to expect you.
5. **Reply to every comment and message** â€ fast.

Real-life comparison. Think of a market trader. A trader who puts out a clear display every day, with clear prices and a friendly manner â€ that trader has regular customers. A trader who puts out a display once a month â€ that trader is forgotten. The seven-day plan is the digital version of the daily display.

Misconception to correct. "Marketing is posting random photos." No â€ marketing is a plan. Seven days, seven types of content, one goal: be visible and build trust.

F.7 Summary of the session

- **Being found online matters** â€ customers search Google, WhatsApp and social media before they buy.
- **WhatsApp Business** is a free digital shopfront â€ profile photo, description, hours, catalogue, greeting, labels.
- **Google Business Profile** is a free listing for "near me" searches â€ create it, verify it, keep it updated.
- **Choose one social platform** â€ and do it well. One platform done well beats five done poorly.
- **Build trust** with six signals: consistent name and logo, fast replies, honest descriptions, real photos, real feedback, no fake testimonials.
- **Plan seven days of free marketing** â€ real work, before/after, feedback, price list, availability, behind the scenes, offer.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[WhatsApp Business] --> B[Google Business Profile]
    B --> C[Social media page]
```

```
C --> D[Customer reviews]
D --> E[More customers]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Show the class how to set up a WhatsApp Business profile and plan seven days of free marketing â€” live â€” so they can do it themselves.

Setup: Open WhatsApp Business on the instructor's phone (projected). Have the seven-day marketing plan template on the projector. Project both.

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- WhatsApp Business installed on the instructor's phone.
- The seven-day marketing plan template on the projector.
- A sample profile and sample plan ready.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€” set up WhatsApp Business (8 minutes)

Say: "We will set up a WhatsApp Business profile. Seven parts â€” watch."

Walk through the setup on the projector, narrating each step:

1. **Profile photo:** "I will use a photo of me repairing a phone â€” clear and professional."
2. **Business name:** "FastFix Phone Repair â€” the name customers know me by."
3. **Description:** "Phone repair and accessories at Mile 3 Market, Diobu, Port Harcourt. Same-day screen and battery repair with 30-day warranty. Call or WhatsApp 0803-XXX-XXXX."
4. **Business hours:** "Monâ€“Sat: 8 a.m.â€“6 p.m. Sun: Closed."
5. **Catalogue:** "I will add three items: Screen repair â€” â‚¦4,000â€“â‚¦7,000. Battery replacement â€” â‚¦2,500â€“â‚¦4,000. Phone case â€” â‚¦1,500â€“â‚¦3,000."
6. **Greeting message:** "Hello! Thank you for contacting FastFix Phone Repair. How can I help you today? Please describe your phone problem."
7. **Labels and broadcast list:** "I will create labels: New enquiry, Quoted, Paid, Completed. And a broadcast list: Happy customers."

Say: "Seven parts. A complete profile. A customer who finds this profile knows exactly what I do, where I am, and how to contact me. That is a digital shopfront."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€” plan seven days of free marketing (5 minutes)

Say: "Now the seven-day plan. Seven types of content â€” one for each day."

Fill in the plan template on the projector:

Day	Content	Example
Day 1	Real work photo	Photo of a repaired phone â€” "Screen repair â€” â‚¦6,500. Call or WhatsApp to book."
Day 2	Before and after	Cracked screen â†' new screen â€" "From broken to brand new. Same-day repair."
Day 3	Customer feedback	"Chidi fixed my screen in 2 hours. It looks brand new." â€" Mr. Obi
Day 4	Price list	"Screen repair â‚¦4,000â€“â‚¦7,000. Battery â‚¦2,500â€“â‚¦4,000. Charger â‚¦1,500â€–â‚¦3,000."
Day 5	Availability	"I am taking orders for this week. Call or WhatsApp to book."
Day 6	Behind the scenes	Photo of Chidi repairing a phone â€" "This is how I work. Care and precision."
Day 7	Offer or reminder	"10% off screen repairs this week. Call or WhatsApp to book."

Say: "Seven days. Seven types of content. One goal: be visible and build trust. This plan takes 30 minutes a week â€" and it works."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€” trust signals (2 minutes)

Say: "Last â€” trust signals. What makes a customer choose you over the competitor?"

List the six trust signals on the projector:

1. Consistent name and logo
2. Fast replies
3. Honest descriptions
4. Real photos of real work
5. Real customer feedback
6. No fake testimonials

Say: "Six signals. A business with all six is trusted. A business with none is invisible â€” no matter how good the work."

G.5 Questions to ask during the demo

- "What are the seven parts of a WhatsApp Business profile?" (Profile photo, business name, description, hours, catalogue, greeting, labels.)
- "Why choose one social platform?" (One platform done well beats five done poorly.)
- "What are the six trust signals?" (Consistent name/logo, fast replies, honest descriptions, real photos, real feedback, no fake testimonials.)
- "What are the seven days of marketing?" (Real work, before/after, feedback, price list, availability, behind the scenes, offer.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner sets up a WhatsApp Business profile (or completes the checklist on paper) and writes a seven-day free marketing plan.

Starting materials: A smartphone with WhatsApp (or a paper checklist); the WhatsApp Business setup checklist and seven-day marketing plan template (projected and printed).

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name and today's date at the top of your workbook or notes app.
2. **Set up WhatsApp Business:** If you have a smartphone, download WhatsApp Business and set up your profile. If not, complete the checklist on paper. (Worksheet 8.1.)
3. **Profile photo:** Choose a photo â€” of you, your logo, or your work.
4. **Business name and description:** Write your business name and a clear description â€” what you do, where you are, what makes you different.
5. **Business hours:** Write your hours.
6. **Catalogue:** Add at least three items with photos, prices and descriptions.
7. **Greeting message:** Write your greeting message.
8. **Labels:** Create labels â€” new, quoted, paid, completed.
9. **Pause and predict:** Ask yourself: "If a customer found this profile, would they know what I do, where I am, and how to contact me?"
10. **Write the seven-day marketing plan:** Fill in the template (Worksheet 8.5) â€” one type of content for each day.
11. **Share:** Show your profile and plan to your partner. Ask: "Is this complete? Is it clear? Would you trust this business?"
12. **Revise:** Based on your partner's feedback, revise if needed.

Expected result: A complete WhatsApp Business profile (or checklist) and a seven-day marketing plan.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 9: "Would a customer know what you do, where you are, and how to contact you?"
- After step 11: "Would you trust this business? What is missing?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner's description is vague â†’ Ask: "What do you do? Where are you? What makes you different?"

- Learner's catalogue has no prices â†’ Ask: "What do you charge for each item?"
- Learner's plan is random â†’ Ask: "What is the goal of each day? Is it clear?"
- Learner cannot set up WhatsApp Business â†’ Help them complete the checklist on paper.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Profile photo chosen
- ☐ Business name and description written
- ☐ Business hours written
- ☐ Catalogue with at least three items
- ☐ Greeting message written
- ☐ Labels created
- ☐ Seven-day marketing plan written
- ☐ Profile and plan shared with a partner and revised

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Write a **Google Business Profile step list** and a **trust-building action plan** for a fictional business.

Scenario. *Mama Chika* sells jollof rice and small chops from her home in Port Harcourt. She has a WhatsApp Business profile â€" but she does not have a Google Business Profile, and she has not thought about trust-building. She wants to be found when someone searches "food seller near me" on Google.

Requirements:

1. **Google Business Profile steps:** Write the steps Mama Chika should follow to create a Google Business Profile â€" in order, in simple English. (Worksheet 8.2.)
2. **Trust-building action plan:** Write six specific actions Mama Chika can take to build trust online â€" based on the six trust signals. (Worksheet 8.4.)
3. **Choose one platform:** Which social platform should Mama Chika choose â€" and why? (Worksheet 8.3.)
4. **Write one sentence:** "Mama Chika's biggest visibility risk is _____, and she can manage it by _____."

Constraints:

- Write in simple English â€" Mama Chika is not a marketing expert.
- The steps must be in order and specific.
- The trust-building actions must be realistic for a food seller.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Google Business Profile steps are in order and specific.
- Six trust-building actions are realistic.
- Platform choice is justified.
- Risk sentence is realistic.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For the Google Business Profile steps, use the ten steps from Section F.3 â€" but write them as instructions for Mama Chika.
- Hint 2: For the trust-building actions, think of the six trust signals â€" and what Mama Chika can do for each.
- Hint 3: For the platform, think: where are Mama Chika's customers? What content can she create easily?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Google Business Profile steps (model â€" in order, simple English):

1. Go to Google Business Profile â€" search "Google Business Profile" on Google, or go to business.google.com.
2. Sign in with your Gmail account.
3. Enter your business name â€" "Mama Chika's Kitchen".

4. Choose your business category â€" "Food seller" or "Restaurant".
5. Add your location â€" your home address, or the area you serve.
6. Add your contact information â€" phone number and WhatsApp link.
7. Add your business hours â€" when you are open.
8. Add photos â€" photos of your food, your workspace, and your packaging.
9. Verify your business â€" Google will send a verification code. Enter it to confirm you are real.
10. Keep it updated â€" update your hours, photos, and offers regularly.

Trust-building action plan (model â€" six actions):

1. **Consistent name and logo:** Use "Mama Chika's Kitchen" with the same simple logo on WhatsApp Business, Google Business Profile, and social media.
2. **Fast replies:** Reply to every WhatsApp message within 15 minutes â€" even if it is "I will get back to you in one hour."
3. **Honest descriptions:** Describe your food honestly â€" "Fresh jollof rice, cooked daily, â¦1,500 a plate." Do not promise what you cannot deliver.
4. **Real photos of real work:** Take real photos of your actual food â€" not stock photos. Post them on WhatsApp status and social media.
5. **Real customer feedback:** Ask happy customers for a testimonial â€" and share it (with permission). "Mama Chika's jollof is the best in PH." â€" a real customer.
6. **No fake testimonials:** Never invent testimonials. Real work builds real trust.

Platform choice (model): Mama Chika should choose **Instagram** â€" because her customers (office workers, students) are on Instagram, and she can easily take photos of her food. She should post 3â€"4 times a week â€" real photos, clear prices, and a clear call to action.

Risk sentence (model): "Mama Chika's biggest visibility risk is inconsistency â€" she posts for one week and then disappears for a month. She can manage it by planning seven days of content every week and posting at the same time each day."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Google Business Profile steps in order and specific (3)
- Six trust-building actions realistic (3)
- Platform choice justified (2)
- Risk sentence realistic (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Blessing* is a hairdresser in Port Harcourt. She works from a small salon near a busy junction. She is good at her work â€" her customers are happy. But she has a problem: new customers do not know she exists. She has a personal Facebook page she rarely updates. She has no WhatsApp Business profile. She has no Google Business Profile. When someone searches "hairdresser near me" on Google, Blessing does not appear. She relies entirely on walk-in customers and word of mouth â€" and business is slow.

Relevant facts.

- Blessing has been a hairdresser for five years â€" she is skilled.
- She charges â¦3,000â€"â¦8,000 per style â€" a fair price.
- She has a smartphone and uses WhatsApp personally.
- She has about 200 contacts on her phone â€" mostly customers and friends.
- She has never posted her work on social media â€" she feels shy.

Decision point. What is Blessing's real problem?

Possible approaches.

1. Lower her prices â€" "maybe I am too expensive."
2. Move to a bigger salon â€" "maybe my location is the problem."
3. Build a digital presence: WhatsApp Business, Google Business Profile, one social platform, regular posts.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Blessing's problem is not her skill, her price, or her location â€" it is that she is invisible. A hairdresser with a complete WhatsApp Business profile, a Google Business Profile, and regular Instagram posts â€" that hairdresser gets found. And getting found is free.

Reasoning / example actions for Blessing:

- **WhatsApp Business:** Set up a profile â€" photo of her work, description, hours, catalogue of styles with prices, greeting message.
- **Google Business Profile:** Create a profile â€" so she appears when someone searches "hairdresser near me."
- **Instagram:** Choose Instagram â€" her customers are there, and she can post photos of her work. Post 3â€"4 times a week â€" real photos, clear prices, clear call to action.
- **Trust-building:** Ask happy customers for testimonials â€" and share them. Reply to every message fast. Use a consistent name and logo.
- **Seven-day plan:** Day 1 â€" a photo of a recent style. Day 2 â€" before and after. Day 3 â€" a customer testimonial. Day 4 â€" a price list. Day 5 â€" availability. Day 6 â€" behind the scenes (her workspace). Day 7 â€" a special offer.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (lower prices) reduces her income without increasing customers.
- Approach 2 (move to a bigger salon) costs money and does not solve the real problem.
- Approach 3 (build a digital presence) costs nothing but time â€" and it solves the real problem.

Professional connection. The difference between a busy hairdresser and an empty hairdresser is not talent â€" it is **visibility**. A hairdresser who is findable and trusted gets customers; a hairdresser who is invisible does not â€" no matter how skilled. Digital presence is not a luxury â€" it is a necessity.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 No WhatsApp Business profile

Symptoms: The learner uses personal WhatsApp for business â€" no profile, no catalogue, no greeting. **Likely cause:** They do not know WhatsApp Business exists â€" or they think it is only for big companies. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Do you have a WhatsApp Business profile? What does it say about your business?" **Corrective steps:** Download WhatsApp Business and set up a complete profile â€" seven parts. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner has a complete WhatsApp Business profile. **Prevention:** WhatsApp Business is free and essential â€" set it up from day one.

K.2 No Google Business Profile

Symptoms: The learner does not appear when someone searches "near me" on Google. **Likely cause:** They do not have a Google Business Profile. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Search your business name on Google. Do you appear?" **Corrective steps:** Create a Google Business Profile â€" ten steps, verify it, keep it updated. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner appears in Google searches. **Prevention:** Google Business Profile is free â€" create it and keep it updated.

K.3 Being on every platform â€" poorly

Symptoms: The learner has five social media profiles â€" all inactive or inconsistent. **Likely cause:** They think they need to be everywhere â€" so they are nowhere. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Which platform do you post on regularly? When did you last post?" **Corrective steps:** Choose one platform â€" and do it well. Post 3â€"4 times a week. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner has one active platform. **Prevention:** One platform done well beats five done poorly.

K.4 Fake testimonials

Symptoms: The learner has testimonials that sound fake â€" or they are. **Likely cause:** They think testimonials must be impressive â€" so they invent them. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Are these testimonials real? Can the customer confirm them?" **Corrective steps:** Remove fake testimonials. Ask real customers for real feedback. **How to confirm resolved:** All testimonials are real and confirmed. **Prevention:** A fake testimonial is a lie â€" and lies are always discovered. Real work builds real trust.

K.5 Inconsistent name and logo

Symptoms: The learner uses different names on different platforms â€” customers are confused. **Likely cause:** They have not chosen a consistent brand identity. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What is your business name? Is it the same on WhatsApp, Google and social media?" **Corrective steps:** Choose one name and one logo â€” and use them everywhere. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner uses a consistent name and logo. **Prevention:** A consistent name and logo build recognition â€” choose them and stick to them.

K.6 No regular posting

Symptoms: The learner posts once a month â€” or less. They are forgotten. **Likely cause:** They do not have a plan â€” so they post randomly. **How to investigate:** Ask: "When did you last post? What did you post?" **Corrective steps:** Use the seven-day plan â€” one type of content for each day. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner has a seven-day plan and posts regularly. **Prevention:** Marketing is a habit â€” plan seven days, post consistently.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it with the learner â€” ask them the investigation question and listen to the answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Be Findable â€” WhatsApp Business Profile and Seven-Day Marketing Plan"

Purpose: To practise setting up a complete WhatsApp Business profile and planning seven days of free marketing â€” the skills that make you findable and trusted â€” and to build the profile and plan that will feed the capstone pack.

Realistic scenario. You have a business, a price, and a way to get paid. This week, you will set up your digital presence: a complete WhatsApp Business profile and a seven-day free marketing plan.

Detailed instructions:

1. **Set up WhatsApp Business:** Download WhatsApp Business and set up your profile â€” all seven parts. (Worksheet 8.1.) If you cannot set up the app in class, complete the checklist on paper.
2. **Write the Google Business Profile steps:** Write the steps to create a Google Business Profile â€” in order, in simple English. (Worksheet 8.2.)
3. **Choose one platform:** Choose one social platform â€” and explain why. (Worksheet 8.3.)
4. **Trust-building action plan:** Write six specific actions you will take to build trust online. (Worksheet 8.4.)
5. **Seven-day marketing plan:** Write a seven-day plan â€” one type of content for each day. (Worksheet 8.5.)
6. **Reflection:** Write 3â€“5 sentences: "What I learned about visibility this week is _____. What I will do differently is _____."

Required deliverables:

- A complete WhatsApp Business profile (or checklist).
- A Google Business Profile step list.
- A platform choice with reasons.
- A trust-building action plan.
- A seven-day marketing plan.
- A short reflection.

Submission format: Save as a Google Doc (or a clear photo of handwritten work) and upload to your Drive folder `CEA-Biz-YourName`, or show it to the instructor at the start of Session 9. You may also copy the text into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 9.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
WhatsApp Business profile	5	All seven parts, complete and clear
Google Business Profile steps	3	In order, specific, simple English
Platform choice	2	Chosen with reasons
Trust-building action plan	4	Six specific, realistic actions

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Seven-day marketing plan	4	Seven days, clear content, realistic
Reflection	2	Honest and specific

Common mistakes to avoid: no WhatsApp Business profile; no Google Business Profile; being on every platform poorly; fake testimonials; inconsistent name and logo; no regular posting.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

WhatsApp Business profile (model â€" for a fictional "Adaeze's Sewing"):

- Profile photo: A photo of Adaeze sewing, or a simple logo with "Adaeze's Sewing".
- Business name: "Adaeze's Sewing".
- Description: "Custom dresses, skirts and blouses for women in Port Harcourt. Quality fabric, perfect fit, 7-day fitting guarantee. Call or WhatsApp 0803-XXX-XXXX."
- Business hours: "Monâ€"Sat: 9 a.m.â€"6 p.m. Sun: Closed."
- Catalogue: (1) Custom dress â€" â‚¦8,000â€"â‚¦15,000. (2) Skirt and blouse â€" â‚¦5,000â€"â‚¦8,000. (3) Alterations â€" â‚¦1,000â€"â‚¦3,000.
- Greeting message: "Hello! Thank you for contacting Adaeze's Sewing. What would you like me to sew for you today?"
- Labels: New enquiry, Quoted, Paid, Completed.

Google Business Profile steps (model): (Same as the model in Section I â€" ten steps, in order, simple English.)

Platform choice (model): Adaeze should choose **Instagram** â€" because her customers (working women) are on Instagram, and she can easily take photos of her work. She should post 3â€"4 times a week.

Trust-building action plan (model):

1. Consistent name and logo â€" "Adaeze's Sewing" with the same logo everywhere.
2. Fast replies â€" reply to every message within 15 minutes.
3. Honest descriptions â€" "Custom dress, 7-day fitting guarantee" â€" and deliver exactly that.
4. Real photos â€" photos of actual dresses she has sewn.
5. Real feedback â€" ask happy customers for testimonials and share them.
6. No fake testimonials â€" never invent feedback.

Seven-day marketing plan (model):

Day	Content
Day 1	Photo of a recent dress â€" "Custom dress â€" â‚¦10,000. Call or WhatsApp to order."
Day 2	Before and after â€" fabric â†' finished dress.
Day 3	Customer testimonial â€" "Adaeze sewed my wedding dress. It was perfect." â€" a real customer.
Day 4	Price list â€" "Dress â‚¦8,000â€"â‚¦15,000. Skirt and blouse â‚¦5,000â€"â‚¦8,000."
Day 5	Availability â€" "I am taking orders for this week. Call or WhatsApp to book."
Day 6	Behind the scenes â€" photo of Adaeze sewing.
Day 7	Offer â€" "10% off alterations this week."

Reflection (model): "What I learned about visibility this week is that being found is not about adverts â€" it is about being complete and consistent. What I will do differently is to set up my WhatsApp Business profile, create a Google Business Profile, and post on Instagram three times a week."

A strong learner solution differs in content but ticks every rubric row.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What are the seven parts of a complete WhatsApp Business profile?

Q2. Multiple choice. Why should a small business choose one social platform instead of being on every platform? a) Because it is cheaper b) Because one platform done well beats five done poorly c) Because other platforms are not useful d) Because it is easier to get followers

Q3. Matching. Match each trust signal to what it is: (1) consistent name and logo, (2) fast replies, (3) honest descriptions, (4) real photos. a) Describing your work honestly â€" not promising what you cannot deliver b) Using the same name and logo on every platform c) Responding to messages within minutes d) Using real photos of your actual work

Q4. True or false. "Fake testimonials are a good way to build trust quickly."

Q5. Explain. What are the steps to create a Google Business Profile?

Q6. Practical. Write the seven days of a free marketing plan â€" one type of content for each day.

Q7. Scenario. Your friend has a business but no digital presence. She says "I do not need all that â€" my customers come from word of mouth." What would you tell her?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q7)

A1. The seven parts: profile photo or logo, business name, description, business hours, catalogue (at least three items), greeting message, customer labels and broadcast lists.

A2. (b) Because one platform done well beats five done poorly.

A3. (1) = b, (2) = c, (3) = a, (4) = d.

A4. False. Fake testimonials are a lie â€" and lies are always discovered. When discovered, they destroy your reputation permanently. Real work builds real trust.

A5. The steps: (1) Go to Google Business Profile (business.google.com). (2) Sign in with your Gmail account. (3) Enter your business name. (4) Choose your business category. (5) Add your location or service area. (6) Add your contact information. (7) Add your business hours. (8) Add photos. (9) Verify your business. (10) Keep it updated.

A6. The seven days: (1) Real work photo, (2) Before and after, (3) Customer feedback, (4) Price list, (5) Availability, (6) Behind the scenes, (7) Offer or reminder.

A7. Word of mouth is good â€" but it is not enough. Customers now search Google, check WhatsApp, and look at social media before they buy. If you are not findable, you are invisible to new customers â€" even if your current customers are happy. A complete WhatsApp Business profile, a Google Business Profile, and a regular social media presence â€" these are free and they make you findable. Word of mouth plus digital presence is the strongest combination.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that being found online matters â€" and that it is free. You learned to set up a complete WhatsApp Business profile: profile photo, business name, description, hours, catalogue, greeting message, labels. You learned the steps to create a Google Business Profile â€" so you appear when someone searches "near me". You learned to choose one social platform and do it well â€" one platform done well beats five done poorly. You learned to build trust with six signals: consistent name and logo, fast replies, honest descriptions, real photos, real feedback, no fake testimonials. And you learned to plan seven days of free marketing: real work, before/after, feedback, price list, availability, behind the scenes, offer.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Being found is free** â€" WhatsApp Business, Google Business Profile, and social media are all free.
2. **WhatsApp Business** is your digital shopfront â€" seven parts, complete and clear.
3. **Google Business Profile** makes you appear in "near me" searches â€" create it, verify it, keep it updated.
4. **One platform done well** beats five done poorly.
5. **Trust is built** with consistent signals â€" not fake testimonials.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I set up a complete WhatsApp Business profile?

- Can I describe the steps to create a Google Business Profile?
- Can I choose one social platform and justify it?
- Can I name the six trust signals?
- Can I plan seven days of free marketing?

Connection to the next session. You now have everything: a validated offer, a price, a way to get paid, a way to manage clients, and a way to be found. Next session is the capstone: you will assemble everything into a one-page business and freelance plan, deliver a 60-second pitch, and answer questions about your plan. This is where it all comes together â€” and where you prove you are ready.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner sets up a complete WhatsApp Business profile â€” all seven parts.
- Learner describes the Google Business Profile steps in order.
- Learner chooses one platform and justifies it.
- Learner names the six trust signals and applies them.
- Learner writes a seven-day marketing plan with clear content.
- Learner uses a consistent name and logo.
- Learner never uses fake testimonials.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "I need to pay for adverts to be found." â†' Being found is free â€ WhatsApp Business, Google Business Profile, and social media are all free.
- "WhatsApp Business is only for big companies." â†' It is for any business that wants to be findable and professional.
- "I need to be on every platform." â†' One platform done well beats five done poorly.
- "Fake testimonials build trust." â†' Fake testimonials destroy trust when discovered â€ real work builds real trust.
- "Marketing is posting random photos." â†' Marketing is a plan â€ seven days, seven types of content.
- "I do not need a Google Business Profile." â†' Without it, you do not appear in "near me" searches.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Profile completion:** give a partially completed WhatsApp Business profile and ask the learner to fill in the missing parts â€ then check against the seven parts.
2. **Platform choice practice:** give three business scenarios and ask the learner to choose one platform for each â€ and explain why.
3. **Trust signal matching:** give six trust signals and six actions â€ ask the learner to match them.
4. **Seven-day plan practice:** give a business and ask the learner to write a seven-day plan â€ then check for clarity and realism.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed WhatsApp Business profile (photo, name, description already filled); learner adds the rest. Provide a seven-day plan template with prompts.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€ full profile, Google steps, platform choice, trust plan, seven-day plan.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to write a **monthly marketing calendar** â€ four weeks of content, with a theme for each week (e.g., Week 1: real work, Week 2: customer feedback, Week 3: offers, Week 4: behind the scenes). Also ask them to write a **response plan** for a negative comment or review â€ how they would handle it professionally.

Capstone links. This session's WhatsApp Business profile and seven-day marketing plan become the "how customers find us" section of the capstone. The Google Business Profile steps become part of the plan's visibility strategy. The trust-building actions become part of the plan's marketing approach. In Session 9, the learner will show that their plan is not just a document â€ it is a business that is findable, trusted, and ready to serve customers.

Timing guidance. The priority is learners setting up a WhatsApp Business profile and writing a seven-day marketing plan (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten Section F.5 (trust-building) to the four most important signals (consistent name, fast replies, honest descriptions, real photos), and limit the independent exercise to the Google steps and

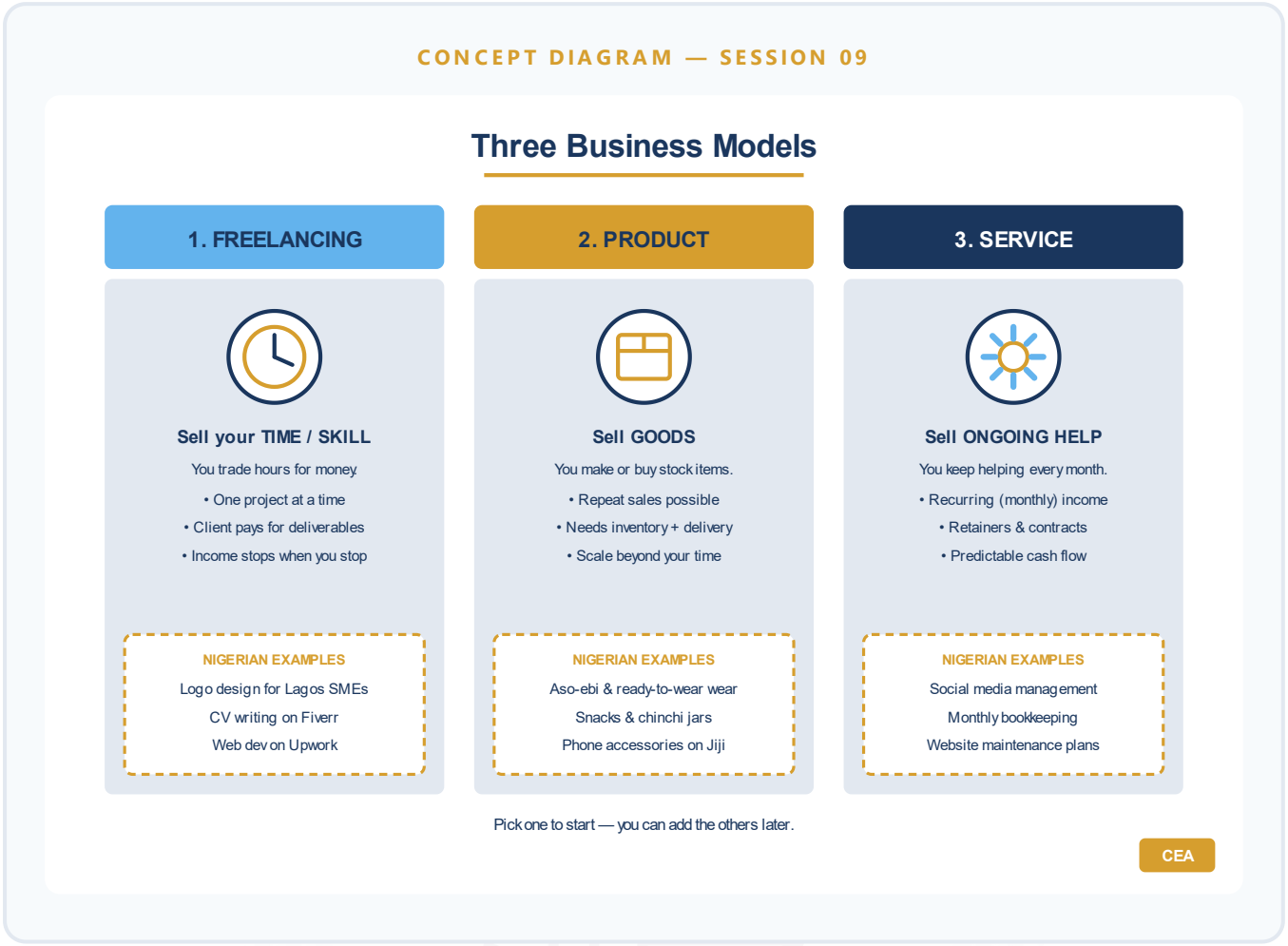
platform choice. Protect the profile setup time â€" a learner who leaves without a complete WhatsApp Business profile is not findable.

END OF SESSION 8

Next: Session 9 â€" Capstone: Your Business and Freelance Plan.

SESSION 09 OF 9

Capstone Your Business and Freelance Plan



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" BUSINESS & FREELANCING

SESSION 9 â€" CAPSTONE: YOUR BUSINESS AND FREELANCE PLAN

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	9 of 9
Session title	Capstone: Your Business and Freelance Plan
Week / Module	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Run and Grow
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (assembly and presentation, not new theory)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"8 completed: offer sheet, validation notes, money rules, costed price list, pitch script, client agreement, sample invoice, tracker, WhatsApp Business profile, seven-day

Item	Detail
	marketing plan. Learners must bring their working folder (Google Drive or printed pack).
Connection to previous work	In Session 8 you built your free digital presence â€" WhatsApp Business profile, Google Business Profile steps, and a seven-day marketing plan. Today you stop collecting pieces and **assemble the machine**: every document from Sessions 1â€"8 becomes one page of decisions, one financial snapshot, and one spoken pitch. This is the session the whole course has been building toward.
Preparation before class	Print the one-page plan canvas (Section F.4) for each learner; print the capstone checklist (Section H); prepare the projector with the FastFix finished plan as a model; have the FastFix case pack ready; bring a timer for pitch rehearsals; prepare a simple peer-feedback form (two stars and a wish).

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Assemble** a one-page business and freelance plan from the artefacts produced in Sessions 1â€"8, with every section filled and internally consistent.
2. **Build a simple financial snapshot** â€" launch costs, monthly fixed costs, unit price, break-even and a first-month revenue target â€" with correct arithmetic in naira.
3. **Deliver a 60-second pitch** and a 3â€"4 minute talk that explains the plan, then **defend key decisions** (price, validation, break-even, first seven days) under questioning.
4. **Check internal consistency** across the plan, price list and financial snapshot so the numbers match everywhere they appear.
5. **Give and receive structured peer feedback** using a simple two-stars-and-a-wish format.
6. **State honest limits** â€" three things the plan has not yet proven and what will be done next to test them.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with Google Docs/Sheets) or an academy computer.
- Instructor device connected to the projector.
- Timer (phone timer is fine) for pitch rehearsals and presentations.

Software

- Google Docs â€" the one-page plan canvas and pitch script.
- Google Sheets â€" the financial snapshot.
- Google Drive â€" each learner's working folder (`CEA-Biz-FirstnameLastname`).
- WhatsApp Business â€" for reference during the "how customers find us" section.

Sample files

- Printed **one-page plan canvas** (Section F.4) â€" one per learner.
- Printed **capstone checklist** (Section H) â€" one per learner.
- Printed **peer-feedback form** (two stars and a wish) â€" one per learner.
- The **FastFix finished plan** on the projector as a live model.
- The **FastFix case pack** â€" job log, competitor price list, customer messages, late-payment conversation.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 9.1 â€" "Financial Snapshot Builder" (launch costs, fixed costs, unit price, break-even, first-month target).
- Worksheet 9.2 â€" "Pitch and Defence Prep" (60-second pitch skeleton + four likely questions with answer frames).

Accounts

- Each learner's free Gmail account (from Session 1).
- Each learner's WhatsApp Business account (from Session 8).

Internet

- Not required for the assembly work. Useful if learners want to verify a figure live, but all needed data is already in their folders.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- A learner who cannot type may dictate sections to a classmate or the instructor, or write by hand and photograph the page. The skill is the **thinking and assembling**, not the typing.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two versions of the same business idea side by side. Do not label them yet.

- **Version A (scattered):** A desk with eight separate papers â€" an offer sheet, a price list, a pitch script, an agreement, an invoice, a tracker, a WhatsApp screenshot, a marketing plan. Each paper is good on its own. Nothing connects them.
- **Version B (assembled):** The same eight documents, but now arranged around a single one-page plan in the centre. Arrows show how each document feeds one section of the plan. The financial snapshot sits below the plan. The pitch script sits to the right.

What the instructor says:

> *"Version A is where most people stop. They have good pieces â€" a price list here, a pitch there â€" but the pieces do not talk to each other. A customer asks 'how much?' and the answer is on one paper. A mentor asks 'how will you find customers?' and the answer is on another. Version B is what you are building today: **one page that holds the whole business**, with every piece in its place. By the end of this session, you will have Version B for your own business."*

Ask for a show of hands: "Which version would you show to a mentor, a bank, or a customer?" The class will choose Version B.

Then reveal the hook: "The difference between A and B is not more work â€" it is **assembly**. You already did the work in Sessions 1â€"8. Today you put it together, you check that the numbers match, and you learn to explain it out loud. That is what a real business plan is: not a 40-page document nobody reads, but **one page of decisions you can defend**."

Why this opener works: It shows the destination before the journey, uses the learners' own artefacts (not a stranger's example), and frames the session as assembly rather than new learning â€" which reduces anxiety and focuses attention on the task.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector. Point to the relevant section of the Version B diagram as each answer comes.

Question 1: "What are the seven sections of the one-page plan canvas?"

- Expected answer: **Who we serve / The problem / What we sell / How we price / How customers find us / What it costs us / First-month target and next 30 days.**
- Common gap: learners name the documents (price list, invoice) instead of the plan sections. Clarify: the canvas sections are **decisions**, not documents. The documents are the evidence behind each decision.

Question 2: "What is break-even, and how do you calculate it?"

- Expected answer: **Fixed costs Ã· (unit price â^' variable cost per unit) = number of units to break even.** Or in service terms: fixed costs Ã· profit per job = number of jobs to break even.
- Common gap: learners confuse break-even with profit. Clarify: break-even is the point where **total revenue equals total cost** â€" you have not lost money, but you have not made profit yet. Every sale after break-even is profit.

Question 3: "What are the four parts of a 60-second pitch?"

- Expected answer: **Who you serve / the problem they have / what you do about it / what happens next (the ask or the next step).**
- Common gap: learners describe the pitch as "introducing yourself." Clarify: the pitch is not a biography â€" it is a **problem-solution-ask** in sixty seconds.

Question 4: "What three things must every invoice contain?"

- Expected answer: **Business name and contact / description of the job or item / amount in naira with payment details and terms.** (Also acceptable: date, invoice number, payment terms.)
- Common gap: learners forget payment terms. Clarify: an invoice without payment terms is a request, not a business document â€" the customer needs to know **how and when** to pay.

Question 5: "What is the honest-limits note, and why does the capstone require it?"

- Expected answer: **Three things the plan has not yet proven, and what you will do next to test them.** It is required because a plan that claims to know everything is a plan that cannot be trusted. Honesty about limits is a sign of a real businessperson, not a weakness.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have spent eight sessions building the pieces. You have an offer, a price, a pitch, an agreement, an invoice, a tracker, a profile and a marketing plan. Today you put them on one page, you check that the numbers agree with each other, and you stand up and explain your business to the room. That is what business owners do â€" not once, but every time someone asks 'what do you do?' or 'how much do you charge?' or 'how will this work?' Let us build."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the seven canvas sections, spend 3 extra minutes writing them on the board with one-line descriptions before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What a one-page business plan is

The idea. A **one-page business plan** is a single sheet â€" physical or digital â€" that holds the most important decisions about a business in one place. It is not a summary of a longer plan; it **is** the plan. Every section is a decision you have made, written down clearly enough that a stranger can read it and understand the business in two minutes.

Plain-English definition. A one-page business plan is **your business on one sheet of paper**: who you serve, what problem you solve, what you sell, how you price it, how customers find you, what it costs you, and what you will do in the first month. If a section is blank, the plan is not finished â€" it is a to-do list.

Why one page. A 40-page plan is written for a bank or an investor, and most small businesses never need one. A one-page plan is written for **you** â€" the owner â€" so you always know what you decided and why. It is also the document you show a mentor, a partner, or a customer who asks "how does this work?" One page forces you to make decisions. A blank space on a one-page plan is a decision you have avoided.

What it is not. It is not a certificate, a licence, or a guarantee of success. It is a **thinking tool** â€" a way of checking that your offer, your price, your costs and your marketing all point in the same direction. If they do not, the one-page plan shows you where the mismatch is.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **market trader in Port Harcourt** who has been selling for ten years. She has no written plan, but she has a plan in her head: "I sell rice to the women in this market. I buy from the same supplier every Monday. I charge â‚¦2,000 more than the shop next door because I sell by the cup, not the bag. I restock when I have â‚¦50,000 in the box." That is a one-page plan â€" it just lives in her memory instead of on paper. Writing it down means you can check it, change it, and show it to someone else.

How a learner recognises a finished plan. Read the page and ask: Could a stranger understand the business in two minutes? Does every section have a real answer (not "TBD")? Do the numbers in the price list match the numbers in the financial snapshot? If yes to all three, the plan is finished.

F.2 The seven sections of the canvas â€" what goes in each

The CEA one-page plan canvas has seven sections. Each section is a decision, and each decision is backed by a document the learner already has. Here is what goes in each section and where it comes from.

Section	The decision	Backing document
1. Who we serve	The specific customer â€" not "everybody"	Offer Sheet (S1), Validation Notes (S2)
2. The problem	The customer's pain in one sentence	Validation Notes (S2)
3. What we sell	The offer â€" deliverable, not just a skill	Offer Sheet (S1)
4. How we price	The pricing model and the price range	Costed Price List (S4)
5. How customers find us	The marketing channel and the first action	WhatsApp Business Profile + 7-Day Plan (S8)
6. What it costs us	Launch costs, fixed costs, break-even	Financial Snapshot (S4, S7)
7. First-month target and next 30 days	The revenue target and the action list	Tracker (S7), Marketing Plan (S8)

Section 1 â€" Who we serve. This is the customer you chose in Session 2 and validated in the same session. It must be specific: "phone owners in Diobu and Trans-Amadi who need same-day repair" â€" not "everyone with a phone." If the learner validated with three customer conversations, the answer to "who we serve" is the person who actually said "yes, I have this problem and I would pay for it."

Section 2 â€" The problem. One sentence, in the customer's own words if possible. "My phone screen breaks and I cannot afford to replace the phone" is a real problem. "People need phones" is not a problem â€" it is a fact. The problem sentence should make the reader feel the pain.

Section 3 â€" What we sell. The deliverable, not the skill. "Phone screen replacement with a 30-day warranty" is a deliverable. "Phone repair" is a skill. The deliverable includes what the customer receives, how long it takes, and what guarantee comes with it.

Section 4 â€" How we price. The pricing model (per job, per hour, or package) and the price range from the costed price list. This section should name the model and give the starting price â€" not the whole price list, which lives in the supporting pack.

Section 5 â€" How customers find us. The primary channel (WhatsApp Business, word of mouth, Google Business Profile, or one social platform) and the first action the learner will take. "Post the catalogue on WhatsApp Business and send a broadcast to 20 contacts" is an action. "Use social media" is not.

Section 6 â€" What it costs us. The financial snapshot in miniature: launch costs, monthly fixed costs, and the break-even number. The full snapshot lives in the supporting pack; the plan holds the headline numbers.

Section 7 â€" First-month target and next 30 days. A revenue target in naira (not "as much as possible") and a short list of actions for the first seven days. The target should be realistic for a Port Harcourt beginner â€" not a wish. The actions should be specific: "Day 1: set up WhatsApp Business catalogue. Day 2: message 20 contacts. Day 3: post first status."

Common misconception. Learners think the plan is a creative writing exercise. It is not. Every sentence in the plan is a **decision** â€" something you have chosen and will act on. If a sentence could be removed without changing what you do on Monday morning, it does not belong on the plan.

F.3 The financial snapshot â€" the numbers that must agree

The idea. The **financial snapshot** is a small Google Sheet that holds the money side of the plan in one place: what it costs to launch, what it costs to run each month, what you charge, how many jobs or sales you need to break even, and what you aim to earn in the first month. It is the section most learners avoid â€" and the section that most often reveals a problem.

Why it matters. A plan without numbers is a story. A plan with numbers is a business. The financial snapshot is where you discover that your price is too low, your break-even is too high, or your first-month target is fantasy. Better to discover it on paper than in the market.

The five numbers every snapshot must hold:

Number	What it is	How to get it
Launch costs	One-time costs to start â€" tools, registration, initial stock, branding	Add up every one-time cost from the costed price list and the offer sheet
Monthly fixed costs	Costs that happen every month whether you sell or not â€" rent share, data, transport, phone credit	Add up the monthly overhead from the costed price list
Unit price	What you charge for one job or one item	From the costed price list
Variable cost per unit	What one job or one item costs you â€" materials, data, transport per job	From the costed price list
Break-even	How many jobs or sales you need to cover fixed costs	Fixed costs Ã· (unit price â^' variable cost per unit)

Worked example â€" FastFix Phone Repair:

- Launch costs: â‚¦15,000 (basic tools â‚¦8,000, CAC business name registration â€" verify current fee, initial stock of screens and chargers â‚¦5,000, Canva logo and flyer â‚¦0 free tier).
- Monthly fixed costs: â‚¦12,000 (market stall share â‚¦5,000, data and phone credit â‚¦3,000, transport â‚¦2,500, miscellaneous â‚¦1,500).
- Unit price (screen replacement): â‚¦8,000.
- Variable cost per screen replacement: â‚¦4,500 (screen â‚¦3,500, adhesive and materials â‚¦500, transport to market â‚¦500).
- Break-even: â‚¦12,000 Ã· (â‚¦8,000 â^' â‚¦4,500) = â‚¦12,000 Ã· â‚¦3,500 = **3.43 â†' 4 screen replacements per month** to break even.

Say this to the class: "Four screen replacements. That is one per week. If Chidi does one screen replacement a week, he covers his fixed costs. Every screen after that is profit. That is the whole business in one number."

First-month revenue target. This should be a realistic number based on the learner's own market. For FastFix: 10 screen replacements at â‚¦8,000 = â‚¦80,000 revenue, minus variable costs (10 Ã— â‚¦4,500 = â‚¦45,000) = â‚¦35,000 gross profit, minus fixed costs â‚¦12,000 = â‚¦23,000 net for the month. That is a realistic first month for a busy market stall â€" not a fantasy.

The consistency check. The numbers in the financial snapshot must match the numbers in the costed price list, which must match the numbers in the plan. If the price list says â‚¦8,000 and the snapshot says â‚¦6,000, the plan is broken. The instructor's job is to help learners find and fix these mismatches.

Common misconception. Learners think the financial snapshot is "accounting" and therefore too hard for them. It is not. It is five numbers and one division. If a learner can calculate change in a market, they can build a financial snapshot.

F.4 The one-page plan canvas â€" the actual template

This is the template learners will fill in. Print it. Project it. Write on it.

```
â•”â•â•â•
```

```
â•‘  5. HOW CUSTOMERS FIND US                                    â•‘
â•‘     (Primary channel + first action)                         â•‘
â•‘     _____________________________________________________    â•‘
â•‘                                                              â•‘
â•‘  6. WHAT IT COSTS US                                         â•‘
â•‘     (Launch costs â‚¦_____  |  Monthly fixed â‚¦_____  |        â•‘
â•‘      Break-even: _____ jobs/sales per month)                 â•‘
â•‘                                                              â•‘
â•‘  7. FIRST-MONTH TARGET AND NEXT 30 DAYS                      â•‘
â•‘     (Revenue target â‚¦_____  |  Key actions:                  â•‘
â•‘      Day 1: _____________________  Day 2: _____________      â•‘
â•‘      Day 3: _____________________  Day 4â€“7: _____________    â•‘
â•‘                                                              â•‘
â•‘  HONEST LIMITS â€” three things this plan has not yet proven:  â•‘
â•‘  1. _____________________  2. _____________________          â•‘
â•‘  3. _____________________                                    â•‘
â•‘                                                              â•‘
â•šâ•â•â•â
```

2. **"How did you validate that?"** â€" The answer comes from the validation notes. "I spoke to five phone owners in Diobu. Three said they had broken a screen in the last six months and paid between â‚¦6,000 and â‚¦12,000 to fix it. Two said they would use a same-day service if it came with a warranty."
3. **"What is your break-even?"** â€" The answer comes from the financial snapshot. "My fixed costs are â‚¦12,000 a month. I make â‚¦3,500 profit per screen replacement. So I need four screen replacements a month â€" one per week â€" to cover my costs."
4. **"What will you do in your first seven days?"** â€" The answer comes from the marketing plan and the next-30-days section. "Day 1: finish my WhatsApp Business catalogue. Day 2: message 20 contacts. Day 3: post my first status with a before-and-after photo. Day 4: ask my first customer for a testimonial. Day 5: post the testimonial. Day 6: review my numbers. Day 7: plan week two."

Say this to the class: "These four questions are not tricks. They are the questions every customer, every mentor, and every bank will ask. If you can answer them without looking at your notes, you know your business. If you cannot, you have more work to do â€" and that is fine. That is what this session is for."

Common misconception. Learners think the pitch is about being smooth or charismatic. It is not. A clear, honest, specific pitch beats a smooth, vague one every time. The goal is not to impress â€" it is to be **understood**.

F.6 Assembling the supporting pack â€" the evidence behind the plan

The idea. The one-page plan is the **decision**. The supporting pack is the **evidence**. The capstone requires at least three supporting documents from the list below. The plan says "I charge â‚¦8,000" â€" the pack shows the costed price list that proves it. The plan say "I validated with five customers" â€" the pack shows the validation notes with their actual words.

The supporting pack checklist:

Document	From session	What it proves
Costed price list	S4	The price is based on cost, not guesswork
Validation notes	S2	Real customers said they have the problem
One-page client agreement	S6	The learner can set scope professionally
Sample invoice	S7	The learner can bill properly
Income/expense tracker	S7	The learner can keep records
WhatsApp Business profile	S8	The learner can be found for free
Seven-day marketing plan	S8	The learner has a plan, not just an idea

The rule of three. The capstone requires **at least three** of these documents. But a strong plan has all seven â€" because every section of the plan is stronger when the evidence is in the pack. A plan that says "I charge â‚¦8,000" with a costed price list in the pack is more credible than the same plan with no price list.

How to assemble. The learner creates a folder in Google Drive called `CEA-Biz-FirstnameLastname-Capstone`. Inside, they place: the one-page plan (Google Doc), the financial snapshot (Google Sheet), and the supporting documents (already in their working folder from Sessions 1â€"8). They share the folder with the instructor. That is the submission.

Common misconception. Learners think the pack is a filing exercise. It is not. The pack is what makes the plan **believable**. A plan without evidence is a wish. A plan with evidence is a business.

F.7 Presenting and defending â€" the viva

The idea. The **viva** is the short talk and question-and-answer that follows the pitch. It is 3â€"4 minutes total: 60 seconds of pitch, 2â€"3 minutes of questions. The viva is not an exam â€" it is a **conversation about the learner's business**. The instructor is not trying to catch the learner out; the instructor is asking the questions a real customer or mentor would ask.

The structure of the viva:

Part	Time	What happens
Pitch	60 seconds	The learner delivers the pitch from memory or notes

Part	Time	What happens
Question 1: Price	1 minute	"Why this price?" â€" learner explains the costing
Question 2: Validation	1 minute	"How did you validate that?" â€" learner shares what customers said
Question 3: Break-even	1 minute	"What is your break-even?" â€" learner explains the maths
Question 4: First seven days	1 minute	"What will you do in your first seven days?" â€" learner lists the actions
Peer feedback	2 minutes	One classmate gives two stars and a wish

What the instructor listens for:

- **Clarity:** Can the learner explain the business in plain English without jargon?
- **Honesty:** Does the learner admit what they do not know? (This is a strength, not a weakness.)
- **Consistency:** Do the numbers in the pitch match the numbers in the plan and the snapshot?
- **Specificity:** Does the learner name real customers, real prices, real actions â€" or vague generalities?

What the instructor does not do:

- Do not interrupt the pitch unless it goes over 90 seconds.
- Do not ask questions the learner has not been told to expect.
- Do not mark the viva on charisma or confidence â€" mark it on clarity, honesty and consistency.

Common misconception. Learners think the viva is a test they can fail. It is not. The viva is a **rehearsal for the real conversations they will have with customers, mentors and partners**. The instructor's feedback is the same feedback they will get in the market â€" but in a safe room, where mistakes cost nothing.

F.8 Summary of the session

- A **one-page business plan** is the whole business on one sheet: seven sections, each a decision.
- The **financial snapshot** holds five numbers â€" launch costs, fixed costs, unit price, variable cost, break-even â€" and they must match the price list.
- The **pitch** is sixty seconds: who, problem, what, price, next step.
- The **defence** is four questions: why this price, how validated, what break-even, what first seven days.
- The **supporting pack** is the evidence â€" at least three documents from Sessions 1â€"8.
- The **viva** is a conversation, not an exam â€" clarity, honesty and consistency are what count.
- The **honest limits** section is the most important writing on the page â€" it shows the learner knows what they do not know.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[One-page business plan] --> E[Present & defend]
    B[Financial snapshot] --> E
    C[Elevator pitch] --> E
    D[Portfolio of work] --> E
    E --> F[CEA Certificate]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- On the projector: the blank one-page plan canvas (Section F.4).
- The FastFix case pack open â€" offer sheet, validation notes, costed price list, financial snapshot, pitch script.
- A Google Doc open for live assembly.
- A timer visible to the class.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€” assemble the plan live (6 minutes)

Say: "I am going to build the FastFix plan from the documents you have already seen. Watch where each answer comes from."

Fill the canvas on the projector, narrating each transfer:

1. **Who we serve:** "From the offer sheet â€” phone owners in Diobu and Trans-Amadi who need same-day repair. Not 'everyone with a phone.' The validation notes confirm this is the customer who actually said yes."
2. **The problem:** "From the validation notes, in the customer's words â€” 'My screen broke and I cannot afford a new phone.' That is the problem sentence."
3. **What we sell:** "From the offer sheet â€” screen and battery replacement, on the spot, with a 30-day warranty. That is the deliverable."
4. **How we price:** "From the costed price list â€” per job, starting at â‚¦8,000 for a screen replacement. The model is per job because each repair is different."
5. **How customers find us:** "From the marketing plan â€” WhatsApp Business first, then word of mouth. The first action is: message 20 contacts with the catalogue link."
6. **What it costs us:** "From the financial snapshot â€” launch â‚¦15,000, fixed â‚¦12,000 a month, break-even 4 screen replacements per month."
7. **First-month target:** "From the tracker and marketing plan â€” â‚¦80,000 revenue target, which is 10 screen replacements. Day 1: finish catalogue. Day 2: message 20 contacts. Day 3: post first status."

Say: "Every answer came from a document I already had. I did not write anything new. I transferred decisions onto one page. That is assembly."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€” build the financial snapshot live (4 minutes)

Open a blank Google Sheet on the projector. Build the snapshot step by step:

```
Row 1: LAUNCH COSTS
  Tools          â‚¦8,000
  CAC registration (verify current fee)  â‚¦10,000
  Initial stock  â‚¦5,000
  TOTAL LAUNCH   â‚¦23,000

Row 2: MONTHLY FIXED COSTS
  Market stall share  â‚¦5,000
  Data and phone      â‚¦3,000
  Transport           â‚¦2,500
  Miscellaneous       â‚¦1,500
  TOTAL FIXED         â‚¦12,000

Row 3: UNIT ECONOMICS
  Unit price (screen replacement)     â‚¦8,000
  Variable cost per unit               â‚¦4,500
  Profit per unit                      â‚¦3,500

Row 4: BREAK-EVEN
  Fixed costs Ã· profit per unit = 12,000 Ã· 3,500 = 3.43 â†’ 4 jobs/month

Row 5: FIRST-MONTH TARGET
  10 screen replacements Ã— â‚¦8,000 = â‚¦80,000 revenue
  Minus variable costs (10 Ã— â‚¦4,500) = â‚¦45,000
  Minus fixed costs = â‚¦12,000
  Net for month = â‚¦23,000
```

Say: "Five numbers. One division. That is the whole financial side of the business. If you can do this, you know more about your business than most market traders."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€” deliver the pitch and take questions (3 minutes)

Deliver the FastFix pitch from memory (55 seconds, from Section F.5). Then role-play the four vina questions with a confident learner or a teaching assistant playing the customer:

- "Why â‚¦8,000?" â€” Answer from the costed price list.
- "How do you know people want this?" â€” Answer from the validation notes.
- "How many jobs do you need to survive?" â€” Answer from the break-even.

- "What will you actually do next week?" â€” Answer from the marketing plan.

Say: "Notice I did not bluff. Every answer came from a document. That is what 'defending your plan' means â€” not arguing, but showing the evidence."

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€” the honest limits section (2 minutes)

Write three honest limits for FastFix on the projector:

1. "I have not yet proven that 20 contacts will message me back. I will test this in week one and adjust."
2. "I have not yet tested whether the 30-day warranty will cost me more than â‚¦500 per month. I will track warranty claims in the tracker."
3. "I have not yet confirmed the current CAC registration fee. I will check cac.gov.ng before I register."

Say: "These are not weaknesses. They are **the next three experiments**. A business plan is not a promise â€” it is a set of things you will test. The honest limits section shows you know which tests come next."

G.6 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Where did the 'who we serve' answer come from?" (The offer sheet and validation notes.)
- "What is the break-even number, and what does it mean in plain language?" (4 screen replacements a month â€” one per week.)
- "What happens if the learner cannot answer one of the four viva questions?" (They go back to the document and find the answer. The viva is a rehearsal, not a wall.)
- "Why is the honest limits section the most important?" (Because it shows the learner knows what they do not know â€” and has a plan to find out.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner assembles their one-page plan and financial snapshot from their own documents, then checks internal consistency.

Starting materials: The learner's working folder (Google Drive or printed pack) with all documents from Sessions 1â€“8; the printed one-page plan canvas; Worksheet 9.1 (Financial Snapshot Builder).

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Open your working folder. Take out your offer sheet, validation notes, costed price list, and financial snapshot (or the numbers from Sessions 4 and 7).
2. Fill in **Section 1 (Who we serve)** from your offer sheet. Write the specific customer â€” not "everybody."
3. Fill in **Section 2 (The problem)** from your validation notes. Use the customer's own words if you have them.
4. Fill in **Section 3 (What we sell)** from your offer sheet. Write the deliverable â€” what the customer receives.
5. Fill in **Section 4 (How we price)** from your costed price list. Name the pricing model and the starting price.
6. Fill in **Section 5 (How customers find us)** from your marketing plan. Name the primary channel and the first action.
7. Fill in **Section 6 (What it costs us)** from your financial snapshot. If you do not have a snapshot yet, build it now using Worksheet 9.1.
8. Fill in **Section 7 (First-month target and next 30 days)** from your tracker and marketing plan. Set a realistic revenue target and list the first seven days of actions.
9. Fill in the **Honest limits** section â€” three things your plan has not yet proven.
10. **The consistency check:** Read your plan aloud. Does the price in Section 4 match the price in your costed price list? Does the break-even in Section 6 match your financial snapshot? Does the first action in Section 5 match your marketing plan? Fix any mismatches.

Expected result: A complete one-page plan with all seven sections filled, a financial snapshot with correct arithmetic, and three honest limits.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 2: "Is your customer specific enough that you could point to them in a market?"
- After step 7: "What is your break-even number? Say it out loud. Does it feel achievable?"

- After step 10: "Find one number on your plan and trace it back to the document it came from. Can you do that for every number?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Section is blank â†' ask "which document has this answer?" and point to it.
- Price in plan does not match price list â†' ask "which one is correct?" and help them fix the mismatch.
- Break-even is a decimal â†' remind them to round up (3.43 means 4, because you cannot do 0.43 of a job).
- First-month target is vague ("as much as I can") â†' ask "how many jobs is that? At what price? Write the naira figure."
- Honest limits are vague ("I need to learn more") â†' ask "what specifically do not you know yet? What will you do to find out?"

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ All seven sections are filled â€" no blanks
- ☐ The customer is specific, not "everybody"
- ☐ The problem is one sentence, in the customer's words
- ☐ The deliverable is clear (what the customer receives)
- ☐ The price matches the costed price list
- ☐ The marketing channel and first action are named
- ☐ The financial snapshot has all five numbers
- ☐ The break-even is calculated and rounded up
- ☐ The first-month target is a naira figure, not a hope
- ☐ Three honest limits are written
- ☐ The consistency check is done â€" all numbers match

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Build the one-page plan and financial snapshot for a **different business** than your own, using the supplied scenario and figures. Do not copy the FastFix model â€" use the new numbers.

Scenario. *Adaeze Tailoring* is a small tailoring service in Port Harcourt, owned by **Adaeze Eze**. She makes dresses, skirts and blouses for women in GRA and Trans-Amadi. She charges â‚¦5,000 for a dress, â‚¦3,500 for a skirt, and â‚¦2,500 for a blouse. She works from her home, so she has no rent. Her costs are: fabric (â‚¦2,000 per dress, â‚¦1,200 per skirt, â‚¦800 per blouse), thread and materials (â‚¦300 per item), transport to deliver (â‚¦500 per delivery), and data/phone credit (â‚¦2,000 per month). She wants to make â‚¦50,000 in her first month.

Requirements:

1. Fill in the one-page plan canvas for Adaeze Tailoring â€" all seven sections plus honest limits.
2. Build the financial snapshot: launch costs (assume â‚¦20,000 for a sewing machine and initial materials), monthly fixed costs, unit price, variable cost per unit, and break-even.
3. Calculate how many dresses, skirts and blouses Adaeze needs to sell to reach â‚¦50,000 in her first month. (Assume she sells equal numbers of each.)
4. Write three honest limits for Adaeze's plan.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- All seven sections are filled with specific, realistic answers.
- The financial snapshot has correct arithmetic.
- The break-even is calculated and rounded up.
- The first-month target is broken down into a number of items.
- Three honest limits are written and specific.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: Start with the financial snapshot â€" the numbers will tell you what the plan needs to say.

- Hint 2: For break-even, use the dress as the unit (it is the most common item). Fixed costs Ã· profit per dress = number of dresses to break-even.
- Hint 3: For the first-month target, divide â‚¦50,000 by the average price of the three items to get a rough number of items, then adjust.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

One-page plan canvas â€" Adaeze Tailoring:

```
1. WHO WE SERVE
   Women in GRA and Trans-Amadi who need custom dresses,
   skirts and blouses for work and events.

2. THE PROBLEM
   "I need a dress for an event and the ready-made ones
   do not fit me well."

3. WHAT WE SELL
   Custom-made dresses, skirts and blouses, measured to
   fit, delivered to your home.

4. HOW WE PRICE
   Per item. Dress â‚¦5,000, skirt â‚¦3,500, blouse â‚¦2,500.

5. HOW CUSTOMERS FIND US
   WhatsApp Business and word of mouth. First action:
   post photos of recent work to WhatsApp Status and
   message 10 past customers.

6. WHAT IT COSTS US
   Launch â‚¦20,000 | Monthly fixed â‚¦2,000 (data/phone)
   Break-even: 5 dresses per month (see snapshot)

7. FIRST-MONTH TARGET AND NEXT 30 DAYS
   Revenue target: â‚¦50,000
   Day 1: Take photos of 3 recent dresses.
   Day 2: Post photos to WhatsApp Status.
   Day 3: Message 10 past customers with the new catalogue.
   Day 4: Post a "how to measure yourself" tip.
   Day 5: Ask a happy customer for a testimonial.
   Day 6: Post the testimonial.
   Day 7: Review numbers and plan week two.

HONEST LIMITS
1. I have not yet proven that 10 past customers will
   respond to my message. I will test this in week one.
2. I have not yet tracked how much transport actually
   costs per delivery. I will record every delivery cost.
3. I have not yet confirmed how long a dress takes me.
   I will time myself on the next three dresses.
```

Financial snapshot â€" Adaeze Tailoring:

```
LAUNCH COSTS
  Sewing machine        â‚¦15,000
  Initial materials     â‚¦5,000
  TOTAL LAUNCH          â‚¦20,000

MONTHLY FIXED COSTS
  Data and phone        â‚¦2,000
  TOTAL FIXED           â‚¦2,000

UNIT ECONOMICS (dress)
  Unit price            â‚¦5,000
  Variable cost         â‚¦2,800 (fabric 2,000 + materials 300 + transport 500)
  Profit per dress      â‚¦2,200

BREAK-EVEN
  â‚¦2,000 Ã· â‚¦2,200 = 0.91 â†’ 1 dress per month to break even

FIRST-MONTH TARGET
  â‚¦50,000 Ã· â‚¦5,000 (dress) = 10 dresses
```

```
(Or a mix: 5 dresses + 5 skirts + 5 blouses =
 â‚¦25,000 + â‚¦17,500 + â‚¦12,500 = â‚¦55,000)
```

Note: Adaeze's break-even is very low (1 dress) because she has almost no fixed costs. This is realistic for a home-based service business â€" and it is a strength, not a weakness. The plan should say this.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- All seven sections filled with specific answers (3)
- Financial snapshot has correct arithmetic (2)
- Break-even calculated and rounded up (1)
- First-month target broken down into items (2)
- Three honest limits written and specific (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Chidi Okonkwo* â€" the FastFix Phone Repair owner from our running example â€" has been operating for six months. He followed the plan he built in this course. Here is what happened:

- **Month 1:** He did 8 screen replacements and 12 battery replacements. He earned â‚¦104,000. His fixed costs were â‚¦12,000. He made â‚¦28,000 net.
- **Month 2:** He did 10 screen replacements and 15 battery replacements. He earned â‚¦145,000. He made â‚¦41,000 net.
- **Month 3:** A competitor opened in the same market. Chidi's screen replacements dropped to 6 for the month. He earned â‚¦82,000. He made â‚¦18,000 net.

The problem. Chidi is worried. His income dropped in Month 3. He is thinking about lowering his prices to match the competitor. He comes to you â€" his CEA instructor â€" for advice.

Relevant facts.

- Chidi's break-even is 4 screen replacements per month. He did 6 in Month 3 â€" still above break-even, but barely.
- The competitor charges â‚¦7,000 for a screen replacement â€" â‚¦1,000 less than Chidi.
- Chidi has a 30-day warranty; the competitor does not.
- Chidi has 40 WhatsApp Business contacts who have bought from him before. The competitor has no customer list.
- Chidi's validation notes show that customers chose him because of the warranty and the same-day service, not because of price.

Decision point. What should Chidi do â€" lower his prices, or something else?

Possible approaches.

1. Lower his screen replacement price to â‚¦7,000 to match the competitor.
2. Keep his price at â‚¦8,000 and emphasise the warranty and same-day service in his marketing.
3. Add a new service â€" phone cleaning and software updates â€" at â‚¦1,500, to bring in extra revenue.
4. Do nothing and wait to see if the competitor leaves.

Recommended solution. Approach 2, with elements of Approach 3.

Reasoning:

- Approach 1 starts a price war. If Chidi lowers to â‚¦7,000, the competitor may lower to â‚¦6,000. Chidi's break-even rises from 4 to 5 screen replacements per month â€" he needs more work just to survive. And he loses the margin that makes the business worth running.
- Approach 2 plays to Chidi's strengths. His validation notes show customers chose him for the warranty and same-day service â€" not price. He should remind his 40 existing customers of this. A WhatsApp broadcast to his customer list is free and takes 10 minutes.
- Approach 3 adds a low-cost, high-margin service. A phone cleaning and software update costs Chidi almost nothing (his time and a small amount of data) but can earn â‚¦1,500. If he does 10 of these in a month, that is â‚¦15,000 â€" almost enough to cover his fixed costs on its own.
- Approach 4 is passive. The competitor is not going to leave because Chidi ignores them. Chidi needs to act â€" but act on his strengths, not his weaknesses.

What Chidi actually did (the real ending): Chidi kept his price at â¦8,000. He sent a WhatsApp broadcast to his 40 customers: "Screen replacement with 30-day warranty â€" same-day service at Mile 3 Market. Reply 'SCREEN' for a quote." He got 12 replies and did 8 screen replacements in two weeks. He also added phone cleaning at â¦1,500 and did 15 in the month. His Month 4 revenue was â¦98,000 â€" back above his Month 2 level. He did not lower his price once.

Professional connection. This is why the capstone requires a financial snapshot and a marketing plan. Without the snapshot, Chidi would not have known his break-even was 4 â€" and he might have panicked and cut prices. Without the marketing plan, he would not have known to message his 40 existing customers. The plan is not a document you file and forget â€" it is the tool you use when things get difficult.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Blank sections on the plan

Symptoms: One or more of the seven sections is empty or says "TBD." **Likely cause:** The learner has not found the document that holds the answer, or has not made the decision yet. **How to investigate:** Ask "which document has this answer?" If the learner does not know, point to the relevant session's artefact. **Corrective steps:** Open the working folder, find the document, transfer the answer to the plan. **How to confirm resolved:** Every section has a real answer â€" no blanks, no "TBD." **Prevention:** Before the session, check that the learner's folder has all seven documents from Sessions 1â€"8.

K.2 Numbers that do not match across documents

Symptoms: The price in the plan is â¦8,000 but the price list says â¦6,000. Or the break-even in the snapshot does not match the one in the plan. **Likely cause:** The learner changed a number in one place and forgot to change it everywhere. **How to investigate:** Pick one number (the unit price) and trace it through the plan, the price list, and the snapshot. Where does it change? **Corrective steps:** Decide which number is correct, then update every document to match. **How to confirm resolved:** The same number appears everywhere it is mentioned. **Prevention:** Do the consistency check (Section H, step 10) before finishing the plan.

K.3 Break-even not rounded up

Symptoms: The break-even is written as "3.43 jobs per month." **Likely cause:** The learner did the division but did not round up. **How to investigate:** Ask "can you do 0.43 of a job?" The learner will say no. **Corrective steps:** Round up to the next whole number. 3.43 becomes 4. **How to confirm resolved:** The break-even is a whole number. **Prevention:** Remind the class that break-even is always rounded up â€" you cannot do a fraction of a job.

K.4 Vague first-month target

Symptoms: The target is "as much as I can" or "a lot of customers." **Likely cause:** The learner has not calculated a naira figure. **How to investigate:** Ask "how many jobs is that? At what price?" **Corrective steps:** Calculate: number of jobs Ã— price = revenue target. Write the naira figure. **How to confirm resolved:** The target is a specific naira amount. **Prevention:** The financial snapshot requires a first-month target â€" build it there first, then transfer it to the plan.

K.5 Honest limits are vague

Symptoms: The honest limits say "I need to learn more" or "I hope it works." **Likely cause:** The learner does not understand what an honest limit is. **How to investigate:** Ask "what specifically do you not know yet? What will you do to find out?" **Corrective steps:** Write three specific unknowns and three specific tests. "I have not proven that 20 contacts will reply. I will test this by messaging 20 contacts in week one and recording the replies." **How to confirm resolved:** Each limit names a specific unknown and a specific test. **Prevention:** Explain that honest limits are experiments, not confessions.

K.6 Pitch is too long

Symptoms: The pitch goes over 90 seconds. **Likely cause:** The learner is including too much detail â€" background, history, multiple services. **How to investigate:** Time the pitch. Where does it go over? **Corrective steps:** Cut everything except who, problem, what, price, next step. Practice with a timer. **How to confirm resolved:** The pitch is 60 seconds or less. **Prevention:** Rehearse with a timer before the viva. Sixty seconds is shorter than you think.

K.7 Pitch is too vague

Symptoms: The pitch says "I do phone repair" and "I charge reasonable prices." **Likely cause:** The learner has not used the costed price list or the offer sheet. **How to investigate:** Ask "what is your starting price? What is your deliverable?" **Corrective steps:** Fill in the specific price and the specific deliverable from the documents. **How to confirm resolved:** The pitch names a specific price and a specific deliverable. **Prevention:** The pitch structure (Section F.5) requires a price and a deliverable â€" do not let the learner skip them.

K.8 The learner cannot answer one of the four viva questions

Symptoms: The learner freezes or bluffs when asked "why this price?" or "what is your break-even?" **Likely cause:** The learner has not connected the question to the document that holds the answer. **How to investigate:** Ask "which document has the answer to that question?" **Corrective steps:** Open the document, find the answer, practise saying it out loud. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can answer all four questions without bluffing. **Prevention:** Before the viva, have the learner practise the four questions with a partner.

K.9 The supporting pack is incomplete

Symptoms: The learner submits the plan but only one or two supporting documents. **Likely cause:** The learner does not understand that the pack is the evidence. **How to investigate:** Ask "which document proves your price? Which proves your validation?" **Corrective steps:** Identify the missing documents and add them to the folder. **How to confirm resolved:** At least three supporting documents are in the folder. **Prevention:** The capstone checklist (Section F.6) lists the seven possible documents â€" check the folder against it before submission.

K.10 The learner apologises for the plan

Symptoms: The learner says "I know it is not very good" or "I am not really a business person." **Likely cause:** The learner is comparing themselves to an imaginary perfect businessperson. **How to investigate:** Ask "what is one thing in this plan that you are sure about?" **Corrective steps:** Point out the sections that are strong. Remind the learner that the plan is a first version, not a final exam. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can name one strong thing about the plan. **Prevention:** Normalise imperfection from the start. Say: "Every business plan is a first draft. The goal is not perfection â€" it is honesty and clarity."

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: Check before fixing â€" trace the number, time the pitch, ask which document holds the answer. Confirm the cause, then correct.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Capstone Pack â€" Plan, Snapshot, Pitch and Evidence"

Purpose: To assemble the complete capstone submission â€" the one-page business plan, the financial snapshot, the written pitch, and the supporting pack â€" and to rehearse the pitch for the viva. This is the final assignment of the course and the document that earns the CEA certificate.

Realistic scenario. You are a business owner in Port Harcourt. You have spent eight sessions building your offer, validating your market, pricing your work, writing your pitch, agreeing your scope, invoicing a sample job, setting up your records, and building your digital presence. Now you assemble everything into the capstone: the document you will show to mentors, partners, and customers â€" and the pitch you will deliver when someone asks "what do you do?"

Detailed instructions:

1. Open your working folder (`CEA-Biz-FirstnameLastname`). Check that you have all seven documents from Sessions 1â€"8: offer sheet, validation notes, costed price list, pitch script, client agreement, sample invoice, tracker, WhatsApp Business profile, seven-day marketing plan.
2. Fill in the one-page plan canvas (Section F.4) for your own business â€" all seven sections plus honest limits.
3. Build or update your financial snapshot (Worksheet 9.1) â€" launch costs, fixed costs, unit price, variable cost, break-even, first-month target.
4. Do the consistency check: trace every number in your plan back to the document it came from. Fix any mismatches.
5. Write your 60-second pitch (Section F.5 structure) and practise it with a timer until it is 60 seconds or less.
6. Prepare answers to the four viva questions: why this price, how validated, what break-even, what first seven days.
7. Assemble your supporting pack: at least three documents from the checklist (Section F.6).

8. Share your folder with the instructor.

Required deliverables:

- A complete one-page business plan (Google Doc or photographed handwritten page).
- A financial snapshot (Google Sheets or photographed handwritten page).
- A written 60-second pitch (in the same Doc or a separate one).
- A supporting pack of at least three documents.
- A shared Google Drive folder with all of the above.

Submission format: Share your Google Drive folder with the instructor's email. If you do not have Google Drive, photograph each page clearly and send via WhatsApp or email. Voice-note submissions of the pitch are acceptable if typing is a barrier.

Deadline: Before the viva session (the final class). The instructor will confirm the exact date.

Marking rubric (10 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Plan completeness	2	All seven sections filled â€" no blanks, no "TBD"
Financial snapshot accuracy	2	All five numbers present; arithmetic correct; break-even rounded up
Internal consistency	1	Numbers in the plan match the price list and the snapshot
Pitch clarity	2	60 seconds or less; names customer, problem, deliverable, price, next step
Viva readiness	2	Can answer all four questions without bluffing; answers come from documents
Honest limits	1	Three specific unknowns and three specific tests

Common mistakes to avoid: blank sections; numbers that do not match across documents; break-even not rounded up; vague first-month target; honest limits that are vague; pitch over 90 seconds; pitch without a specific price; supporting pack with fewer than three documents; apologising for the plan instead of fixing it.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

The instructor's reference solution is the FastFix Phone Repair plan built live in Section G. Use it as the model â€" not as the only correct answer. A learner's plan for their own business will differ in content but should match the FastFix plan in structure, specificity and internal consistency.

Key marks of a strong learner plan:

- Every section has a specific, realistic answer â€" not "TBD" or "as much as I can."
- The customer is a specific person or group, not "everybody."
- The problem is one sentence, in the customer's words.
- The deliverable is clear â€" what the customer receives, not just the skill.
- The price matches the costed price list.
- The break-even is calculated and rounded up.
- The first-month target is a naira figure.
- Three honest limits name specific unknowns and specific tests.
- The pitch is 60 seconds and names a specific price.
- The supporting pack has at least three documents.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key below.)

Q1. Short answer. What are the seven sections of the one-page plan canvas, in order?

Q2. Multiple choice. Which of these is the best example of a "who we serve" statement? a) "Everyone with a phone." b) "Phone owners in Diobu and Trans-Amadi who need same-day repair." c) "People who break their screens." d) "All my customers."

Q3. Calculation. A business has monthly fixed costs of â‚¦15,000. Each job brings in â‚¦6,000 and costs â‚¦3,500 in materials and transport. What is the break-even number of jobs per month? (Round up.)

Q4. True or false. A one-page business plan should be at least five pages long to be taken seriously.

Q5. Explain. Why is the honest-limits section the most important part of the plan?

Q6. Scenario. A learner's plan says "I charge â‚¦8,000 for a screen replacement" but their costed price list says â‚¦6,000. What is the problem, and how should they fix it?

Q7. Match the question to the document. Match each viva question to the document that holds the answer. a) "Why this price?" b) "How did you validate that?" c) "What is your break-even?" d) "What will you do in your first seven days?"

1. Validation notes
2. Costed price list
3. Financial snapshot
4. Marketing plan

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q7)

A1. Who we serve / The problem / What we sell / How we price / How customers find us / What it costs us / First-month target and next 30 days.

A2. (b) "Phone owners in Diobu and Trans-Amadi who need same-day repair." (It is specific â€” a real place, a real need, a real service. The others are too vague.)

A3. Fixed costs â‚¦15,000 Ã· profit per job (â‚¦6,000 â^' â‚¦3,500 = â‚¦2,500) = 6 jobs per month. (Exactly 6 â€” no rounding needed, but if the result were 6.2, the answer would be 7.)

A4. False. A one-page plan is one page by design. Its power is that it forces decisions. A longer plan is for banks and investors, not for a beginner business owner.

A5. Because it shows the learner knows what they do not know â€” and has a plan to find out. A plan that claims to know everything cannot be trusted. Honest limits are a sign of a real businessperson, not a weakness. They also tell the learner (and the instructor) what to test next.

A6. The problem is an internal inconsistency â€” the plan and the price list disagree. The learner should check which number is correct (by recalculating from cost), then update both documents so they match. Every number in the plan must trace back to a document.

A7. a) 2 (Costed price list), b) 1 (Validation notes), c) 3 (Financial snapshot), d) 4 (Marketing plan).

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you built the thing this whole course has been pointing toward: your one-page business plan. You learned that a plan is not a long document â€” it is **seven decisions on one page**: who you serve, the problem, what you sell, how you price, how customers find you, what it costs, and what you will do in the first month. You learned that the financial snapshot is five numbers and one division â€” and that those numbers must match everywhere they appear. You learned that the pitch is sixty seconds: who, problem, what, price, next step. You learned that the viva is four questions â€” why this price, how validated, what break-even, what first seven days â€” and that every answer comes from a document you already have. And you learned that the honest-limits section is the most important writing on the page, because it shows you know what you do not know.

Five important takeaways:

1. **A one-page plan is seven decisions** â€” not a creative writing exercise, not a summary, but a set of choices you can defend.
2. **The financial snapshot is five numbers** â€” launch costs, fixed costs, unit price, variable cost, break-even â€” and they must match the price list.
3. **The pitch is sixty seconds** â€” who, problem, what, price, next step. If you cannot say it in sixty seconds, you do not understand it yet.
4. **The viva is four questions** â€” and every answer comes from a document. No bluffing, no improvising.
5. **Honest limits are strength, not weakness** â€” they show you know what to test next.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I fill in all seven sections of the plan canvas without leaving a blank?
- Can I calculate my break-even and say it out loud in plain language?
- Can I deliver my pitch in sixty seconds or less?
- Can I answer "why this price?" by pointing to my costed price list?
- Can I name three things my plan has not yet proven â€" and three tests I will run?

Course wrap-up â€" "From Zero to Expert, Together."

Nine sessions ago, you walked in with a skill and no plan. Today you walked out with a business on one page, a financial snapshot that proves the numbers work, a pitch you can deliver in sixty seconds, and a folder full of evidence â€" an offer, validation notes, a price list, an agreement, an invoice, a tracker, a WhatsApp Business profile, and a marketing plan.

That is not a small thing. Most people with a skill never write any of it down. Most market traders, most freelancers, most side-hustlers run on instinct and memory â€" and when things go wrong, they do not know why. You now know why. You can look at your plan and see where the numbers do not match. You can look at your break-even and know how many jobs you need to survive. You can look at your honest limits and know what to test next.

But â€" and this is the honest truth â€" **the plan is not the business**. The business is the first customer you serve, the first job you finish well, the first invoice you send, the first testimonial you earn. The plan is the map. The business is the walk.

So here is what you do next, in your first seven days:

1. **Day 1:** Finish your WhatsApp Business catalogue. Add your three best items with photos and prices.
2. **Day 2:** Message 20 contacts. Not 200 â€" 20. People you know, people who might need your service or know someone who does.
3. **Day 3:** Post your first WhatsApp Status. A photo of your work, your price, and how to reach you.
4. **Day 4:** Ask your first customer â€" or your first contact â€" for honest feedback. What did they expect? What did they get?
5. **Day 5:** Post a testimonial or a before-and-after photo. Real work, real words.
6. **Day 6:** Open your tracker. Write down every naira that came in and every naira that went out. All week.
7. **Day 7:** Review your plan. What worked? What did not? Update the plan. It is a living document â€" it should change as you learn.

And then you do it again. And again. That is how a business is built â€" not in one day, but in seven-day cycles, for weeks and months, until the plan in your head and the plan on paper and the business in the market are all the same thing.

You came to Cyber Elias Academy as a beginner. You are leaving as someone who can define an offer, validate a market, price with cost and profit in mind, quote, sell, agree scope, invoice and chase payment, keep simple records, set up a free digital presence, and explain the whole thing on one page and in sixty seconds.

That is not "expert" in the sense of knowing everything. It is "expert" in the sense of **being able to do the basics properly** â€" which is more than most people ever learn. From zero to expert, together. You did it.

What to do if you want to keep going:

- Take the CEA Content Creation course to sharpen your marketing.
- Take the CEA Cybersecurity course to protect your digital presence.
- Take the CEA Computer Basics course to speed up your admin.
- Join the CEA alumni practice sessions â€" bring your plan, get feedback, keep improving.
- Update your plan every month. The best business plan is the one that is never finished.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- The learner fills all seven sections of the plan canvas without being prompted â€" and every answer is specific, not vague.
- The learner calculates break-even correctly and rounds up without being reminded.
- The learner traces a number from the plan back to the source document when asked.
- The learner delivers the pitch in 60 seconds or less, naming a specific price and a specific deliverable.
- The learner answers all four viva questions without bluffing â€" and points to the document that holds each answer.

- The learner writes three honest limits that name specific unknowns and specific tests.
- The learner's supporting pack has at least three documents, and the learner can explain what each one proves.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "A plan is a creative writing exercise." â†' No â€" every sentence is a decision you will act on.
- "The financial snapshot is accounting, and accounting is too hard for me." â†' It is five numbers and one division. If you can calculate change, you can build a snapshot.
- "The pitch is about being charismatic." â†' No â€" it is about being clear. A clear, honest, specific pitch beats a smooth, vague one every time.
- "The viva is an exam I can fail." â†' It is a rehearsal for real conversations. The questions are the questions customers and mentors actually ask.
- "Honest limits are confessions of weakness." â†' They are experiments. They show you know what to test next â€" which is a sign of strength.
- "The plan is finished now." â†' The plan is a living document. It should be updated every month as you learn.
- "I need to lower my prices when a competitor appears." â†' Not necessarily. Check your break-even first. Compete on your strengths, not your weaknesses.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Section-by-section assembly:** If the learner cannot fill the whole canvas, fill one section at a time across three sessions. Start with "who we serve" and "what we sell" â€" the easiest sections.
2. **Break-even drill:** Give five simple scenarios (fixed costs, price, variable cost) and ask the learner to calculate break-even for each. Repeat until it is automatic.
3. **Pitch timer drill:** Have the learner deliver the pitch while you time it. Cut whatever makes it go over 60 seconds. Repeat until it fits.
4. **Viva rehearsal:** Have the learner practise the four viva questions with a partner. The partner asks the questions; the learner answers from their documents. Repeat until the learner can answer without bluffing.
5. **Consistency check drill:** Give the learner a plan with three deliberate mismatches (price in plan does not match price list, break-even does not match snapshot, first action does not match marketing plan). Ask them to find and fix the mismatches.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a plan canvas with the first three sections already filled in (from the learner's offer sheet). The learner fills sections 4â€"7 and the honest limits. Provide a financial snapshot with the numbers filled in â€" the learner only calculates the break-even.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full plan, full snapshot, full pitch, full viva.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** The learner builds the plan for their own business **and** for a second, different business (e.g., a product business if their main plan is a service business). They also write a 30-day action plan with specific, dated tasks â€" not just "message 20 contacts" but "message 20 contacts by 10am on Day 2, record replies in tracker by 5pm." They also identify one risk in their plan and write a one-paragraph contingency.

Capstone links:

- This session is the capstone. The plan, snapshot, pitch and pack assembled here are the submission marked against the rubric in `Part6_Capstone_Project/01_Capstone_Assessment_Rubric.md`.
- The viva is marked as 5% of the total score (see Section 10.1 of the Course Design Document).
- The capstone is 30% of the total score and is a **pass/fail gate** â€" a learner cannot pass the course without passing the capstone, regardless of other marks.
- After this session, the instructor marks the capstone, conducts the viva, and confirms the learner's certification. The certificate is issued on successful completion of the capstone and its defence.

Timing guidance. The priority is **learners assembling their own plans** (Sections H and I). If the room is slow, shorten Section J (the case study) to a 5-minute mention and reduce the number of viva questions demonstrated in G.4 from four to two. Protect assembly and pitch time â€" a learner who leaves without a complete plan and a rehearsed pitch has no capstone to submit.

END OF SESSION 9

Next: Capstone marking, viva, and certification. Congratulations â€" you have reached the end of the course.